

OCHA

2005

OFFICE FOR THE COORDINATION OF HUMANITARIAN AFFAIRS

ANNUAL REPORT

ACTIVITIES AND USE OF EXTRABUDGETARY FUNDS



United Nations

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OCHA'S MISSION

The mission of the Office for the Coordination of Humanitarian Affairs (OCHA) is to mobilise and coordinate effective and principled humanitarian action in partnership with national and international actors in order to:

- alleviate human suffering in disasters and emergencies;
- advocate for the rights of people in need;
- promote preparedness and prevention; and
- facilitate sustainable solutions.

TABLE OF CONTENTS

Foreword

Part I Financial Information and Analysis

Introduction	1
How OCHA is Funded	2
Donor Funding in 2005	4
Core Activities	4
Headquarters Projects	5
Integrated Regional Information Networks (IRIN)	5
Field Coordination Activities	5
Budgetary Cash Reserve Fund (BCRF)	6
Earmarked, Loosely Earmarked and Unearmarked Contributions	6
Timeliness of Contributions	6
Expenditure	9
Carry-Over	11
Management of Cash Resources	13
Building Partnerships	15
Accountability and Risk Management	16
Key Financial Tables	18
Explanation of Financial Statements and Terminology	18
Statement of Income and Expenditure in 2005	22
Extra-budgetary Requirements and Expenditures in 2005	24
Donor Contributions in 2005	26
Voluntary Contributions to OCHA in 2005 From the Top 20 Donors	27
Voluntary Contributions to OCHA by Activity in 2005	30

Part II Headquarters Core Activities and Projects

Executive Management	33
Office of the Under-Secretary-General/Emergency Relief Coordinator, Deputy Emergency Relief Coordinator, Director, NY; and Assistant Emergency Relief Coordinator/Director, Geneva	33
Donor and External Relations Section (Project)	35
Executive and Administrative Offices	37
Field Support Section	39
Staff Development and Learning Section	40
Inter-Agency Standing Committee/Executive Committee on Humanitarian Affairs (IASC/ECHA) Secretariat ..	42
Emergency Response Coordination	44
Coordination and Response Division	44
Consolidated Appeals Process Strengthening Section	46
Surge Capacity and Contingency Planning Section	48
Disaster Preparedness Project	50
Emergency Services Branch	52
Field Coordination Support Section (Project)	53
UNDAC Developing Countries Deployment and Training Project	55
Civil Military Coordination Section (Project)	56
Logistics Support Unit (Project)	58
Environmental Emergencies Section (Project)	60
Internal Displacement Division	62
Policy Development	64
Policy Development and Studies Branch	64
Protection of Civilians Project	66
Evaluation and Studies Project	68
Gender Equality Project	69
Advocacy and Information Management	71
Advocacy and Information Management Branch	71
Advocacy Section	72
Information Analysis Section	74
Early Warning and Contingency Planning Unit	74
ReliefWeb Project	75

Field Information Support Section (Project)	77
Field Information Management Project	79
Information and Communications Technology Section	80

Part III Coordination Activities in the Field

Integrated Regional Information Networks (IRIN)	84
Africa	86
Angola	88
Burundi	90
Central African Republic	92
Chad	94
Côte d'Ivoire	96
Democratic Republic of the Congo	98
Eritrea	100
Ethiopia	102
Guinea	104
Liberia - Humanitarian Information Centre	106
Niger	108
Republic of Congo	110
Sierra Leone	112
Somalia	114
Sudan	116
Uganda	120
Zimbabwe	122
Regional Office for Southern Africa	124
Regional Office for Central and East Africa	126
Regional Office for West Africa	128
Middle East	130
occupied Palestinian territory	132
Regional Office for the Middle East, North Africa, Iran and Afghanistan	134
Asia	136
Democratic People's Republic of Korea	138
Indonesia	140
Islamic Republic of Iran	142
Nepal	144
Regional Disaster Response Advisor for Asia	146
Regional Disaster Response Advisor for the Pacific	148
Regional Office for Asia and the Pacific	150
Europe	152
Russian Federation	154
Americas and the Caribbean	156
Colombia	158
Haiti ...	160
Regional Office for Latin America and the Caribbean	162

Part IV Sudden-Onset Disaster Coordination Activities

Indian Ocean Tsunami	165
Indonesia, Maldives, Myanmar, Seychelles, Somalia, Sri Lanka, Thailand, Lessons Learned	
South Asia Earthquake	175
Pakistan	175

Annexes

I. In-kind and Other Contributions	179
II. Afghanistan and the Afghanistan Emergency Trust Fund (AETF)	180
III. Central Emergency Revolving Fund (CERF)	182

Acronyms

FOREWORD

Welcome to OCHA's Annual Report 2005, the third I have had the pleasure of presenting since becoming Under-Secretary-General for Humanitarian Affairs and Emergency Relief Coordinator. I am happy to note that each of these has improved on the last, providing more comprehensive financial reporting and a clearer focus on performance throughout the organisation.

Looking back, I am struck by what an exceptional year it was in terms of the scope, if not the number, of natural disasters and other humanitarian emergencies to which OCHA responded. It was only as a result of the strong support from our partners that we could do so, providing the coordination needed to strengthen humanitarian responses to natural disasters and complex emergencies, while engaging in robust advocacy for vulnerable populations and neglected emergencies.

The Annual Report represents OCHA's commitment to transparency, to accounting for our income and expenditure on humanitarian imperatives, and to continuously improving the efficiency with which we manage and use our resources. The report, a crucial element in our strategic planning cycle, establishes the use of funding in the context of OCHA's achievements, and as measured against objectives, activities and performance indicators. While we continued to focus throughout 2005 on our primary concerns of providing strong advocacy, increasing access, improving response capacity and regional networks and broadening partnerships, we also revised our objectives in support of the humanitarian reform process and in the face of the year's major crises.

2005 was a year book-ended by two catastrophic natural disasters. On December 26, 2004 the Indian Ocean earthquake and tsunami took more than two hundred thousand lives and destroyed millions of livelihoods in 12 countries in Southeast Asia and Africa. Later, in October 2005, the South Asia earthquake struck, devastating large areas of northeastern Pakistan and parts of India.

Throughout the course of the year, civilians across the globe suffered from the cruelty of conflict in the DRC, Sudan, northern Uganda, Nepal, and Colombia, while millions more were affected by natural disasters ranging from drought in Niger, the Horn of Africa and southern Africa, to floods and mudslides resulting from hurricanes and tropical storms in Guatemala and throughout the Caribbean.

To complement the coordination support provided by our field offices in complex emergencies and natural disasters, we expanded our network of regional support offices and advisors to better address developments with cross-border and regional implications, including in the areas of early warning, contingency planning and response preparedness.

2005 was a year punctuated by having to scale up, often as a matter of great urgency, to cope with the humanitarian requirements of rapid-onset crises even as elsewhere we were planning to scale back our involvement, close operations, or manage a hand-over to recovery and development partners. Even as OCHA was responding to the tsunami, elsewhere we were scaling back, transitioning out of Liberia, Angola and the DPRK. However, before we can transition out, we need our partners in place, and too often OCHA has been forced to stay in countries longer than needed or planned because we have not been able to effect the planned hand-over.

During the year, we continued our emphasis on performance and evaluation, focusing on lessons learned, mistakes to be avoided and successes to be built upon. In particular, real-time evaluation in the field in Darfur helped develop an approach that promises to strengthen continuing and future humanitarian interventions. With the tsunami response, OCHA also learned valuable lessons and took on board recommendations from internal and external audits.

The number and intensity of the conflicts and disasters in 2005 clearly underline the need for stronger contingency planning, risk management, emergency preparedness, capacity building and predictability in response by the humanitarian community at local, national, regional and global levels.

The breadth and scale of the humanitarian response following the Indian Ocean tsunami presented us with unprecedented challenges. An urgent Flash Appeal, coordinated by OCHA, sought US\$ 977 million for a strategic and coordinated response to the needs of some five million people, and resulted in an unprecedented outpouring from governments, NGOs, civil society and the private sector. This should be the rule, not the exception, for every crisis. On our part, to ensure the highest standards of accountability and transparency, OCHA developed a new partnership with a private sector accounting firm, and instituted real-time, online financial

tracking. Both have raised the bar and set new standards for UN humanitarian operations.

All the while, conflict-related suffering on an enormous scale continued to require significant commitment in DRC and in Sudan, OCHA's largest field operation. While the crisis in DRC remains acute, despite the challenges in Darfur we made huge strides last year. Working together, UN Agencies and our NGO partners have reduced deaths among displaced people in Darfur by two-thirds from their 2004 levels while halving malnutrition rates in 2005. Unfortunately, despite these gains, this crisis and many others remain intractable and under-funded.

By 2005's end, when an earthquake devastated north-eastern Pakistan, against all odds and racing against the clock the humanitarian community was able to prevent a much-feared, massive loss of life in the days and weeks following the deadly quake. The quick response from the Government of Pakistan, combined with effective civil-military coordination and assistance, enabled us to provide critically needed aid in one of the toughest logistical operations the humanitarian community has ever faced.

Such large humanitarian operations, urgent and extremely demanding by their very nature, place considerable strain on humanitarian organisations and require sustained institutional, organisational and funding support. Broadening partnerships for humanitarian response is a crucial element of this support, and last year OCHA adopted a regional approach, developing tailor-made strategies and institutionalising policy dialogues with each regional group.

We all recognise that we must continue our work on improving response capacity, and in 2005 the humanitarian community embarked on the path-breaking Humanitarian Reform agenda. We at OCHA are proud of the part we have played in developing the mechanisms to support three important pillars of the reform: implementation of the Cluster Approach, strengthening of the Humanitarian Coordinators (HC) system, and establishment of the Central Emergency Response Fund (CERF).

As part of the Reform, in December 2005 the General Assembly approved the addition of a US\$ 450 million grant facility to the Central Emergency Revolving Fund, creating the Central Emergency Response Fund – the first element of the S-G's reform to be implemented. The introduction of the new CERF should allow humanitarian partners to rapidly address core emergency humanitarian needs when lives are most at risk, both

from rapid-onset crises and from under-funded emergencies.

Consultative meetings with regional groups and donor partners throughout the year also lead to real progress in improving the predictability of humanitarian response when IASC partners approved the cluster approach to emergency action, which endorses the concept of working together in well-coordinated clusters, with specific sectoral responsibility and accountability.

The approach, piloted in three countries during 2005, was also partially employed during the extremely challenging relief operations in Pakistan at the end of the year, and its use will be broadened over time to new and existing emergencies. OCHA's field role will be to facilitate the work of these clusters, respond to common inter-cluster issues and take a lead on information management.

2005 also demonstrated the important leadership role of Humanitarian Coordinators in relief operations, given their increasing scale and complexity, and the need to strengthen the support of the humanitarian community to the HC. Accordingly, OCHA also took the lead in developing mechanisms to ensure the strengthening of the HC system through systematic training of HCs and the development of a deeper pool of qualified candidates.

The scale and scope of responses, especially as humanitarian emergencies become more complex or protracted, also has cost implications for OCHA, requiring us to continually address the need for more predictable and flexible, yet accountable, financing. We appreciate the generous support of donors for OCHA itself, especially the trend toward unearmarked funding.

Improving our response to crises and emergencies requires us to continue working with partners, new and old, on strengthening and creating better structures of support and response. OCHA will continue to work on strengthening humanitarian response and enhancing the performance of humanitarian assistance, and we look forward to the continued support, collaboration and engagement of our partners in building the mechanisms to respond more rapidly, efficiently and effectively to humanitarian crises throughout the world.

Jan Egeland
May 2006

PART I

FINANCIAL INFORMATION AND ANALYSIS



OCHA/IRIN

INTRODUCTION

The Annual Report 2005 is OCHA's main reporting tool for donors and the international community, sharing with stakeholders what has been accomplished during the calendar year. In accordance with the Good Humanitarian Donorship initiative, the report presents, in one all-inclusive publication, a comprehensive picture of OCHA's performance, the overall impact of its activities, and the use of voluntary contributions to support them. It takes stock of the implementation of planned activities, provides an account on how these activities were funded and, most importantly, tries to capture the impact of these activities at the corporate level, particularly those in the field. The report complements OCHA's appeal document *OCHA in 2005 – Activities and Extra-budgetary Requirements*.

The report provides OCHA with an opportunity to account for its performance and financial responsibilities for the year. It covers the financial and programmatic elements of OCHA's core, project and field activities, while providing quantitative and qualitative analysis of performance. The report sets out to measure achievement as a step toward results-based reporting and highlights OCHA's efforts to become more strategic, accountable and transparent in its performance.

In order to provide a more meaningful analysis of the use and management of funds OCHA received, improvements have been made in the presentation of financial information. Additional explanatory narratives and graphics have been introduced in support of the financial tables to better define the different categories of activities funded under each trust fund. In this way, the report distinguishes between complex emergencies, natural disasters, headquarters projects, and humanitarian funds and other activities that were not included in *OCHA in 2005* but for which OCHA received funding.

In addition to a detailed description of OCHA's core, project and field activities, the report includes narratives on various administrative tools and methods that contribute towards its effective management of funds, such as accountability and risk management, building partnerships, and management of cash resources.

Information has been added on new and changing humanitarian emergency requirements that arose in the course of 2005, and which were therefore not reflected in *OCHA in 2005*. In particular, a chapter each in Part IV has been dedicated to the activities and funding requirements stemming from the Indian Ocean tsunami disaster, which made enormous demands of OCHA in 2005, as well as to the South Asia earthquake.

As in previous years, Annex I provides information on in-kind and other non-cash contributions that OCHA receives annually.

Annex II provides a brief update on the continued support provided from the Afghanistan Emergency Trust Fund.

Annex III provides an update on the status and utilisation of the revolving CERF as of 31 December 2005, and a summary of the Central Emergency Response Fund (CERF) established pursuant to General Assembly resolution 50/124 of 12 December 2005, which added a grant element to the existing loan mechanism of the CERF.

Through this report, OCHA would like to express its profound appreciation to its donors for their generous support and collaboration throughout this extraordinary year, and looks forward to strengthened partnerships in 2006. OCHA welcomes any suggestions that would enhance the usefulness of this reporting tool in meeting the needs of its donors and partners.

HOW OCHA IS FUNDED

OCHA is funded from the United Nations regular budget and from voluntary contributions, supplemented by income generated from programme support costs. Viewed against the revised requirements of *OCHA in 2005*, the regular budget share comes to seven percent, while 83 percent is derived from donor contributions and the remaining 10 percent from programme support income.

The regular budget appropriation for OCHA for the biennium 2004-2005, under Section 27: Humanitarian Assistance was US\$ 23.9 million, of which US\$ 11.7 million was approved for 2004, while the remaining US\$ 12.2 million related to the year 2005.

OCHA's share of the regular budget represents 0.6 percent of the total United Nations budget of US\$ 3.7 billion, one of the lowest proportions among Secretariat bodies.

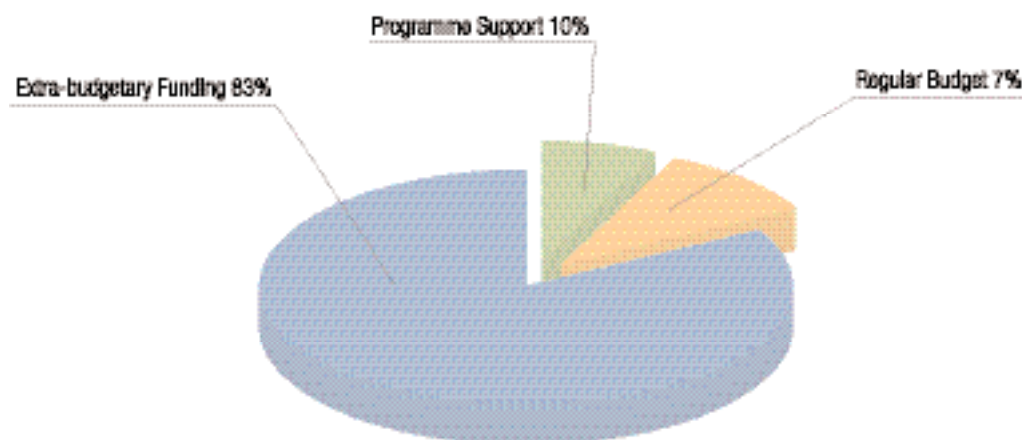
In 2005, total voluntary contributions towards planned activities outlined in *OCHA in 2005* reached US\$ 94.9 million, against requirements that were initially projected at US\$ 99.4 million and subsequently revised to US\$ 122.6 million. The revised requirements can be attributed to

new and supplementary emergency needs arising in the course of the year, particularly in Sudan and DRC, Pakistan and Nepal. Total donor contributions in 2005 represented an increase of US\$ 14.3 million or 18 percent compared to the previous year. An additional US\$ 8.7 million was received to implement various additional headquarters and field activities not included in *OCHA in 2005*.

In addition, contributions to the tsunami disaster totalled US\$ 72.7 million, of which US\$ 20.2 million was earmarked for OCHA response activities, while US\$ 49.7 million was allocated to operational agencies, based on needs, and US\$ 2.7 million was used for HRF in Somalia and other grants. There is a special section on the tsunami response, with detailed information on overall contributions, activities and funding requirements, in Part IV.

Financial support for activities that were not reflected in *OCHA in 2005* but were nevertheless funded through OCHA, such as grants for natural disasters, and humanitarian funds and other activities consisting of country humanitarian response funds, as well as funds earmarked for other implementing Agencies and NGOs but channelled through OCHA, came to US\$ 25.6 million.

Funding Sources in 2005

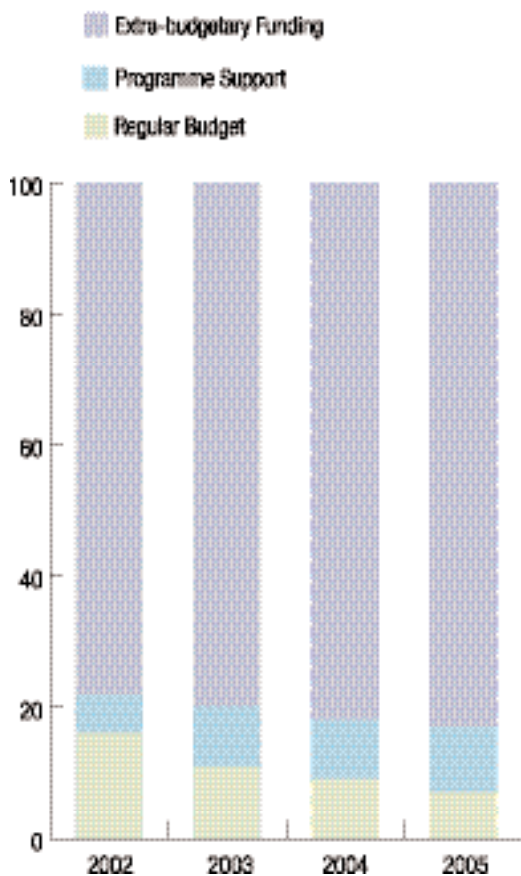


Thus, total voluntary contributions received by OCHA in 2005, as described above, amounted to US\$ 201.9 million including the Trust Fund for Tsunami Relief. For the total funds received for *OCHA in 2005*, 51 percent was earmarked and 49 percent was unearmarked.

Supplementary funding totalling US\$ 16.2 million was provided for administrative costs from the Special Account for Programme Support.

In addition, OCHA received contributions in-kind, primarily in the context of response to natural disasters and complex emergencies, comprising stand-by emergency arrangements, technical expertise, training facilities and communications equipment.

OCHA Funding 2002 - 2005



Voluntary contributions to OCHA are managed primarily through the following:

- Trust Fund for Disaster Relief (DMA), which finances humanitarian coordination activities in all countries affected by conflicts, natural disasters and industrial, environmental and technological accidents;
- Trust Fund for Strengthening of the Office of the Coordinator (DDA), which supports OCHA's core mandate for activities undertaken by headquarters that are not funded by the regular budget;
- Trust Fund for the Tsunami Disaster (TKB), which provides funding for the coordination of humanitarian assistance to victims of the Indian Ocean tsunami and other immediate recovery-related activities;
- Special Account for Programme Support (ODA), which supplements funding from the aforementioned trust funds. Resources from the special account are derived from the programme support costs applied to all trust funds administered by OCHA, normally ranging from 3 to 13 percent of annual final expenditures of the funds; and
- In-kind contributions through stand-by emergency arrangements, technical expertise, training facilities and emergency equipment.

DONOR FUNDING IN 2005

Donors generously supported OCHA's activities as outlined in *OCHA in 2005*, funding 96 percent of the original extra-budgetary requirements of US\$ 99.4 million and 77 percent of the revised requirements of US\$ 122.6 million. In addition, 49 percent of overall contributions were provided unearmarked or loosely earmarked, allowing OCHA greater flexibility in the allocation of resources to meet priority needs and ensure a more balanced overall funding of its activities.

Despite the major challenge for donors to respond to a number of large emergencies, donors contributed US\$ 94.9 million against OCHA's requirements in 2005 (revised upwards by 23 percent during the year to reflect the scale of unexpected humanitarian crises and needs), which was a US\$ 14.3 million increase on contributions in 2004.

Yet, in percentage terms, donor funding to OCHA dropped from 81 percent of revised requirements in 2004 to 78 percent in 2005.

While overall donor funding received by OCHA increased from US\$ 102 million in 2004 to US\$ 129.2 million in 2005 (excluding the Tsunami Trust Fund), both amounts included funds channelled through OCHA for grants for natural disasters, country-specific humanitarian response funds, operation of the Brindisi warehouse, and

funds prepositioned by governments for UNDAC deployment of their nationals.

Donors increasingly followed the principles of Good Humanitarian Donorship to provide a large proportion, 49 percent, of contributions fully unearmarked or loosely earmarked subject to consultations with OCHA on priorities. The disparity in coverage between field offices and between headquarters-based projects reduced considerably as a result.

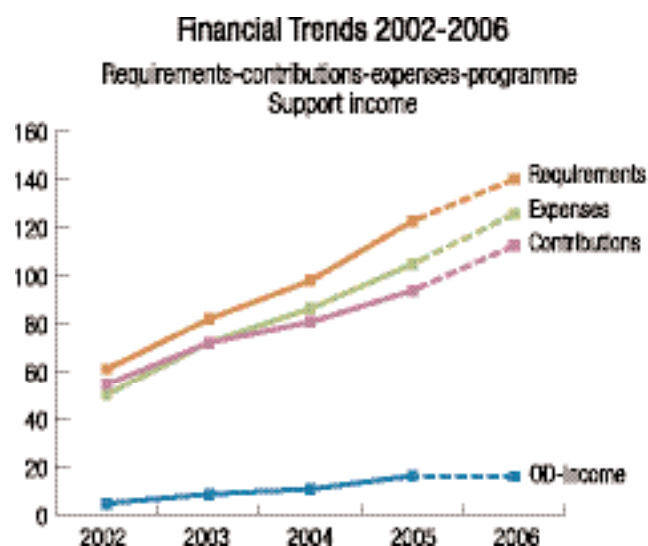
Donor funding for the activities in *OCHA in 2005* can be summarised as follows:

- Contributions for core requirements increased to US\$ 14.1 million, an increase of US\$ 2.9 million on 2004;
- Projects at headquarters level received US\$ 18.0 million, US\$ 2.1 million more than in 2004;
- IRIN was 112 percent funded, with US\$ 6.1 million in contributions, an increase of US\$ 0.9 million on 2004;
- The revised requirement for OCHA's field presence was for US\$ 74.3 million, of which US\$ 56.7 million was received, leaving a 24 percent gap. By comparison, the revised requirements for the field in 2004 were US\$ 56.7 million, with US\$ 48.3 million funded and a gap of 15 percent. More funds were received unearmarked or loosely earmarked for field coordination, which were partly channelled by OCHA through the Field Coordination Reserve Fund and exhausted at year end.

A more detailed analysis of the funding level for different requirements is provided below.

Core Activities

Voluntary contributions for extra-budgetary headquarters core activities funded from the Trust Fund for Strengthening (DDA) amounted to US\$ 14.1 million against revised requirements of US\$ 22.4 million. Although this represented only 62 percent of the total requirements, the remaining 38 percent was covered from the carry-



over from 2004 and an infusion of US\$ 5.9 million from the Special Account for Programme Support income of US\$ 16.2 million. In that way, OCHA's core requirements for 2005 were fully covered.

Headquarters Projects

US\$ 18.0 million (90 percent) of the US\$ 20.5 million requirement was received for projects at New York and Geneva headquarters. This represented an increase of US\$ 2.1 million and 12 percent over the funding received in 2004. Furthermore, because funds for headquarters were increasingly received as unearmarked, it was possible to implement nearly all planned activities. The second year of the ECHO thematic funding for information management provided a considerable injection.

Integrated Regional Information Networks (IRIN)

In 2005, IRIN received contributions of US\$ 6.1 million, an increase of 17 percent on 2004, against revised requirements for 2005 of US\$ 5.4 million. Donors have increasingly supported its activities and IRIN continues to improve its financial position, but it has not yet accumulated sufficient reserves to fully meet statutory management responsibilities and extend its staff contracts by a full year, like the rest of OCHA core staff. IRIN continues

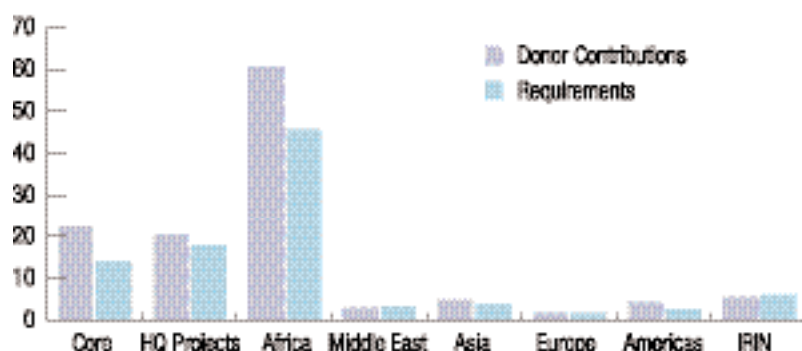
to need more predictable and timely funding to allow for the timely implementation of its "core" activities without interruption.

Field Coordination Activities

In 2005, donor contributions for OCHA's field requirements amounted to US\$ 56.7 million. Against requirements of US\$ 74.2 million, revised upwards from the original projection of US\$ 55.2 million, total donor contributions represented 76 percent. This meant that, compared to 2004 contributions of US\$ 48.3 million against annual requirements of US\$ 57.1 million (85 percent funding), the 2005 contributions widened the requirements-funding gap by nine percent.

The increase of US\$ 17.5 million over 2004 in revised requirements for field coordination was largely due to the changing situation in Sudan, which required US\$ 21.5 million compared to US\$ 8.4 million in 2004, as well as increased needs in DRC, Colombia, Côte d'Ivoire, Guinea, Nepal and Niger; the sub-regions covered by the Regional Office in Dakar; and in oPt, Somalia and Uganda. Fortunately, these increases could be offset, to a considerable extent, by the scaling down or closing of offices in Angola, Liberia, Sierra Leone, Indonesia (apart from the structure set in place in response to the tsunami), DPRK and Tajikistan.

OCHA Requirements versus Donor Contributions in 2005 (US\$)



As the increase in requirements occurred mostly in the second and third quarters of the year, OCHA did not receive adequate funding for some of the larger budgets, especially that for Sudan. On a more positive note, donors increasingly provided their funding for the field fully unearmarked or only loosely earmarked, which helped to achieve more balanced funding between offices. Even so, a number of new posts could not be filled until sufficient funds were available.

Budgetary Cash Reserve Fund (BCRF)

In common with the trend over several years, OCHA faced a shortfall at year-end of some US\$ 30 million needed to issue 12-month contracts for all eligible field staff. Sweden, as the chair of the OCHA Donor Support Group, initiated the establishment of a Budgetary Cash Reserve Fund (BCRF) to provide a reserve of US\$ 30 million at the end of each calendar year and allow for the issuance of one-year contracts and cover the financial requirements for the first quarter of the following year on a reimbursable basis. The fund was established in November, US\$ 3 million had already been contributed by year-end and OCHA will continue its efforts to mobilise resources to reach US\$ 30 million by November 2006. However, the fund will only serve its intended purpose if the gap between requirements and receipts does not further widen and the fund can be replenished in full.

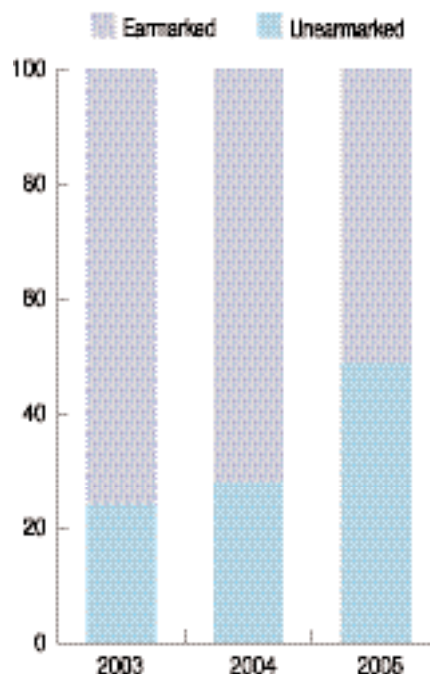
In order to help OCHA avoid funding gaps and imbalances between offices and to allow for more flexible and efficient use of resources, a greater share of funding would have to be received as unearmarked. But if earmarking is a necessary precondition, it would be most effective to earmark to the Field Coordination Reserve Fund (FCRF), through which resources can be allocated to least-funded field offices, thus allowing a more equitable distribution of resources.

Earmarked, Loosely Earmarked or Unearmarked Contributions

The trend towards more flexible funding continued in 2005 as more donors provided a larger share of their funding either completely unearmarked, or loosely earmarked for priority activities in consultation with OCHA. Earmarking was reduced from 76 percent in 2003 and 72 percent in 2004, to 51 percent of all contributions related to requirements reflected in *OCHA in 2005*.

While this pattern was particularly applicable to headquarters in 2004, it also applied to a greater extent for field offices in 2005. OCHA wishes to encourage other donors to follow this pattern to the extent possible.

Donor Funding 2003-2005



Contributions received for field coordination but not earmarked for a specific country are held in the Field Coordination Reserve Fund (FCRF). In 2005, the total amount channelled through this mechanism was US\$ 3 million, although this does not reflect the full amount received as unearmarked for field coordination, since about US\$ 9 million was allocated directly to deserving field offices without being passed through the FCRF. Since funds from the FCRF are almost fully allocated before the end of the year, these funds are reflected as contributions received for the respective field offices. OCHA would like to see the FCRF annual income raised to at least US\$ 10 million to manage field activities with more flexibility and allow for resources to be allocated in accordance with priority or emergency requirements.

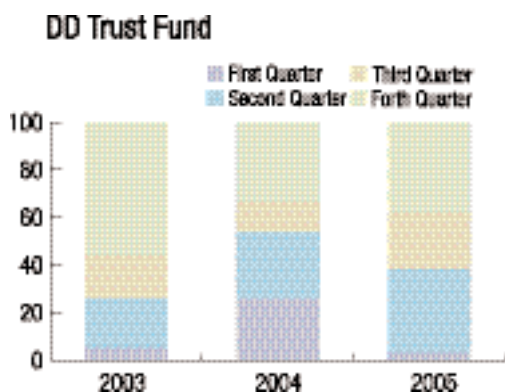
Timeliness of Contributions

Apart from the flexibility of donor funding, the timely receipt of funds is critical to allowing full and balanced implementation of OCHA's planned activities. As OCHA does not have access to a large

reserve account, it cannot incur expenditures until pledges are followed through with cash contributions.

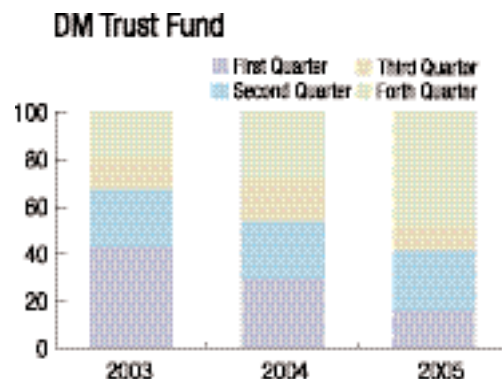
A review of receipt dates confirms expectations that the tsunami response urged donors to advance the release of funds. However, nearly half of the funds for field coordination were received in the last two months of the year, which meant that a number of activities were delayed or even cancelled. To allow for timely renewal of staff appointments (which comprise some 80 percent of OCHA's annual requirements) and continuation of activities without interruption at year-end, UN rules require that at least four-fifths of the funds required for a given year be available by November of the previous year. If OCHA could rely on donors transferring their funds in the first quarter of their financial cycle, this would mean that activities could be funded more evenly throughout the calendar year.

After the major improvement seen in 2004 on the timely receipt of contributions for the Trust Fund for Strengthening OCHA (DD), when over half of the funds received arrived in the first half of the year, 2005 was considerably slower, with only 2.36 percent received in the first quarter and 35.62 percent in the second. Fortunately, the year had opened with a healthy balance, which allowed for continuation of ongoing activities without interruption, but new initiatives had to be postponed until adequate funding was received.

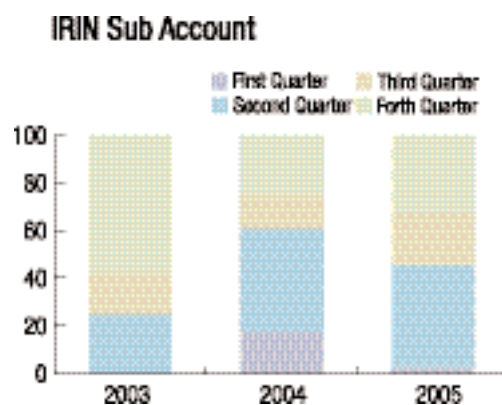


The delay in receipt of funds for the Trust Fund for Disaster Relief (DM), which primarily covers field coordination, caused a rather critical cash flow

situation, as nearly half of the contributions were received in the last two months of the year. Only 41 percent of funds had been received by mid-year, continuing a downward trend from 53.6 percent in 2004 and 67.3 percent in 2003.



The picture was not much better for the IRIN sub account (QTA), with less than 2 percent of contributions received by the end of the first quarter and 45.5 percent in the first half. This was a worrying decrease from 2004, when there was 60.3 percent coverage by the end of June, and put IRIN in a difficult cash flow situation. Fortunately IRIN's requirements were fully covered at year-end.



OCHA understands the financial and legal constraints that affect donor governments in the timing of their cash contributions. The BCRF will be of great assistance in countering such constraints when it is funded to the US\$ 30 million target level, helping to keep ongoing activities funded and allow one-year contracts to be issued for all eligible field staff.

Status of Earmarking by Donors in 2005

Contributions by descending order (us\$)

Donor	Total OCHA in 2005 Appeal	OCHA in 2005 APPEAL								Other Contributions		Total Contributions
		Unearmarked				Earmarked						
		Core Activities	Headquarter Projects	Field Offices ^a	Total Unearmarked	Core Activities	Headquarter Projects	Field Offices ^a	Total Earmarked	Humanitarian Funds, Natural Disasters & Other Activities		
United Kingdom	18,544,331	3,865,000	1,651,744	7,333,025	12,849,769	-	209,521	5,485,041	5,694,562	8,701,195	27,245,526	
Norway	14,091,063	1,008,973	2,966,623	2,836,944	6,812,540	-	351,027	6,927,497	7,278,524	3,195,013	17,286,076	
Sweden	12,434,618	1,200,000	2,931,715	6,539,704	10,671,419	-	1,763,199	-	1,763,199	6,610,259	19,044,877	
Netherlands	12,018,075	775,000	900,995	553,005	2,229,000	-	59,735	9,729,340	9,789,075	604,000	12,622,075	
ECHO	9,552,307	-	3,372,242	-	3,372,242	-	-	6,180,065	6,180,065	4,465,203	14,017,510	
United States of America	8,503,778	-	-	-	-	-	1,229,855	7,273,923	8,503,778	50,000	8,553,778	
Canada	3,895,307	837,932	40,266	1,708,845	2,587,043	-	287,422	1,020,843	1,308,264	210,722	4,106,026	
Switzerland	3,151,925	1,157,477	-	-	1,157,477	-	1,244,003	750,445	1,994,448	882,731	4,034,656	
Ireland	2,899,970	-	-	-	-	-	-	2,899,970	2,899,970	857,746	3,757,716	
Australia	2,744,453	775,000	575,000	525,000	1,875,000	-	-	869,453	869,453	99,790	2,844,243	
Denmark	2,418,862	607,059	468,303	659,092	1,734,454	-	284,408	400,000	684,408	416,560	2,835,422	
Belgium	1,727,228	361,882	-	-	361,882	-	-	1,365,346	1,365,346	-	1,727,228	
Finland	1,204,820	722,892	120,482	361,446	1,204,820	-	-	-	-	-	1,204,820	
Japan	840,577	300,000	-	-	300,000	-	190,577	350,000	540,577	50,000	890,577	
France	779,616	480,000	226,831	72,785	779,616	-	-	-	-	35,000	814,616	
Germany	627,980	474,708	-	-	474,708	-	47,032	106,240	153,272	40,207	668,187	
Russia	500,000	-	-	-	-	-	500,000	-	500,000	2,500,000	3,000,000	
Luxembourg	438,094	438,094	-	-	438,094	-	-	-	-	135,685	573,779	
Italy	433,735	361,446	-	-	361,446	-	-	72,289	72,289	1,228,978	1,662,713	
New Zealand	429,217	359,237	-	-	359,237	-	-	69,980	69,980	50,000	479,217	
Other Agencies	172,000	140,000	-	-	140,000	-	-	32,000	32,000	-	172,000	
Spain	117,817	67,843	49,974	-	117,817	-	-	-	-	-	117,817	
Austria	117,270	56,822	-	-	56,822	-	60,448	-	60,448	49,975	167,245	
Qatar	100,000	-	-	-	-	-	-	100,000	100,000	-	100,000	
Private Donors	78,219	28	-	-	28	-	-	78,191	78,191	22,347	100,566	
Iceland	48,442	48,442	-	-	48,442	-	-	-	-	-	48,442	
Liechtenstein	26,549	-	-	-	-	-	26,549	-	26,549	-	26,549	
South Africa	25,287	-	-	-	-	-	-	25,287	25,287	50,538	75,825	
Greece	24,390	24,390	-	-	24,390	-	-	-	-	-	24,390	
China	20,000	20,000	-	-	20,000	-	-	-	-	45,980	65,980	
Singapore	20,000	20,000	-	-	20,000	-	-	-	-	20,000	40,000	
Philippines	12,381	-	-	-	-	-	12,381	-	12,381	-	12,381	
Slovenia	5,000	-	-	-	-	-	-	5,000	5,000	-	5,000	
Venezuela	5,000	5,000	-	-	5,000	-	-	-	-	-	5,000	
Bahamas	1,900	1,900	-	-	1,900	-	-	-	-	-	1,900	
Kuwait	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	
Turkey	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	500,000	500,000	
Lithuania	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	250,000	250,000	
Mexico	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	105,189	105,189	
Total	98,010,210	14,109,125	13,304,174	20,589,846	48,003,145	-	4,502,957	45,504,109	50,007,066	31,217,119	129,227,329	

^a Includes IRIN

EXPENDITURE

In 2005, OCHA's expenditures, for activities under *OCHA in 2005*, increased by US\$ 18.6 million, a rise of 21 percent over 2004. The higher level of expenditure can be attributed to new and changing humanitarian emergencies during the year and a corresponding increase in projected requirements, as well as new headquarters projects. This was most evident in the field country offices, such as Sudan, oPt, DRC, Niger and Nepal.

Overall, OCHA expended 85 percent of its revised extra-budgetary requirements for the year, with core expenditures at 91 percent, headquarters projects at 86 percent and field offices at 85 percent.

OCHA's expenditures against the regular budget appropriation amounted to US\$ 10.7 million, of which US\$ 10 million supported core staffing and activities and the remaining US\$ 0.7 million related to natural disaster grants. The regular budget is used exclusively for OCHA's core activities and for natural disaster grants approved by the General Assembly.

33 percent of OCHA's core expenditures (US\$ 10 million) were funded from the regular budget, while 67 percent (US\$ 20.5 million) were financed from extra-budgetary resources.

The expenditure level was influenced, to varying degrees, by the following factors: (i) the vacancy rate, which reflects the delayed recruitment factor (while posts are budgeted for a full year, recruitment delays left some posts vacant for a few months); (ii) the variance between UN standard salary costs, used for budgeting purposes, and the actual salaries paid to staff; and (iii) the timeliness of funding, given that activities cannot be implemented until cash contributions are received.

OCHA's extra-budgetary expenditures can be divided into two general categories, staff costs and non-staff costs, as indicated in the document *OCHA in 2005*. Staff costs include salaries and the related entitlements of staff members; non-staff costs include expenses related to consultants, travel, contractual services, operating expenses, supplies and grants.

For core activities, staff costs represented an average of 75 percent of expenditure and non-staff costs an average of 25 percent. For headquarters projects, staff costs represented an average of 65 percent of expenditure and non-staff 35 percent; and, for

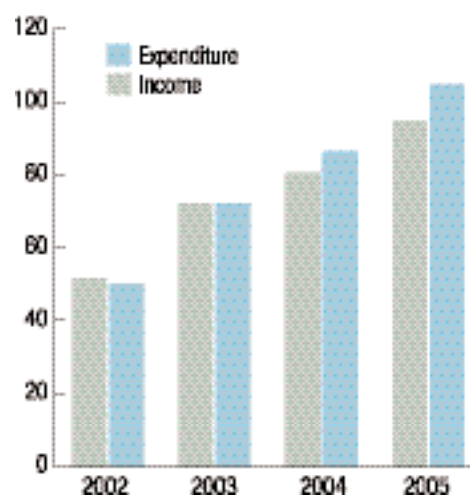
the field offices, staff costs accounted for an average of 55 percent and non-staff for 45 percent.

Staff and non-staff expenses in the field offices varied depending on: the start-up of operations, scaling down of presence or closing of offices; the size of the operation; and the intensification of humanitarian activities in the country. Field offices tend to have higher non-staff costs since their demands under operational expenses are much more complex than those of headquarters: they have to manage their own transport (purchase and maintenance of vehicles), provide additional communications equipment, additional security support, and many other services that are not required by headquarters.

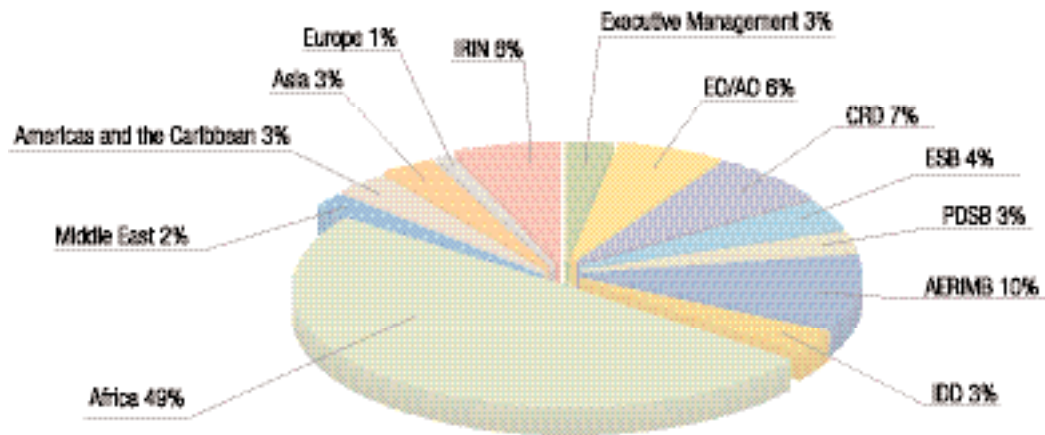
Expenditures for natural disaster activities (other than the Indian Ocean tsunami) totalled US\$ 8.5 million in 2005, an increase of 117 percent on 2004, as a result of the hurricane season which affected Central America and the Caribbean, extensive flooding in central Africa and central Europe, and the South Asia earthquake in October.

The total expenditure under Humanitarian Funds and other activities was US\$ 6.4 million, an increase of only 4 percent. Humanitarian Relief Funds (HRF) were active in Liberia (closed in July 2005), Somalia, DRC, Republic of Congo, Iraq, DPRK and Indonesia.

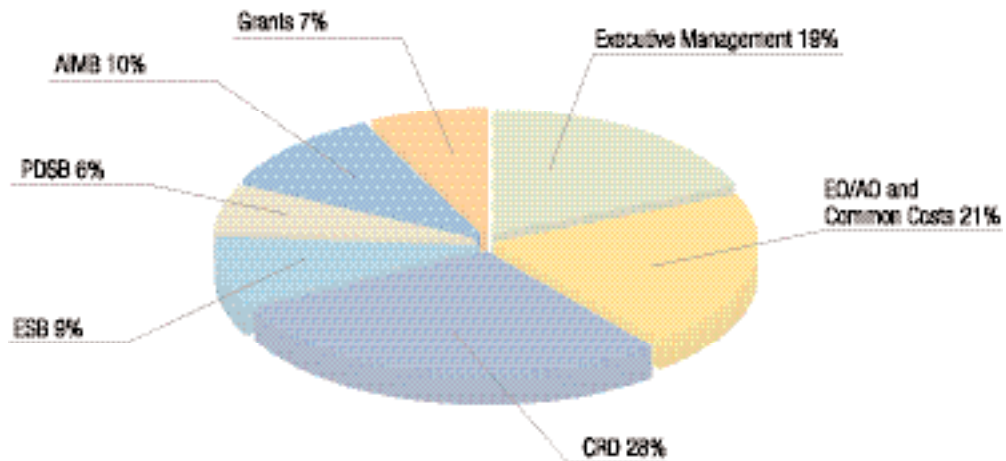
Extra-budgetary income and Expenditure 2002-2005 (US\$)



OCHA Extra-budgetary Expenditure in 2005



OCHA Regular Budget Expenditure in 2005



CARRY-OVER

The level and composition of carry-over is critical to OCHA, since it determines the extent to which OCHA core, project and field activities can continue uninterrupted from one year to the next, pending receipt of new donor contributions.

Carry-over balances may include unpaid pledges that are recorded as income and are not available cash for spending, and the mandatory operating reserves for contingency purposes that cannot be used for annual programming and implementation purposes.

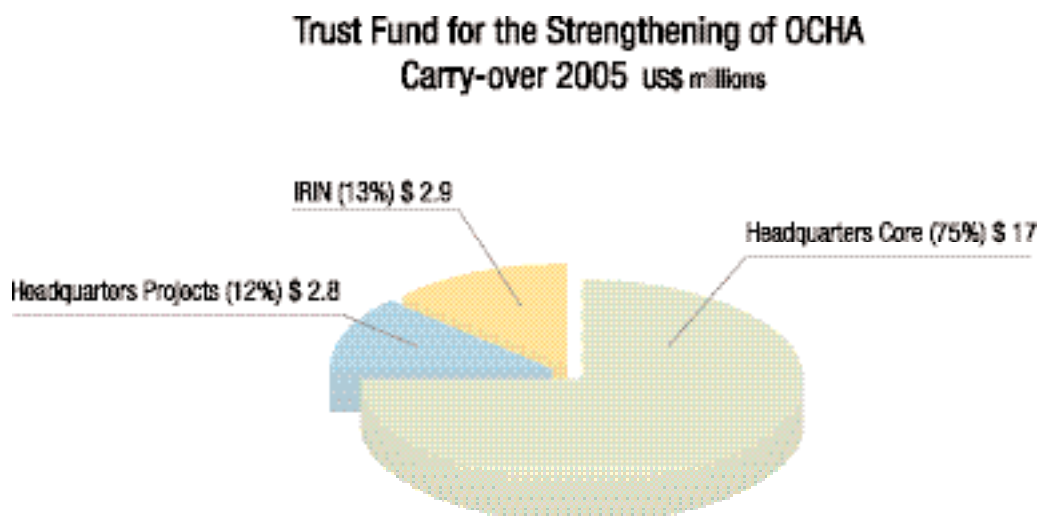
Although the “carry-over” is reflected in the end-of-year financial statements, the actual carry-over sum cannot be determined until after the closing of the books for the year. Under UN Financial Regulations and Rules, that does not occur until 31 March of each year. The closing date is set at three months after the end of the calendar year to enable all offices, particularly those away from headquarters and in the field, sufficient time to account for all financial transactions, up to 31 December; to record last-minute contributions and payments; to review outstanding allotments and obligations with a view to closing or liquidating those that are no longer needed, thus releasing additional resources or savings; and to record interest earned, which is reported by banks only after 31 December.

In the case of the Trust Fund for Disaster Relief, which supports other activities outside the appeal document, the net carry-over that can be used for implementation of activities reflected in *OCHA in 2005* is actually lower than the figure indicated in

the statement. The carry-over under the Trust Fund includes the Unearmarked Funds derived from interest and miscellaneous income, net exchange gains/losses and operating reserves of the Trust Fund, grants for natural disaster activities, other country humanitarian response funds earmarked by donors for specific emergencies, government pre-positioned funds for UNDAC country accounts and funds for the operation of the Brindisi warehouse, none of which were included in the appeal document for 2005. Except for the income generated from interests earned and gains on currency exchange, none of these funds can be used by OCHA for its planned activities.

Carry-Over from 2005 to 2006

The carry-over for the Trust Fund for Strengthening of the Office of the Coordinator, which supports OCHA’s core requirements, New York-based projects and IRIN, amounted to US\$ 22.7 million, a three percent increase on the balance at the end of the previous year. Of this carry-over balance, US\$ 17 million, or 75 percent, was part of the core activities, and used to cover the extension of staff contracts for the full year and six months of operational requirements; US\$ 2.8 million, or 12 percent, was used to extend project staff and provide project operation costs for six months; the balance of US\$ 2.9 million, or 13 percent, from the IRIN Sub-Account was used for the extension of IRIN staff contracts for three months and to allow for the first three months of operational costs.



Although the carry-over of the Trust Fund for Disaster Relief, as reported in the financial statement, appears substantial, only 46.9 percent, or US\$ 48.7 million, related to activities outlined in *OCHA in 2005* that can actually be used to meet the cost of extending staff contracts and covering the first quarter's operating costs for field offices and Geneva-based projects.

This amount was sufficient to cover only three months of staff and operational costs for offices of the Africa region; and three to six months staff cost, plus three months operational costs, for most field offices in the Middle East, Asia, Europe, the Americas and the Caribbean, and headquarters projects.

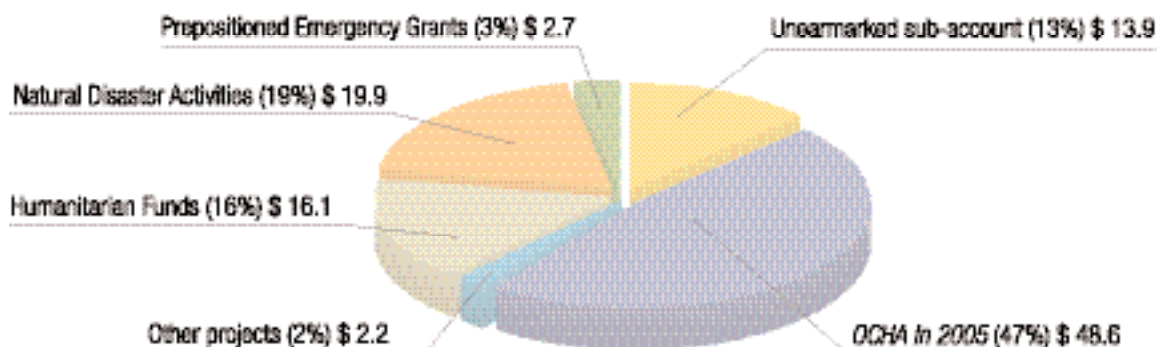
The remaining 53.1 percent, or US\$ 55.0 million, consists of amounts held for varying purposes, as follows:

- i. US\$ 2.8 million, or 2.7 percent, for natural disaster emergency grants;

- ii. US\$ 6.2 million, or 6.0 percent, for underfunded offices, drawn from the Unearmarked Funds;
- iii. US\$ 7.7 million, or 7.4 percent, for mandatory operating reserves; and
- iv. US\$ 38.3 million, or 37 percent, for earmarked funds to be used for natural disasters, other country humanitarian response funding, funds for UNDAC deployment and earmarked funds for the operation of the Brindisi warehouse.

Overall, the carry-over for the Trust Fund for Disaster Relief came to US\$ 103.7 million, 12.4 percent up on the previous year's balance. The increase can be attributed to the significant growth in the carry-over balances for natural disaster activities and humanitarian funds, and other activities described above, which were not included in *OCHA in 2005*. Natural disaster activities benefited from a 43 percent increase, while other humanitarian response funds grew by 70 percent as a result of strong donor support.

Trust Fund for Disaster Relief Assistance
Carry-over 2005 US\$ millions



MANAGEMENT OF CASH RESOURCES

Cash management plays an important role in ensuring that activities continue without interruption, that funding is readily available to address new and deteriorating emergencies, and that surge capacity can be promptly deployed when required. For OCHA, this is all the more critical given its heavy reliance on voluntary contributions which are unpredictable, and uneven in their disbursement.

Unlike regular budget funds, available at the beginning of the year, extra-budgetary funds are only available for use upon actual receipt of cash contributions. Pledges made by donors are firm indications of resources that will become available in the future, but their utilisation depends on the receipt of cash against the pledges.

Management of cash resources depends on a number of factors: the timeliness of contributions and the manner in which donors provide such contributions; the way resources are used for the implementation of activities; UN rules and procedures, which set the parameters governing cash management; the establishment of financial obligations, which set aside the full value of the expenditures, whether or not they have been disbursed; allotment advices; maintenance of operating reserves; and the actual amount of cash on hand.

Timely receipt of contributions is critical for effective cash management. Without the funds, activities cannot commence or continue uninterrupted. Late receipt of funds results in delayed implementation of activities. It is thus critical to keep the time lag between pledges and receipt of donor contributions to a minimum.

The degree of earmarking of contributions by donors also affects the manner in which funds can be used, since earmarked contributions do not allow the flexibility to channel resources where they may be most needed. Excess funds from generously-funded programmes cannot be used for other activities that are underfunded and the implementation of activities can be delayed or postponed subject to the availability of unencumbered cash resources.

UN rules and regulations governing cashflow management stipulate that the financial groundwork for annual programming of extra-budgetary activities must commence in the last quarter of the prior year, through the preparation of cost plans that show overall requirements for the next year and distinguish between

authorised staffing and operating requirements. Staff costs comprise the major component of OCHA's cost plans due to its coordination mandate. To allow for timely renewal of staff appointments, UN rules demand that the funds needed to cover salaries for the following year be available by November of any given year.

OCHA's management of cash resources is also affected by the financial obligations it raises during the year. Under UN financial rules and regulations, expenditures over US\$ 2,500 require the establishment of financial obligations setting aside the full value of the envisaged expenditure, which cannot be used for other purposes until such obligations are liquidated.

In the field, where most of OCHA's financial obligations exist, the situation is somewhat more complex. Given the inevitable delays in financial reporting from the field, funds set aside for these obligations remain encumbered for longer before they can be released for use in the implementation of activities.

The funding of extra-budgetary activities is further governed by three mechanisms under UN financial regulations and rules: the issuance of allotments, the maintenance of operating reserves, and provision for programme support costs. All these translate to encumbered funds. Thus, only unencumbered cash after allotments have been issued and provision has been made for operating reserves and programme support costs can be used for programming purposes.

Regardless of the level of cash resources appearing in the financial statements, therefore, their use is governed and controlled by the factors described above. These constraints clearly influence and inhibit OCHA's management of its funds, and result in occasional cash flow problems. This is most evident around the last quarter of the year, when OCHA starts programming activities for the following year and has to set aside the cash resources needed to meet its statutory and management obligations. In order to ensure the uninterrupted implementation of its programmed activities, OCHA has to commit funds for the extension of staff contracts for another year, and the coverage of its operational needs for at least the first quarter of the new year. It was for that reason that OCHA appealed to donors in 2004 for

contributions to a Budgetary Cash Reserve Fund (BCRF) of US\$ 30 million to meet these statutory commitments.

While it may appear that sufficient funds are available from the carry-overs of the respective accounts, project funding is mostly earmarked. Therefore, the extension of staff contracts and provision for operating costs depend largely on sufficient funding earmarked for each project, or the availability of unearmarked funds that can be used for underfunded projects. Unless donors revert to more unearmarked or loosely earmarked funding, and more timely payment of their contributions, some of the projects that have been chronically underfunded will continue to face severe cash management problems.

Cash Management in 2005

In 2005, OCHA's cash flow management showed some improvement on previous year. Donors provided a larger share of their contributions unearmarked, allowing OCHA to exercise flexibility in allocating the funds to underfunded activities and other priority requirements, and reducing the imbalance that inevitably occurs with earmarked funding. However, the timeliness of contributions received was down (See Donor Funding in 2005).

OCHA managed to continue its planned activities with relatively little interruption, given healthy carry-overs from the previous year, but delays in receipt of contributions for field coordination – almost half of which were received only in the last two months of the year – resulted in the postponement of some activities.

For the tsunami disaster, for which there was generous donor support, the level of funding enabled OCHA to meet its operational needs and, as mandated, channel contributions to UN Agencies for their priority needs.

Other than that, the demands of new and deteriorating emergencies clearly taxed OCHA's cash resources, creating a gap between funding and urgent requirements. Such was the case with the South Asia earthquake later in the year and in the crises in Sudan and DRC, where the increase in emergency needs outpaced cash contributions.

In these instances, as in other sudden-onset disasters and protracted emergencies, OCHA was compelled to secure advance funding from the FCRF and/or the Unearmarked Sub-Account.

While the shortfalls were adequately covered from these sources to ensure the uninterrupted implementation of OCHA's most critical activities in these countries, they put considerable strain on the funds in the FCRF and the Unearmarked Sub-Account, depleting OCHA's cash reserves for new emergencies at the start of 2006.

While there was a marked increase in grants for natural disasters and other humanitarian response funds earmarked for agencies and NGOs, and channelled through OCHA, these funds are not OCHA's and cannot be used for its own funding requirements.

In an effort to achieve better use of unearmarked contributions, OCHA reviewed its cash flow on a continuous basis, including the opening balance of both the disaster response and the strengthening trust funds, as well as funds received since the beginning of the calendar year, the prospect of funds on the basis of pledges received, predictable contributions on multi-year arrangements or funds from other sources such as the Special Account for Programme Support.

Tighter monitoring of project implementation and of expenditures allowed for improved cash flow management throughout the year. Since OCHA has to ensure that its extra-budgetary core requirements are fully resourced, the distribution of unearmarked contributions is particularly important.

A Programme and Funding Review Group was also established within OCHA to review and advise on matters related to the management of regular budget and extra-budgetary resources. In particular, the group is tasked with reviewing cash flows against OCHA requirements, identifying trends, constraints and funding shortfalls, and recommending redeployment of resources whenever necessary. The group also reviews and recommends the allocation of unearmarked donor contributions across different priorities, activities and projects, and reviews requests for advances against the Unearmarked Sub-Account.

BUILDING PARTNERSHIPS

With the growing scale and impact of humanitarian crises, especially those that have resulted from natural disasters, OCHA has been engaged in building partnerships that will allow it to respond in a timely and effective manner. Some of these efforts involve growing the predictability of support by enhancing relations with existing partners; others involve forging new, sustainable partnerships with non-traditional donors and private sector partners.

The international community has responded to natural disasters in the last few years with unprecedented support, but there is still a clear need to have a more systematic and predictable partnership in responding to crises. As the tsunami and South Asia earthquake disasters demonstrated in 2005, many governments provide support through bilateral channels. Yet, the multitude of actors and contributing nations has clearly highlighted the added value of multilateralism and a coordinated response.

OCHA's strategy is to build new partnerships as well as to increase understanding of the UN's coordination role. With the support of some Member States and the members of the OCHA Donor Support Group, OCHA has developed constructive dialogue with G-77 members and non-traditional humanitarian partners. Meetings will be convened under the leadership of the ODSG in Istanbul and Abu Dhabi in 2006 to highlight the added value of collective action and raise awareness of humanitarian response tools.

Implementation of the Middle East Initiative, launched in 2004, has helped build cooperation between the international humanitarian community and regional governments. The initiative increased collaboration and working opportunities with NGOs from the Middle East and promoted IHL and principles, and the humanitarian efforts of the UN with counterparts in the Arab/Muslim world. It is important, too, to note the valuable contribution to humanitarian activities made by Arab and Muslim governments, NGOs and Red Crescent Societies, for which there is little visibility.

OCHA has also developed institutional dialogues with the members of the Cooperation Council for the Arab States of the Gulf and the Organisation of the Islamic Conference to find ways to work together with these partners on global humanitarian actions.

Building partnerships with regional and sub-regional organisations was the focus of OCHA Regional Offices' work in the Americas, Asia and Pacific, Africa and the Middle East. Activities focused on strengthening regional and local disaster management capabilities through training, and operational cooperation for disaster response and reduction. OCHA works with more than 18 organisations involved in disaster management and capacity building, including ECOWAS, CDERA and the ADRC.

Humanitarian actors have diverse identities, missions and mandates, approaches, processes and methodologies. This diversity is matched by an increasingly recognised level of interdependence, yet, too often, this complementarity is not capitalised upon.

Throughout 2005, OCHA planned and laid the groundwork for a meeting in July 2006 of the heads of some 20 INGOs, national NGOs, Red Cross and Red Crescent Societies, and of the IASC Principals, including UN and non-UN humanitarian organisations, to find means to enhance the effectiveness of humanitarian action and establish better relations at the global and operational levels. That meeting will seek to clarify the relationship between the UN and non-UN humanitarian organisations in order to respond more effectively to needs. Participants will examine how to use new and existing mechanisms, processes and systems to ensure an effective relationship that allows for more effective humanitarian action – both in terms of operations and advocacy.

Realising the potential of the private sector in emergency relief after the tsunami, OCHA also played an active role in developing guidelines for the acceptance of pro bono goods and services offered by the private sector. OCHA led and coordinated partnerships between the private sector and the UN, by successfully channelling pro bono services from PricewaterhouseCoopers to 20 different projects managed by several UN Agencies and departments.

A partnership with the World Economic Forum has been developed in order to ensure an efficient and effective private sector participation in humanitarian relief efforts, in line with the UN Reform. The USG's participation at the Forum's annual meeting in January, advocating for UN humanitarian relief assistance, represented a significant step in that direction.

ACCOUNTABILITY AND RISK MANAGEMENT

Recent years have seen heightened concern and focus on risk management. The need for a robust framework to effectively identify, assess and manage risk has become increasingly accepted in the United Nations. Risk management enables management to effectively address uncertainty and associated risk and opportunity, enhancing the capacity to build value. Recognising its importance, OCHA was quick to buy in on the process when it was first introduced in the UN some two years ago.

Working closely with the Office for Internal Oversight Services on a joint risk assessment, OCHA focused on defining its processes, identifying risks, controls and risk tolerance, and developing a risk profile and internal audit plan. Based on its mission statement, strategy and objectives, OCHA examined its leadership, advocacy, management/financial support, programme management and donor relations, administrative support in finance and budgeting, procurement and acquisitions, human resources management, logistics, operations and ICT.

In each of these areas, OCHA identified risks, controls on those risks and risk tolerance. Resources allocated to each activity were examined and a risk profile developed that showed the potential probability of each risk by dollars invested, organisational unit and processes, as well as the impact of each risk, the existing risk management techniques and an assessment of their effectiveness. Assigning a probability rating for each risk, the exercise reviewed the impact of the risk or threat on OCHA's programmes. The probability of the risk was mapped against its potential impact in a matrix that became the basis of the audit plan.

Employing these risk management techniques, audits were conducted in the DRC, Sudan, Indonesia and Geneva, giving priority to those activities with the "most certain risks". These audits have proved to be an effective means for early identification of potential risk areas and the formulation of responses, as well as to manage risk within acceptable levels.

The Indian Ocean tsunami and its aftermath triggered heightened public awareness around issues of humanitarian transparency and accountability. In response, OCHA engaged in a number of accountability initiatives throughout the year,

in addition to subjecting itself to a series of early audits in some of the tsunami-affected countries.

The ERC advocated with agencies, donors and other partners for greater transparency, and OCHA also engaged with a number of fora that discussed accountability and transparency issues, such as the international conference in Jakarta in April on Promoting Financial Accountability in Managing Funds Related to the Tsunami, Conflict and Other Disasters, and a meeting of the International Group for Anti-Corruption Coordination.

Bringing in cutting-edge private sector expertise

Crucial in this regard was the expansion of a Financial Tracking Service (FTS) accessible publicly through OCHA's website. This was facilitated by the donation by Pricewaterhouse Coopers (PwC) of 8,000 staff-hours in pro bono professional services to help the UN system strengthen its financial accountability mechanisms, in particular around funding for the tsunami response.

This private sector partnership facilitated the development, for the first time, of a common UN platform to publicly account for the receipt and use of funds. This project earned PwC the International Visionaries Award from the United Nations Association of the USA and United Nations Association of the National Capital Area, and raised the standards in public reporting requirements.

Other areas of expertise provided through the PwC partnership included support to internal audit missions, forensic data analyses, developing fraud risk controls, and conducting enterprise-wide risk assessments. In addition, PwC conducted two cross-agency fraud and risk-control training workshops in September 2005, at which agencies that did not form part of the PwC agreement were also invited to participate.

OCHA and its humanitarian partners within the UN system have since developed partnerships with other private sector firms such as First Logic and World Check, which provide risk-related services such as enhanced forensic data analysis.

Managing risks through timely audits

Both internal and external auditors assessed OCHA's response to the tsunami as well as providing timely audits of OCHA in Indonesia, Sri Lanka, the regional office in Bangkok and OCHA Geneva. Audits raised issues about staff deployment and turnover, training and pre-mission briefings, performance monitoring, inconsistencies between financial tracking systems, compliance with UN safety and security requirements, and the quality of data and information management services.

For each of these audits, OCHA has provided comprehensive management responses, and has fed the results into an overall strategy to improve performance and manage risks. Among other actions, management moved to increase administrative capacity by 26 posts to address human resource management and administration deficiencies identified, and to improve support to the field.

The OIOS reported in May 2005 on an October 2004 audit of OCHA's Office in Geneva, which manages key trust funds in the area of humanitarian assistance. The audit affirmed its meaningful functions of support to OCHA's coordination offices in the field, while making recommendations on aspects of the organisation's restructuring in 2004, delineation of authority, and accountability of support for OCHA field offices, financial tracking, emergency services and staffing arrangements.

Promoting joint accountability and learning through internal and sector-wide initiatives

OCHA now implements a lesson learning review (LLR) within two months of a major emergency response. This was done one month after the tsunami hit. The review confirmed that the media strategy deployed by OCHA and others (such as WHO) managed to galvanise international support, as well as to draw attention to gaps and needs for additional assistance. Stand-by arrangements

with external partners in donor countries and the private sector as well as agency-specific mechanisms (such as surge capacity, emergency revolving funds and UNDAC) all contributed to an effective immediate response.

OCHA's early presence in most of the affected areas helped position OCHA in a key coordination leadership role. The appointment of the Deputy Emergency Relief Coordinator at a regional level was also seen as a positive new element for a response of such large dimensions. Key lessons that emerged from this review included the fact that UNDAC teams, deployed within 24 hours of the tsunami, need to integrate expertise on logistics, civil-military liaison and administration. Common services such as the HIC, JLC, communications/information technology and civil-military liaison are also key elements of response and need to be deployed much earlier.

At sector-wide level, OCHA was instrumental in setting up the Tsunami Evaluation Coalition (TEC) during the first half of 2005. The coalition, chaired by OCHA, now includes over 40 UN Agencies, NGOs, donors and non-profit organisations that have agreed to jointly evaluate sector-wide performance.

In the field, OCHA organised a series of tsunami lesson-learning workshops for national/local stakeholders in May, which were well received by all actors and contributed to a critical assessment of what worked well and what areas require improvement. At the time, shelter and transition issues were highlighted for urgent attention.

Based on its experience of the last two years, it is clear to OCHA that risk management is an important element of its operations. It provides OCHA with ownership of its future helping management achieve its performance targets and prevent loss of resources; helping ensure effective reporting and compliance with rules and regulations; and, ultimately, helping avoid damage to OCHA's humanitarian operations.

KEY FINANCIAL TABLES

Explanation of Financial Statements and Terminology

The financial statements and financial tables in the following pages present an overview of the sources and use of extra-budgetary funds administered by OCHA through its main Trust Funds and other funding mechanisms in the year 2005.

Funding Sources and Mechanisms

Voluntary contributions to OCHA are received and managed through the following trust funds and special accounts:

The **Trust Fund for Strengthening of the Office of the Emergency Relief Coordinator (DD)** was established in 1974 pursuant to General Assembly resolution 32/43. Voluntary contributions to the Fund are used primarily to support the core activities of OCHA that are not funded by the regular budget. It is also used to fund New York headquarters projects that support OCHA's core mandate. The fund is subject to 13 percent programme support costs.

The **Integrated Regional Information Networks (IRIN) Sub-Account (QT)** was established under the Trust Fund for Strengthening of OCHA to finance IRIN core needs. The sub-account is subject to 13 percent programme support charge.

The **Trust Fund for Disaster Relief Assistance (DM)** was established by General Assembly resolution 28/16 to receive earmarked and unearmarked contributions for emergency relief assistance. The fund, which finances humanitarian coordination in natural disasters and complex emergencies, serves as the vehicle for financially supporting all of OCHA's field activities (except for IRIN), and Geneva-based headquarters projects, as reflected in *OCHA in 2005*. The fund is also used to channel donor contributions for natural disaster activities, humanitarian funds and other activities of operational Agencies and NGOs. The fund is subject to 13 percent programme support costs for activities directly implemented and supported by OCHA, and three percent for funds channelled through OCHA. Funding mechanisms under the Trust Fund are as follows:

- The **Field Coordination Reserve Fund (FCRF)** was established to receive contributions for field coordination that are not earmarked for a specific country. It may include other unearmarked

contributions from donors who do not otherwise provide any contributions directly for the field. The contributions from the FCRF are allocated

- i. for the establishment of field presence in new emergencies, either natural disaster or complex emergencies;
- ii. expansion of field presence due to a change in the coordination needs of a deteriorating situation or increased access to previously inaccessible areas; and
- iii. support to severely underfunded offices to avoid interruption in contractual and operational commitments.

- The **Budgetary Cash Reserve Fund (BCRF)** was established in November 2005 with the intention of establishing a reserve of US\$ 30 million so that, at the end of each calendar year, OCHA can meet its immediate requirements for the following year. In particular, the fund would be used to enable the issuance of one-year contracts for eligible field staff and to cover the operational requirements of field offices for the first quarter. So far, OCHA has received US\$ 3 million for this newly established reserve.

- The **Unearmarked Sub-Account** consists of funds that are derived from the interest generated by the Trust Fund for Disaster Relief (DM) and are primarily used: (i) to fund activities pending receipt of actual cash contributions against unpaid pledges, whenever the activity requires urgent infusion of funds; (ii) as cash reserve to provide funding for severely underfunded activities, on the basis of urgent needs and priorities and where funds from the Field Coordination Reserve (FCRF) are insufficient; (iii) as an advance to meet the urgent requirements of new emergencies, pending receipt of donor contributions; and (iv) to provide for the mandatory operating reserve. In all instances where monies are used as advance against unpaid pledges, the Sub-Account is reimbursed upon receipt of donor contributions. Reimbursements may occur in other instances if unexpected contributions are received at a later date or unearmarked funds are received in the FCRF accounts for distribution to various priority activities.

The **Trust Fund for Tsunami Disaster Relief (TKB)** was established in February 2005 to fund activities related to the coordination of humanitarian action providing relief to victims of the Indian Ocean tsunami and other immediate recovery related activities. The magnitude and the regional scope of the tsunami, together with the unprecedented response by donor countries, humanitarian partners, private sector and the general public required a specific and separate account that would facilitate the management and reporting of the funds entrusted to OCHA. The funds were used to finance OCHA's coordination and response activities, and to provide allocations to UN Agencies and NGOs in meeting their priority needs in responding to the crisis. The trust fund is subject to 13 percent programme support charge for activities implemented by OCHA, and three percent for allocations provided to Agencies and NGOs.

Special Account for Programme Support consists of resources derived from the programme support costs or overhead charges applied to all trust funds administered by OCHA. The rate charged is that which has been approved by the General Assembly, normally ranging from three to 13 percent of the annual final expenditures of the trust funds. Charges of three percent are levied for contributions channelled through OCHA for other UN Agencies and NGOs, and 13 percent for activities directly implemented and supported by OCHA, such as those reflected in *OCHA in 2005*.

While OCHA generates a relatively good annual income from its programme support account, the use of such resources is limited to areas where a demonstrable relationship exists between the activities which generated the programme support revenue and the supporting activities. They cannot be used to fund substantive activities and can only be used for administrative support functions, finance, personnel and common services.

Financial Tables

The **statements of income and expenditure** summarise the total funds available under each trust and/or account, their utilisation during the year, and the year-end balance as of 31 December 2005. Funds available consists of the beginning balance or carry-over from 2004, adjustments to

prior periods' income and expenditure, income for the year comprising cash contributions and unpaid pledges in accordance with the UN accounting standards; miscellaneous income, transfers from other funds and savings from financial commitments of the prior year. Expenditure shows their utilisation during the year, and includes both actual disbursements as well as commitments made but not yet disbursed. The closing balances show the remaining funds available at the end of the year to be carried forward into 2006. It also includes the mandatory operating reserves for contingency purposes.

Table 1 shows the Statement of Income and Expenditure of the Trust Fund for the Strengthening of the Office of the Emergency Relief Coordinator (DD), the Trust Fund for Disaster Relief (DM) and the Trust Fund for the Tsunami Disaster Relief (TKB).

Table 2 shows the financial status, income and expenditure, of the Trust Fund for the Strengthening of the Office of the Emergency Relief Coordinator (DD), broken down by activities, namely, headquarters core, headquarters projects and IRIN.

Headquarters core activities comprise the minimum level of activities that OCHA must carry out to effectively discharge its mandate, given an average level of humanitarian emergency programming around the world. The definition of "core" is based on three priority functions identified by the General Assembly: humanitarian coordination, advocacy and policy development. OCHA's core activities can also be seen as the basis that underpin and allow for additional activities to take place. Examples include the capacity required to establish field offices in an emergency or to undertake evaluation of activities. These are supported by executive direction and management, IASC and ECHA mechanisms, as well as external relations and resource mobilisation.

Headquarters Projects New York are other incremental activities of time-limited duration, generally implemented at headquarters. In particular, these are the activities associated with coordination of emergency response, time-bound projects undertaken by OCHA on behalf of the IASC or the international community, and projects including ReliefWeb, Field Information Management, Donor Relations, Staff Development and Learning, Field Support, Evaluation and

Studies, and Protection of Civilians. These activities may also include other projects that OCHA takes on, at the request of the Security Council, Secretary-General, IASC or similar body on the understanding that such activities are not part of OCHA's regular activities but meet an emerging need for the short term.

The **Integrated Regional Information Networks (IRIN)**, which is reflected in *OCHA in 2005* under Field Activities, is an independent humanitarian news service covering Sub-Saharan Africa, Central Asia and the Middle East. It was established to improve the flow of vital information to those involved in relief efforts, and help the humanitarian community better understand, anticipate and respond to evolving crises and emergencies.

Table 3 shows the financial status, income and expenditure, of the Trust Fund for Disaster Relief (DM), broken down by complex emergencies, headquarters projects – Geneva, natural disaster activities, humanitarian funds and other activities, and unearmarked sub-account.

Complex Emergencies refers to the coordination activities of field offices as reflected in *OCHA 2005*, including the utilisation of the Field Coordination Reserve Funds (FCRF), a mechanism that enables donors to provide unearmarked resources in support of field coordination offices in emergencies in three circumstances: establishment of coordination offices in new emergencies, expansion of existing offices due to deteriorating situations, and support to severely underfunded offices. The FCRF allows OCHA to manage the field activities with the necessary flexibility.

Headquarters Projects Geneva are projects administered and managed in Geneva. Like the New York-based projects, they comprise incremental activities of limited duration in support of OCHA's core mandate. They include, in particular, support activities associated with the coordination of disaster and emergency response such as UNDAC, CMCS and INSARAG, and other activities aimed at strengthening existing capacities in areas including the Consolidated Appeals Process (CAP), Surge Capacity, Donor Relations, and Staff Development, among others.

Natural Disaster Activities consist of Regional Disaster Response Advisor (RDRA) offices, government prepositioned funds used for emergency

grants to provide immediate humanitarian relief at the onset of disasters, UN Disaster Assessment and Coordination (UNDAC) activities, and other natural disaster related activities including funds for the Brindisi warehouse.

Humanitarian Funds and other Activities include rapid response mechanisms for humanitarian aid. Funds in this category are expended in the form of grants to NGOs and are not available for use by OCHA.

The **Unearmarked Sub-Account** consists of funds advanced from the Sub-Account to other activities pending receipt of cash contributions against pledges, to support severely underfunded activities, to meet urgent needs of new emergencies and to provide for the mandatory operating reserve.

Table 4 shows the status of the Special Account for Programme Support, the income generated from programme support costs levied on OCHA's trust funds and expenditure to support the administrative and common services requirements of OCHA's extra-budgetary activities.

Extra-budgetary Requirements and related Income and Expenditure

Table 5 and **Table 6** summarise the budget and expenditure tables by Headquarters Core and Project Activities, and Field Coordination Activities respectively. These tables present OCHA's extra-budgetary requirements as reflected in *OCHA in 2005*, the revised requirements, and contributions, other income and expenditure recorded for each activity. Contributions include cash receipts and unpaid pledges earmarked by donors for each activity and allocations from the Field Coordination Reserve Funds (FCRF). Expenditure includes obligations and actual disbursements.

Donor Contributions

Table 7 shows cash contribution and pledges made by governments, and individual donors to each trust fund. Tables are provided on the top 20 donors and their contributions, broken down by headquarters activities, field offices and other activities to which they contributed. The information is summarised in **Table 8** in the form of a matrix that matches donors with activities.

Requirements, Income and Expenditure Breakdown

Narratives on core activities, headquarters projects and field offices are complemented by financial tables that show the revised requirements, income from voluntary contributions and expenditure breakdown, using UN accounting standards.

Explanation of Terminology used in the Financial Statements

Opening balance represents the total amount of funds available for the trust fund and/or main activity on 1 January 2005, and is also referred to as carry-over balance from 2004. Fewer actual funds are available for implementation purposes because unpaid pledges, while recorded as income, are not cash on hand; and because a mandatory 10 percent cash operating reserve must be held to cover any unforeseen expenditure.

Adjustment includes adjustments of income or expenditure reported in 2004 or previous years. This may be due to adjustments for contributions recorded and other miscellaneous income for prior years and adjustments for expenses incorrectly reported.

Income from contributions is composed of contributions received from donors that have been credited to OCHA's trust funds and unpaid pledges.

A **pledge** is a written commitment by a donor to provide, at a future date, a monetary contribution to OCHA's activities and is recorded as income under the UN Financial Regulations and Rules at the time of receipt of the written commitment. If the pledge is in a currency other than US dollars, its value is converted according to established UN rates of exchange prevailing at the time of receipt. The US dollar value of the pledge changes in accordance with the UN rates of exchange for as long as the pledge remains outstanding as a receivable in the UN financial statement. Foreign exchange gains or losses may arise at the time of receipt of cash.

Transfers, refunds and savings include transfers between projects, allocations from the Field Coordination Reserve Funds to underfunded field offices, transfers from/to the unearmarked fund sub-account, transfers between trust funds, refunds to donors and savings from prior period unused obligations.

Other funds available includes contributions from other UN Agencies and other miscellaneous income, such as gain or loss on currency exchange, proceeds from sale and disposition of old equipment, etc.

Total funds available comprise opening balance, adjustments, income from contributions, and other funds available.

Expenditure corresponds to the disbursements and obligations recorded for the year.

Closing balance represents funds carried over from 2005 to 2006. The carry-over available for the implementation of activities is lower than the figure indicated in the statement of income and expenditure.

For the Trust Fund for Disaster Relief (Table 3), a substantial portion of the carry-over relates to government prepositioned funds for natural disasters and humanitarian funds, and other activities that have not been included in the extra-budgetary programme requirements laid out in *OCHA in 2005*, as well as mandatory operating reserves not available for use by programmes.

Expenditure is grouped into the following broad categories:

- Staff costs: salaries and related entitlements of staff holding United Nations contracts
- Consultants fees and travel: salaries and travel costs of consultants engaged for a specific time-bound mandate and purpose
- Travel: includes travel and related expenses incurred on official business by staff or other representatives participating in OCHA activities
- Contractual services: relates to payments for outsourced services, such as printing, translation, editing, security services
- Operating expenses: payments for rental and maintenance of office premises and equipment, communications, shipment, banking charges, etc.
- Supplies, furniture and equipment: payments for office supplies, materials, furniture, and equipment, including computers, fax machines, photocopiers, and vehicles in the field
- Grants, contributions, fellowships, and seminars: grants provided to external entities, including UN Agencies, NGOs, institutions, universities and other organisations working in partnership with OCHA. It includes seminars and workshops included in requirements as reflected in *OCHA in 2005*
- Programme support costs: calculated at 13 percent of all activities and projects executed and directly supported by OCHA, and 3 percent of grants provided to other entities that do not require significant administrative support from OCHA. These programme support costs, while recorded as expenditure in each trust fund, revert to OCHA as income for its Special Account for Programme Support Costs

Statement of Income and Expenditure in 2005*

TABLE 1

Trust Funds Administered by OCHA (US\$)

Summary	Trust Fund for the Strengthening of OCHA	Trust Fund for Disaster Relief	Trust Fund for Tsunami Disaster Relief ^c
1 Opening balance	22,078,230	92,253,631	-
2 Adjustments	(171)	303,422	-
3 Income from Contributions	25,524,773	103,702,556 ^{a b}	72,696,230
4 Transfers, refunds, savings	(1,355)	(48,215) ^{a b}	-
5 Other funds available	1,312,199	1,770,499	1,360,596
6 Total funds available	48,913,676	197,981,893	74,056,826
7 Expenditure	26,151,823	94,252,240	63,140,928 ^d
8 Closing balance	22,761,853	103,729,653	10,915,898

a Contributions totalling US\$ 799,611 for the tsunami disaster received in 2004 were transferred to the Tsunami Disaster Trust Fund in 2005. This amount which was deducted from income in UN Financial Statement is treated as a transfer of contributions

b Refunds of US\$ 62,422 and US\$ 210,938 were made to the Netherlands and Switzerland respectively. These amounts which were deducted from income in UN Financial Statement are treated as refunds of contributions

c See Paart IV for Financial detailed information on the Tsunami Trust Fund

d Expenditure includes allocations to UN Agencies for US\$ 46,335,059

TABLE 2

Trust Fund for the Strengthening of OCHA (US\$)

Summary	Headquarters Core New York - Geneva	Headquarters Projects New York	IRIN	TOTAL
1 Opening balance	16,844,121	3,058,136	2,175,973	22,078,230
2 Adjustments	(171)	-	-	(171)
3 Income from Contributions	14,109,125	5,279,187	6,136,461	25,524,773
4 Transfers, refunds, savings	(24,867)	-	23,512	(1,355)
5 Other funds available	694,989	43,896	573,314	1,312,199
6 Total funds available	31,623,197	8,381,219	8,909,260	48,913,676
7 Expenditure	14,609,146	5,564,031	5,978,646	26,151,823
8 Closing balance	17,014,051	2,817,188	2,930,614	22,761,853

TABLE 3**Trust Fund for Disaster Relief (US\$)**

Summary	Complex Emergencies	Headquarters Projects Geneva	Natural Disasters Activities	Humanitarian Funds and Other Activities	Unearmarked Sub Account	Total
1 Opening balance	38,254,933 ^a	12,008,090	13,981,316	9,512,912	18,496,380 ^a	92,253,631
2 Adjustments	305,639	(2,138)	(79)	-	-	303,422
3 Income from Contributions	61,477,862 ^b	16,506,598 ^c	13,064,166 ^d	12,653,930 ^e	-	103,702,556
4 Transfers, refunds, savings	4,241,646	(15,191)	1,317,286	350,000	(5,941,956)	(48,215)
5 Other funds available	407,766	(195,636)	77,021	70,210	1,411,138	1,770,499
6 Total funds available	104,687,846	28,301,723	28,439,710	22,587,052	13,965,562	197,981,893
7 Expenditure	66,837,799	12,453,191	8,506,781	6,454,469	-	94,252,240
8 Closing balance	37,850,047	15,848,532	19,932,929	16,132,583	13,965,562	103,729,653

a Unearmarked sub account balance of US\$ 18,496,380 reflected in the closing balance for 2004 is shown separately in the opening balance for 2005

b Includes income for the Field Coordination Reserve Fund (FCRF) US\$ 3,279,794 and US\$ 3,000,000 towards Budgetary Cash Reserve Fund (BCRF)

c Includes contributions to the Protection Stand-by Capacity Project US\$ 2,732,726 and other headquarters activities US\$ 1,342,495

d Includes Government Prepositioned Funds for US\$ 1,725,324, UNDAC Aircraft support US\$ 2,100,000, UNDAC Country projects US\$ 771,435 and funds for the Brindisi Warehouse US\$ 561,573

e Consists of country Humanitarian Response Funds (HRF) for DPRK, Democratic Republic of Congo, Côte d'Ivoire and Somalia

TABLE 4**Special Account for Programme Support (US\$)**

Summary	TOTAL
1 Opening balance	9,512,905
2 Adjustments	-
3 Income	16,185,418 ^a
4 Transfers, refunds, savings	-
5 Other funds available	672,073
6 Total funds available	26,370,396
7 Expenditure	9,205,654 ^b
8 Closing balance	17,164,742

a Includes US\$ 2,869,295 of income from the Trust Fund for Tsunami Disaster Relief

b Expenditure consists of US\$ 2,010,520 NY-core activities, US\$ 3,880,252 Geneva-core activities, US\$ 402,405 ISDR, US\$ 2,606,700 payments to UNOG and other support cost of US\$ 305,777

*** All figures subject to audit**

1 The opening balance reflects the situation of each Trust Fund as of 1 January 2005

2 Includes adjustments to prior period income and expenditure

3 Includes contributions from donors for the year 2005

4 Includes transfers between Trust Funds, refunds to donors and savings on prior period obligations

5 Consists of interest and miscellaneous income and exchange adjustments for the year 2005

6 Consists of the opening balance and income (addition of 1+2+3+4+5)

7 Includes disbursements and unliquidated obligations as of 31 December 2005

8 Includes operating cash reserves and fund balances as of 31 December 2005

Extra-budgetary Requirements and Expenditures in 2005

TABLE 5

Headquarters Core Activities and Projects (US\$)

CORE ACTIVITIES	Requirements 2005	Revised Requirements 2005	Opening Balance	Contributions	Other Income, Transfers, Savings and Adjustments	Expenditure 2005	
Trust Fund for the Strengthening of OERC			16,844,121	14,109,125 ^a	669,951	-	
Office of the USG, ERC, and Director New York	765,241	765,241	-	-	-	1,333,775	
Office of the Director of OCHA Geneva	776,997	776,997	-	-	-	772,237	
Executive Office - New York	838,130	838,130	-	-	-	911,734	
Common Costs - New York	640,150	640,150	-	-	-	854,786	
Administrative Office - Geneva	2,828,309	3,177,031	-	-	-	2,027,905	
Common Costs - Geneva	465,424	465,424	-	-	-	465,400	
Field Support Unit	1,240,170	1,618,047	-	-	-	1,056,544	
IASC/ECHA Secretariat	812,597	812,597	-	-	-	594,502	
Coordination and Response Division (CRD)	5,158,903	5,158,903	-	-	-	5,390,544	
Emergency Services Branch (ESB)	512,573	512,573	-	-	-	380,239	
Policy Development and Studies Branch (PDSB)	2,758,767	2,758,767	-	-	-	1,931,867	
Advocacy and External Relations and Information Management and Technology (AERIMB)	- 4,923,213	- 4,923,213	- -	- -	- -	- 4,780,385	
Subtotal for Core Activities	21,720,474	22,447,073	16,844,121	14,109,125	669,951	20,499,918^b	
PROJECTS	Requirements 2005	Revised Requirements 2005	Opening Balance	Contributions	Other Income, Transfers, Savings and Adjustments	Expenditure 2005	Closing Balance
Donor and External Relations	1,358,078	1,498,655	560,953	499,372	134	524,402	536,057
Staff Development and Training	804,909	804,909	720,687	601,595	13	564,936	757,359
CAP Strengthening	1,810,339	1,810,339	1,253,094	1,471,278	295	1,433,731	1,290,936
Surge Capacity	846,271	846,271	415,399	871,850	38	353,036	934,251
Disaster Response Preparedness Project	241,820	241,820	60,000	400,577	-	103,090	357,487
Field Coordination Support Section	1,647,615	1,647,615	2,270,678	1,511,553	(210,756)	1,492,860	2,078,615
UNDAC Developing Countries	898,787	898,787	638,421	1,256,914	183,828	527,378	1,551,785
Military and Civil Defence	1,620,057	1,629,774	1,491,161	1,018,931	(190,175)	1,199,447	1,120,470
Logistics Support Project	123,735	123,735	-	123,735	-	122,812	923
Environmental Emergency Services	252,221	252,221	247,871	275,000	-	210,366	312,505
Internal Displacement Division	3,456,272	3,456,272	1,393,758	4,080,094	(247,224)	3,143,186	2,083,442
Protection of Civilians	769,883	769,883	459,088	350,000	7,032	438,448	377,672
Evaluation and Studies	406,800	406,800	313,311	622,120	30,334	402,671	563,094
Gender Equality	301,602	301,602	-	269,378	-	55,299	214,079
Relief Web	2,030,824	2,001,614	2,157,380	1,592,297	1,416	1,836,316	1,914,777
Field Information Support	970,279	970,279	729,644	885,000	2,120	1,108,821	507,943
Field Information Management	2,808,953	2,808,953	635,373	2,230,869	-	2,689,222	177,020
Subtotal for Headquarters Projects	20,348,445	20,469,529	13,346,818^c	18,060,563	(422,945)	16,206,021^d	14,778,415
Total for OCHA Headquarters	42,068,919	42,916,602	30,190,939	32,169,688	247,006	36,705,939	

a Core activities are funded from voluntary contributions and from the Special Account from Programme Support

b Consists of expenditure of US\$ 14,609,146 under the Trust Fund for Strengthening of OCHA, US\$ 5,890,772 under Special Account for Programme Support

c Closing Balance for HQ Projects for 2004 were US\$ 13,587,295 (Annual Report 2004). 2005 table does not include US\$ 300,478 for Humanitarian Impact of Sanctions and includes US\$ 60,000 for Disaster Response Preparedness that were not in the 2005 Annual Report

d Consists of expenditure of US\$ 5,564,031 under the Trust Fund for Strengthening of OCHA and US\$ 10,641,990 under Trust Fund for Disaster Relief

TABLE 6 Field Coordination Activities (US\$)

	Requirements 2005	Revised Requirements 2005	Opening Balance	Contributions	Other Income, Transfers, Savings and, Adjustments	Expenditure	Closing Balance
AFRICA							
Angola	510,997	1,561,732	1,965,626	676,566	807,563	1,833,092	1,616,663
Burundi	2,154,372	2,154,372	1,636,107	2,100,471	1,547	2,062,078	1,676,047
Central African Republic	534,861	534,861	503,410	298,024	(1,275)	486,995	313,164
Chad	546,337	546,337	130,415	597,222	(1,278)	501,298	225,061
Côte d'Ivoire	2,979,494	3,083,877	708,077	3,084,517	(926)	3,139,920	651,748
Democratic Republic of Congo	7,496,000	10,718,184	3,858,555	8,235,481	135,562	10,831,478	1,398,120
Eritrea	526,681	618,591	173,439	632,467	(216,293)	411,265	178,348
Ethiopia	1,567,470	1,684,717	547,245	2,291,263	(87,305)	1,323,056	1,428,147
Guinea	1,272,007	1,529,986	396,751	1,149,823	74,057	1,347,986	272,645
Liberia - Monrovia HIC	775,354	804,728	494,338	642,540	(144,130)	821,087	171,661
Niger	-	700,549	-	477,947	157,693	391,480	244,160
Republic of the Congo	858,337	858,337	600,397	559,519	(1,303)	715,458	443,155
Sierra Leone	215,902	331,360	187,864	173,744	(20,572)	291,516	49,520
Somalia	1,856,617	2,271,146	779,812	1,560,549	5,755	1,792,475	553,641
Sudan	9,970,409	21,475,870	5,627,884	11,814,895	3,422,138	18,157,060	2,707,857
Sudan - Darfur HIC	1,353,844	1,353,844	38,341	1,141,838	2,630	410,057	772,752
Uganda	3,580,154	3,580,154	1,853,993	4,060,305	(1,316,512)	2,661,453 ^a	1,936,333
Zimbabwe	731,576	731,576	380,040	1,587,933	-	359,205	1,608,768
Regional Office for Central & East Africa (Nairobi)	1,833,710	1,833,710	559,595	1,750,099	1,678	1,504,527	806,845
Regional Office for Southern Africa (Johannesburg)	699,687	912,754	763,004	728,286	(183,583)	887,627	420,080
Southern Africa Humanitarian Information Management System (SAHIMS)	687,546	687,546	204,863	200,000	294,043	413,938	284,968
Regional Office for West Africa (Dakar)	2,330,934	2,481,746	542,267	1,849,716	(50,136)	1,602,540	739,307
Subtotal for Africa	42,482,289	60,455,977	21,952,023	45,613,205	2,879,353	51,945,591	18,498,990
MIDDLE EAST							
occupied Palestinian territory	2,588,423	2,588,423	734,537	2,746,891	(106)	2,207,933	1,273,389
Regional Office for the Middle East, North Africa, Iran and Afghanistan (Dubai)	452,009	376,408	-	533,000	-	337,749	195,251
Subtotal for Middle East	3,040,432	2,964,831	734,537	3,279,891	(106)	2,545,682	1,468,640
ASIA							
Democratic People's Republic of Korea	432,926	432,926	458,755	266,930	-	300,121	425,564
Indonesia	632,615	697,687	1,172,428	-	(144,476)	739,802	288,150
The Islamic Republic of Iran	293,782	328,984	269,534	127,000	(104,748)	158,355	133,431
Nepal	369,774	1,626,350	97,413	1,785,334	141	891,280	991,608
Regional Disaster Response Advisor - Asia (Kobe)	528,786	528,786	186,944	164,000	85,000	259,402	176,542
Regional Disaster Response Advisor - Pacific (Suva)	327,011	419,917	120,664	382,368	-	254,948	248,084
Regional Office for Asia and the Pacific (Bangkok)	740,842	804,687	396,407	1,057,500	19,160	778,958	694,109
Subtotal for Asia	3,325,736	4,839,337	2,702,145	3,783,132	(144,923)	3,382,866	2,957,488
EUROPE							
The Russian Federation	1,734,229	1,645,993	651,322	1,492,250	-	1,026,538	1,117,034
Subtotal for Europe	1,734,229	1,645,993	651,322	1,492,250	-	1,026,538	1,117,034
AMERICAS AND THE CARIBBEAN							
Colombia	2,797,691	2,797,691	1,194,494	1,512,390	92,326	2,114,332	684,878
Haiti	563,879	563,879	206,788	443,980	121,456	504,510	267,714
Regional Office for Latin America & Caribbean (Panama)	1,269,128	983,694	370,667	555,000	28,527	604,871	349,323
Subtotal for Latin America and the Caribbean	4,630,698	4,345,264	1,771,949	2,511,370	242,309	3,223,713	1,301,915
Integrated Regional Information Network (IRIN)	5,214,189	5,442,491	2,175,973	6,136,461	596,826	5,978,646	2,930,614
Total for OCHA 2005 Field Offices	60,427,573	79,693,893	29,987,949^a	62,816,309^b	3,573,459^c	68,103,036	28,274,681
Total for OCHA 2005 HQ and Field Offices	99,410,458^d	122,610,495	60,178,888	94,985,997	3,820,465	104,808,975	
Field Coordination Reserve Fund (FCRF)	-	-	1,042,975	3,279,794	(3,106,360)	-	1,216,409

a Includes opening balance Republic of Congo US\$ 600,397, Islamic Republic of Iran US\$ 269,534 and RDRA South Asia (Bangkok) US\$ 396,407 not in *OCHA in 2004*, but included in *OCHA in 2005*.

Does not include balances of 2004 projects that are not part of *OCHA in 2005* - Mozambique US\$ 437,257, Liberia US\$ 22,335, Iraq US\$ 1,640,059, Tajikistan US\$ 59,469 and Georgia US\$ 10,657

b Includes allocations from FCRF for US\$ 3,408,823

c Includes transfers from the Unearmarked sub account of US\$ 4,666,510 and other net transfers, refunds and miscellaneous income and adjustments of US\$ 819,691

d Total requested in *OCHA in 2005* did not include other funds available for US\$ 3,086,034

Donor Contributions in 2005

TABLE 7

SOURCE OF CONTRIBUTIONS	Trust Fund for Disaster Relief		Trust Fund for the Strengthening of OCHA		Total
	Field Activities and HQ Projects	Natural Disasters Humanitarian Funds and other activities	Core Activities and HQ Projects	IRIN	
United Kingdom	13,247,799	8,701,195	4,274,521	1,022,011	27,245,526
Sweden	9,604,772	6,610,259	1,889,029	940,817	19,044,877
Norway	11,389,929	3,195,013	2,063,026	638,108	17,286,076
ECHO	6,543,228	4,465,203	2,230,869	778,210	14,017,510
Netherlands	10,567,495	604,000	909,735	540,845	12,622,075
United States of America	7,423,923	50,000	279,855	800,000	8,553,778
Canada	2,733,157	210,722	878,197	283,953	4,106,029
Switzerland	1,590,937	882,731	1,366,215	194,773	4,034,656
Ireland	2,842,186	857,748	-	57,782	3,757,716
Russia	500,000	2,500,000	-	-	3,000,000
Australia	1,744,453	99,790	775,000	225,000	2,844,243
Denmark	1,516,945	416,561	676,437	225,479	2,835,422
Belgium	1,365,346	-	361,882	-	1,727,228
Italy	-	1,228,978	361,446	72,289	1,662,713
Finland	361,446	-	722,892	120,482	1,204,820
Japan	540,577	50,000	300,000	-	890,577
France	196,093	-	545,738	72,785	814,616
Germany	-	40,207	521,740	106,240	668,187
Luxembourg	-	135,685	438,094	-	573,779
Kuwait	-	500,000	-	-	500,000
New Zealand	69,980	50,000	359,237	-	479,217
Turkey	-	250,000	-	-	250,000
Other Agencies	-	-	140,000	32,000	172,000
Austria	60,448	49,975	56,822	-	167,245
Spain	-	-	117,817	-	117,817
Lithuania	-	105,189	-	-	105,189
Private Donors	77,791	22,347	28	400	100,566
Qatar	100,000	-	-	-	100,000
South Africa	-	50,538	-	25,287	75,825
China	-	45,980	20,000	-	65,980
Iceland	-	-	48,442	-	48,442
Singapore	-	20,000	20,000	-	40,000
Mexico	-	40,000	-	-	40,000
Liechtenstein	26,549	-	-	-	26,549
Greece	-	-	24,390	-	24,390
Philippines	12,381	-	-	-	12,381
Slovenia	5,000	-	-	-	5,000
Venezuela	-	-	5,000	-	5,000
Bahamas	-	-	1,900	-	1,900
Total US\$	72,520,435	31,182,121	19,388,312	6,136,461	129,227,329

Voluntary Contributions to OCHA in 2005 from the Top 20 Donors

UNITED KINGDOM

	Contribution US\$
OCHA Headquarters:	
Core Activities	3,865,000
Projects	1,861,267
OCHA Field Offices:	
FCRF Unallocated	148,000
Burundi	471,698
Chad	186,855
Côte d'Ivoire	692,442
Democratic Republic of Congo	1,842,513
Eritrea	370,000
Guinea	429,457
Liberia - Monrovia HIC	200,000
Niger	101,665
RO - Central and East Africa (Nairobi)	500,000
RO - Southern Africa (Johannesburg)	228,286
RO - West Africa (Dakar)	454,619
SAHIMS	100,000
Sierra Leone	100,000
Somalia	300,000
Sudan	1,957,354
Sudan - HIC	300,000
Uganda	717,310
Nepal	800,712
RDRA - Asia (Kobe)	52,000
RDRA - Pacific (Fiji)	40,000
RO - South Asia (Bangkok)	870,000
Russian Federation	383,142
Haiti	275,000
RDRA - Latin America & the Caribbean (Panama)	275,000
IRIN	1,022,011
Sub-Total OCHA 2005 Contributions	18,544,331
Other Contributions	
Non-OCHA 2005 and Other Activities	1,138,680
Natural Disasters	41,000
NGO Grants	7,521,515
Total US\$	27,245,526

SWEDEN

	Contribution US\$
OCHA Headquarters:	
Core Activities	1,200,000
Projects	2,931,715
OCHA Field Offices:	
FCRF Unallocated	162,892
Angola	485,149
Burundi	280,366
Central African Republic	140,183
Chad	280,366
Côte d'Ivoire	280,366
Democratic Republic of Congo	280,366
Eritrea	70,092
Guinea	280,366
Republic of Congo	140,183
RO - Central and East Africa (Nairobi)	280,366
RO - West Africa (Dakar)	280,366
Somalia	420,549
Sudan	1,641,541
Uganda	560,732
occupied Palestinian territory	700,915
DPR Korea	266,930
Russian Federation	280,366
Colombia	529,992
IRIN	940,817
Sub-Total OCHA 2005 Contributions	12,434,618
Other Contributions	
Non-OCHA 2005 and Other Activities	1,620,985
Natural Disasters	245,964
NGO Grants	4,743,310
Total US\$	19,044,877

NORWAY

	Contribution US\$
OCHA Headquarters:	
Core Activities	1,008,973
Projects	3,317,651
OCHA Field Offices:	
FCRF Unallocated	333,482
Central African Republic	157,841
Côte d'Ivoire	978,669
Democratic Republic of Congo	770,594
Eritrea	71,553
Ethiopia	940,599
RO - Central and East Africa (Nairobi)	335,000
RO - West Africa (Dakar)	78,950
Republic of Congo	709,336
SAHIMS	100,000
Somalia	200,000
Sudan	825,056
Uganda	612,933
Zimbabwe	1,487,933
occupied Palestinian territory	445,626
RO - Middle East (Dubai)	420,000
Nepal	378,759
RO - Latin America & the Caribbean (Panama)	280,000
IRIN	638,108
Sub-Total OCHA 2005 Contributions	14,091,063
Other Contributions	
Non-OCHA 2005 and Other Activities	1,322,275
Natural Disasters	1,872,738
Total US\$	17,286,076

ECHO

	Contribution US\$
OCHA Headquarters:	
Projects	3,162,211
OCHA Field Offices:	
Angola	191,417
Burundi	448,407
Côte d'Ivoire	292,683
Democratic Republic of Congo	1,004,375
Eritrea	20,822
Ethiopia	261,438
Liberia - Monrovia HIC	294,884
RO-Central and East Africa (Nairobi)	293,301
Sudan	390,244
Sudan - Darfur HIC	241,838
Uganda	818,353
occupied Palestinian territory	1,354,125
IRIN	778,210
Sub-Total OCHA 2005 Contributions	9,552,308
Other Contributions	
Non-OCHA 2005 and Other Activities	3,053,437
Natural Disasters	1,411,765
Total US\$	14,017,510

NETHERLANDS

	Contribution US\$
OCHA Headquarters:	
Core Activities	775,000
Projects	960,730
OCHA Field Offices:	
Burundi	600,000
Côte d'Ivoire	181,000
Democratic Republic of Congo	1,205,000
Ethiopia	100,000
RO - Southern Africa (Johannesbourg)	200,000
RO - West Africa (Dakar)	301,000
Somalia	840,000
Sudan	2,113,000
Uganda	600,000
Russian Federation	240,000
Colombia	361,500
IRIN	540,845
Sub-Total OCHA 2005 Contributions	9,018,075
Other Contributions	
Non-OCHA 2005 and Other Activities	3,000,000
Natural Disasters	604,000
Total US\$	12,622,075

UNITED STATES OF AMERICA

	Contribution US\$
OCHA Headquarters:	
Projects	1,229,855
OCHA Field Offices:	
FCRF Unallocated	150,000
Burundi	300,000
Côte d'Ivoire	178,093
Democratic Republic of Congo	500,000
Ethiopia	750,000
Guinea	100,000
RO - Southern Africa (Johannesbourg)	200,000
RO - West Africa (Dakar)	200,000
Sudan	2,200,000
Sudan - Darfur HIC	600,000
Uganda	500,000
Zimbabwe	100,000
Russian Federation	426,000
Colombia	269,830
IRIN	800,000
Sub-Total OCHA 2005 Contributions	8,503,778
Other Contributions	
Natural Disasters	50,000
Total US\$	8,553,778

CANADA

	Contribution US\$
OCHA Headquarters:	
Core Activities	837,932
Projects	327,687
OCHA Field Offices:	
Chad	130,000
Côte d'Ivoire	234,000
Eritrea	100,000
Guinea	220,000
RO - West Africa (Dakar)	357,000
Republic of Congo	10,000
Uganda	250,977
occupied Palestinian territory	246,225
RO - Middle East (Dubai)	113,000
The Islamic Republic of Iran	77,000
Nepal	205,863
RDRA - Asia (Kobe)	87,000
RDRA - Pacific (Suva)	129,868
Russian Federation	162,742
Colombia	122,060
IRIN	283,953
Sub-Total OCHA 2005 Contributions	3,895,307
Other Contributions	
Natural Disasters	210,722
Total US\$	4,106,029

SWITZERLAND

	Contribution US\$
OCHA Headquarters:	
Core Activities	1,157,477
Projects	1,244,003
OCHA Field Offices:	
Ethiopia	229,008
Liberia - Monrovia HIC	97,656
Colombia	229,008
IRIN	194,773
Sub-Total OCHA 2005 Contributions	3,151,925
Other Contributions	
Non-OCHA 2005 and Other Activities	593,748
Natural Disasters	288,983
Total US\$	4,034,656

IRELAND

	Contribution US\$
OCHA Field Offices:	
Democratic Republic of Congo	588,235
Niger	121,951
RO-Central and East Africa (Nairobi)	324,254
Sudan	1,807,748
IRIN	57,782
Sub-Total OCHA 2005 Contributions	2,899,970
Other Contributions	
Non-OCHA 2005 and Other Activities	237,839
Natural Disasters	230,803
NGO Grants	389,104
Total US\$	3,757,716

RUSSIA

	Contribution US\$
OCHA Headquarters:	
Projects	500,000
Sub-Total OCHA 2005 Contributions	500,000
Other Contributions	
Non-OCHA 2005 and Other Activities	250,000
Natural Disasters	2,250,000
Total US\$	3,000,000

AUSTRALIA

	Contribution US\$
OCHA Headquarters:	
Core Activities	775,000
Projects	575,000
OCHA Field Offices:	
RO - Southern Africa (Johannesbourg)	100,000
Sudan	769,453
RDRA - Pacific (Suva)	112,500
RDRA - South Asia (Bangkok)	187,500
IRIN	225,000
Sub-Total OCHA 2005 Contributions	2,744,453
Other Contributions	
Non-OCHA 2005 and Other Activities	50,000
Natural Disasters	49,790
Total us\$	2,844,243

DENMARK

	Contribution US\$
OCHA Headquarters:	
Core Activities	607,059
Projects	809,211
OCHA Field Offices:	
FCRF Unallocated	65,513
RO - West Africa (Dakar)	96,898
Sierra Leone	65,702
Iran	50,000
Nepal	400,000
Haiti	99,000
IRIN	225,479
Sub-Total OCHA 2005 Contributions	2,418,862
Other Contributions	
Non-OCHA 2005 and Other Activities	378,560
Natural Disasters	38,000
Total us\$	2,835,422

BELGIUM

	Contribution US\$
OCHA Headquarters:	
Core Activities	361,882
OCHA Field Offices:	
Democratic Republic of Congo	1,365,346
Sub-Total OCHA 2005 Contributions	1,727,228
Total us\$	1,727,228

ITALY

	Contribution US\$
OCHA Headquarters:	
Core Activities	361,446
OCHA Field Offices:	
IRIN	72,289
Sub-Total OCHA 2005 Contributions	433,735
Other Contributions	
Natural Disasters	1,228,978
Total us\$	1,662,713

FINLAND

	Contribution US\$
OCHA Headquarters:	
Core Activities	722,892
Projects	120,482
OCHA Field Offices:	
FCRF Unallocated	105,854
Guinea	120,000
RO-Central and East Africa (Nairobi)	15,110
IRIN	120,482
Sub-Total OCHA 2005 Contributions	1,204,820
Total us\$	1,204,820

JAPAN

	Contribution US\$
OCHA Headquarters:	
Core Activities	300,000
Projects	540,577
Sub-Total OCHA 2005 Contributions	840,577
Other Contributions	
Natural Disasters	50,000
Total us\$	890,577

FRANCE

	Contribution US\$
OCHA Headquarters:	
Core Activities	480,000
Projects	226,831
OCHA Field Offices:	
IRIN	72,785
Sub-Total OCHA 2005 Contributions	779,616
Other Contributions	
Non-OCHA 2005 and Other Activities	35,000
Total us\$	814,616

GERMANY

	Contribution US\$
OCHA Headquarters:	
Core Activities	474,708
Projects	47,032
OCHA Field Offices:	
IRIN	106,240
Sub-Total OCHA 2005 Contributions	627,980
Other Contributions	
Natural Disasters	40,207
Total us\$	668,187

LUXEMBOURG

	Contribution US\$
OCHA Headquarters:	
Core Activities	438,094
Other Contributions	
Natural Disasters	135,685
Total us\$	573,779

KUWAIT

	Contribution US\$
Other Contributions	
Natural Disasters	500,000
Total us\$	500,000

TABLE 8

Voluntary Contributions to OCHA by Activity in 2005 (US\$)

ACTIVITIES	UK	Sweden	Norway	ECHO	Netherlands	USA	Canada	Switzerland	Ireland
Core Activities	3,865,000	1,200,000	1,008,973	-	775,000	-	837,932	1,157,477	-
Headquarters Projects	1,861,267	2,931,717	3,317,651	3,162,210	960,730	1,229,855	327,687	1,244,003	-
Evaluation and Studies	209,521	75,000	75,000	-	59,735	29,855	40,265	20,000	-
Field Information Support	-	100,000	460,000	-	75,000	250,000	-	-	-
Field Information Management	-	-	-	2,230,869	-	-	-	-	-
Gender Equality	-	100,000	100,000	-	-	-	-	-	-
Protection of Civilians	100,000	100,000	100,000	-	-	-	-	-	-
ReliefWeb	100,000	314,031	319,055	-	-	-	-	-	-
ReliefWeb Project	146,937	-	-	311,282	50,995	-	-	-	-
ReliefWeb - Kobe	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
CAP Strengthening Project	100,000	250,000	150,000	570,687	125,000	-	-	275,591	-
Disaster Response Preparedness Project	60,000	100,000	100,000	-	-	-	-	-	-
Environmental Emergency Project	75,000	100,000	50,000	-	50,000	-	-	-	-
Donor and External Relations	-	200,000	100,000	49,372	100,000	-	-	-	-
Field Coordination Support Project	-	350,000	303,101	-	75,000	300,000	165,728	305,344	-
Internal Displacement Division	600,000	442,686	478,581	-	250,000	650,000	121,694	346,218	-
Logistics Support	-	50,000	50,000	-	-	-	-	-	-
Civil-Military Coordination	218,214	200,000	150,000	-	75,000	-	-	100,000	-
Staff Development & Training Project	101,595	150,000	250,000	-	100,000	-	-	-	-
Surge Capacity	100,000	200,000	175,000	-	-	-	-	196,850	-
UNDAC Developing Countries	50,000	200,000	456,914	-	-	-	-	-	-
FCRF	148,000	162,892	333,482	-	3,000,000	150,000	-	-	-
Africa	8,952,199	5,420,989	7,268,464	4,257,762	6,140,000	5,628,093	1,301,977	326,664	2,842,188
Angola	-	485,148	-	191,417	-	-	-	-	-
Burundi	471,698	280,366	-	448,407	600,000	300,000	-	-	-
Central African Republic	-	140,183	157,841	-	-	-	-	-	-
Chad	186,855	280,366	-	-	-	-	130,000	-	-
Côte d'Ivoire	692,442	280,366	978,669	292,683	181,000	178,093	234,000	-	-
Democratic Republic Of Congo	1,842,513	280,366	1,070,594	1,004,375	1,205,000	500,000	-	-	588,235
Eritrea	370,000	70,091	71,553	20,822	-	-	100,000	-	-
Ethiopia	-	-	940,599	261,438	100,000	750,000	-	229,008	-
Guinea	429,457	280,366	-	-	-	100,000	220,000	-	-
Liberia - Monrovia HIC	200,000	-	-	294,884	-	-	-	97,656	-
Niger	101,665	-	200,000	-	-	-	-	-	121,951
Republic of Congo	-	140,183	409,336	-	-	-	10,000	-	-
RO - Central & East Africa (Nairobi)	500,000	280,366	335,000	293,301	-	-	-	-	324,254
RO - Southern Africa (Johannesburg)	228,286	-	-	-	200,000	200,000	-	-	-
RO - West Africa (Dakar)	454,619	280,366	78,950	-	301,000	200,000	357,000	-	-
SAHIMS	100,000	-	100,000	-	-	-	-	-	-
Sierra Leone	100,000	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
Somalia	300,000	420,549	-	-	840,000	-	-	-	-
Sudan	1,957,354	1,641,541	825,056	390,244	2,113,000	2,200,000	-	-	1,807,748
Sudan - Darfur HIC	300,000	-	-	241,838	-	600,000	-	-	-
Uganda	717,310	560,732	612,933	818,353	600,000	500,000	250,977	-	-
Zimbabwe	-	-	1,487,933	-	-	100,000	-	-	-
Middle East	-	700,915	865,626	1,354,125	-	-	359,225	-	-
occupied Palestinian territory	-	700,915	445,626	1,354,125	-	-	246,225	-	-
RO - ME, N. Africa, Iran, Afghanistan (Dubai)	-	-	420,000	-	-	-	113,000	-	-
Asia	1,762,712	266,930	378,759	-	-	-	499,731	-	-
DPR Korea	-	266,930	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
The Islamic Republic of Iran	-	-	-	-	-	-	77,000	-	-
Nepal	800,712	-	378,759	-	-	-	205,863	-	-
RDRA - Asia (Kobe)	52,000	-	-	-	-	-	87,000	-	-
RDRA - Pacific (Suva)	40,000	-	-	-	-	-	129,868	-	-
RO - South Asia (Bangkok)	870,000	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
Europe	383,142	280,366	-	-	240,000	426,000	162,742	-	-
The Russian Federation	383,142	280,366	-	-	240,000	426,000	162,742	-	-
Americas and the Caribbean	550,000	529,992	280,000	-	361,500	269,830	122,060	229,008	-
Colombia	-	529,992	-	-	361,500	269,830	122,060	229,008	-
Haiti	275,000	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
RDRA - Latin America & Caribbean (Panama)	275,000	-	280,000	-	-	-	-	-	-
IRIN	1,022,011	940,817	638,108	778,210	540,845	800,000	283,953	194,773	57,782
Total OCHA 2005 Appeal	18,544,331	12,434,618	14,091,063	9,552,307	12,018,075	8,503,778	3,895,307	3,151,925	2,899,970
Non-OCHA 2005 and Other Activities	1,138,680	1,620,985	1,322,275	3,053,437	-	-	-	593,748	237,839
Natural Disasters	41,000	245,964	1,872,738	1,411,766	604,000	50,000	210,722	288,983	230,803
Humanitarian Funds and other Activities	7,521,515	4,743,310	-	-	-	-	-	-	389,104
Total Contributions by Donor	27,245,526	19,044,877	17,286,076	14,017,510	12,622,075	8,553,778	4,106,029	4,034,656	3,757,716

	Russia	Australia	Denmark	Belgium	Italy	Finland	Japan	France	Germany	Luxembourg	Kuwait	Others	Grand Total
	-	775,000	607,059	361,882	361,446	722,892	300,000	480,000	474,708	438,094	-	743,662	14,109,125
500,000	575,000	575,000	809,211	-	-	120,482	540,577	226,831	47,032	-	-	206,314	18,060,567
	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	15,738	47,032	-	-	49,974	622,120
	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	885,000
	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	2,230,869
	-	-	69,378	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	269,378
	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	50,000	-	-	-	-	350,000
	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	733,086
	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	509,214
	-	-	-	-	-	-	350,000	-	-	-	-	-	350,000
	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	1,471,278
	-	-	-	-	-	-	140,577	-	-	-	-	-	400,577
	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	275,000
	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	50,000	-	-	-	-	499,372
	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	12,381	1,511,554
	-	375,000	531,698	-	-	120,482	-	50,000	-	-	-	113,735	4,080,094
	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	23,735	-	-	-	-	123,735
	-	-	208,135	-	-	-	-	37,358	-	-	-	30,224	1,018,931
	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	601,595
	-	200,000	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	871,850
500,000	-	-	-	-	-	-	50,000	-	-	-	-	-	1,256,914
	-	-	65,513	-	-	105,854	-	-	-	-	-	-	3,965,741
	-	869,453	162,600	1,365,346	-	135,110	-	-	-	-	-	125,828	44,796,673
	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	676,565
	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	2,100,471
	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	298,024
	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	597,221
	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	2,837,253
	-	-	-	1,365,346	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	7,856,429
	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	632,466
	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	10,218	2,291,263
	-	-	-	-	-	120,000	-	-	-	-	-	-	1,149,823
	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	592,540
	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	5,110	428,726
	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	559,519
	-	100,000	-	-	-	15,110	-	-	-	-	-	-	1,748,031
	-	-	96,898	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	728,286
	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	1,768,833
	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	200,000
	-	-	65,702	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	165,702
	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	1,560,549
	-	769,453	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	110,500	11,814,896
	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	1,141,838
	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	4,060,305
	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	1,587,933
	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	3,279,891
	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	2,746,891
	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	533,000
	-	300,000	450,000	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	3,658,132
	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	266,930
	-	-	50,000	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	127,000
	-	-	400,000	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	1,785,334
	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	139,000
	-	112,500	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	282,368
	-	187,500	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	1,057,500
	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	1,492,250
	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	1,492,250
	-	-	99,000	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	69,980	2,511,370
	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	1,512,390
	-	-	99,000	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	69,980	443,980
	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	555,000
	-	225,000	225,479	-	72,289	120,482	-	72,785	106,240	-	-	57,687	6,136,461
500,000	2,744,453	2,418,862	1,727,228	433,735	1,204,820	840,577	779,616	627,980	438,094	-	-	1,203,471	98,010,210
250,000	50,000	378,560	-	-	-	-	35,000	-	-	-	-	116,518	8,797,042
2,250,000	49,790	38,000	-	1,228,978	-	50,000	-	40,207	135,685	500,000	-	517,512	9,766,148
	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	12,653,929
	3,000,000	2,844,243	2,835,422	1,727,228	1,662,713	1,204,820	890,577	814,616	668,187	573,779	500,000	1,837,501	129,227,329

PART II

HEADQUARTERS CORE ACTIVITIES AND PROJECTS



OCHA/IRIN

EXECUTIVE MANAGEMENT

Office of the Under-Secretary-General/Emergency Relief Coordinator; Deputy Emergency Relief Coordinator; Director, New York; and Assistant Emergency Relief Coordinator/Director, Geneva

2005 was characterised by major disasters such as the Indian Ocean tsunami and the South Asia earthquake and by emergencies such as those in Sudan and the Democratic Republic of the Congo. OCHA executive management provided leadership in the response to these disasters, while maintaining an active engagement with advocacy, broadening partnerships, strengthening field support and supporting numerous monitoring and evaluation activities.

In addition, OCHA executive management focused on humanitarian reform. The OUSG's and Directors' offices led OCHA in developing the mechanisms to support three pillars of the reform process: implementation of the cluster approach, strengthening of the HC system, and establishment of the Central Emergency Response Fund.

Key objective

- In line with OCHA's 2005 Strategic Plan, the key objective of executive management was to provide leadership in preparedness and response to crises, including advocacy for effective and principled humanitarian action. An important component of this objective during the course of the year was the overseeing of the humanitarian reform process in light of the recommendations of the Humanitarian Response Review and the Secretary-General's report *In larger freedom*

Activities

OCHA's executive management assisted governments of affected countries in coordinating the response of the international community to humanitarian crises. It rapidly deployed staff and emergency response teams in the aftermath of major disasters and effectively provided coordination structures for humanitarian assistance in crises. OCHA executive management also facilitated improvements in the delivery of aid to war torn areas of the world, including Darfur.

Throughout 2005, the ERC made numerous field visits to countries from Zimbabwe and Sudan to Pakistan and Sri Lanka. Especially, the ERC's visits to the year's major crises, such as the South Asia earthquake and Darfur, strengthened political and humanitarian

engagement and served a strong advocacy function, while his visit to the Caribbean helped to lead the Hurricane Season Initiative.

The DERC visited other areas affected by the year's major crises. Most prominent was her involvement with post-crisis follow-up to the Sahel drought and her three months as the Secretary-General's Special Coordinator for Humanitarian Assistance to Tsunami-affected Communities.

Additionally, the ERC conducted numerous high profile interviews on the year's crises and placed op-eds on humanitarian issues in major papers around the globe.

The ERC continued to advocate for humanitarian issues in the Security Council in five briefings on country situations such as Darfur and Uganda and on the protection of civilians.

In its efforts to broaden partnerships, executive management increased dialogue with Regional Groupings, the private sector, emerging donors and non-governmental organisations. A number of information meetings for all Member States were held on the major crises which occurred during the course of the year.

Throughout 2005, executive management steered the humanitarian reform process. With its support, the cluster approach was developed as a means to strengthen capacities in sectors and areas of response where gaps had been identified. Clusters now have been established for nine areas. OCHA also supported the first field implementations of the cluster approach in the pilot countries of Liberia, DRC and Uganda. This approach also was instituted in Pakistan, resulting in valuable lessons learned to further improve response.

OCHA's executive management successfully supported the further enhancement of response capacity by spearheading the development of an IASC pool of 20 rapidly deployable HCs and by widening the pool of qualified candidates by providing training and by strengthening the support to HCs.

Executive management also led the process that culminated in the establishment of a US\$ 450 million grant facility which, combined with the existing US\$ 50 million dollar loan facility of the Central Emergency Revolving Fund, resulted in the establishment of the new Central Emergency Response Fund, and was approved by the General Assembly in

December of 2005. The upgraded CERF marks great progress in providing more equitable humanitarian funding based on need.

Executive management also addressed internal improvements. A pre-screened, pre-approved Roster system and a Rotation Policy were developed during the year for approval and implementation in 2006. Delegation of authority for OCHA to recruit, deploy and administer its field staff was approved in principle by OHRM. Senior management also began a process of improved, more regular and more transparent communications to mid-level management and other staff.

Following the World Conference on Disaster Risk Reduction, the functioning and structure of the International Strategy for Disaster Reduction (ISDR) Secretariat was improved and a new system for the ISDR was approved.

In order to further develop linkages between development and other humanitarian partners, executive management focused on transition and early recovery through a strengthened country-level coordination system with the active participation of the RC and HC. For example, the joint DPKO/UNDP/OCHA mission to the DRC resulted in a more coherent Action Plan for the DRC prior to the 2006 elections.

Performance evaluation

OCHA gained wide recognition from donors, humanitarian partners and the press for its leadership in coordinating the response to crises such as the Indian Ocean tsunami and the South Asia earthquake.

Through its sustained advocacy, the executive management succeeded in raising funds for emergencies occurring during the course of the year.

The ERC conducted high-profile visits to neglected crises, including Sri Lanka and Indonesia as the world's attention was turning away and Labado in Darfur, gave 125 interviews and placed over two dozen op-eds in major media outlets to help bring neglected emergencies

to the attention of member governments, donors and other relevant actors.

New partnerships developed with non-traditional donors and the private sector strengthened OCHA's ability to respond to humanitarian crises. For example, partnerships developed with the UN Foundation, PricewaterhouseCoopers (PWC) and Deutsche Post (DHL) will help increase private sector resource mobilisation, strengthen accountability, and increase UN capacity for airport logistics during crises.

Through OCHA's successful advocacy and mobilisation of support, the General Assembly approved the Central Emergency Response Fund in December 2005, making it the first implemented element of the S-G's reform.

The cluster lead approach was accepted by the IASC and adopted in four countries.

OCHA bolstered humanitarian response capacity by laying the foundations for a pool of 20 deployable Humanitarian Coordinators and by deepening the pool of qualified candidates.

The Advocacy Strategy was adopted, as was a position paper that defined the role of OCHA in disaster risk reduction in the light of the Hyogo Framework for Action.

The ISDR system was strengthened and the "Hyogo Framework for Action" was advocated for by the Secretary-General and his special envoy for tsunami recovery.

The World Conference on Disaster Reduction resulted in broad agreement from Member States on steps to address risk reduction.

Executive Management

	Office of the USG New York	Office of the Director Geneva	2005 TOTAL
Requirements	765,241	776,997	1,542,238
Expenditure			
Staff Costs	913,146	576,352	1,489,498
Consultant Fees and Travel	-	17,170	17,170
Travel	300,464	89,485	389,949
Operating Expenses	-	-	-
Contractual Services	-	388	388
Supplies, Material, Furniture and Equipment	-	-	-
Fellowships, Grants and Contributions	-	-	-
Programme Support Costs	120,165	88,842	209,007
Total Expenditure US\$	1,333,775	772,237	2,106,012

Income for Core Activities is recorded in total under the Trust Fund for the Strengthening of OCHA

Donor and External Relations Section

The work of the Donor and External Relations Section was greatly influenced by the humanitarian response to the Indian Ocean tsunami and the South Asia earthquake, which required mobilisation of all capacities in the section. The Humanitarian Reform also took shape and the General Assembly endorsed an upgrade of the Central Emergency Revolving Fund (CERF). Opportunities presented themselves to move forward with the development of a system to receive funding from the private and corporate sectors.

OCHA made progress in broadening partnerships and the donor base, with the support of members of the OCHA Donor Support Group and other key developing countries. As the overall requirements increased by some 20 percent in the course of the year, the share received from the UN regular budget dropped to less than nine percent of the global budget. Despite the major financial challenges, donors contributed 97 percent of the initial needs and fully funded several short-term projects.

The planned integration of Donor and External Relations to strengthen the coherence and effectiveness of support to humanitarian and donor partners did take place in New York, but implementation has been delayed in Geneva. Nevertheless a number of activities were undertaken jointly in Geneva, in particular with regard to initiatives on new partnerships.

Key objectives

- Advocate and mobilise support for humanitarian initiatives by strengthening relationships with Member States of the United Nations system, intergovernmental, regional and European organisations and civil society, the Red Cross movements, and NGOs involved in humanitarian action
- Advise the Senior Management Team on the strategic management of the relationship of OCHA with humanitarian partners and the mobilisation of resources
- Serve as the focal point of support to management in focusing within OCHA on proactive and strategic interactions with donors

Activities

Relations with an increased number of Member States were further strengthened thanks to a great extent

to support from the Chair and a number of members of the OCHA Donor Support Group. This was reflected, for instance, in a seminar on partnerships in international humanitarian action held in Abu Dhabi in May 2005 and organised in close cooperation between OCHA, Sweden and the United Arab Emirates Red Crescent Society.

OCHA also adopted a regional approach in broadening humanitarian partnerships, developing tailor-made strategies and institutionalising policy dialogues with each regional group. Senior managers undertook missions to target countries to concretise partnerships.

The mobilisation of resources was supported by increased interaction with existing and potential new donors, and with advice to the SMT on the strategic management of proactive interaction with donors and all entities within OCHA, both at headquarters and in the field.

The section worked closely with a number of donors towards a more strategic and multi-year partnership, with the aim of achieving greater predictability of funding for OCHA's annual and project-specific requirements.

The requirements for an OCHA Contributions Tracking system to form the basis for systematic reporting to donors were outlined in 2005, but a heavy workload and delayed recruitment of an expert meant that its development was not started until year-end.

Against the background of the generous response to the two major natural disasters in 2005, the Indian Ocean tsunami and the South Asia earthquake, the number of donors who provided funding to OCHA for activities inside and outside the requirements reflected in *OCHA in 2005* increased considerably. The section followed up with these new donors to find ways to translate ad hoc contributions into more sustained relationships.

The reform of the humanitarian system, and especially the endorsement of the Central Emergency Response Fund (CERF), provided a unique opportunity to play a pivotal role on behalf of the wider UN humanitarian family in mobilising support. The section organised a number of consultation meetings with OCHA senior managers and Member States to ensure broader support to the reform processes.

One of the most important messages to United Nations Member States was that funding for the CERF should be additional to the contributions provided to

humanitarian agencies on an annual basis, rather than a shift of resources towards a central fund.

As a direct result of the unprecedented response to the tsunami, the section became actively involved in efforts to harness and facilitate private sector engagement. The most concrete outputs were the development of a relationship with the Business Roundtable, the joint organisation of a high-level conference on Advancing Public Private Partnership in Response to Global Disasters, and the launch of an online orientation guide for corporate donations, developed in cooperation with the Global Compact.

In addition, the section developed partnerships with the UN Foundation on resource mobilisation from the private sector by online contribution facilities for earthquake relief in Pakistan; with PricewaterhouseCoopers (PWC) to strengthen accountability; and with Deutsche Post (DHL) to increase UN capacity for airport logistics during crises.

Continued participation in the Good Humanitarian Donorship Implementation Group in Geneva, on behalf of the IASC Contact Group on GHD, made it possible to continue follow-up with its members on a number of principles with direct implications for OCHA's funding situation.

Meanwhile, the harmonisation of reporting requirements, for which OCHA was one of the three pilot agencies, was adopted as a key objective for the OCHA Donor Support Group. The section developed a tracking matrix on the reporting and management demands from ODSG members, which clearly shows the progress made since 2003 and where further improvement can be made.

The section continued to be the focal point with donors and DESA for the Associate Experts Programme for OCHA Geneva and the field, and was involved in the selection and recruitment of a number of AEs, including liaison with donors on prospective candidates and positions, and making recommendations to relevant OCHA branches and units.

Performance evaluation

Interaction with UN Member States, including with members of the G-77 in Geneva and New York, and with the European Commission, increased considerably and resulted in additional funding and

other forms of support for OCHA's annual and ad hoc requirements.

The funding in real terms increased from US\$ 80.6 million in 2004 to US\$ 94.9 million in 2005. Despite the considerable increase in OCHA's requirements, 81 percent were met, which is the same percentage level as in 2004. Based in part on consultation and advocacy by the section, developing countries became strong supporters of the CERF and now constitute 50 percent of donors to the fund.

The number of donors who contributed to activities in *OCHA in 2005* rose to 40 in 2005, up from 34 who contributed to *OCHA in 2004*. Luxembourg joined the ODSG in 2005, bringing the number of members to 18 at the end of 2005.

On top of this, there were many donors, including from the corporate and private sector, who provided funding and in-kind assistance to OCHA in response to the Indian Ocean tsunami. OCHA allocated these funds to UN Agencies and international organisations participating in the Flash Appeal on the basis of priorities identified by the Humanitarian Coordinators on behalf of the country teams.

The establishment of Public-Private Partnerships was a real breakthrough in 2005, and has laid the groundwork for future developments, in particular in allowing for private or corporate contributions to the upgraded CERF. The section concluded three public-private partnerships, with PriceWaterhouseCoopers (PWC), Deutsche Post (DHL) and First Logic.

The share of unearmarked or less rigidly earmarked funding grew from 28 percent in 2004 to close to 50 percent in 2005.

Donor and External Relations Section

Requirements	1,498,655
Income from Voluntary Contributions	499,372
EXPENDITURE	
Staff Costs	401,055
Consultant Fees and Travel	-
Travel	50,123
Operating Expenses	8,176
Contractual Services	-
Supplies, Material, Furniture and Equipment	4,719
Fellowships, Grants and Contributions	-
Programme Support Costs	60,329
Total Expenditure US\$	524,402

Executive and Administrative Offices

The Executive Office (EO) serves as the focal point in OCHA for all budgetary, financial, human resources management and common administrative support services, and assists the Under-Secretary-General and ERC with the provision of administrative support for activities at headquarters and in the field. The EO comprises the administrative services in New York, which also serves as the Executive Office of OCHA, and the Administrative Office in Geneva (AO).

Under the umbrella of the AO, the Field Support Section and the Staff Development and Learning Project supported the overall objectives of the Executive/Administrative Offices. The FSS came into existence in March 2005, to serve as focal point for administrative, financial and especially human resources requests and queries from the field. The SDL focuses on strengthening staff capacity through learning programmes.

Key objectives

- Provide strengthened support to OCHA field operations
- Ensure the proper functioning of the Field Support Section
- Develop tools, in collaboration with the ICT section, to enhance the management of resources and operations
- Assist and support executive management

Activities

OCHA's expanded field presence saw AO focus on enhancing its capacity, structures and mechanisms to improve support to the field. EO/AO also participated in regional meetings to identify areas in which Regional Offices can provide supplementary support. A workshop on best practices was held in Geneva to address common concerns, learn from experience and ultimately enhance local administrative services.

After the tsunami disaster and the South Asia earthquake, EO/AO was tasked with establishing new field offices, preparing emergency cost plans, deploying emergency personnel and installing key administrative and financial mechanisms.

Pending the dissemination of the Field Administrative Manual, completed in 2005 and undergoing final review, EO/AO launched a series of circulars to keep field offices up to date and address common queries.

Troubleshooting missions were undertaken, as were field visits to address staff concerns, provide training and discuss practices with local service providers.

The establishment of the FSS in March 2005 added value to the EO/AO role in addressing emergencies, supporting the financial and human resources sections of the AO in support to the field. EO/AO offered support to the nascent FSS in defining its role and relationships with other administrative sections.

The Field Accounting System was put into operation in August, and enhancements in financial reporting were introduced to improve cash flow management and managers' continuous knowledge of financial reserves.

The EO assisted the Under-Secretary-General in his presentations before intergovernmental bodies to justify and articulate OCHA's budgetary requests. It also attended to the requirements of the Fifth Committee, including the implications of tabled resolutions for budgets and programmes, and assisted executive management in General Assembly deliberations that led to the establishment of the upgraded CERF.

Under delegation of authority, EO/AO accepted voluntary contributions on behalf of OCHA, issued allotments and approved staffing authorisations, including the creation of extra-budgetary posts.

The delegation of authority for OCHA to recruit, deploy and administer its field staff was approved by OHRM, and EO/AO is undertaking discussions with OHRM to develop the parameters, elaborate monitoring mechanisms and ensure that adequate capacity is in place to take on this added responsibility.

Staff rotation policy guidelines were completed (though not endorsed by OHRM until 2006) and will help provide a structured career development path for staff. EO/AO continued to follow up and seek authorisation from OHRM to implement, on an exceptional basis, the recommendations of the Secretary-General's Working Group to align the conditions of service for OCHA field staff with those of the UN Funds and Programmes.

The General Service Skills Inventory project, aimed at providing enhanced career opportunities for General Service support staff, reached an advanced stage, with specific recommendations on staff development and career prospects for each staff member.

To address chronic delays in recruitment, despite expedited procedures, EO/AO started the development of a roster system intended to supersede the expedited procedures and be the sole modality for recruitment of field staff. While consultations with OHRM are continuing, the system is expected to be launched in 2006.

In Geneva, the process of converting project posts continued and is ongoing as these posts become vacant and are redefined to conform to posts of a continuing nature. A total of 13 posts remain to be converted.

The EO/AO continued to assist executive management in the implementation of the Human Resources Action Plan for 2005, ensuring OCHA performance in meeting vacancy, geography, gender and staff development targets. Apart from dialogues between staff and management, and quarterly meetings with the Under-Secretary-General, 'town hall meetings' were held throughout the year on various topics of interest to staff.

Support was also provided to executive management with regard to OCHA's recommendations for the Secretary-General's reform programme, consolidating and articulating earlier OCHA proposals in the areas of human resources and financial management.

Performance evaluation

AO's expansion and establishment of various administrative mechanisms led to improvements in the timeliness of response to field queries, the facilities accorded field offices in preparing cost plans and monitoring of their financial status, and administrative support provided by regional offices, particularly in Africa. Improvements were seen in response to the Indian Ocean tsunami and South Asia

earthquake, when the first cohort of staff was deployed immediately and a second group was quickly recruited, using expedited procedures.

While a number of human resources management initiatives affecting field staff were pursued, implementation was delayed in 2005 pending OHRM endorsement. Most of these initiatives were included in the Secretary-General's reform proposals, however, increasing the possibility of their implementation in OCHA on a pilot basis.

The design of tools to improve the management of financial authorisations to the field offices, and to provide offices with access to generate available funds at a given point in time, was not completed due to the reordering of priorities within the ICT section.

Tools were put in place to improve the management of cost plans and provide financial information to field offices through FAS, allowing one login ID with controlled access rights for all OCHA applications, standard and protected presentation of cost plans to all authorised persons worldwide, and access by field offices and headquarters to financial information at any given time.

Executive management was supported through help with preparation of *OCHA in 2005* and the 2006-2007 programme budget, and its articulation before inter-governmental reviewing bodies. The General Assembly approved all of OCHA's proposals, representing a 4.2 increase in regular budget appropriations for 2006-2007, despite a zero growth policy overall.

At the end of 2005, the EO coordinated the preparation and submission of OCHA's biennial programme performance report to the General Assembly, with an implementation rate of 97 percent.

Executive and Administrative Offices, New York and Geneva

	New York		Geneva		2005 TOTAL
	EO	Common Costs	AO	Common Costs	
Requirements	838,130	640,150	3,177,031	465,424	5,120,735
Expenditure					
Staff Costs	859,849	270,273	2,027,905	49,901	3,207,928
Consultant Fees and Travel	-	76,360	-	14,700	91,060
Travel	-	113,205	-	53,246	166,451
Operating Expenses	-	144,133	-	183,436	327,569
Contractual Services	-	105,288	-	45,716	151,004
Supplies, Material, Furniture and Equipment	-	57,032	-	64,857	121,889
Fellowships, Grants and Contributions	-	-	-	-	-
Programme support costs	51,885	88,495	-	53,544	193,924
Total Expenditure US\$	911,734	854,786	2,027,905	465,400	4,259,825

Income for Core Activities is recorded in total under the Trust Fund for the Strengthening of OCHA

Field Support Section

The Field Support Section (FSS) was established in March 2005 as the principal entry point for field-related administrative requirements, whether related to human resources, financial management or procurement. Field staff demands resulting from existing large-scale emergencies, primarily in Sudan and DRC, combined with new emergencies including the Indian Ocean tsunami, a drought and food security crisis in Niger and the South Asia earthquake, dictated that the initial focus should be on supporting the recruitment and deployment of field staff.

Key objective

As a newly created unit within the Administrative Office, FSS further developed and refined the objectives of the section during the second quarter of 2005. Given the workload related to recruitment of emergency staff, the initial objectives articulated in *OCHA in 2005* regarding support on cost plans and financial management were suppressed in favour of dedicated support for recruitment processes.

The section's main objective, therefore, became to:

- improve performance on recruitment of field staff by clarifying the steps in the process, identifying reasonable timeframes, and monitoring individual recruitments against these targets

Activities

As the entry point on administrative matters, FSS developed an inventory of issues that field staff face. In addition to responding to staff queries, many of these issues were addressed through systematic briefings for new staff and the ongoing development of guidance materials on matters such as basic entitlements for international staff, national staff contracts and provisions, procurement and so forth.

During 2005, FSS facilitated and oversaw vacancy management of 137 field openings and initiated 106 short-term recruitments, mainly for the tsunami and Pakistan earthquake emergencies.

In addition to managing field vacancies, FSS developed procedures, tool and standardised forms aimed at clarifying and streamlining the recruitment steps, as well as improving consistency and transparency throughout the process. To track the recruitment process and provide an overview of OCHA's field operations, FSS developed a Post and Incumbency Matrix. This was used as a tool for

analysis on timeframes, staff coverage by office and region, as well information of gender and geographic distribution of field staff.

The systematic tracking of information using these tools enabled FSS to extract statistics to monitor and inform future recruitments and management decisions. The unit also developed a standardised briefing package for new field staff.

Performance evaluation

The section helped reduce the number of vacant OCHA posts from 32 percent in July 2005, when FSS began to track overall statistics, to 25 percent at the end of the year.

Development and implementation of systematic tracking using the Post and Incumbency Matrix System, combined with standardised formats and the elaboration of guidelines for vacancy management of 200 series field posts, helped improve consistency in managing the recruitment cycle.

There was no reduction in the recruitment time during 2005, but FSS was able to streamline work flow from substantive branches (such as CRD) and organise requests in a clear and efficient manner, alleviating the administrative burden on desk officers and facilitating processing for HRS.

Rostering is not yet in place, but preparatory work undertaken in 2005 is expected to allow its introduction in 2006. OCHA is also striving to make progress on multiple duty station recruitment (especially for P3 and P4 level humanitarian affairs officers) in order to fill more posts from the pool of suitable applicants.

Field Support Section

Requirements	1,618,047
Expenditure	
Staff Costs	877,206
Consultant Fees and Travel	24,227
Travel	78,376
Operating Expenses	-
Contractual Services	-
Supplies, Material, Furniture and Equipment	-
Fellowships, Grants and Contributions	-
Programme Support Costs	76,735
Total Expenditure US\$	1,056,544

Income for Core Activities is recorded in total under the Trust Fund for the Strengthening of OCHA

Staff Development and Learning Section

The Staff Development and Learning Project (SDL) aims to strengthen the capacity of OCHA staff at headquarters and in the field in their mission to carry out effective and accountable humanitarian response coordination. Through the design, development and implementation of specific training programmes, and by disseminating information on various training opportunities, the project aims to enhance and support the continuous learning and improved competencies of OCHA staff.

Key objectives

- Continue the implementation of Emergency Field Coordination Training (EFCT)
- Introduce an induction programme for new OCHA staff
- Continue with the implementation of the training management system to centralise all training-related information
- Establish a training course to address the well-being and security of staff

Activities

OCHA's prime focus for the first four months of 2005 was on activities to support the countries affected by the tsunami, and resource people were unavailable for consultation on the development of new training programmes. The section's activities were also modified to provide input and support to such priorities as the HCs Training and Retreat. Staff Development and Learning Policies and Guidelines were finalised in 2005, and circulated to OCHA management and staff, as SDL strove to support a culture of organisational learning and to establish systems and procedures to promote transparency, accountability and equitable learning opportunities. These documents outlined principles for effective learning, provided guidance on how to ensure fair and equitable learning opportunities for all staff, and clarified training application procedures, endorsement routines and a post-training reporting system.

A workshop was held in Geneva for OCHA administrative officers with the aim of creating

institutional learning and documenting best practices in administration and finance. As a result, the administrative manual was revised and complemented with additional tools and procedures to facilitate and standardise the operational, logistical, financial and administrative procedures of field offices.

SDL launched the development of the OCHA orientation CD-ROM in the autumn. In consultation with OCHA subject-matter experts, its objectives and content were defined and the first set of storyboards developed. The CD-ROM and a standardised briefing procedure are set to be introduced in June 2006.

The Training Management System was kept updated and captured the training activities of staff, offices and branches in 2005. The system tracked that a total of 597 OCHA staff took part in various training activities during the year: 45 percent participated in training courses organised by OCHA, 18 percent attended external training programmes, 17 percent benefited from training organised by other UN Agencies and collaborating partners, 13 percent attended UNOG and OHRM courses, and seven percent followed programmes funded through OHRM Training Funds. Women staff accounted for 49 percent of participants and 54 percent were from field offices.

Three Emergency Field Coordination Training workshops, with content modified slightly to adjust to the needs of staff members and a changing environment, were organised in 2005 in Switzerland. A total of 80 staff from OCHA and IASC partners participated, which was broadly in line with numbers in previous years. Field staff, both national and international, accounted for 58 percent of participants, headquarters staff for 11 percent and IASC for 31 percent.

SDL also organised a number of other ad hoc training courses to address the needs of OCHA staff, such as a two-day training session on natural disasters for Geneva desk officers and information sessions on HIV/AIDS.

SDL provided technical assistance to the United Nations System Staff College on the development of its humanitarian programme, and collaborated on the IASC Task Force on Training on the design of the Emergency Team Leadership Programme.

Performance evaluation

Formative and summative evaluations were used to continuously scrutinise the content and outcomes of the Emergency Field Coordination Training and make necessary adjustments. The three EFCTs held in 2005 rated 4.4, 4.0 and 4.6 respectively on a scale of 1-5.

A Training Impact Assessment conducted by the Evaluation and Studies Unit two to six months after the training sessions found that EFCT had been successful in building upon individual knowledge, skills and attitudes for effective inter-agency humanitarian coordination, as well as helping participants understand perspectives and identify and apply tools, techniques and approaches to coordination. The assessment also confirmed that fulfilment of the course objectives contributed to the EFCT's goal of "improving the ability of participants to facilitate effective humanitarian assistance" and, in turn, OCHA's fulfilment of its mandate and mission.

The Training Management System allowed OCHA to ensure more equitable and relevant training opportunities for all staff. Of the 597 training sessions for OCHA staff recorded by SDL in 2005, 293 were by male staff members and 304 female, with 273 from headquarters and 324 from the field.

Some staff members also attended outside training events. Information on the effectiveness and impact of the other training courses that staff attended, organised by other sections of the organisation or externally is not available to the Staff Development and Learning Project.

No new staff member received a standardised induction in 2005 because its development only began in the autumn, mostly as a result of OCHA priorities and resources being focused on the tsunami for much of 2005 so that few subject matter experts were available for earlier in the year.

Likewise, SDL was unable to develop a training course to enhance the well-being and security of staff, or complete the development and implementation of the OCHA Orientation CD-ROM, within the expected timeframe due to the tsunami response. The Orientation CD-ROM and a standardised briefing procedure are set to be introduced in June 2006.

Staff Development and Learning Project

Requirements	804,909
Income from Voluntary Contributions	601,595
EXPENDITURE	
Staff Costs	213,109
Consultant Fees and Travel	85,210
Travel	5,226
Operating Expenses	-
Contractual Services	194,222
Supplies, Material, Furniture and Equipment	2,176
Fellowships, Grants and Contributions	-
Programme Support Costs	64,993
Total Expenditure US\$	564,936

Inter-Agency Standing Committee/Executive Committee on Humanitarian Affairs (IASC/ECHA) Secretariat

The Inter-Agency Standing Committee (IASC), established by Resolution 46/182, is a unique inter-agency mechanism for humanitarian dialogue and decision-making involving a range of UN and non-UN humanitarian partners. Under the leadership of the Under-Secretary General for Humanitarian Affairs, in his capacity as Emergency Relief Coordinator (ERC), the primary role of the IASC is to shape humanitarian policy as well as to ensure a coordinated and affective response to emergencies. The Executive Committee on Humanitarian Affairs (ECHA) is chaired by the USG for Humanitarian Affairs and brings together UN humanitarian agencies and the political, peacekeeping and security departments of the UN Secretariat to address issues related to humanitarian crises.

A joint Secretariat based in OCHA Geneva and in New York serves both the IASC and ECHA, ensuring that discussions in the two committees are based on a common understanding of problems and effective decision-making processes. The Secretariat supports the Under-Secretary-General as the chairperson of both committees, and the Assistant ERC in her capacity as chairperson of the IASC Working Group.

Key objectives

- Facilitate inter-agency collaboration in the development and implementation of the three main areas of the Humanitarian Reform Agenda
- Support inter-agency discussions and decision-making on all major humanitarian policy issues and situations through the IASC and/or ECHA, including protecting humanitarian space in Integrated Missions and implementing the Humanitarian Reform Agenda
- Ensure effective communication regarding the work of the IASC and ECHA with other inter-agency bodies, notably the United Nations Development Group (UNDG) and the Executive Committee on Peace and Security (ECPS), in order to strengthen the linkage among humanitarian, political and development actors

Activities

In addition to work plan objectives, major new emergencies required increased attention by all humanitarian actors, particularly in response to the Indian Ocean tsunami and the South Asia earthquake.

Many new initiatives were also launched within the framework of the humanitarian reform process, which required the Secretariat's engagement and support, including advancing the discussion and implementation of the cluster approach within the reform agenda.

The Secretariat provided support to the nine Cluster Working Groups: Camp Coordination and Camp Management; Early Recovery; Emergency Shelter; Emergency Telecommunications; Health; Logistics; Nutrition; Protection; and Water and Sanitation. Nine IASC Working Group meetings and three IASC Principals meetings were held in 2005, though only four Working Group meetings and two Principals had been planned.

The IASC actively supported the Humanitarian Response Review process by organising consultative meetings during and after the issuance of the report to agree on follow-up actions. The IASC encouraged agency participation in the consultative process on global benchmarking and linkages between the DfID-led process and other processes, such as Sphere. Through OCHA and the ERC, the IASC facilitated inter-agency consultations on negotiations for the ECOSOC Humanitarian Segment and the General Assembly, and contributed to discussions on the upgraded CERF and flexible funding mechanisms such as pooled funding.

Throughout 2005, the Secretariat supported the work of 11 IASC subsidiary bodies: CAP, Emergency Telecommunications, Preparedness and Contingency Planning, Gender, Human Rights, Training, HIV/AIDS, Good Humanitarian Donorship, Humanitarian Security, Natural Disasters, and Mental Health and Psychosocial Support – the latter established in 2005 to develop guidelines on such support during humanitarian crises.

The IASC issued a number of publications in 2005, including the Guidelines for Gender-Based Violence Interventions in Humanitarian Settings, available on the IASC website in English, French, Spanish and Arabic; and the Human Rights Guidance Note for Humanitarian Coordinators. The Secretariat designed and launched a new interactive website to provide easier access to and discussions on the inter-agency agenda.

The IASC/ECHA Secretariat in New York organised ECHA's monthly meetings and a series of ad hoc meetings of the ECHA Core Group, focused on a broad

range of humanitarian issues. These ranged from policy matters, such as the humanitarian reform agenda and preserving humanitarian space in Integrated Missions, to more specific discussions on particular crises. In addition, an ECHA/ECPS Task Force on Protection from Sexual Exploitation and Abuse was established and tasked with developing a comprehensive policy on assistance.

The IASC/ECHA Secretariat in New York provided support to the DERC in her capacity as the Secretary-General's Special Coordinator for Tsunami-affected Communities and to the Office of the Special Envoy for Tsunami Recovery during its first months.

Performance evaluation

The IASC facilitated broad and inclusive discussions among its 17 members (including the NGO Consortia representing a few hundred organisations) at all levels: Principals, Working Group, weekly meetings in New York and Geneva, as well as IASC Subsidiary Bodies on the humanitarian reform agenda, resulting in significant progress in the development and implementation of its three components. The IASC, with support from the Secretariat, was instrumental in developing, piloting and streamlining the cluster approach, which is expected to increase the predictability of humanitarian response.

A simple ECHA database was established in 2005 compiling discussions and decisions, and efforts are now being made to integrate this in the OCHA Document Management System. The IASC maintained its own decision matrix, regularly updated, to ensure progress on decisions and action points between meetings.

In November, the IASC Working Group reviewed and endorsed in principle the 2005 progress reports

of the subsidiary bodies on CAP, Preparedness and Contingency Planning, Emergency Telecommunications, Good Humanitarian Donorship, Gender, Human Rights and Humanitarian Action, and Mental Health and Psychosocial Support, as well as final reports from Training and HIV/AIDS Task Forces. It endorsed the closure of the Task Forces on Humanitarian Security and Natural Disasters, the latter having finalised the In-Country Self Assessment Tool for Natural Disaster Response Preparedness and reviewed the capacity of IASC agencies and organisations in selected disaster-prone countries.

The IASC also facilitated wide-ranging consultations on the establishment of the upgraded CERF, including for the establishment of its Advisory Group. The Humanitarian Coordinators segment also progressed, with the IASC decision to establish a pool of HCs, including non-UN partners, and to develop a long-term Action Plan.

Through extensive consultations at all levels, Principals, Working Group, weekly meetings in New York and Geneva, the Subsidiary Bodies and ad hoc Task Forces, the IASC was the main forum of discussion to ensure coordinated response to the Indian Ocean tsunami and the South Asia earthquake, and in the development of guidance on matters such as gender-based violence interventions in humanitarian settings.

Through ongoing consultations with the offices responsible for supporting the ECPS and the UNDG, the Secretariat ensured complementarities in the topics discussed, and more effective engagement of the most senior management of the United Nations on important issues on the humanitarian, political and development agenda.

IASC/ECHA Secretariat

	New York	Geneva	2005 TOTAL
Requirements	496,192	316,405	812,597
Expenditure			
Staff Costs	422,179	47,311	469,490
Consultant Fees and Travel	-	36,889	36,889
Travel	15,982	23,691	39,673
Operating Expenses	-	-	-
Contractual Services	-	3,675	3,675
Supplies, Material, Furniture and Equipment	-	-	-
Fellowships, Grants and Contributions	-	-	-
Programme Support Costs	36,310	8,465	44,775
Total Expenditure US\$	474,471	120,031	594,502

Income for Core Activities is recorded in total under the Trust Fund for the Strengthening of OCHA.

EMERGENCY RESPONSE COORDINATION

Coordination and Response Division

Coordination and Response Division

	New York	Geneva	2005 TOTAL
Requirements	2,268,702	2,890,201	5,158,903
Expenditure			
Staff Costs	1,329,138	2,898,018	4,227,156
Consultant Fees and Travel	-	25,477	25,477
Travel	384,820	237,519	622,339
Operating Expenses	-	-	-
Contractual Services	-	1,163	1,163
Supplies, Material, Furniture and Equipment	-	-	-
Fellowships, Grants and Contributions	-	-	-
Programme Support Costs	220,193	294,216	514,409
Total Expenditure US\$	1,934,151	3,456,393	5,390,544

Income for Core Activities is recorded in total under the Trust Fund for the Strengthening of OCHA

The Coordination and Response Division (CRD) was formed in March 2005 with the merger of the former Response Coordination Branch (RCB) in Geneva and the Humanitarian Emergency Branch (HEB) in New York. In the new division, the New York office has primary responsibility for managing the response to complex emergencies and the Geneva office has primary responsibility for natural disasters.

CRD has three major responsibilities: to provide direct support to the ERC in his role as principal advisor on humanitarian issues to the Secretary-General and coordinator of the international humanitarian response; to provide support and guidance to UN Resident and Humanitarian Coordinators on complex emergencies and natural disasters; and to provide support to OCHA field offices on operational and policy matters. It also facilitates the advocacy, financial and human resources work of OCHA's other Branches. The surge capacity section was substantially reinforced in 2005 to provide more systematic and comprehensive support to field offices experiencing gaps in their staffing level or in new emergencies. The Consolidated Appeals Process continues to be a key component of CRD's portfolio.

In 2005, CRD focused on clarifying OCHA's role in natural disasters and confirmed that its primary responsibility lies in disaster response and response preparedness. CRD consequently strengthened its capacity to fulfill its role, in particular through reinforced regional offices and improved synergy with other branches in OCHA and partners such as ISDR and UNDP. CRD spearheaded OCHA's response to the major disasters that marked 2005, in particular

the Indian Ocean tsunami and the South Asia earthquake. CRD also advocated for and supported a UN system-wide response to the drought in the Sahel. As a follow up initiative, CRD undertook consultations on the Sahel with a wide variety of partners aimed at reviewing the UN and its partners' roles in slow-onset disasters such as droughts. The continuing crises in Sudan (Darfur in particular) and Zimbabwe took much of CRD's attention, while concerted efforts were made to provide adequate coverage to all countries or regions in need of OCHA support. In particular, CRD provided strong support to countries in West Africa and advocated for better coverage of the situation in this region, which is one of the most volatile in the world.

Key objectives

- Implement all aspects of the CRD merger
- Improve support to Humanitarian Coordinators and OCHA offices by strengthening policy, administrative and logistical support arrangements
- Refocus activities on natural disasters and establish coordination with other tools and services available within OCHA
- Redefine and standardise the work of the Regional Offices and RDRAs
- Work toward ensuring that humanitarian principles are fully considered and respected in the establishment, structure and strategies of UN missions

Activities

Following the reorganisation of CRD, the two parts of the division had to develop their capacity and expertise in order to fulfill CRD's role vis-à-vis natural disasters and complex emergencies. A CRD retreat in July contributed to greater understanding of the new division of responsibilities and set concrete common goals.

In addition to its core activities of supporting the field and the ERC, CRD was under intense pressure to increase the speed and size of OCHA's response to disasters and emergencies by immediately deploying its own staff from headquarters. In 2005, over 200 missions were undertaken by 60 staff, mostly to support new or ongoing emergencies. While the high number of deployments stretched CRD, at times in an unsustainable manner, this direct support was greatly appreciated by the RC/HCs and UNCTs.

In addition to this direct support, CRD continued to improve on delivery of its other core functions. Despite extremely high demand, staff were identified and deployed more smoothly and speedily than during the previous reporting period. However, the issue of staff turn over remains unsolved and is being addressed. The CAP section further improved the rapid issuance of Flash Appeals, finalising and issuing the South Asia Earthquake Appeal less than one week after the disaster. The Financial Tracking Service (FTS) also continued to improve, thanks to continuous dialogue with the donor community and IASC members in particular. Political support was ensured by the division providing, on a continuous basis, humanitarian information and analysis for the USG/ERC, and through him to the Secretary-General. CRD staff also organised and managed inter-agency and inter-departmental meetings on key crises such as the tsunami, South Asia earthquake, hurricane Katrina, Ethiopia/Eritrea, Darfur, Zimbabwe and the Sahel drought, and ensured that humanitarian concerns were properly reflected in Security Council deliberations on complex emergencies such as Côte d'Ivoire, DRC and Sudan.

CRD also increased its strategic partnerships. Particularly, the division played an important role and represented OCHA in inter-departmental processes such as those dealing with coordination during recovery or Avian and Human Influenza. CRD also played a key role in setting up and strengthening of the offices of the RC in several tsunami-affected countries. Close coordination with UNDP and UNDGO was achieved and will have to be maintained, if not further reinforced. In 2005, CRD staff led or participated in various inter-agency and inter-departmental missions, including DPKO missions, to Sierra Leone, Senegal, DRC, Côte d'Ivoire, Burundi, and Sudan. CRD staff also

provided direct support to Special Envoys for the Horn of Africa, Zimbabwe and the Tsunami.

In addition to improving networking with partners within the IASC system and beyond, CRD continued to work closely with all other branches of OCHA. CRD worked with PDSB to prepare the inputs for the country-specific reports to the General Assembly and ECOSOC and contributed to various evaluations (tsunami, Angola), as well as briefings to the Security Council on the Protection of Civilians. CRD worked closely with IDD on IDP-related issues and on the implementation of the cluster approach, in both cases undertaking joint field missions to the field. CRD also worked closely with AIMB on advocacy efforts and on the establishment and management of the HICs in Indonesia, Sri Lanka, Niger, Liberia, Sudan and Pakistan.

The division also played an active part in RC/HC training events, helping to put together the training modules, contents, presentation as well as the logistics. The training gave the RC/HCs exposure to disaster response tools that they may have to utilise in case of a disaster striking.

In enhancing its activities on natural disasters, CRD took the initiative to consolidate further the natural disaster tools and services available within OCHA by creating a joint operations matrix with the Emergency Services Branch. This provided OCHA with a comprehensive view to its own role in natural disaster, and linked this with the broader UN action on natural disaster prevention and reduction by UNDP/BCPR, ISDR and Member States that adhered to the Hyogo Framework of Action. The matrix was also a useful tool in bringing together and standardising the work of the Regional Offices. A retreat of the RDRAs in the summer started the process of "cross-fertilisation" of ideas and methodologies between the RDRAs to bring some consistency in the type of services provided by OCHA in the different regions. CRD initiated the expansion of the functions of the Regional Offices, both in terms of the geographical reach (through antennae in Mauritania, Burkina Faso, Guinea-Bissau and Mali, for example), or through more targeted focus on previously neglected crises such as Laos and Myanmar. Regional Offices have also taken a greater lead in responding to natural disasters, as was shown by the Regional Office for West Africa's pivotal role in the Sahel drought crisis.

CRD actively participated in the humanitarian reform process, lending support to the Humanitarian Response Review, as well as participating in the cluster meetings in order to help ensure a coherent and integrated approach. In addition, CRD staff participated in assessment missions to DRC, Liberia and Uganda in the context of the cluster system roll-out in these three pilot countries.

Through its security focal point, and close interface with the UNDSS, CRD led OCHA towards greater recognition of security requirements in the field. A Minimum Operating Security Standards and Minimum Operating Residential Security Standards survey was carried out in all OCHA field offices. This resulted in a strengthening of existing security measures and implementation of new safety and security procedures. The ASFP also put together an OCHA-wide Security Policy that was endorsed by senior management and disseminated to all staff.

Performance evaluation

Clarified division of responsibilities (and reduced administrative workload from the creation of FSS) allowed CRD desk officers to concentrate on more substantive policy support and guidance to field offices. Early indications from the field offices show some recognition of greater support, with a gradual improvement throughout the course of the year.

The natural disaster operations resulted in better utilisation of OCHA resources and enhanced planning capabilities, particularly through the lessons learned from the tsunami. In Pakistan, for example, CRD steered the operation to be focused and time-limited. Clear planning was achieved from the outset with measurable objectives to be attained, and an exit strategy.

The expansion of the functions, staffing and geographical reach of the Regional Offices resulted in a more efficient network for information gathering, early warning and early humanitarian intervention in countries previously less well covered in Asia, West Africa and in the Americas particular.

With no new Security Council-mandated integrated missions in 2005, CRD concentrated on delineating a greater humanitarian space in existing missions, particularly in Sudan, DRC and Liberia. While humanitarian space was retained with a separate OCHA identity in Sudan and DRC, the experience in Liberia has been less positive. CRD also contributed to the formulation of the guidelines for integrated missions agreed with DPKO and endorsed by the Secretary-General.

The deployment time of staff members going to the field continued to vary depending on factors outside of CRD's control. While EO and FSS helped greatly in streamlining procedures and making deployment times more predictable, the process still takes too long due in good part to existing rules and regulations. CRD New York conducted a regularisation exercise whereby 12 staff went through the recruitment process and received better contracts.

Consolidated Appeals Process Strengthening Project

The Consolidated Appeals Process (CAP) is a field-based coordination mechanism used by aid organisations to plan, coordinate, fund, implement and monitor their activities. As a planning mechanism, it has contributed significantly to developing a more coherent and strategic approach to humanitarian action. The CAP provides a framework for aid agencies to analyse the context in which humanitarian action takes place, consider scenarios, assess needs, agree on priorities, set goals, draw up a Common Humanitarian Action Plan (CHAP) to address them, monitor the strategy, and revise it as necessary.

As a coordination mechanism, it has fostered closer cooperation between host governments, donors, aid agencies and beneficiaries, resulting in a more effective system-wide response to complex emergencies and natural disasters. The section, which is part of

the Coordination and Response Division, manages the CAP day to day, and develops and implements long-term improvements.

Key objectives

- Strengthen the CAP as a tool for strategic planning, programming and coordination, for example by developing guidelines for Flash Appeals
- Support development, dissemination and implementation of policy and guidelines for more effective humanitarian action
- Implement a comprehensive training programme to ensure that OCHA staff are effective in leading the CAP in the field and at headquarters
- Manage the development and launch of consolidated appeals and mid-year reviews

- Improve the timeliness, accuracy and scope of the Financial Tracking Service (FTS)
- Provide FTS training to key donors, HCs and OCHA staff, and NGOs
- Support the donor-led Good Humanitarian Donorship CAP pilot (in the DRC and Burundi)

Activities

The CAP section led the IASC Sub-working Group in the preparation and monitoring of CAP policy. In the CAP training programme, the section organised CAP best-practice workshops for OCHA, UN Agency staff and NGOs. Throughout 2005, in order to strengthen the appeal process in the field, the section facilitated 18 inter-agency field workshops with over 1,000 participants from 175 NGOs, 23 UN Agencies, and 19 donor governments for the preparation of Consolidated Appeals for 2006.

In 2005, the section oversaw the preparation and launch of nine flash appeals for breaking emergencies or natural disasters, mid-year reviews for all 15 of the 2005 Consolidated Appeals and 16 Consolidated Appeals for 2006. The section organised the global launch of the appeals in New York, and launched a new website (www.humanitarianappeal.net) to present appeal documents and CAP professional tools.

Throughout 2005, the section led the development and field pilots of the Needs Analysis Framework (NAF), much in demand from donors keen to see more reliable humanitarian needs assessments. Use of the NAF is expected to expand from five pilot countries in 2005 to a target of 75 percent of CAP countries through 2006.

In 2005, the Financial Tracking Service (FTS) launched a major upgrade of its website to give more user-friendly access to its ever-expanding worldwide database. For 2005, FTS recorded 8,500 funding items (up from 6,200 in 2004) to over 100 destination countries and 620 implementing organisations from 370 donor countries and organisations. Staff provided FTS training sessions to field office and headquarters staff from OCHA, UN Agencies, NGOs, donors and the media.

As part of UN transparency and accountability initiatives, FTS also developed and launched (in pro bono collaboration with PriceWaterhouseCoopers) an expenditure tracking website for the tsunami Flash Appeal, the first of its kind.

The mounting profile of the CAP as an advocacy tool was reflected in the fact that, again in 2005, the summary document of the consolidated appeals (Humanitarian Appeal 2006) bore the Secretary-General's signature. Flash appeals for the Indian Ocean tsunami and the South Asia earthquake crystallised high-profile humanitarian funding needs. FTS analyses of flash appeal underfunding were instrumental in obtaining the General Assembly's approval of the new Central Emergency Response Fund (CERF).

The CAP section supported the Good Humanitarian Donorship initiative, which aims to measure and improve donor performance in providing aid impartially and on time.

A common definition of humanitarian aid for statistical purposes was agreed with donor countries and coordinated with OECD, which will eventually allow the UN and OECD aid databases to publish more recognisably consistent global data.

Performance evaluation

New guidelines for flash appeals were developed and used on 10 occasions such as the Indian Ocean tsunami and the South Asia earthquake. It took a median 11.1 days to launch flash appeals issued in 2005 and, as the year progressed, a significant reduction of this time was achieved culminating in three days to issue the Flash Appeal for Pakistan. Speed can have an impact on quality, a fear addressed by the new flexibility allowing the revision of any part of any appeal at any time.

During the Programme Kick-Off meeting in January 2006, donors praised the 2006 Consolidated Appeals, prepared in 2005. They highlighted, in particular, the strengthened focus on humanitarian aspects and improvements in needs analysis and prioritisation in CHAPs.

The training workshops for leading the CAP in the field and using FTS, plus guidance provided by the section, were found to be effective by both HCs and the staff involved, according to participant evaluations, facilitators' reports and workshop reports by the OCHA field offices.

All Consolidated Appeals and mid-year reviews were prepared and published within the prescribed time frame (in time for long-scheduled, high-level

launch conferences) and according to the section's work plan.

For the first time, all 2006 appeals (developed in 2005) included NGO project proposals from a total of 145 NGOs as well as from 26 UN Agencies.

The FTS was significantly improved, with the help of donors, humanitarian organisations and private sector partners. Website hits showed a healthy increase in its use, from a monthly average of 57,000 hits between January and June 2004 to 145,000 for the month of March 2005 and 932,000 for December 2005.

CAP Strengthening Project

Requirements	1,810,339
Income from Voluntary Contributions	1,471,278
EXPENDITURE	
Staff Costs	1,047,602
Consultant Fees and Travel	51,817
Travel	115,115
Operating Expenses	24,659
Contractual Services	7,796
Supplies, Material, Furniture and Equipment	21,799
Fellowships, Grants and Contributions	-
Programme Support Costs	164,943
Total Expenditure US\$	1,433,731

Surge Capacity and Contingency Planning Section

As part of strengthening OCHA's rapid deployment to sudden-onset disasters and emergency situations, and timely support to the field, the Surge Capacity Project was renamed and expanded in early 2005 to include both Surge Capacity and Contingency Planning 2005. The main tasks of the section were to support RC/HCs and United Nations Country Teams at the sudden-onset or intensification of a crisis that was beyond the capacity of the country team, and to provide internal support within headquarters. This particularly included coordination support; undertaking assessments of the needs of affected populations; assessing the capacity and capability of the UN to address the emergency; and providing experienced leadership in designing and facilitating contingency planning.

The capacity of OCHA and the humanitarian community to respond to both sudden-and slow-onset natural disasters was severely tested in 2005, given the Indian Ocean tsunami, the Sahel food crisis, hurricane season in the Caribbean region and the South Asia earthquake. Furthermore, a combination of man-made and natural disasters stretched the capacity of many UNCTs that had a mainly developmental profile. An expanded Surge Capacity Team served to bolster the capacity of country teams and national governments in a number of these crises.

Key objectives

- Support the RC/HC and UNCT at the sudden-onset of a new crisis, or the intensification of an existing crisis that is beyond the scope of the country team
- Fill critical human resources gaps in existing OCHA field offices
- Undertake assessments of the needs of beneficiaries and of the capacity of the UNCTs to address the emergency/disaster
- Support UNCTs in developing contingency plans

Activities

Staff were deployed at very short notice to fill key coordination positions in tsunami relief efforts in Aceh, Indonesia; and to address the drought and food crisis in Niger and surrounding countries in the Sahel; the intensification of civil unrest in Nepal; the South Asia earthquake; the 'triple threat' of food insecurity, weakened governance capacity and HIV/AIDS in Zimbabwe; and potential civil unrest in Guinea Bissau.

Members of the Surge Capacity Team assisted RC/HCs in the establishment of OCHA sub-offices in Aceh; country and sub-offices in Nepal; and country and sub-offices in Niger. They also

reinforced OCHA's presence in other RC offices in the Sahel and assisted in the establishment of sub-hubs in Pakistan. Furthermore, advice on strengthening existing coordination mechanisms was provided to RC/HCs and UNCTs in Guinea Bissau and Laos, and in particular, to the protection network in Côte d'Ivoire.

Specific missions were carried out to assist UNCTs in developing or updating contingency plans. These included support in Nepal, Iran, Guinea Bissau, Laos, the Great Lakes Region, the Sahel and at the sub-hub level in Pakistan.

The Senior Emergency Officer was deployed to fill critical gaps at the head of office level in Niger, Eritrea and DRC. Furthermore, associate humanitarian affairs officers provided support to geographical desks at headquarters.

The sheer scale and number of disasters and ongoing emergencies in 2005 warranted the mobilisation of a much larger number of OCHA staff worldwide, as well as secondments from standby partners and the recruitment of external candidates on a short-term basis to fill critical gaps and vacancies. Furthermore, specialised branches are increasingly seeing the need to develop thematic rosters to ensure that trained and experienced staff with the necessary expertise can be deployed at short notice. In this regard, the Surge Capacity Section will work with all branches within OCHA to ensure that specialised rosters are developed and a higher quality of assistance is provided to UNCTs in 2006.

Performance evaluation

Some 60 percent of requests from RC/HCs were deemed urgent and necessary by CRD management and were responded to by the rapid deployment of Surge Capacity Staff within 48 hours. In three sudden-onset disasters, coordination mechanisms were established within 48 hours of arrival, helping to ensure that proper lines of communication between humanitarian actors and local authorities were established from the onset of the crises.

Of the five critical human resource vacancies that arose in 2005, three (or 60 percent) were filled within 24 hours.

All eight of the contingency plans prepared with the assistance of the Surge Capacity Team were prepared

in accordance with IASC guidelines. However, only 40 percent were prepared in cooperation with national authorities due to political sensitivities.

Three deployable members of the Surge Capacity Unit were available in 2005 and were deployed to a total of 13 missions. Six of those were deemed urgent and saw staff arrive in-country within 48 hours. Staff members were deployed within seven days to other planned or less urgent missions.

An official and fully functional Emergency Response Roster was not developed but, with the leadership of the AERC and the support of desk officers and regional offices, several hundred OCHA staff worldwide were mobilised and deployed to respond to sudden-onset and large-scale disasters. Furthermore, some branches within OCHA developed specialised rosters, including Public Information, Information Management and Protection Capacity (PROCAP) rosters, in collaboration with UN Agencies. These mechanisms were used in meeting OCHA's needs for an Emergency Response Roster. In order that OCHA can deploy staff in a rapid and organised fashion, an OCHA roster for field recruitment will become operational in 2006.

In order to increase the Surge Capacity Section's usefulness, more needs to be done to integrate its role with early warning, early action and contingency planning activities.

Surge Capacity and Contingency Planning Section

Requirements	846,271
Income from Voluntary Contributions	871,850
EXPENDITURE	
Staff Costs	301,093
Consultant Fees and Travel	-
Travel	1,942
Operating Expenses	9,386
Contractual Services	-
Supplies, Material, Furniture and Equipment	-
Fellowships, Grants and Contributions	-
Programme Support Costs	40,615
Total Expenditure US\$	353,036

Disaster Preparedness Project

Major disasters such as the Indian Ocean tsunami and the South Asia earthquake underscored for the international community the importance of strengthening disaster preparedness for effective response and recovery.

The World Conference on Disaster Reduction (WCDR) in January 2005 adopted the Hyogo Framework for Action (HFA) with five priorities for action to promote a strategic and systematic approach to reducing vulnerabilities and risk of hazards between 2005 and 2015. OCHA is participating in these efforts to strengthen response preparedness as one of the five priorities in the HFA. At the WCDR, the International Recovery Platform (IRP) was launched as a networking mechanism for post-disaster recovery and bridging relief.

Key objectives

- Identify disaster-prone countries requiring assistance in response preparedness
- Promote the development of contingency plans and standard procedures to assist UNCTs in disaster-prone countries and regions to enhance response preparedness
- Host contingency planning and response preparedness missions, and country and regional workshops

Activities

During 2005, OCHA developed its Natural Disaster Action Plan to map out its response preparedness activities. That included activities such as contingency planning, capacity building, and supporting national disaster preparedness strategies, early warning and transitioning to recovery. OCHA's Regional Offices and Regional Disaster Response Advisors (RDRAs), with the support of CRD, implemented several projects to promote disaster preparedness activities. Most of these activities were carried out in the two particularly disaster-prone regions: Asia and the Pacific, and the Americas and the Caribbean.

In Asia and the Pacific, contingency planning workshops were held in Nepal and Bangladesh, which strengthened UNCTs' response capacities and identified areas of UN support to the governments, such as the formulation of contingency planning for both natural disasters and complex emergencies, and strengthening of UN Disaster Management Teams (UNDMTs). A mission was also fielded to the Pacific to develop a regional strategy for disaster response and preparedness.

In the Americas and the Caribbean, OCHA supported the organisation of the 10th Meeting of the Association of Caribbean States (ACS), Special Committee on Natural Disasters. That resulted in the formulation of lines of action to enhance preparedness and response measures for the 2005 hurricane season for countries in the Caribbean basin. The event also contributed to ongoing efforts to raise the level of awareness of emergency managers and other government authorities about the need to improve their country's level of preparedness to confront the hurricane season. OCHA also participated in the Regional Review Forum in Jamaica to strengthen disaster management capacities of the RCs' offices in the Caribbean.

Contingency planning workshops were held with UNCTs in Chile, Guyana, Mexico and Venezuela, which provided basic knowledge of disaster preparedness and response.

An UNDAC mission was pre-deployed to Nicaragua in October to support national authorities and UN Agencies there in preparing for the potential effects of the rapidly approaching Hurricane Beta. The mission arrived 48 hours before the hurricane made landfall, pre-positioning the team well before the possible closure of airports so that response coordination activities could be activated at once.

OCHA also fielded UNDAC preparedness missions to assess the national response capacity of the Philippines, Mongolia, the Dominican Republic and Georgia, at the request of those governments. A mission was sent to Papua New Guinea to support the government and RC in responding to the

volcanic eruption on Manam Island. The mission identified gaps and challenges in shelter, health, education and other sectors.

In addition to the original work plan, two new projects were developed to link enhanced response systems with risk reduction and recovery activities. One was a pilot project providing NDRAs to strengthen UNCTs' disaster response and response preparedness capacities in selected disaster-prone countries. NDRAs, once in place in 2006, will support the work of RDRAs in between workshops and missions, respond to major and minor disasters, and liaise with government authorities.

The second new project was the development of guidelines to ensure OCHA's smooth transfer of responsibilities into the recovery phase by incorporating recovery tasks in the early stages of the relief phase. The guidelines will be fashioned into a checklist, after consulting with partner organisations, and tested in a few disaster situations.

Performance evaluation

Priority countries were identified in the Americas, the Caribbean, Asia and the Pacific regions so that the work of RDRAs can focus on identifying gaps and providing targeted assistance in response preparedness capacity.

Contingency planning workshops were held in Bangladesh, Nepal, Chile, Guyana, Mexico and Venezuela, enhancing the response preparedness capacity of UNCTs and partner organisations through interactive planning.

UNDAC response preparedness missions were sent to Mongolia, the Philippines, the Dominican Republic and Georgia, resulting in targeted support and recommendations, pinpointing gaps in each disaster management office by RDRAs.

Disaster response and preparedness training missions fielded to the Maldives, Thailand and Samoa enhanced the response preparedness capacity of UNDMTs through workshops and contingency planning sessions.

Networks and cooperation platforms assisted included ASEAN disaster response working groups, the Asian Disaster Reduction and Response Network,

and the Asia Partnership Meeting to discuss Strategic National Action Plans (SNAP) for HFA.

In the Americas and the Caribbean, collaboration was strengthened with the Association of Caribbean States (ACS), the Caribbean Disaster and Emergency Response Agency (CDERA), and the Coordination Centre for Natural Disaster Prevention for Central America (CEPREDENAC).

The regional inter-agency coordination platform was established in 2003 with the participation of regional UN Agencies' offices (UNICEF, UNDP, WHO/PAHO, WFP, ISDR, OCHA) and the IFRC. Through enhanced exchange of information, the platform served in 2005 as a forum for joint planning of meetings and workshops, as well as preparedness and contingency planning missions.

Disaster Preparedness Project

Requirements	241,820
Income from Voluntary Contributions	400,577
EXPENDITURE	
Staff Costs	79,232
Consultant Fees and Travel	-
Travel	11,998
Operating Expenses	-
Contractual Services	-
Supplies, Material, Furniture and Equipment	-
Fellowships, Grants and Contributions	-
Programme Support Costs	11,860
Total Expenditure US\$	103,090

Emergency Services Branch

The Emergency Services Branch (ESB) is responsible for developing, mobilising and coordinating the deployment of OCHA's international rapid response capacities to provide assistance to countries affected by natural disasters and other emergencies. In 2005, ESB managed three sections, which are presented as projects: the Field Coordination Support Section (FCSS); the Military, Civil Defence and Logistics Support Project, consisting of the Military and Civil Defence Unit (MDCU) and the Logistics Support Unit (LSU); and the Environmental Emergencies Section (EES).

In 2005, the need for further development of OCHA's logistical capacity gave rise to the Logistics Support Unit (LSU) becoming an independent project within the branch. Its strengthening with additional resources is foreseen for 2006. MCDU, for its part, was renamed the Civil Military Coordination Section (CMCS) to better reflect its functions. ESB also continued to oversee three units dealing with information management and technology.

Key objectives

- Strengthen existing partnerships and develop new networks in the area of disaster response and response preparedness within a broader effort to improve the quality, timeliness, efficiency and integration of different disaster response services
- Contribute to the advancement of a holistic and systematic approach to disaster response and response preparedness by promoting cooperation among internal and external response tools and services
- Increase awareness of response tools and mechanisms among partners

Activities

The main thrust of ESB's activities is reflected in the narratives of its four projects (FCSS, CMCS, LSU and EES) in the following pages. In addition to managing these, the branch was active in the wider area of disaster response preparedness. One of these activities, the IASC WG Task Force on Natural

Emergency Services Branch	2005 TOTAL
Requirements	512,573
Expenditure	
Staff Costs	372,986
Consultant Fees and Travel	-
Travel	3,613
Operating Expenses	-
Contractual Services	2,748
Supplies, Material, Furniture and Equipment	-
Fellowships, Grants and Contributions	-
Programme Support Costs	892
Total Expenditure US\$	380,239

Income for Core Activities is recorded in total under the Trust Fund for the Strengthening of OCHA

Disasters (TFND), concluded its work in 2005. Another, the Humanitarian Common Services process, conducted jointly with WFP, saw further developments of this concept.

The key functions of the branch included the timely dispatch of well-trained and equipped UNDAC teams, civil-military expertise and assets, and environmental emergency experts. In addition, ESB was responsible for the coordination of international urban search and rescue activities, managing stand-by arrangements with partners, providing staff and support modules to field operations, as well as monitoring the international logistics situation during major disasters. The branch continued to manage and replenish OCHA stocks of relief items, and to organise shipments from the UN Humanitarian Response Depot (UNHRD) in Brindisi, Italy.

The operations and effectiveness of the different projects managed by the branch are detailed later in this section.

Performance evaluation

The timeliness of deployments remained at a target of 24/48 hours from receipt of request for the UNDAC teams. Extensive, multiple and rotating deployments of UNDAC teams, UN Civil-Military Coordination (UN-CMCoord) officers, as well as environmental expertise, occurred following the Indian Ocean tsunami and the South Asia earthquake. The effectiveness of the experts deployed was addressed by training increasing numbers of disaster managers worldwide

in emergency response and field coordination procedures. There were 72 graduates of six UNDAC courses in 2005, as well as 437 graduates of 16 UN-CMCoord courses.

Partners increasingly applied common methodologies, such as environmental guidelines and INSARAG guidelines (that benefited from a major revision in 2005), the “Oslo” and “MCDA” Guidelines on the use of military and civil defence assets, and the guidelines for the use and logistics of family tents, published in November 2004. Procurement, replenishment of stocks and dispatch of emergency goods resulted in timely shipments from the UNHRD to both natural disasters and complex emergencies.

Strengthened partnerships with donors resulted in the provision of a Swiss aeroplane for the rapid deployment of UNDAC teams to earthquakes, tested in Pakistan. Engagement with developing countries grew to the extent that they now comprise 47 percent of the membership of the UNDAC team worldwide. The INSARAG network continues to grow and now comprises 64 member countries, 40 of which have 62 international search and rescue teams between them.

Eight new stakeholders were engaged through a range of collaborative approaches, such as the

Environmental Emergencies Partnership. NGOs such as Map Action and Telecoms Sans Frontières became valuable new partners during training activities and field deployments, particularly in the aftermath of the Indian Ocean tsunami and the South Asia earthquake. Efforts at enhanced civil-military coordination at the national and regional level gained momentum, especially in the Asia and Pacific region and in Africa.

Awareness of the available response tools and mechanisms continued to be improved through the development of new approaches. The “IASC In-Country Team Self-Assessment Tool for Natural Disaster Response Preparedness” developed the IASC WG Task Force on Natural Disasters under ESB’s co-leadership, and disseminated widely to in-country teams and OCHA regional offices, served as a step towards holistic, systematic and integrated approaches to disaster response preparedness.

ESB advocacy for stronger inter-agency cooperation in the area of disaster response tools and services benefited from a wide acceptance of the Humanitarian Common Services (HCS) concept, to which CMCoord belongs. Further development of the HCS concept was delayed by the number of large-scale disasters in 2005.

Field Coordination Support Section

The role of the FCSS project is to strengthen the mobilisation and coordination capacity of OCHA during the emergency phase following a disaster, while contributing to OCHA’s role in boosting response preparedness in developing countries.

FCSS has five major functions. It manages the UN Disaster Assessment & Coordination (UNDAC) system, with regional teams in Africa/Europe, Latin America and the Caribbean, and Asia-Pacific. The project manages the OCHA Standby Partnerships which provide humanitarian experts for short-term assignments in OCHA field offices. FCSS also acts as secretariat of the International Search and Rescue Advisory Group (INSARAG), with regional groupings in Africa/Europe, the Americas and Asia-Pacific.

As such, it coordinates all international urban search and rescue activities involving collapsed structures.

FCSS acts as secretariat of the International Humanitarian Partnership (IHP) which provides technical support modules for humanitarian missions, as well as the Asia-Pacific Humanitarian Partnership (APHP), which provides similar support in that region. FCSS also maintains the Virtual On-Site Operations Coordination Centre (V-OSOCC), which allows real-time information exchange for emergency managers and provides the platform for the Global Disaster Alert and Coordination System (GDACS), integrating international on-line disaster information management systems under one umbrella.

Key objectives

- Respond rapidly and effectively to requests from governments/RC/HCs for an UNDAC team to assist in coordinating international response to sudden-onset emergencies
- Strengthen the capacity of UNDAC teams through training, exercises, consolidation and development of partnerships
- Expand awareness of the INSARAG network and foster adoption of common methodologies
- Support the International Humanitarian Partnership and the Asia-Pacific Humanitarian Partnership through regional activities
- Expand the OCHA Standby Partners arrangement

Activities

Seventeen UNDAC missions were deployed during 2005, involving 131 UNDAC members from 34 countries and five organisations. Fourteen were in response to sudden-onset natural disasters: Sri Lanka, the Maldives, Thailand, Indonesia and the Seychelles (tsunami); Guyana (floods); Tokelau and Cook Islands (cyclone); Indonesia (earthquake); USA (hurricane); El Salvador (floods); Pakistan (earthquake); Guatemala (mudslides); and Nicaragua (tropical storm). One hundred and three UNDAC members from 30 countries and four organisations ensured coordination of international assistance during the emergency phase of these disasters.

Three UNDAC response preparedness missions took place following requests from the governments of the Dominican Republic, the Philippines and Georgia for assistance in analysing national disaster response preparedness plans. These missions involved 28 UNDAC members from 14 countries and two organisations.

The International Humanitarian Partnership (involving Belgium, Finland, Norway, Sweden, Denmark, the Netherlands and the UK) supported seven UNDAC missions, with large-scale support camps in Indonesia and Pakistan. The IHP also provided telecommunications and logistical support modules and personnel during missions to Sri Lanka, Thailand, Guyana, Guatemala and Nicaragua. 2005 also saw the development of the Asia-Pacific

Humanitarian Partnership (involving Australia, China, Japan, Korea, New Zealand and Singapore) to provide similar support in that region.

UNDAC capacity was strengthened through the organisation of seven UNDAC training courses during 2005, including two induction courses (Europe and Asia-Pacific regions), three OSOCC training courses (Europe and the Caribbean regions) and refresher training (Africa-Europe region). The IHP provided support with staff and equipment for UNDAC training, and a support staff refresher course was held in Finland. An APHP training course also took place in Singapore.

In 2005, FCSS continued to work closely with UN Agencies, the IFRC, regional organisations and other humanitarian response partners, including the NGOs MapAction and Telecoms sans Frontières, with which it collaborated in the field during the tsunami and Pakistan earthquake responses, as well as in training activities.

In 2005, FCSS mobilised 59 expert personnel from Standby Partners to support OCHA offices in 10 countries (Sudan, Pakistan, Colombia, the occupied Palestinian territory, Sri Lanka, Afghanistan, DRC, Indonesia, Maldives and the Cook Islands). These personnel were seconded to OCHA on a cost-sharing basis.

FCSS organised INSARAG regional group meetings in Europe/Africa and the Asia-Pacific regions, with participants from 60 countries and organisations. Two USAR exercises were organised jointly with governments, in Geneva and Armenia. An USAR evaluation exercise was held in Hungary and a global USAR team leaders meeting was held in Estonia. A major initiative in 2005 was the revision of the INSARAG Guidelines, as well as the development of a USAR classification system.

Performance evaluation

All UNDAC teams were dispatched to sudden-onset emergencies within 48 hours of receipt of requests for assistance. The arrangement concluded with the Swiss government for provision of an aircraft allowed the first UNDAC team deployed to Pakistan after the South Asia earthquake to arrive within 24 hours of the disaster, and to set up coordination structures in the capital and affected region within 36 hours.

Rapid deployment is essential for UNDAC to effectively carry out its coordination role.

UNDAC training courses brought 72 candidates from 43 countries and six organisations into the teams. Practical training and lessons-learned exercises updated and consolidated skills of existing members at various training sessions. Partnerships functioned well, both in the field and for training events. UNDAC mission equipment was prepositioned in some OCHA regional offices to facilitate future deployments.

Revision of the INSARAG Guidelines updated coordination methodology and agreed classification standards of international USAR teams, thereby improving the quality and timeliness of international USAR assistance.

IHP support proved invaluable during 2005, both in missions and for training events. Development of the Asia-Pacific Humanitarian Partnership (APHP) boosted capabilities within that region, with the first support modules now available for deployment.

The 59 experts deployed through OCHA's Standby Partners enabled short-term staffing needs to be rapidly met by appropriately-qualified personnel. The seven partners include Denmark, Norway, Sweden, the UK, UN Volunteers, Registered Engineers for Disaster Relief Australia and Austcare Australia, an agency specialising in the provision of protection personnel, which joined in 2005.

Field Coordination Support Section

Requirements	1,647,615
Income from Voluntary Contributions	1,511,553
EXPENDITURE	
Staff Costs	906,122
Consultant Fees and Travel	129,364
Travel	204,643
Operating Expenses	66,601
Contractual Services	2,466
Supplies, Material, Furniture and Equipment	10,521
Fellowships, Grants and Contributions	1,398
Programme Support Costs	171,745
Total Expenditure us\$	1,492,860

UNDAC Developing Countries Deployment and Training Project

FCSS works to strengthen national capabilities to respond to sudden-onset disasters through increased developing country membership in the UNDAC system and INSARAG network. Through this project, developing country emergency managers are funded for UNDAC training and participation in UNDAC missions, particularly in their regions, as well as in INSARAG training and development activities.

Disaster Response Preparedness missions are arranged, following an express request to the Emergency Relief Coordinator from the government of a country and the RC, to assist in analysing national disaster response preparedness plans. The Terms of Reference are agreed with the government and RC prior to dispatch of the mission.

Key objectives

- Ensure developing country participation in international disaster response networks and activities, such as INSARAG and UNDAC
- Provide assistance to developing countries in analysing their national disaster response preparedness plans in order to build disaster response capacity in the regions as well as to absorb regional expertise into both INSARAG and UNDAC

Activities

FCSS funded 44 participants from developing countries to the various INSARAG meetings, training sessions and exercises organised in 2005. In addition, an INSARAG Awareness Course was held in Tunisia

for African and Middle Eastern countries, to increase understanding of and encourage participation in the network.

FCSS funded 32 developing country UNDAC team members from 18 countries on 11 missions in 2005. A further 28 developing country UNDAC members from 17 countries and organisations attended UNDAC courses.

Three UNDAC disaster response preparedness missions took place in 2005 in response to requests from the governments of the Dominican Republic, the Philippines and Georgia, to assist them with development of their national disaster response plans.

Performance evaluation

FCSS continued to expand the number of developing countries participating in the UNDAC system, with the result that the UNDAC team currently comprises 47 percent developing country members among its regional teams in Africa-Europe, Latin America and the Caribbean and Asia-Pacific. In this way, not only is national and regional expertise incorporated into UNDAC teams, but developing country members also take home their experiences and lessons learned through participation in UNDAC missions and training events.

UNDAC induction and training courses were held in three regions (Africa-Europe, Latin America and the Caribbean, and Asia-Pacific) to facilitate participation and tailor them to regional settings and requirements. UN Agencies and organisations in these regions were included in development of the regional UNDAC teams.

Meetings and exercises of the INSARAG regional teams continued to strengthen the use of common methodology for international urban search and rescue activities in collapsed structure situations, as well as to foster exchanges and build capacity of developing country teams, particularly those from disaster-prone countries.

UNDAC Developing Countries Project

Requirements	898,787
Income from Voluntary Contributions	1,256,914
EXPENDITURE	
Staff Costs	59,396
Consultant Fees and Travel	250,607
Travel	104,916
Operating Expenses	49,515
Contractual Services	-
Supplies, Material, Furniture and Equipment	-
Fellowships, Grants and Contributions	2,272
Programme Support Costs	60,672
Total Expenditure US\$	527,378

Civil-Military Coordination Section

The Civil-Military Coordination Section (CMCS), a project formerly called the Military and Civil Defence Unit (MCDU), facilitates and coordinates access to and use of international Military and Civil Defence Assets (MCDA) in countries affected by humanitarian emergencies. The project is responsible for the timely mobilisation of MCDA and for liaison with governments, international organisations and the military and civil defence establishments deploying these assets.

CMCS conducts UN Civil-Military Coordination (UN-CMCoord) training courses for the international community and draws on graduates to act as UN-CMCoord Officers in major humanitarian

emergencies. It conducts pre-deployment training for international military forces and assists in the planning and coordination of UN Agency participation in major military exercises with significant humanitarian assistance scenarios. The section acts as custodian for UN-CMCoord related guidelines and manages the UN Central Register of disaster management capacities, including the directory of international MCDA.

Key objectives

- Improve planning, monitoring and accountability of the civil-military coordination interface, to

include the application of MCDA and deployment of UN-CMCoord Officers in emergencies

- Strengthen the UN-CMCoord model for building disaster response management capabilities at national and international levels
- Enhance clarity in the relationship between humanitarian and military actors

Activities

CMCS promoted the use of the principles of the Oslo and MCDA Guidelines (use of MCDA in natural disaster relief and in complex emergencies respectively) through presentations at conferences, seminars, workshops and meetings, as well as their practical application in humanitarian emergency operations.

Significant MCDA support was provided to the Indian Ocean tsunami response. CMCS managed a total of 14 international MCDA requests, nine in support of WFP and UNHCR in response to the South Asia earthquake, with requests ranging from strategic airlift of essential non-food items to the provision of transport helicopters, air traffic control facilities, and water treatment and purification units, most of which were met by NATO forces deployed to the affected region. International MCDA support was explored for the provision of transport helicopters following severe flooding in Guatemala, and for transportation of relief supplies and equipment to Niger during its drought and food crisis at the request of WFP and UNICEF.

The section maintained a UN-CMCoord officer system for rapid response to humanitarian field operations to facilitate communication and coordinate activities between humanitarian and military actors.

In March 2005, the IASC endorsed the UN Humanitarian CMCoord Concept, aimed at standardising the deployment of UN-CMCoord Officers. Work continued on the establishment of national stand-by teams for a rapid and coherent response mechanism in support of humanitarian field operations.

CMCS participated in the planning and conduct of 11 large-scale military-led exercises comprising military, humanitarian and regional actors. Exercises involved the coordination of MCDA in humanitarian

relief scenarios, along with practising, strengthening and developing coordination tools, techniques and instruments.

CMCS continued to participate in the operational NATO pre-deployment training for the Afghanistan ISAF mission. This training was extended to the new NATO Response Forces and the Military Staff Colleges of NATO member and partner states.

With ECHO sponsorship, CMCS led a series of technical workshops to facilitate the development of the UN-CMCoord Field Handbook, a reference guide for humanitarian and military actors. The handbook will be practically tested in the field before final issue.

CMCS conducted 13 UN-CMCoord training courses and three UN-CMCoord staff level courses. With strong support and participation from Member States and regional organisations, regional coordination and capacity building mechanisms were enhanced through a mixed training audience from the humanitarian community and military/civil defence organisations. The UN-CMCoord training programme was expanded to support two in-mission training sessions in Liberia and one in Afghanistan. Training courses were also held in Switzerland, Indonesia, Kenya, the Dominican Republic, Slovenia, Finland and Ghana.

CMCS piloted an in-house lessons-learned database, capturing issues from past UN-CMCoord operations.

Performance evaluation

The objectives of the Civil-Military Coordination Section were met in 2005, despite staffing levels at some 60 percent of the authorised establishment. CMCS researched, prepared, released and tracked all MCDA requests to Member States within three hours of receipt. Member States met 80 percent of all requests.

Strengthening the UN-CMCoord model was achieved through developing a broader support base, with CMCS delivering 13 UN-CMCoord training courses and three staff level courses to do so. The number of personnel trained in 2005 on the UN-CMCoord training programme rose to a total of 437, with zero growth in staff resources.

Pre-deployment training activities for international military forces were strengthened by their expansion to include the new NATO Response Forces, briefings

to military staff colleges and training of the new NATO Expeditionary Forces Course.

The critical need for early UN-CMCoord deployment was recognised in a lessons-learned review of the tsunami response. This resulted in more timely deployment of UN-CMCoord Officers following the South Asia earthquake.

Civil-Military Coordination Section

Requirements	1,629,774
Income from Voluntary Contributions	1,018,931
EXPENDITURE	
Staff Costs	885,711
Consultant Fees and Travel	4,575
Travel	79,436
Operating Expenses	77,579
Contractual Services	9,864
Supplies, Material, Furniture and Equipment	4,293
Fellowships, Grants and Contributions	-
Programme Support Costs	137,989
Total Expenditure US\$	1,199,447

Logistics Support Unit

The LSU is involved in logistics coordination through close interaction with the UNJLC, and contributes to inter-agency discussions related to logistical aspects (other than military) of emergency relief. As OCHA's focal point for suppliers, it provides logistical support to the field and headquarters, particularly on transport issues.

LSU is also responsible for the timely mobilisation and delivery of emergency relief goods, among other items, through the management and immediate dispatch of OCHA stocks of basic non-food, non-medical relief items held at the Humanitarian Response Depot in Brindisi, Italy. While these stocks are not designed to provide relief in all situations, they can, thanks to the support of the governments of Italy, Norway and Luxembourg, contribute to filling gaps in emergency assistance.

Key objectives

- Strengthen coordination in inter-agency logistical efforts
- Manage and replenish the OCHA stockpile of basic relief items in the UNHRD, and provide support to interested governments for the dispatch of appropriate items to disaster-affected countries in a timely manner
- Achieve progress in the areas of shelter guidelines, enhanced customs facilitation and logistical support to the field and headquarters

Activities

In 2005, LSU planned and arranged for 10 emergency relief shipments from the UNHRD to five countries in Africa and Asia (the latter mostly related to the Indian Ocean tsunami and South Asia earthquake), in response to natural disasters and complex emergencies. Shipments grossed 256mt, roughly in line with 2003 and 2004 levels. A more detailed report on this activity is available in electronic format on OCHA online, or in hard copy on request to lsu@un.org.

Thanks to an Italian contribution for 2004/2005 and pre-established commercial contracts, the unit procured emergency relief items to a value of some US\$ 1.8 million in 2005. It also obtained goods in kind from Norway to a value of some US\$ 850,000.

In light of OCHA's coordination efforts for the tsunami relief, LSU was tasked, in early 2005, with issuing Logistics Bottlenecks Reports summarising and analysing most crucial information available. Approximately 30 such reports were issued between January and May. This arrangement was repeated in large-scale emergencies throughout the year, notably during the responses to the Nias earthquake in Indonesia in April and the South Asia earthquake in October.

LSU's Logistics Bottlenecks Reports issued between January and March during the tsunami response, and limited at first to internal use, were later

disseminated and found useful for logistics coordination on a much wider, external basis. During the response to the South Asia earthquake later in the year, an innovative joint reporting mechanism was put in place with UNJLC by which joint OCHA/UNJLC Logistics Bottlenecks Reports were posted on the UNJLC website as well as on ReliefWeb. After initial questioning by readers about the difference between the OCHA/UNJLC Logistics Bottlenecks Reports and the already existing UNJLC Bulletins, it was made clear that the role of the first was to reflect the situation at a given moment, in order to facilitate immediate decision-making, while the aim of the second type was to reflect a much broader, analytical view of the logistics situation.

LSU also took part, as OCHA focal point, in both the Logistics and Emergency Shelter Cluster Working Groups. After the Humanitarian Response Review recommendation to “expand global mapping of relief stocks”, the Logistics cluster decided to use the Register of Emergency Stockpiles, managed by LSU, as a basis. LSU started to revise the Register in line with the parameters of the cluster, such as setting up a new classification, common to all users, for items in stock; inclusion of detailed data about stock levels; revision and update of contact points; and possible inclusion (in cooperation with UNJLC) of a mapping tool.

LSU continued to disseminate, as widely as possible, its November 2004 booklet on Tents – A Guide to the Use and Logistics of Family Tents in Humanitarian Relief. Some 200 copies were circulated to relief partners in Pakistan during the earthquake response. LSU also won the support of a number of partners for the launch of a revised version of the 1982 UNDRO publication, Shelter after Disaster – Guidelines for Assistance. Despite its age, this book remains a key reference source in natural disasters and its revision is overdue. As a first step, OCHA/LSU commissioned a study of major gaps in the material and evolutions during the last 20 years, which was started in November.

LSU was also instrumental in securing funding from EMERCOM for a multi-purpose, cargo-passenger air complex to facilitate support to UNDAC field missions, and is in discussions with WFP on practical implementation.

The unit was very involved in discussions around partnerships with the private sector, in particular the donation of in-kind relief goods or logistics

expertise. It participated in the establishment of online business guidelines, drafted project proposals, provided advice and information on a framework for discussions with potential partners, and acted as counterpart for the donation of vehicles by a private donor in response to the South Asia earthquake.

Given the size of the unit (just one professional and one general service post in 2005), LSU is heavily dependent on external actors and partners such as UNOG for the procurement of relief items, WFP for the dispatch arrangements from the Brindisi stocks, and UNJLC for the gathering and analysis of logistics information at field level.

Performance evaluation

A total of 10 relief shipments were organised from OCHA/UN Humanitarian Response Depot stocks, providing assistance to five countries affected by natural disasters or emergencies. A recent audit of OCHA's relief operations in Sri Lanka showed that these relief items were distributed to beneficiaries in an adequate and timely manner. Given its limited capacity, LSU was not able to systematically follow up the dispatches at destination and report about the whereabouts of some of the consignments. The LSU still has some improvements to make in this area.

Some progress was achieved in 2005 in the areas of implementation of border crossing measures, guidelines for emergency shelter and logistical support to the field and headquarters. Work in these areas is ongoing with interested parties.

Logistics Support Unit

Requirements	123,735
Income from Voluntary Contributions	123,735
EXPENDITURE	
Staff Costs	111,952
Consultant Fees and Travel	-
Travel	6,441
Operating Expenses	842
Contractual Services	-
Supplies, Material, Furniture and Equipment	-
Fellowships, Grants and Contributions	-
Programme Support Costs	3,577
Total Expenditure us\$	122,812

Environmental Emergencies Section

The Environmental Emergencies Section (EES) is the United Nations mechanism to mobilise and coordinate international assistance to countries facing environmental emergencies and natural disasters with significant environmental impacts. It is a collaborative arrangement between OCHA and UNEP.

The section focuses, in particular, on identifying and addressing the most urgent and life-threatening environmental aspects of disasters such as chemical and oil spills, floods, forest fires, hurricanes, earthquakes, complex emergencies and other crises with potentially significant risks to human life, welfare and the environment. EES also supports response preparedness by helping countries to increase their environmental emergency response capacity, and provides secretariat support to the global Environmental Emergencies Partnership.

Key objectives

- Mobilise and coordinate timely emergency assistance to countries facing environmental emergencies and natural disasters with significant environmental impacts
- Share environmental emergencies information and expertise for improved environmental emergencies management
- Expand the Environmental Emergencies Partnership by engaging stakeholders in a range of collaborative activities
- Provide training for environmental emergencies preparedness and response to facilitate capacity-building and awareness-raising
- Integrate an environmental perspective into the response to disasters

Activities

In 2005, EES responded to requests for assistance in connection with disasters including: flooding in Guyana, potential risks of a dam break in Cameroon, Hurricane Stan in Guatemala and the South Asia earthquake. This was achieved primarily by ensuring the presence of environmental experts on UNDAC missions to conduct rapid environmental assessments, and mobilising experts and resources

to address their findings wherever required. For example, the section supported emergency response in Pakistan by ensuring rapid environmental assessments through UNDAC teams, and mobilising additional experts to act on waste management, slope instability issues and threats to the natural resource base.

EES organised a major meeting of the international Advisory Group on Environmental Emergencies (AGEE). This provided a forum for governments and experts to share and discuss lessons learned, good practices and develop options to strengthen response.

Information sharing was enhanced in the global Environmental Emergencies Partnership, for which the EES provides a secretariat, through an electronic newsletter and activities including an exercise to learn lessons from environmental aspects of the Indian Ocean earthquake-tsunami. A range of countries and organisations were engaged in partnership activities, including Iran and Yemen, UNV, UNOSAT and ISDR, and NGOs including the Benfield Hazard Research Center.

Two major exercises to ensure the sharing of good practice and practical lessons learned were undertaken in 2005. The most significant was the post-tsunami lessons learned exercise, noted above. This led to a number of specific follow-up activities, including a new project to develop a 'flash environmental assessment tool'. The second was integrated into a capacity building mission in Iran, during which lessons from other countries in the region were shared and discussed. EES has recognised that improvements to its website would facilitate greater sharing of good practice and lessons learned.

Through partnership with a Canadian academic institution, a strategy was developed to engage additional private sector corporations, offering an informal, flexible and simple way for stakeholders to engage with the UN in reducing the risks from environmental emergencies.

EES provided training for environmental emergency preparedness and response through, for example, the multi-stakeholder environmental emergencies capacity building workshop in Iran. EES also delivered the environmental component of the

UNDAC training course in Singapore, and organised a major multi-stakeholder workshop for January 2006.

Other noteworthy activities included responding to AGEE guidance to strengthen further EES's ability to respond to disasters. The section undertook activities to enhance methodologies for identifying environmental risks from disasters and increase the number of experts who can be deployed in response to government requests for assistance. EES also undertook activities to strengthen further OCHA-UNEP collaboration in the response to environmental emergencies.

Performance evaluation

EES ensured that official requests for assistance from countries facing environmental emergencies were addressed promptly. Specifically, countries received a response to a request from assistance within a day in the event of an emergency, and in less than five to seven business days where the request was for non-emergency related assistance. An area for improvement is to make additional efforts to ensure a clear division of labour between UNEP and OCHA, such that all requests related to environmental emergency response are immediately sent to EES. This would further enhance response speed and effectiveness.

EES ensured that environmental risks were identified during the initial disaster response and that where appropriate, additional experts were mobilised to address assessment findings. This helped to ensure that environmental issues were reflected in humanitarian response. To illustrate, during the response to the South Asia earthquake, the section ensured the presence of an expert to conduct environmental assessments on the first UNDAC team within one day of the disaster. This allowed EES to deploy additional experts to actually address the findings of the assessment within approximately three weeks, well within the initial response phase. A potential weakness is the insufficient number of environmental experts available for rapid deployment, particularly in the face of concurrent multi-country disasters.

A major capacity building exercise was carried out in collaboration with partner organisations in Tehran, which is expected to increase country-level capacity to deal with environmental disasters. It raised

awareness of EES capacity building potential, which resulted in three additional requests for support in 2006. Based on this exercise, EES also identified, with partners, that a better initial assessment of country needs at strategic, managerial and operational levels is required to improve overall mission effectiveness. A new methodology to this end needs to be developed.

Eight new stakeholders were engaged in Environmental Emergencies Partnership activities, broadening the range of skills and expertise that EES can call upon to reduce the risk of environmental emergencies. EES underestimated the difficulty in involving private sector stakeholders and overestimated the benefits of doing so when expertise can be more readily drawn by focusing on relations with key donor governments familiar with and supportive of EES activities.

Environmental Emergencies Services Section

Requirements	252,221
Income from Voluntary Contributions	275,000
EXPENDITURE	
Staff Costs	105,162
Consultant Fees and Travel	38,656
Travel	23,761
Operating Expenses	13,644
Contractual Services	-
Supplies, Material, Furniture and Equipment	4,942
Fellowships, Grants and Contributions	-
Programme Support Costs	24,201
Total Expenditure us\$	210,366

INTER-AGENCY INTERNAL DISPLACEMENT DIVISION

In spring 2005, the division's analysis of efforts to strengthen the collaborative response in eight priority countries concluded that HCs could not lead an effective inter-agency response to internal displacement without predictable 'collaborative partners' on the ground who had both the capacity and the willingness to lead and be accountable to the HC for critical aspects of the operational response. This finding was fed into and complemented by the Humanitarian Response Review (HRR) report issued in August 2005. As a consequence, the work plan for the division was substantially amended to focus on developing and promoting system-level solutions, in line with the demands of the General Assembly.

The resulting concept of assigned sectoral accountability for particularly weak areas of the displacement response represented an effort to improve predictability and accountability, as well as overall response capacity. After July 2005, IDD expended particular energy in supporting the elaboration of what became known as the cluster leadership approach. The second major focus for IDD in 2005 was the development of the Protection Standby Capacity roster (ProCap), a flexible deployment mechanism aimed at increasing the number of experienced, pre-selected and pre-trained protection staff to meet urgent short-term protection needs.

Key objectives

IDD's key objectives for 2005, adjusted in line with a major work plan reorientation, were:

- more predictable, effective and accountable response to internal displacement through development and implementation of concrete strategies for improving the collaborative response at the systemic level
- heightened stakeholder awareness on internal displacement, aiming to secure enhanced institutional, political and financial support from all concerned stakeholders towards improved IDP protection and assistance in key countries
- enhanced operational policy and capacity on internal displacement, particularly on protection, through technical support, capacity building and policy development activities
- improved inter-agency response to internal displacement at the field level, with a focus on eight priority countries

Internal Displacement Division	2005 TOTAL
Requirements	3,456,272
Income from Voluntary Contributions	4,080,094
EXPENDITURE	
Staff Costs	2,250,934
Consultant Fees and Travel	116,767
Travel	321,943
Operating Expenses	28,161
Contractual Services	9,086
Supplies, Material, Furniture and Equipment	10,375
Fellowships, Grants and Contributions	43,550
Programme Support Costs	362,370
Total Expenditure US\$	3,143,186

Activities

IDD submitted a proposal to OCHA's senior management, the IASC Working Group and, subsequently, the HRR team and donors aimed at securing a more predictable and accountable division of labour in four areas of IDP response (camp coordination and management, emergency shelter, protection and early recovery). This division supported the ERC and AERC in elaborating and securing buy-in for the cluster leadership approach concept. IDD also supported UNHCR by acting as secretariat and principal drafter in the Protection cluster working group, and engaged proactively in the Emergency Shelter and Camp Coordination and Camp Management working groups, as well as the UNDP-led Early Recovery working group.

Following IDD-led inter-agency support missions, the IASC agreed that three priority countries would be the first ongoing emergencies where the cluster leadership approach would be implemented in an effort to substantially strengthen the inter-agency response.

IDD led consultations with the Africa Group, GRULAC and host authorities in priority countries to raise awareness of displacement concerns. It mobilised donors to improve financial and political support, both at the systemic level and in certain country-specific situations, and held two informal all-day donor-hosted consultations. The implementation of IDD's media and public information strategy generated over 40 media pieces on internal displacement.

IDD developed and secured financing for the Protection Standby Capacity. The first ProCap pre-deployment mission was to Somalia in

December 2005. IDD co-convened a workshop bringing together OCHA heads of office in Africa on internal displacement and protection, and co-facilitated two WFP field workshops on protection.

IDD was an active member of the Representative of the Secretary General on the Human Rights of IDPs' steering group to produce a manual for legislators on developing national law and policy on IDPs, and supported the development of common policy approaches on the response to natural disaster-induced displacement. IDD commissioned, with UNHCR, a review on HIV/AIDS among IDPs, which made 10 major recommendations. In the framework of OCHA's Gender Mainstreaming Action Plan, IDD incorporated gender-sensitive indicators in its priority country criteria, developed a gender mainstreaming action plan and advocated on women's issues and sexual and gender-based violence.

IDD led missions to support HCs and country teams in the priority countries on the response to internal displacement. Structured follow-through with agencies translated into greater buy-in to IDD's suggestions and improved implementation. IDP/protection advisors were deployed to support HCs/OCHA offices in six countries. IDD also facilitated three consultations with groups of RC/HCs on the collaborative response.

IDD supported non-priority country displacement responses, including through deployments to Sri Lanka, the Maldives, Pakistan and Côte d'Ivoire. IDD coordinated the inter-agency support missions to DRC, Liberia and Uganda to consult on the possible implementation of the cluster leadership approach.

Performance evaluation

IDD's analysis and policy proposals on enhancing sectoral accountability were fully incorporated into the heart of the humanitarian reform agenda. IDD was subsequently a key actor in developing and securing stakeholder buy-in for the 'cluster leadership approach', which substantially strengthens the collaborative response to internal displacement, as acknowledged by donors and IASC partners.

Over 40 media pieces (press, radio, television and wire services) were generated by IDD, leading to heightened awareness of the IDP issue in decision-making capitals and displacement-affected countries. IDD recorded a substantial increase in Geneva-based

donor awareness of the link between lack of sectoral accountability at field level and weakness in IDP response on the ground.

IDD staff provided policy guidance and technical advice (on return planning, protection frameworks, shelter, for example) to country teams in the priority countries on over 20 separate mission deployments. The majority of these interventions resulted in adoption by UNCTs teams of advice given. In some instances, however, follow-through on the ground was less than optimal, due to lack of capacity among country teams.

Implementation of a systematic tracking system, coupled with close liaison between IDD and country teams on follow-up to IDD recommendations, resulted in over 70 percent of IDD's recommendations on the eight priority countries being implemented.

IDD recorded improvements against nine of 14 country indicators in the last six months of 2005. The division noted particular progress in securing enhanced HC leadership and OCHA support on IDP issues, greater engagement from country teams, and enhanced division of labour and strategic engagement on protection issues. Progress was mixed on securing better planning on return, reintegration and durable solutions, and galvanising the development of national plans on IDPs.

POLICY DEVELOPMENT

Policy Development and Studies Branch

The mandate of the Policy Development and Studies Branch (PDSB) is to provide policy guidance and clarity on humanitarian issues and to develop policies and tools that improve the effectiveness and efficiency of humanitarian action. To achieve this, PDSB engages with states, UN humanitarian organisations, states, humanitarian partners, field colleagues and academics to develop relevant and practical policies.

2005 saw the branch focus strongly on developing the humanitarian reform agenda, specifically in the elaboration of the new Central Emergency Response Fund (CERF) and the Cluster Leadership Approach. PDSB also sustained its core activities of further developing the humanitarian agenda through the main organs of the UN, namely the General Assembly, ECOSOC and the Security Council. Recognising the increasing number of natural disasters, the branch stepped up its activities in the areas of risk reduction and response preparedness. New support was provided on gender mainstreaming and protection from sexual exploitation and abuse.

Key objectives

- Elaborate the main elements of a humanitarian reform agenda that will provide more predictable and effective humanitarian response to crises
- Identify and address the challenges to humanitarian operations in the context of an increasing proliferation of assistance providers and new threats to humanitarian staff
- Offer guidance on relationships and terms of engagement with armed groups
- Further develop and disseminate policy guidance on key elements of civil-military relationships, and the planning, design and management of humanitarian components in multidimensional peace operations
- Maintain a watching brief on the potential humanitarian impact of sanctions and provide guidance on mitigation measures to sanction authorities
- Support policy development in natural disasters and risk reduction
- Develop policy in the areas of humanitarian and broader system wide UN reform

Policy Development and Studies Branch	2005 TOTAL
Requirements	2,758,767
Expenditure	
Staff Costs	1,482,377
Consultant Fees and Travel	18,037
Travel	223,070
Operating Expenses	495
Contractual Services	1,548
Supplies, Material, Furniture and Equipment	-
Fellowships, Grants and Contributions	30,500
Programme Support Costs	175,840
Total Expenditure US\$	1,931,867

Income for Core Activities is recorded in total under the Trust Fund for the Strengthening of OCHA

Activities

PDSB's efforts in 2005 were focused on the identification of emerging humanitarian trends and changes in the humanitarian environment, and on the development of common or harmonised humanitarian policies. Work with Member States in the humanitarian segment of ECOSOC was practically oriented to address the reform of the Central Emergency Revolving Fund and other improvements to the humanitarian system. The branch also engaged with Member States in the General Assembly on matters of humanitarian principle and their implementation by governments. The Security Council was the main focus of the branch's work on the protection of civilians, where activities focused on better integration of protection concerns into peacekeeping mandates and the preparation of recommendations for a new Security Council resolution.

To facilitate engagement with armed non-state actors and enhance negotiations on humanitarian access, PDSB developed a practical and user-friendly guide on negotiations. After research, extensive consultations and field visits, PDSB finalised the work on a manual, a companion set of field guidelines and a CD-ROM including relevant background material. See <http://ochaonline.un.org/humanitariannegotiations/index.html>.

To improve civil-military liaison in disasters and complex emergencies, and, where appropriate, collaboration between civil and military actors, PDSB continued to disseminate and promote guidelines and reference and policy papers. The branch seconded

a staff member to the civil-military coordination cell for the tsunami response in January and February. PDSB also participated in conferences, seminars and workshops to promote understanding of civil-military relations in the humanitarian context.

The need for clearer guidance on relations with the International Criminal Court arose out of the ICC's engagement in Uganda, Sudan and the DRC, where humanitarian organisations may be called on to support the IASC or to give testimony. PDSB initiated a series of meetings with ICC representatives and, together with the UN Office of Legal Affairs and other UN humanitarian agencies, instigated the drafting of practical guidelines for UN-ICC cooperation.

PDSB contributed substantively to the World Conference on Disaster Reduction in Kobe by drafting the Cluster Five background paper and report, organising the Panel on Disaster Preparedness and actively participating. It also contributed to rethinking OCHA's role in disasters; conceptualised and participated in the organisation of post-tsunami lessons learned workshops in affected countries; helped conceptualise the regional consultative process on the Sahel; and provided policy support to the IASC, OCHA field offices, and the Office of the Director of OCHA Geneva.

The branch participated in the IASC Human Rights-Humanitarian Action Sub-Working Group, the Protection Cluster and other fora concerned with human rights mainstreaming and/or the development of tools and guidelines to enhance protection, including in relation to disasters. The work on gender mainstreaming was carried out on an inter-agency basis and with the extensive involvement of the IASC Gender sub working group, resulting in common guidance and training material.

Performance evaluation

PDSB successfully developed some of the main elements for the humanitarian reform. Following extensive consultation with all stakeholders and Member States, PDSB drafted a report to ECOSOC and the General Assembly outlining the operation of the enhanced CERF. This was later adopted unanimously by the General Assembly, forms the legal basis for the operation of the CERF and constitutes the first major revision to the

institutional architecture since the adoption of GA resolution 46/182.

With PDSB support, the humanitarian response review resulted in strong inter-agency buy-in and commitment to broader reforms. A direct outcome of the process has been the IASC adoption of all nine recommendations regarding the cluster approach for all future emergencies. Future responses should thus become more predictable, with lead agencies for each cluster, and more effective.

In September 2005, the informal UN Working Group on humanitarian negotiations endorsed the PDSB draft of the Manual and Field Guidelines on Humanitarian Negotiations with Armed Groups. An official presentation and launch will be held in New York and Geneva in 2006.

An independent study undertaken on Integrated Missions formed the basis of key policy recommendations for improving their planning, design and management. There have been two key outcomes: a new SG's note of guidance on integrated missions that outlines how human rights and humanitarian issues should be addressed; and a revision of the Integrated Mission Planning Process that will lead to more appropriate mission design and better engagement of UN humanitarian and development organisations.

The Evaluation and Studies Unit within PDSB initiated and supervised a number of evaluations and reviews in 2005. The real-time evaluation in Darfur helped to establish agreed performance standards and led to the IASC commitment to initiate real-time evaluations at the earliest opportunity in all major crises. The response to the tsunami garnered sufficient international attention to warrant a major multi-donor and inter-agency evaluation, in which ESU played a key management and design role.

PDSB worked extensively with the UN Development Group Office on transition issues. A number of joint guidance products have arisen, including a review of funding mechanisms in transition and development of coordination handover processes.

Protection of Civilians Project

The Protection of Civilians in Armed Conflict Project plays a key role in PDSB's efforts to support the humanitarian policy agenda and to foster strategic and operational coherence within the United Nations Secretariat and the IASC. The Secretary-General has entrusted OCHA to lead and coordinate efforts to advance the protection agenda.

In 2005, the project aimed to: actively engage with the Security Council, other UN Member States and regional organisations to strengthen the protection framework, promote compliance with legal standards and norms, and improve response at the political level; and promote strategic coordination within the UN system, including the provision of training, advocacy and information management support.

In 2005, OCHA also played an active role in the work of the Protection Cluster established under the Humanitarian Response Review.

Key objectives

- Broaden the protection dialogue to include additional key constituencies through increased engagement with governments and regional organisations on the development of their protection policies and response
- Provide training and policy advice to colleagues at headquarters and in the field, particularly RC/HCs, OCHA heads of office and desk officers, in order to enable them to provide appropriate protection-related support services
- Develop tools, such as a collaborative monitoring and reporting mechanism

The establishment of the cluster approach as part of the Humanitarian Review Process led to a modification of the role of OCHA in supporting protection services at some field locations. While OCHA will continue to support protection response in the field, with the designation of clear lead agencies for protection OCHA will provide coordination support to the protection cluster.

Activities

During 2005, the project promoted the protection agenda in the Security Council through thematic

briefings on the protection of civilians, the incorporation of protection issues into situation-specific briefings, and assistance in the preparation of the Secretary-General's Fifth Report on the Protection of Civilians in Armed Conflict in November.

The project continued its outreach work with Member States and with regional and other inter-governmental organisations. A notable result was the adoption at the 6th High-level Meeting between the Secretary-General and the Heads of Regional and other Inter-Governmental Organisations in July of a joint work plan for strengthening cooperation on the protection of civilians in armed conflict. This plan envisages closer cooperation on networking and promotion of the protection agenda, as well as the development of protection policy frameworks, practical guidance and tools for use by regional and other inter-governmental organisations.

These initiatives complemented continuing work within the Secretariat, with UN Agencies through ECHA and the IASC, and, especially, support to the newly-established Protection Cluster. Efforts to broaden support for the protection of civilians agenda, develop a more effective protection framework and strengthen field response included support to peacekeeping missions, training, workshops, round tables and policy guidance.

OCHA's work with the Security Council, Member States, DPKO and DPA resulted in the integration of protection concepts into peacekeeping and peace-building efforts. Several field support missions were undertaken, most notably to DRC and Sudan, in an attempt to strengthen implementation of the protection agenda in peacekeeping and peace-building missions.

The basic framework for the development of a monitoring and reporting mechanism on protection of civilians in armed conflict was established through close collaboration with humanitarian partners. The protection components to be reported upon were agreed, and efforts were made to incorporate the reporting mechanism for children in armed conflict.

OCHA convened the first in a series of roundtables that examined the implementation of the protection mandate of the United Nations Organisation Mission

to the DRC (MONUC). That identified key challenges to implementation of the protection mandate and highlighted new approaches being adopted to strengthen collaboration between the mission and the humanitarian community. It also examined efforts to develop a robust protection framework. It is intended that observations and recommendations from the roundtable will be used to develop practical guidance for current and future peacekeeping missions.

The project provided training, workshops and targeted policy support in an effort to strengthen the protection of civilians. Training was provided to heads of OCHA country/regional offices and IASC partners in Africa, as well as to RC/HCs. In a workshop on the Northern Caucasus held in Nazran in March, over 60 participants representing all stakeholders addressed post-conflict protection concerns.

These training activities, along with policy guidance provided to RC/HCs, OCHA field staff and desk officers, facilitated the development and/or strengthening of country-specific protection strategies, such as in Côte d'Ivoire, DRC, the Russian Federation, Somalia, Sudan and Uganda. Specific training modules were developed for various target groups, including OCHA staff and RC/HCs, forming the basis of a protection training kit to be developed and field-tested in 2006.

The collaborative development of a global monitoring and reporting mechanism to facilitate analysis of trends, as well as subsequent decision-making by the Security Council and other stakeholders, advanced in 2005. Working together with the ECHA Implementation Group on the Protection of Civilians in Armed Conflict, a work plan was developed, an inventory of existing reporting mechanisms was undertaken, and the core protection components that will be reported against were agreed. Work will continue in 2006.

This effort was complemented by the development of country-level incident reporting mechanisms established in the DRC, Somalia and Sudan.

or by developing specific policies or frameworks during 2005. Further to support from OCHA for regional organisations, 21 regional and other inter-governmental organisations adopted a joint work plan with the UN for promoting the protection of civilians in armed conflict, particularly encouraged by the work done by the AU, ECOWAS and the Mano River Union.

Staff in all 14 OCHA country and regional offices in Africa, along with staff of several partner agencies, were trained in and provided with tools on protection of civilians in armed conflict, enabling them to incorporate protection appropriately into their work and provide direct protection support at the field level.

Protection of Civilians Project

Requirements	769,883
Income from Voluntary Contributions	350,000
EXPENDITURE	
Staff Costs	380,679
Consultant Fees and Travel	-
Travel	7,010
Operating Expenses	-
Contractual Services	-
Supplies, Material, Furniture and Equipment	-
Fellowships, Grants and Contributions	-
Programme Support Costs	50,759
Total Expenditure US\$	438,448

Performance evaluation

Sixty-two UN Member States incorporated protection of civilians elements into their national policies by ratifying key international treaties and/

Evaluation and Studies Project

This project is PDSB's principal vehicle for promoting greater accountability and improving the effectiveness of humanitarian action. The unit's brief includes managing a range of evaluative activities; documenting lessons identified; promoting institutional learning and knowledge sharing; achieving greater accountability in the humanitarian sector; and focusing on the achievement of results and the use of results information.

To achieve this, the unit initiates and manages evaluations, reviews and studies for OCHA and its humanitarian partners. In addition, the unit has been entrusted with helping to design and implement monitoring and evaluation (M&E) standards and systems.

Key objectives

- Improve OCHA's results-based reporting
- Increase the impact of OCHA's evaluative activities

While these objectives remained the same, a third objective – to create a sector-wide learning and accountability initiative in response to the tsunami – had a direct impact on the unit's work. Much energy was spent on promoting sector-wide accountability and learning through the creation of a sector-wide Tsunami Evaluation Coalition (TEC) under the aegis of ALNAP, and two other evaluative activities on the tsunami response.

Activities

In 2005, the ESU was involved in 15 evaluation activities. Seven of these were directly managed or conducted by the unit. These included two inter-agency real-time evaluation missions to Darfur, an evaluation of the ISDR Secretariat, a lesson learning review (LRR) of OCHA's initial response to the tsunami, an evaluation of tsunami emergency coordination efforts, and a review of the impact of select OCHA training courses. While this is one evaluation less than foreseen, this figure hides the complexities of the Darfur and tsunami evaluations. The unit also participated in an inter-agency evaluation of the UNJLC, led by WFP. The Humanitarian Response Review was supported and coordinated by the Geneva-based ESU staff throughout its duration.

Eight, or 53 percent, of the 15 evaluation activities were fully implemented in 2005 and another four (27 percent) are ongoing and should be finalised in

2006. The latter include a review of the effectiveness of Humanitarian Response Funds and a facilitated self-evaluation on the merger of OCHA's headquarters emergency response capacities, which has been transferred to the independent management of OIOS. Three (20 percent) of the planned evaluation activities were cancelled, mainly due to shifting work plan priorities, unforeseen additional work plan items and lack of capacity. They included a comparative review of global needs assessment methods and resources, which was implemented by an IASC-working group and did not require a separate study; a review of exit strategies; and a review of the 2002-2005 strategic plan.

A key but unplanned activity in 2005 evolved around the sector-wide Tsunami Evaluation Coalition (TEC), which ESU was instrumental in creating. The Active Learning Network for Accountability and Performance in humanitarian action provides the institutional platform for the TEC, which contains five cross-cutting evaluations on needs assessment; coordination; local and regional capacities; the link between relief, recovery and development; and donor response. The TEC initiative experienced some teething problems but has been embraced by ALNAP and raised expectations that similar coalitions will be created to review future emergency responses. The challenge will be to ensure concrete action and improvements based on the recommendations.

ESU's work on strengthening OCHA's monitoring and evaluation capacity showed more mixed results. Staff provided internal advice on OCHA's results-oriented monitoring and reporting issues, but implementation was restricted to prioritise time-intensive evaluation activities, such as supporting the Humanitarian Response Review and the TEC.

On inter-agency M&E issues, progress was made by the development of a strategic monitoring and evaluation framework, to be piloted in several CAP countries in 2006, which should lead to improved performance monitoring and evaluation of the CAP.

A communications strategy was not developed, although efforts to disseminate evaluation products increased through an updated website presence and the development of a key insight series.

The ESU is now staffed with a chief, four evaluation officers and one assistant: four in New York (three professionals and one assistant) and two in Geneva (two professionals). Three of these positions are short-term positions funded by Switzerland, Denmark and Germany.

Performance evaluation

The performance indicators for 2005 focused mostly on results-based reporting although the majority of the activities were evaluation related. Advances were made on the second objective of increasing the impact of evaluative activities and regarding the third objective, with the TEC. The first objective regarding improved results-based reporting remains to be achieved.

Improvements in OCHA's results-based reporting were modest. The percentage of "theoretically" measurable and observable indicators rose five percent, from 92 to 97 percent. However, year-end reports often fail to include feedback on indicator achievements in their performance assessments as these are not monitored throughout the year. Most indicators continue to measure product or services, but do not demonstrate whether the set objectives were achieved. This is due in part to OCHA's work planning process having shifted in 2005, which led to a reduced linkage of performance indicators to stated objectives. In recognition of this, the ESU prepared a strategy for improving M&E within OCHA, and intends to implement this in 2006.

Feedback on the current planning guidelines has been mixed, with many staff finding them very useful but some finding them confusing and too long. Revision of the guidelines is envisaged as part of the M&E implementation strategy.

As in 2004, 75 percent of the evaluation activities were undertaken on an inter-agency or joint basis, reflecting OCHA's emphasis on promoting and supporting inter-agency collaboration. While the bulk of the work in 2005 was focused on inter-agency activities, future work programming needs to also reflect internal learning and accountability needs.

Despite efforts to increase the effectiveness and use of evaluations, the implementation of recommendations remains uneven. The unit tracks the implementation of recommendations dating back to 2002. To date, about 58 percent of evaluation and review recommendations have resulted in concrete action, and 25 percent are in the process of being implemented. The degree of compliance varies from evaluation to evaluation, and management needs to ensure that those recommendations reported as being implemented are, in fact, addressed completely.

The creation of a sector-wide learning and accountability coalition on the tsunami was achieved and over 40 UN Agencies, donors, NGOs and non-profit entities agreed by mid-year to join and fund the initiative, and jointly evaluate sector-wide performance. The effectiveness of this effort remains to be seen, but the TEC is recognised as an innovative modality for cross-sectoral inter-agency evaluation.

Evaluation and Studies Project

Requirements	406,800
Income from Voluntary Contributions	622,120
EXPENDITURE	
Staff Costs	-
Consultant Fees and Travel	337,664
Travel	17,870
Operating Expenses	846
Contractual Services	-
Supplies, Material, Furniture and Equipment	-
Fellowships, Grants and Contributions	-
Programme Support Costs	46,291
Total Expenditure US\$	402,671

Gender Equality Project

Enhancing gender equality is an important area of policy for OCHA and the PDSB for three reasons: there is growing evidence that understanding gender relations and inequalities can help improve humanitarian assistance; within the UN system there are commitments to using a gender perspective and working towards greater equality between women and men; and third, evaluations have pointed out that

gender mainstreaming has been a neglected area of humanitarian assistance. Gender mainstreaming refers to how OCHA works on gender issues in its substantive work.

OCHA is also the co-chair of the IASC Task Force on Gender and Humanitarian Assistance. One key output of the IASC Task Force in 2005 was the issuance of the

Guidelines on Gender-based Violence Interventions in Humanitarian Settings: Focusing on Prevention and Response to Sexual Violence in Emergencies.

Key objectives

- Implement the gender action plan
- Raise the awareness of OCHA staff on gender issues
- Coordinate inter-agency work on gender issues under the auspices of the IASC

Activities

OCHA's gender mainstreaming project was in full swing in 2005, with the Senior Gender Advisor beginning work in March 2005. In 24 OCHA offices, gender focal points were named as the point of contact on gender mainstreaming issues.

OCHA reissued its policy on gender equality, and produced it and a gender equality toolkit in a user-friendly format complete with press kit. A progress report on the implementation of the Plan of Action on Gender Equality was prepared, highlighting the successes and failures of OCHA offices.

Guidelines have also been developed on strengthening gender analysis in CAP documents. A mini-workshop was held in November 2005 to plot ways to further strengthen gender mainstreaming in the CAP, including by having a more predictable response to gender needs in CAP projects.

In 2005, capacity building with OCHA staff on gender issues was a priority. Gender training sessions were held with AIMB, CRD, IASC, IDD and while on mission to tsunami-affected countries. These efforts were crucial in raising the understanding of the policy and its implications for operations. Gender resource kits were sent to all field offices, including 10 key gender resources of UN and NGO partners.

The advocacy and information services of OCHA were very successful in mainstreaming gender issues. OCHA senior management continued to bring gender issues to the attention of donors, the media and other decision makers. They have communicated on several occasions to HCs and to OCHA staff on gender mainstreaming, and their expectations regarding the need to increased efforts towards the goal of gender equality.

Protection of Civilian reports to the Security Council dedicated more than 25 percent to the problem of protection of women and girls.

Performance evaluation

The implementation of the policy and action plan progressed, with some areas, such as advocacy and information, showing significant improvements: ReliefWeb increased by 30 percent the number of gender-related documents available online, OCHA Online has a new home page on gender equality and the OCHA Field Guide has been updated with all essential gender resources.

There is still improvement needed in implementation at the country level. Five of 22 countries (Angola, DPRK, DRC, Ethiopia and oPt) reported on the gender work in their offices in 2005, as did three regional offices (South Africa, Latin America and the Caribbean, and Asia-Pacific). Four countries made specific mention of gender issues in their 2006 work plans.

At the inter-agency level, considerable attention was paid to ensuring the mainstreaming of gender issue into the Cluster Approach. The lack of specific field-friendly guidance on how to mainstream gender was recognised, and an IASC handbook on gender is under development. Indicators and tools to measure the degree to which gender is mainstreamed will be a key aspect of the gender handbook.

Gender Equality Project

Requirements	301,602
Income from Voluntary Contributions	269,378
EXPENDITURE	
Staff Costs	34,959
Consultant Fees and Travel	13,978
Travel	-
Operating Expenses	-
Contractual Services	-
Supplies, Material, Furniture and Equipment	-
Fellowships, Grants and Contributions	-
Programme Support Costs	6,362
Total Expenditure US\$	55,299

ADVOCACY AND INFORMATION MANAGEMENT

Advocacy and Information Management Branch

Advocacy and information management are at the heart of OCHA's work. Humanitarian advocacy is a core mandate of OCHA's, while accurate and timely information underpins all humanitarian operations and decisions, from advocacy to policy making to coordination of relief operations on the ground.

In OCHA, the Advocacy and Information Management Branch (AIMB) is responsible for managing these two key functions through a number of projects and activities run by its three component sections: the Advocacy and Public Information Section in New York and its counterpart in Geneva, the Advocacy and External Relations Section; the Information Analysis Section; and the Information Technology Section.

In 2005, AIMB pursued three broad objectives. First, it reinforced several initiatives begun in previous years to develop and deploy information management tools to strengthen humanitarian coordination in all OCHA field offices; strengthen information analysis and early warning capacity to better support strategic decision-making; and develop surge capacity in its key areas of operation (public information, information management and ICT) to allow it respond swiftly and effectively to sudden-onset emergencies. To this end, it worked to enhance collaboration with regional and field offices, and expand advocacy and information sharing networks.

A second priority for the branch was to harness its advocacy and information management resources to advance the humanitarian reform agenda. Advocacy and public information activities helped the ERC convey the reform message through media interviews, public speeches, newspaper articles and opinion pieces. ICT efforts focused on applications to promote transparency and accountability, with due attention paid to using information management to support the cluster approach.

Thirdly, the branch launched a comprehensive initiative to improve organisational effectiveness by using IT tools and expertise to improve internal information flow. In tandem with an OCHA-wide effort to strengthen administration and human resource management at all levels, AIMB started to revamp OCHA's internal communications. It launched a set of IT-based tools (an OCHA intranet, a new document management system and e-mail

Advocacy and Information Management Branch	2005 TOTAL
Requirements	4,923,213
Expenditure	
Staff Costs	3,430,441
Consultant Fees and Travel	266,685
Travel	253,459
Operating Expenses	8,728
Contractual Services	33,691
Supplies, Material, Furniture and Equipment	322,261
Fellowships, Grants and Contributions	-
Programme Support Costs	465,120
Total Expenditure US\$	4,780,385

Income for Core Activities is recorded in total under the Trust Fund for the Strengthening of OCHA

Table consolidates expenses for Advocacy and Information Management

solution) designed to minimise redundancy and promote efficiency in internal information sharing.

The scale and geographic spread of humanitarian emergencies in 2005 presented a major challenge for advocacy and information management, stretching the branch's resources and forcing it to adapt its work processes to address several large-scale and concurrent crises. Yet they also provided an opportunity to demonstrate the efficacy of new or enhanced information services and tools in a variety of crisis environments. For instance, the Indian Ocean tsunami response marked the first deployment of HICs in natural disaster situations (in Banda Aceh and Sri Lanka), while the disasters in Guatemala and Pakistan brought the first deployments of public information surge capacity.

While the value-added of these information tools in coordinating response was acknowledged by UN and other humanitarian organisations on the ground, their deployment also exposed gaps. For example, a joint OCHA-donor evaluation of information management response to the Pakistan earthquake disaster called for the role of the HIC to be redefined in the context of the cluster approach, as well as for more effective collaboration system-wide in assessments, standard setting, monitoring and data analysis to support strategic decision-making.

Neither was the deployment of public information officers to some tsunami-affected regions as swift or smooth as desired. This provided the impetus for setting up the public information surge capacity deployed in Guatemala, Pakistan and Niger later in the year.

With regard to promotion of the humanitarian reform, the ERC's advocacy efforts were enhanced by positive media coverage and strategic message placements by the advocacy sections in New York and Geneva. ICT colleagues also helped to set up the CERF website and developed software and applications to help track donor contributions.

During the response to the Pakistan earthquake, the Field Information Support project joined the rest of the humanitarian community in applying the cluster approach by seeking to adjust the HIC to support the clusters. During the same emergency, OCHA exercised

its role as a service owner of the emergency telecommunications cluster, in tandem with WFP and UNICEF, for the first time. Despite initial difficulties, this represented a major step forward in the quest for coherence and standardisation of telecommunications operations in emergency situations.

Meanwhile, the internal communications initiative holds great promise for improving information sharing and contributing to organisational efficiency.

The following sections elaborate on the activities and accomplishments of the main units and projects of the branch.

Advocacy Section

OCHA's Advocacy and Public Information Section (APIS), located in New York, and the Advocacy and External Relations Section (AERS), located in Geneva, assisted and supported the Secretary-General, the Emergency Relief Coordinator, Humanitarian Coordinators and other parts of OCHA, including CRD and ESB, in advocating for effective and principled humanitarian action at the global, regional and country levels.

Advocacy support was also either undertaken directly or provided to other OCHA branches interfacing with various fora, including regional organisations, the Office of the Spokesperson of the Secretary-General (OSSG), and other international and regional bodies. Both APIS and AERS promoted advocacy on key humanitarian issues and worked for the inclusion of humanitarian concerns in UN decisions and communications, as well as with UN Member States in their decision-making. Regular contacts were maintained with the media, NGOs, civil society groups and academic institutions.

Key objectives

- Improve the visibility coverage of complex emergencies, emerging crises, natural disasters and sudden-onset crises through proactive publication in, and outreach to, diverse media, with the deployment of trained and rostered public information specialists
- Develop joint advocacy campaigns on common priorities with IASC partners

- Support and develop field and regional advocacy strategies
- Improve OCHA Online by increasing and updating content

Activities

In 2005, media outreach was increased to ensure that the ERC's field missions and humanitarian priorities received maximum coverage, particularly through an increased number of op-eds, or opinion articles. There was also a significant increase in OCHA's interactions with international media, particularly after the Indian Ocean tsunami. Between the ERC, other senior officials and OCHA's public information officers, more than 1,500 interviews were done with media outlets worldwide. In addition to providing guidance for the interviews, the section disseminated press releases, organised press briefings and provided regular inputs to the noon briefing of the OSSG.

APIS established OCHA's first ever public information surge capacity roster comprising 21 OCHA field and headquarters staff, as well as staff from the OSSG and DPI. Two newly-trained staff from this roster were quickly deployed after the earthquake in Pakistan and hurricanes in Latin America. APIS and AERS also provided critical advocacy and public information support for the tsunami response, and conducted field support missions to the DRC, Nepal and Sudan.

APIS piloted an advocacy and public information preparedness and early response model in Latin

America (natural disasters) and West Africa (violent conflict), organised events with the International Peace Academy, and continued joint advocacy activities with InterAction and selected INGOs, including by hosting meetings with advocacy counterparts on crises in the DRC, Uganda, and Darfur.

The section also led advocacy efforts on the Secretary-General's UN reform, notably that of the humanitarian system and the enhanced CERF, and undertook joint advocacy campaigns with IASC partners such as Oxfam, and with Refugees International.

In 2005, APIS continued to manage OCHA Online, the organisation's corporate website, adding content to cover human security and gender equality, and resolutions adopted by all the major UN bodies on humanitarian issues. The site continued to add links to field-based OCHA websites and headquarters sub-sites.

OCHA Online also complemented OCHA's flagship websites, ReliefWeb and IRIN, in providing public information on complex emergencies and disasters. While OCHA Online functioned as a consolidator, pulling together information from all parts of OCHA to create strong thematic coverage, a concerted effort was made to increase the links to both ReliefWeb and IRIN wherever possible. Examples of this included the "campaigns" pages incorporating links to both sites, and the use of maps from ReliefWeb and photographs, films and web specials from IRIN to provide visual impact. In planning new campaigns and considering content for the forgotten emergencies and natural disaster sections, OCHA Online liaised with ReliefWeb and IRIN to avoid duplication of material, while maximising the reach of the information.

APIS and AERS continued to strengthen and expand advocacy partnerships with regional organisations, the private sector, policy-making organisations, INGOs and academic institutions. AERS advocated for the EU Council, at the Foreign Ministers level, to endorse critical policy decisions reaffirming the primary role of the UN in directing and coordinating humanitarian relief in emergencies and disasters. The section worked to ensure European relief mechanisms are geared to integrate and cooperate with those managed by the UN.

The section implemented an advocacy plan for the World Conference on Disaster Reduction in Japan in January 2005. AERS also launched the Quarterly OCHA-Geneva Natural Disaster Bulletin, widely distributed to all permanent missions in Geneva and through ReliefWeb.

AERS developed public/private disaster response initiatives with the World Economic Forum operational network. AERS also launched a pilot project, in cooperation with the Special Advisor to the Secretary-General on Sport for Development and Peace, to use major sports events in Europe to promote the UN's role in humanitarian action. AERS ensured regular liaison with European NGOs in support of inclusive system-wide coordination at the field level on specific issues.

Performance evaluation

Coverage of humanitarian issues increased in 2005 through a push on op-eds, press releases and other forms of media outreach, as well as the development of field advocacy and crisis communications strategies. The number of ERC op-eds published (sometimes repeatedly) rose, for instance, from eight in the last half of 2004 to more than 30 in 2005 – more than at any time in OCHA's history. All of the op-eds produced were successfully placed, in newspapers including the New York Times, Le Monde, International Herald Tribune, Wall Street Journal, Al Hayat, Moscow News, USA Today and the Financial Times.

Advocacy work with NGOs, governments, civil society and other entities was enhanced through meetings and briefings through the NGO forum/InterAction and the IASC, and with parliamentarians, donors, universities, focus groups and other stakeholders.

The first public information surge capacity roster was established to ensure the immediate deployment of a UN spokesperson to sudden-onset crises, and it deployed staff for the first time. The roster is intended to ensure the coordination of UN public information activities on the ground and have official UN spokespeople available to meet media demands.

Staffing constraints curtailed certain initiatives, such as joint advocacy campaigns to raise awareness of neglected emergencies and encourage greater funding.

The number of page views for OCHA Online rose from 2.5 million in 2003 to 5 million in 2005, and the addition of new pages on major natural disasters, and sections on neglected and emerging emergencies strengthened the site.

Access to decision-makers in Europe was enhanced, with OCHA invited to contribute to major EU and NATO policy events relating to response to humanitarian crises and preparations for peacekeeping operations.

Information Analysis Section

Located within the Information Analysis Section (IAS) are three important components of OCHA's capacity to collect, manage, exchange and disseminate humanitarian information in support of strategic analytical goals. These three units are

dedicated to early warning analysis, field information support to operations and coordination, and global ReliefWeb coverage of emergencies and disasters as they unfold. The following sections describe the work of each of these components in 2005.

Early Warning and Contingency Planning Unit

The Early Warning Unit of AIMB is responsible for improving OCHA's ability to identify potential complex emergencies. The unit produces in-depth country reports, one-page alerts in response to rapidly deteriorating situations and a quarterly global risk analysis in collaboration with partners. These products inform strategic decisions by OCHA's management, as well as inter-agency partners, with respect to preparedness, advocacy and response coordination.

During 2005 the unit strengthened its ties with regional and country offices, which led to the development of regional inter-agency early warning, preparedness and mitigation strategies for Central Asia, West Africa and the Andean countries. The unit has worked closely with the IASC to improve the quality of its risk assessments and to develop a Standard Operating Procedure that links early warning to different preparedness actions. Work started on developing an action checklist for internal OCHA purposes. The unit has remained highly engaged with the Framework Team.

Key objective

- Produce timely and relevant early warning analysis for countries potentially at risk of humanitarian crisis through strengthened ties with internal and external partners, particularly those based in the field

Activities

During 2005, the Early Warning Unit undertook most of the activities as highlighted in *OCHA in 2005*. In close consultation with partners in headquarters and the field, the unit produced early warning analyses and alerts for countries facing potential humanitarian crises in south and central Asia,

the Pacific, Latin America and West Africa. It also produced 21 early warning fact sheets. These reports supported the ERC in some of his briefings to UN Member States.

The unit produced two OCHA internal risk matrices and four IASC Early Warning – Early Action reports in close collaboration with partners. Each of these matrices included projections on potential developments in more than 50 existing or emerging crises.

The unit worked with IASC partners to refine an inter-agency site that facilitates better sharing of internal early warning and emergency preparedness information, thereby strengthening Early Warning – Early Action decision-making at an inter-agency level.

The unit worked closely with partners on the Framework Team to implement the recommendations of a 2004 evaluation, which included developing a Terms of Reference for the Framework Team Secretariat, sharing its early warning methodology, maintaining the link with ECHA and improving ties with RCs.

Together with OCHA's regional offices, the unit maintained and developed partnerships with global civil society networks, such as the Global Partnership for the Prevention of Armed Conflict (GPPAC), regional organisations such as ECOWAS, and regional NGOs including ECCP (European Centre for Conflict Prevention), WANEP (West Africa Network for Peacebuilding) and CRIES (Coordinadora Regional de Estudios Economicos y Sociales/Regional Coordination for Economic and Social Research).

In July 2005, the unit facilitated the ERC's participation in a panel discussion on Mobilising Early Response at a global conference on conflict prevention organised by GPPAC at UN headquarters in New York.

Performance evaluation

The Early Warning Unit, in collaboration with its humanitarian partners, anticipated 90 percent of non-disaster humanitarian crises that occurred in 2005.

During 2005, early warning products provided information that contributed to eight inter-agency contingency plans, 300 media reports, ReliefWeb coverage of five emerging country/regional crises, and enhanced information management capacity in five different regions.

In the cases of Central Asia, Côte d'Ivoire and its five neighbouring countries, and Ethiopia and Eritrea, the unit worked particularly closely with internal and external partners to ensure a high level of humanitarian preparedness.

Based on early warning analysis, a UN system-wide strategy was developed in Nepal and OCHA established a fully-fledged office.

In one case, Niger, early warning signals did not lead to adequate and timely action by the humanitarian community. An OCHA assessment of the impact of the IASC's Early Warning–Early Action report in triggering action on Niger concluded that, even

though the report flagged food insecurity in the Sahel at an early stage (September 2004), it did not play a role in mobilising early action by the humanitarian community. Reasons for the poor response included weak preparedness, the development of inappropriate responses and lack of capacity.

OCHA shared quarterly early warning and preparedness assessments from 25 OCHA country and regional offices for 50 countries with IASC partners, thereby supporting the humanitarian community in the development of the quarterly IASC Early Warning–Early Action reports, and implementation of follow-up actions.

Early warning analysis distributed to Framework Team members on countries at risk of humanitarian crisis resulted in greater engagement by conflict prevention actors in the UN system. For instance, the unit placed Chad on the agenda of the Framework Team.

Through the Global Partnership for the Prevention of Armed Conflict, the Early Warning Unit increased the number of its partnerships with regional civil society partners from 10 to 25. This led to a 100 percent increase in the contribution of civil society actors to products released by the unit.

ReliefWeb Project

ReliefWeb is the world's leading online gateway to information on humanitarian emergencies and disasters. It is designed to assist the international humanitarian community in effective delivery of emergency assistance, and provides timely, reliable and relevant information as events unfold, while emphasising the coverage of forgotten or neglected emergencies at the same time. ReliefWeb teams in Kobe, New York and Geneva update the website around the clock, and broker information from over 2,500 humanitarian organisations.

The latest site redesign was launched in January 2005, allowing users to more efficiently access information most critical to their specific needs and interests. ReliefWeb's outputs and achievements in 2005 took place against the backdrop of sudden-onset natural disasters unparalleled in recent history, not least the Indian Ocean tsunami, the hurricane season in Latin America and the Caribbean, and the South Asia earthquake.

Key objectives

- Facilitate more effective and efficient sharing of humanitarian information with increased user control and reduction of overload through redesign of ReliefWeb
- Provide improved and more timely map production capacity
- Facilitate wider information exchange through partner websites using content syndicated from ReliefWeb
- Establish closer ties with the academic sector to promote humanitarian principles through sharing of humanitarian policy and issues materials
- Ensure regular communication and relationship building with information partners to maintain the quality and timeliness of information on emergency response activities

Activities

ReliefWeb was enhanced in 2005, with revised content management policies and systems upgrades. Following a tradition of user-centred design, ReliefWeb took advantage of the latest testing techniques to analyse users' information needs in order to prioritise information hierarchies on the site.

Nearly 40,000 documents and maps were posted in 2005, representing a 70 percent increase on 2004. Dramatic peaks in site usage were seen in the months after the tsunami (with over 7.5 million page views during the first quarter) and after the Pakistan earthquake (with over 8 million page views during the fourth quarter). Twenty four-hour coverage provided by three duty stations meant that timely information was put out. The ReliefWeb office in Kobe, Japan, was especially important, given the task of updating the site on the Asian emergencies.

The ReliefWeb vacancies service also published over 8,500 job announcements during the year, a 50 percent increase on 2004.

ReliefWeb gave high visibility to forgotten humanitarian emergencies, including in Somalia, Uganda, Togo and the Sahel. It also raised the profile of themes such as gender and armed conflict, humanitarian reform, the Central Emergency Response Fund (CERF) and resource mobilisation.

Regular editorial meetings within OCHA helped to prioritise humanitarian emergencies in order to strengthen early warning, public information and advocacy efforts. Thematic material in the Policy and Issues section also received increased attention.

A new work flow system distributing the posting of thematic documents across the three ReliefWeb offices led to an increase of over 1,000 such documents on the site.

The production and sharing of maps was up 15 percent on 2004, with more timely maps for Asia- and Africa-based disasters. Data sharing was further supported through the development of new geo-spatial repositories, map-related partnerships and outreach at external events. A strategic partnership with IFRC led to collaboration in map production between the two offices. In the months after the tsunami, maps and graphics created for USG press conferences were produced in collaboration with OCHA desks and field offices. ReliefWeb maps were also used in the production of OCHA publications.

ReliefWeb convened three meetings to build partnerships and strengthen best practices in the exchange of humanitarian information. This included a meeting of the Humanitarian IT Network in Geneva and a regional Humanitarian Information Network (HIN) workshop in Panama, organised in conjunction with the OCHA regional office.

The HIN in Panama brought together information management practitioners from Latin America and the Caribbean, and focused on preparedness measures for the 2005 hurricane season, work towards standards for inter-operability between different information systems, and building a regional community of practice. An Africa-based workshop is planned for 2006.

ReliefWeb continued to strengthen relations with information partners to improve the quality and timeliness of information on emergency responses. All three regional teams undertook outreach work, including at conferences such as Interaction, the Web4Dev forum, Global Knowledge Partnership, the UN's DPI-NGO annual event and with the DPKO and NATO situation centres.

Additional outputs, particularly relevant to the ongoing improvement of the ReliefWeb site and the virtual team approach to global 24 hour coverage from three offices worldwide, included: progress on the first phase of content management and editorial policies; agreement on the use of information management principles; and newly formulated terms of service and privacy policy, which will be available on the site.

Performance evaluation

ReliefWeb increased content output by 70 percent, as well as use of the redesigned website, especially during response to disasters.

The turnaround of maps was improved, with a total of 860 published in 2005.

Partner organisations, including NGOs and OCHA field websites, started using web feeds from ReliefWeb. Many partner websites now also include direct hyperlinks to the site.

ReliefWeb enhanced information-sharing partnerships within the academic and policy fields, and integrated the updating of Policy and Issues section of the site in the regular work of the three ReliefWeb duty stations.

Work on technical services and infrastructure, editorial policy and extending information networks was

adversely affected by the heavy workload that resulted from coverage of the major Asian disasters.

In spite of a new navigation scheme and more integrated content, intensive follow-up was required on several aspects of the technical infrastructure of

ReliefWeb, involving work with IBM to ensure optimum functionality of search and filter tools, increase server stability and remove inconsistencies from the site. These technical problems will become a major focus of work in 2006.

ReliefWeb Project	New York & Geneva	Kobe	TOTAL
Requirements	1,556,163	445,451	2,001,614
Income from Voluntary Contributions	1,242,297	350,000	1,592,297
EXPENDITURE			
Staff Costs	1,019,145	272,632	1,291,777
Consultant Fees and Travel	44,340	10,827	55,167
Travel	78,085	30,400	108,485
Operating Expenses	13,134	5,788	18,922
Contractual Services	57,341	52,325	109,666
Supplies, Material, Furniture and Equipment	29,512	13,605	43,117
Fellowships, Grants and Contributions	-	-	-
Programme Support Costs	159,057	50,125	209,182
Total Expenditure US\$	1,400,614	435,702	1,836,316

Field Information Support Section

The Field Information Support (FIS) Section helps sustain the delivery and coordination of humanitarian assistance through the development and implementation of information management tools in the field. FIS is responsible for supporting OCHA's field information management systems and providing technical and other back-stopping support to field offices. FIS is also responsible for the global oversight and management of HICs, one of the United Nations Humanitarian Common Services.

FIS aims to increase information management capacity in field offices and improve the geographic distribution of information management staff through its partnerships with UN Volunteers and academic institutions.

Key objectives

- Improve deployments of HICs through refinement of implementation methodologies and operations, and expand the cadre of staff trained and experienced for an HIC and/or to provide IM support to OCHA field offices
- Enhance OCHA's capacity to provide data and technical support to HICs and OCHA field offices

- Develop new partnerships with humanitarian partners, such as NGOs and donors, and improve relations with existing partners through the Geographic Information Support Team (GIST), the IASC and stand-by-partners
- Continue to enhance the diversity of IM professionals involved in HICs and working within OCHA field offices, building on partnerships with UNV among others

Activities

In 2005, FIS worked towards strengthening the use of information and data in humanitarian operations. This was achieved through the continued development of HICs and their introduction into natural disaster response environments; implementation of a Field Information Management Strategy for OCHA; and the deepening of partnerships, including through the GIST.

Four HICs were deployed in 2005 (in Sumatra, Sri Lanka, Niger and Pakistan), compared with one in Darfur in 2004 and two, in Iraq and Liberia, in 2003. FIS continued to support the HICs in Liberia and Darfur throughout 2005.

OCHA identified and maintained a roster of trained personnel prepared for deployment, which was used for successive HIC deployments in 2005. Forty four humanitarian and/or technical professionals trained as managers, liaison or GIS officers, and data coordinators for HICs. Standardised information management tools and ICT equipment were made available for immediate deployment, and used in both HIC Niger and HIC Pakistan.

After technical feedback from internal GIS experts on data preparedness systems highlighted a need to develop capacity to meet the functional demands of GIS users, FIS initiated collaboration with Hunter's College in New York and an academic consultant to develop OCHA's Field Information Geospatial-database System (FIGS).

The section maintained its support role to the GIST, which includes UN Agency, university, NGO and donor members. In 2005 the GIST began developing by-laws and formed two working groups, focusing on disaster data preparedness and emergency mobilisation procedures.

FIS, together with key partners, engaged in data preparedness activities to improve its capacity to provide timely and relevant data and information management products to the humanitarian community.

Access to available information was facilitated through HIC websites, maintained on a daily basis. Where connectivity was poor, other means of distribution (hard copies, CD-ROM, document binder sets and memory sticks) were used. For example, HIC Sumatra established an "information kiosk" for hundreds of walk-in clients in Banda Aceh, where maps, documents and forms were distributed.

In partnership with UNV, FIS successfully fielded six volunteers to support implementation of OCHA's information management strategy in Burundi, Senegal, Niger, Sudan, the occupied Palestinian territory and DRC. This initiative contributed to improved geographic distribution of information management staff through the deployment of UN Volunteers from developing countries.

These professionals, ranging in expertise from database experts to information management generalists, were mentored by senior information management officers in the field offices to which they were posted. They were provided with the opportunity to attend training programmes at the country level and Global Field Information Management (FIM) training, enhancing

their knowledge of current information management practices and tools used in humanitarian relief operations.

Performance evaluation

All four HICs deployed in 2005 were established within seven days of a request being received, and provided core products and services soon after.

Considerable management challenges were experienced in managing six HICs concurrently, when there are usually no more than two. Defining the duration that an HIC should be operational and ensuring that transition strategies are in place remain key priorities, and discussions with UNDP to this effect are high on the agenda for 2006.

Stakeholders in all countries made use of HIC products for programme support and fed into HIC-generated information materials, such as the contacts directory and WWW database. Map products, which have come to be expected by all stakeholders, were produced by all HICs. The timeliness of information products and services, identified as problematic in joint review missions, remains reliant on the capacity and willingness of stakeholders to provide data to the HIC in a timely and standardised manner.

A heightened awareness of HICs and their utility has resulted in a number of new partnerships within the humanitarian community (MapAction, UN Volunteers, SIDA's standby force and academic institutions) as well as increased deployment requests. As a result, FIS is starting to formalise partnership procedures and is developing scaleable information management response tools, so that each emergency can be addressed more appropriately.

In partnership with UNV, six information management professionals were placed in OCHA field offices in 2005. Four were from Africa, one from South Asia and one from Eastern Europe. The fielding of UN Volunteers in six countries supported implementation of OCHA's field information management strategy while, at the same time, enabling volunteers from developing countries to be exposed to the United Nations.

Client perceptions of the HICs, gleaned through user surveys, demonstrated that the key function of the HIC in providing information that informs strategic and operational decision-making is still not fully realised. A monitoring mission by OCHA and ECHO to the HICs in Sri Lanka and Sumatra, and a joint ECHO, DFID, OFDA, OCHA review of HIC Pakistan, confirmed that,

although HICs were having a positive impact on humanitarian response, the concept required further clarification in the context of humanitarian reform, and especially in terms of their relationship with HCs, OCHA offices and cluster lead agencies.

Field Information Support Section	
Requirements	970,279
Income from Voluntary Contributions	885,000
EXPENDITURE	
Staff Costs	795,526
Consultant Fees and Travel	54,212
Travel	125,649
Operating Expenses	-
Contractual Services	3,895
Supplies, Material, Furniture and Equipment	1,976
Fellowships, Grants and Contributions	-
Programme Support Costs	127,563
Total Expenditure US\$	1,108,821

Field Information Management Project

In early 2004, OCHA's senior management endorsed a new field information management strategy, recommended by Field Information Support (FIS). The objective is to increase support to humanitarian actors by improving the capacity for decision-making and analysis through strengthened collection, processing and dissemination of information.

In order to implement this strategy OCHA initiated a sub-project, Field Information Management (FIM), within FIS with the specific aim of strengthening field-based information management capacities. This aim is to be achieved by increasing OCHA's information management capacity in field offices to strengthen the internal flow and management of information, and to provide improved external services to its many humanitarian partners.

In 2005, nine field offices were prioritised for implementation of the information management strategy: Côte d'Ivoire, Guinea, Ethiopia, Nepal, Regional Office-West Africa (Dakar), Regional Office-Central and East Africa (Nairobi), Regional Office-Asia Pacific (Bangkok), Russian Federation and Zimbabwe.

Key objectives

- Strengthen OCHA's field-based information management capacities
- Promote a minimum standard of information management within field offices through standardised IM systems and tools

Activities

In 2005, FIM worked with donor partners especially the Humanitarian Aid Department of the, European Commission (DG-ECHO) and OCHA's field offices to build capacity in nine priority OCHA field offices through the creation or designation of Information Management Units (IMU) as an integral component of the operation.

These field offices were assisted through the provision of 11 expert personnel deployed as information management officers, newly created or OCHA-generic information management systems and related ICT equipment, in order to support OCHA in building the capacity of humanitarian actors for decision-making and analysis through strengthened collection, processing and dissemination of information.

Standardised tools were made available to the nine targeted field offices, although integration of these tools into regular work flow and decision-making is ongoing. Of the six applications being developed under the project, two were completed by the end of 2005 (the Field Document Management System and the E-mail Solution) and four were partially completed (Field Website Template, Contact Directory, WWW database and the Geographic Information Database).

The nine offices were connected to OCHA's Wide Area Network (WAN) and have reliable access to OCHA's global e-mail solution and Field Document Management System (FiDMS). This strengthened communication network, coupled with a document

management system that provides concurrent information storage and accessibility for headquarters and field offices, has increased efficiency by reducing duplication and facilitating information retrieval. These systems enable OCHA to improve the accuracy and timeliness of information to aid strategic decision-making in the field and at headquarters.

Geographic data (core data sets such as administrative boundaries and population figures) were collected for Indonesia, Sri Lanka, Niger and Pakistan, and used to produce initial maps of affected populations and other information products to aid humanitarian coordination in response to natural disasters. In 2005, the acquisition of Global Discovery GIS software, which comprises most layers required (boundaries, settlements, transportation and landmarks) for producing baseline (pre-crisis) maps, allowed OCHA to begin the process of improving spatial analysis against various indicators in response to natural disasters and complex emergencies.

Performance evaluation

At the end of 2005, FIM had partially achieved its stated objective. The creation of Information Management Units and improved ICT infrastructure substantially improved the information management

capacity of the nine field offices newly assisted in 2005, as well as those assisted since 2004.

However, the operational environment, coupled with the high staff turnover that characterises humanitarian operations, has meant that the integration of information management into work flow and decision-making has not been fully realised at the field level.

Non-structured feedback from a number of stakeholders also indicated that improvements in information management capacity within field offices had provided limited benefit to the wider humanitarian community so far.

Field Information Management Project

Requirements	2,808,953
Income from Voluntary Contributions	2,230,869
EXPENDITURE	
Staff Costs	847,694
Consultant Fees and Travel	390,251
Travel	325,559
Operating Expenses	-
Contractual Services	26,375
Supplies, Material, Furniture and Equipment	755,028
Fellowships, Grants and Contributions	34,974
Programme Support Costs	309,341
Total Expenditure US\$	2,689,222

Information and Communications Technology Section

OCHA's Information Technology Section (ITS) provides the Information and Communications Technology infrastructure and support required for effective information management, both at headquarters and in the field. The section is also responsible for leading efforts in inter-agency coordination in Emergency Telecommunications, by acting as the secretariat for the IASC sub-working group on the subject.

Key objectives

- Further enhancement of the OCHA Online platform through the development and deployment of the OCHA intranet and field office templates

- Comprehensively review OCHA's telecommunications connectivity, including e-mail services
- Bolster inter-agency coordination and support in the area of emergency telecommunications

Activities

The section finalised the technical platform for the OCHA intranet and launched a pilot version with basic functionality and contents in November. The same platform was used for the migration/creation of field office websites using predefined templates, and website templates were used in eight field offices. The archiving system initially developed for the field was

expanded and adapted for use OCHA-wide, creating the OCHA Document Management System (ODMS). Metadata standards and a classification scheme to be used for all websites and ODMS were established and integrated into the system.

ICT connectivity and e-mail support strategies and guidelines were established, including the design and establishment of a Global Area Network (GAN) including satellite services. Connectivity and e-mail infrastructure was provided to eight field offices.

In the area of inter-agency coordination, the Inter-Agency Emergency Telecommunications (IAET) common service was activated for the tsunami and South Asia earthquake emergencies, providing common inter-agency security and data telecommunications services to UN Agencies and NGOs. IAET lessons-learned exercises were conducted for both these emergencies, and a tsunami user survey was widely disseminated to users. The results were very positive, with high user satisfaction.

Standard technical training modules, including satellite and radio training, were developed and made available to all members of the IASC sub-working group on emergency telecommunications. Open standards for HF radio were developed and a project to inter-connect the different UN networks worldwide was initiated. A second edition of the Handbook on Disaster Communications was published, and the Tampere Convention on the Provision of Telecommunication Resources for Disaster Mitigation and Relief Operations came into force in January 2005, following its ratification by 30 countries.

As planned, a prototype system for tracking donor contributions, based on the Financial Tracking Service (FTS), was developed. This Expenditure Tracking System (ETS) was deployed for the tsunami response. The FTS system itself was also redesigned according to enhanced technical specifications.

Apart from those planned activities, the IT section provided ICT infrastructure to support both the tsunami and the South Asia earthquake operations. Standard collaboration workspaces (QuickPlace) and templates were implemented, and rapidly deployed to support these emergency operations and other needs.

Following the Humanitarian Response Review, OCHA took on the role of chair and process owner for the emergency telecommunications cluster, and contributed significantly to the cluster's work

plan and the framework for its implementation during 2006.

Other applications developed that had not been foreseen in the 2005 work plan were a centralised authentication system, a data collection (survey) system, and a centralised cost plan management system.

Performance evaluation

The OCHA intranet is available to all 27 field offices, providing more efficient and complete access to information, and helping to better inform staff around the world of OCHA activities and events.

Metadata standards for classification and indexing of documents were established, and are available for use throughout OCHA, improving information accessibility and inter-operability of systems.

All field offices and HICs have been equipped with website templates and platforms, providing field offices with an effective way of disseminating electronic information with a minimum of investment of technical expertise and time.

A comprehensive telecommunications connectivity strategy for OCHA's field operations was developed in July, which will improve communications and access to common UN resources by providing reliable and rapid standard connectivity solutions for voice and data, as well as for security telecommunications (in line with MOSS compliance).

A revamped and expanded OCHA e-mail system, available to all field operations, was put in place, increasing reliability of and access to e-mail for field staff, while saving on maintenance costs.

An Inter-Agency Emergency Telecommunications (IAET) common service for the humanitarian community was established under the leadership of ITS, resulting in a coordinated approach with less or no duplication of ICT services.

ITS provided technical support to a tsunami expenditure tracking system, facilitating timely and transparent reporting on expenditures. An evaluation and lessons-learned exercise was done, and both OCHA staff and donors confirmed the utility and value-added of the improved system. OCHA will further enhance the system to make it more generally applicable, rather than tsunami-specific.

PART III

OCHA COORDINATION ACTIVITIES IN THE FIELD



OCHA/IRIN

On the ground, OCHA staff provided humanitarian coordination support to the activities of UN Agencies, NGOs, the Red Cross movement and other members of the humanitarian community. In doing so, OCHA also worked in close collaboration with governments and their agencies. At the end of the year, OCHA had a presence in 35 countries and six Regional Offices, in Bangkok, Dakar, Dubai, Johannesburg, Nairobi and Panama. Regional Disaster Response Advisors are located in those offices as well as in Kobe and Suva, covering Asia and the Pacific respectively.

In 2005, OCHA faced increased challenges responding to both natural disasters and complex emergencies. Following the Indian Ocean tsunami, OCHA deployed more than 100 staff members to the region, opened new offices in Sri Lanka and Thailand, and dramatically expanded its Indonesia office. Throughout the year, OCHA facilitated immediate life-saving humanitarian assistance and collaborated with partners working towards recovery and reconstruction.

On 8 October, the South Asia earthquake struck Pakistan, India and Afghanistan. OCHA focused its response on Pakistan, where some 75,000 people were killed and approximately three million were affected. An UNDAC team was deployed immediately and, by year-end, OCHA had established five sub-offices and deployed 26 staff. OCHA also supported the implementation of the cluster approach in Pakistan, the first time of application in a natural disaster setting.

The response to ongoing complex emergencies was also expanded, notably in Sudan, where OCHA's presence grew from 26 to 55 international staff, particularly in support of operations in Darfur, and IDP and refugee returns in the south. In DRC, OCHA coordinated the development of the US\$ 681 million 2006 Action Plan, drawing on an extensive needs assessment survey and intensive consultations.

The deepening vulnerability in Zimbabwe and the consequences of Operation Restore Order led OCHA to deploy three staff members to bolster humanitarian coordination. It subsequently opened a fully-fledged office in January 2006. In response to the food security

crisis in Niger, OCHA deployed a coordination team to support the HC, and established a HIC to improve information analysis and dissemination. Several OCHA offices, such as Nepal, expanded as humanitarian crises arose or evolved.

OCHA's revised field budget requirements (excluding the tsunami, dealt with separately in Parts I and IV) rose from US\$ 61.6 million in 2004 to US\$ 79.6 million in 2005 due to these growing needs. Income rose to US\$ 62.8 million, up from US\$ 53.5 million in 2004.

During 2005, OCHA also continued its efforts to ensure a smooth handover to transitional and development actors where possible. In Angola, the Transitional Coordination Unit was transformed over time into the Resident Coordinator's Unit, and OCHA ended its presence. The Maldives office was closed, as development actors increased their role following the tsunami.

While the tsunami, South Asia earthquake and Darfur captured most public attention, OCHA also worked hard to highlight neglected emergencies, such as in the Central African Republic, Republic of Congo and Haiti, where funding fell short of needs.

OCHA field offices, particularly Regional Support Offices, increasingly engaged in early warning and preparedness work in 2005, contributing to strategies to mitigate and prevent crises, and to trigger early action.

OCHA recognises the importance of timely, relevant and accurate information to effective operational and strategic coordination, and its emphasis on providing improved information management support to its field offices – as well as improving internal communications systems – continued. Efforts to improve information management support to field offices saw HICs established in Indonesia, Sri Lanka, Niger and Pakistan, while new information management tools were developed to improve communications systems.

The scope of natural disasters and other crises severely stretched the humanitarian community in 2005, and full implementation of the Humanitarian Response Reforms will be important to increasing the system's capacities to deal effectively with multiple large-scale crises.

Integrated Regional Information Networks (IRIN)



- Establish the Middle East service to provide coverage of under-reported humanitarian and human security issues in the region. Based in Dubai, expand reporting to include Yemen, Jordan, Syria, Lebanon, Israel, the occupied Palestinian territory and Egypt, with an Arabic service available later in the year
- Improve the flow of information to those affected by conflict by reinforcing the existing radio service and expanding to new countries and areas of concern

Activities

In line with readership feedback, IRIN placed greater emphasis on contextual analysis in its African coverage, and increased its output in Asia and the Middle East. Overall news output increased by seven percent on 2004, with some 7,284 reports produced, including over 1,700 in local languages.

IRIN is an independent news service covering Sub-Saharan Africa, parts of Asia and the Middle East. It was established in 1995 to provide accurate and timely information on events and issues of concern to humanitarian workers and decision-makers in donor and host governments. The project also attempts to ensure that local populations in humanitarian crises can access credible information to help them make informed decisions about their futures and welfare.

IRIN provides this information through text and radio services. In 2005, it enhanced its advocacy efforts with the provision of an increasingly multi-media output, including photos, short films and reports, which can be used to highlight key concerns, such as emerging or neglected crises.

Key objectives

- Consolidate the existing news services to ensure continued timely, accurate and impartial reporting on humanitarian issues in the regions covered
- Inform humanitarian decision-making and response by producing special reports, analysis and film documentaries focused on evolving crises, post-conflict countries, forgotten emergencies and such as gender-based violence

PlusNews consolidated its position as a leading provider of HIV/AIDS news in Africa by launching French and Portuguese language services, aimed primarily at informing Francophone and Lusophone communities in western and southern Africa respectively.

IRIN continued its commitment to informing humanitarian decision-making and response to evolving and neglected crises. It launched coverage of the deteriorating human rights situation in Nepal and established daily, on-the-ground coverage from Pakistan after the earthquake there, producing some 150 reports from the affected area. In addition, six 'in-depth' reports were produced tackling issues of particular concern – such as refugee return, political tensions in Guinea, ARV treatment – and a major publication addressed gender-based violence worldwide.

IRIN TV trebled its production of footage on under-reported issues and country-specific situations, including the impact of malaria in Ethiopia, HIV/AIDS on Lake Victoria in Kenya, the Niger drought and food crisis, and the impact on civilians of the conflict in Nepal. A documentary on violence against women affected by conflict in the DRC and Liberia won a top award in the 2005 film festival Stories from the Field, hosted by the New School University in New York.

Video footage on key humanitarian concerns was produced and distributed directly to broadcast networks such as SABC and CBC, while 30 news packages were distributed to over 400 broadcasters globally via a daily satellite feed managed by Associated Press.

IRIN expanded its Middle East service from coverage of the humanitarian crisis in Iraq to include humanitarian concerns in the region. The Dubai office was set up in early 2005, and a network of freelance writers trained and established in the ensuing months. Humanitarian reporting on seven focus countries gradually increased, with the service producing three to four articles per week from each, as well as daily coverage from Iraq. The launch of an Arabic website and coverage of Israel and the occupied Palestinian territory were postponed to 2006.

Funding of the IRIN Radio project, primarily by the Human Security Trust Fund, allowed for its expansion to promote peace in Côte d'Ivoire and HIV/AIDS awareness in Lesotho. A new radio initiative aimed at creating HIV/AIDS awareness was launched for the Lagos-Abidjan trucking corridor. The "Let's Talk" soap opera in Burundi played a leading role in keeping dialogue going between Burundians at home and those in camps in western Tanzania, while another soap opera and current affairs programme received widespread acclaim from Angolans struggling with post-conflict reconstruction.

Performance evaluation

IRIN's annual readership survey, devised to gauge the service's added value, recorded that IRIN maintained both the quality and relevance of reports. Almost 90 percent of respondents rated IRIN coverage as "good to excellent" overall. IRIN registered the largest ever readership growth in the overall number of unique monthly web visitors (812,000) and e-mail subscribers (37,000), representing 45 and 24 percent growth respectively on the previous year. Based on 2004 survey results, global readership is estimated to be over 1 million.

Significant gains were observed in 2005 in the number of mainstream and national news organisations reprinting IRIN text reports and photographs, and using video materials. Tracking of usage identified that over 500 news sites in 73 countries – including wire services such as Agence France Presse, BBC monitoring and Spain's Europa Press – regularly cited IRIN or reprinted articles.

Direct feedback by users of the documentaries has demonstrated that film material has been used extensively by new user constituencies, in addition to IRIN's core humanitarian audience. Student, teacher, political and civil society groups have used documentaries to raise awareness of the issues raised in the films. IRIN is planning a more effective feedback system to better measure the impact of its multi-media output.

E-mail subscribers and website visitors increased globally, while many users confirmed that they redistribute articles to thousands of other readers via external and internal mailing lists. Subscribers to the Middle East service grew by 38 percent compared to 2004. Middle East articles were among the most frequently accessed on the IRIN website, with several articles viewed by over 6,000 visitors. The uptake by international and local media (including the Yemen Times, Islam Online, The Daily Star and Jordan Times) highlighted the dearth of stories addressing humanitarian issues in mainstream media coverage.

An independent evaluation in 2005 concluded that IRIN delivered high-quality outputs through all its radio services, and was well received by primary beneficiaries, especially displaced persons and refugees. In particular, it concluded that radio services helped decision-making among affected communities.

IRIN
Requirements, Income and Expenditure Breakdown

Requirements	5,442,491
Income from Voluntary Contributions	6,136,461
EXPENDITURE	
Staff Costs	2,208,340
Consultant Fees and Travel	1,447,914
Travel	422,233
Operating Expenses	782,187
Contractual Services	273,060
Supplies, Material, Furniture and Equipment	157,103
Fellowships, Grants and Contributions	-
Programme Support Costs	687,809
Total Expenditure US\$	5,978,646

AFRICA



Angola



Despite its vast natural resources, Angola remains one of the poorest countries in the world. Sixty-eight percent of the population lives below the poverty line and the life expectancy rate is just 42 years. As the country is emerging from a 30-year civil war, restoring the social sectors is vital to reconstruction, reintegration and human development. The Angolan government, supported by the humanitarian community, has been able to reduce lingering pockets of vulnerability to some extent by increasing the delivery of social services throughout the country, but much remains to be done.

During 2005, the OCHA-supported Transitional Coordination Unit (TCU) moved from traditional humanitarian coordination and reporting towards the promotion of transitional activities in the provinces. Through the Technical Unit for the Coordination of Humanitarian Assistance (UTCAH), OCHA/TCU received a firm commitment that the government was ready to assume full responsibility for the coordination of remaining humanitarian activities. In turn, the UN system concentrated its support on strengthening the government's capacity to coordinate assistance and deliver basic services. At the end of the year, OCHA/TCU handed over its UN responsibilities to the newly created Resident Coordinator's Unit (RCU).

Key objectives

- Ensure that local coordination mechanisms are in place to facilitate the improved delivery of basic social services to vulnerable populations by supporting the government in coordinating assessments and community appraisals for humanitarian and transitional needs
- Ensure that protection and human right safeguards are integrated into resettlement and return programs
- Consolidate the transfer of core coordination functions to the relevant government authorities, define capacity building needs for decentralised coordination at municipal and communal levels, and identify appropriate implementation partners
- Support provincial governments in establishing coordination structures for disaster management and ensure that the government's early warning capacity is established through the transfer of know-how and core competencies

Activities

Through a network of international and national field advisors, OCHA/TCU coordinated field efforts, collected information including lessons learned, advocated at the central, provincial and local levels, and worked to strengthen the capacity of local partners. It also monitored the humanitarian situation, including human rights and protection concerns, and maintained an early warning system on developing needs. OCHA/TCU assisted the humanitarian community with advice and coordination activities, and convened fora to exchange information, discuss issues relevant to transition and monitor projects to avoid gaps and prevent duplication.

Throughout the year, OCHA/TCU provided timely and relevant information on the overall situation, including specific needs or trends, and coordinated a common UN information strategy. It also monitored and verified reports of human rights abuses, politically related violence and other protection issues in the provinces, in collaboration with local partners, government and UN Agencies.

OCHA/TCU identified capacity building needs at both provincial and national levels as they arose, and developed activities to address those needs. It assisted UTCAH in following up on the recommendations of the joint IDP evaluation of April 2005, and assessed government-led provincial coordination mechanisms and personnel needs, including in areas such as disaster management and early warning.

OCHA/TCU-led coordination meetings of UN Agencies, NGOs and donors were held on a monthly basis. Analytical reports such as the UN Bi-monthly Bulletin and monthly provincial reports were disseminated on a regular basis, and helped provide a concise and accurate picture of the humanitarian situation and response. In order to ensure continued UN coordination, a proposal was developed for a Resident Coordinator's Unit (RCU). Following approval of the proposal, four field offices, 12 staff members and relevant assets were transferred from OCHA/TCU to the RCU.

The completion of a lessons-learned report on the OCHA/TCU experience (July 2004-December 2005) was crucial to OCHA's ongoing work of capturing the lessons learned from various field offices, particularly large operations such as the one in Angola. The report will serve as part of an in-house toolbox for OCHA staff working on countries in transition.

Performance evaluation

In the area of protection, OCHA/TCU engaged in field monitoring as well as advocacy and liaison with provincial authorities, the Ministry of Justice, national police, The UN Human Rights Office and UN Department of Safety and Security on incidents of politically-related violence. This work led to a higher awareness of protection concerns among the various stakeholders and helped provide transparency about instances where human rights were not respected. All OCHA/TCU field advisors also participated in a UN Human Rights Office-led training of trainers for protection monitoring and helped share the experience accumulated during the work of OCHA/TCU.

As part of an effort to transfer coordination functions from OCHA/TCU to the government, UTCAH-led coordination mechanisms were established in eight provinces. Joint OCHA/TCU-UTCAH work plans were also developed in 15 provinces, as part of capacity-building workshops. A strong emphasis was placed on joint monitoring, including early warning indicators. For example, joint assessment missions were organised to support return and reintegration, verify reports of human rights abuses, assess food insecurity and vulnerability, and to provide information on public health trends and disease surveillance. In one instance, a joint assessment mission led the UN and the government to reach agreement on the total number of IDPs in Angola, even though initial estimates had been far apart. This consensus greatly facilitated the subsequent joint planning of the response to the needs of the IDP population.

Angola Requirements, Income and Expenditure Breakdown

Requirements	1,561,732
Income from Voluntary Contributions	676,566
EXPENDITURE	
Staff Costs	735,402
Consultant Fees and Travel	-
Travel	44,784
Operating Expenses	42,316
Contractual Services	17,186
Supplies, Material, Furniture and Equipment	5,611
Fellowships, Grants and Contributions	772,428
Programme Support Costs	215,365
Total Expenditure US\$	1,833,092

Burundi



In 2005, major steps towards peace and stability were attained in Burundi, allowing for the start of longer term programmes with a view to durable development. The formal transition period, set up through the August 2000 Arusha Agreement was successfully completed with the election of new central and local authorities. Some 16,000 soldiers were demobilised and an additional 11,000 members of various militias disarmed and returned to the community.

The return of IDPs in southern provinces continued, while the residual caseload (approximately 116,000 IDPs) remained in sites, mostly located in central and northern Burundi. The UNHCR-led voluntary repatriation programme enabled 68,000 refugees to return from Tanzania. The northern provinces of Ngozi and Kirundo witnessed an inward flow of Rwandan asylum seekers from April 2005. The humanitarian community played a critical role in ensuring that cholera outbreaks, food insecurity and other localised emergencies were addressed.

Key objectives

- Ensure the effective and timely provision of assistance to vulnerable populations
- Provide effective national and international coordination structures to address the assistance and protection needs of affected populations

- Support the consolidation/development of early warning and emergency preparedness mechanisms to respond to potential crises and natural disasters

While those objectives remained in force throughout the year, OCHA also focused on bridging the gap between emergency response to humanitarian need, and the various strategies developed towards reconstruction and development, by establishing much closer relationships with key actors such as UNDP and the World Bank.

Activities

Between March and May, OCHA updated its IDP study, the results supporting the design of an IDP Action Plan to respond to IDP return or resettlement-specific needs. A draft was completed in September and the plan is to be submitted to the government in 2006. The IDP study also served as a key tool for government, UN Agencies, NGOs and donors in their own strategic programming.

The office coordinated the elaboration of the 2006 Common Humanitarian Action Plan (CHAP)/ Consolidated Appeal Process (CAP) which succeeded in combining immediate humanitarian priorities and consistently articulating related programmes to reflect transitional needs and avoid impeding the implementation of longer term projects.

OCHA maintained regular contact with civil and military authorities regarding the protection of the civil population in areas still affected by the conflict between the national forces and the last active rebel group, Palipehutu FNL.

The Geographic Information Group (GIG) created in 2004 and facilitated by OCHA, expanded its coverage to include humanitarian actors and relevant national institutions. This resulted in the consolidation and dissemination through maps and databases of large volumes of data addressing humanitarian needs and operations.

The establishment of the Information Management Unit (IMU) in February resulted in regular dissemination of key information products to relevant partners, helped identify gaps in assistance delivery through enhancing information management tools, and allowed for an upgrade of the OCHA Burundi website.

In order to support the integration of post-conflict transition needs at all levels of programming, OCHA carried out wide consultation for the global reshaping of coordination mechanisms. This included the rationalisation of national thematic groups in view of their future integration into the PRSP coordination mechanisms, the creation of an in-country IASC team, and the establishment in 12 of Burundi's 17 provinces of operational sector coordination mechanisms in direct link with the respective thematic group at national level.

Performance evaluation

More than 250 OCHA field missions in all provinces, about half of them joint missions with other UN Agencies or NGOs, ensured regular humanitarian monitoring and dissemination of the findings. In this way, the office enabled appropriate interventions, notably in addressing food insecurity, cholera outbreaks, population displacements and natural disasters.

The protection group chaired by OCHA brought together more than 10 organisations, including UN Agencies, the UN Mission in Burundi (ONUB) and NGOs, on a monthly basis. Advocacy with the national armed forces, agreed through the group, resulted in a significant reduction in post-delivery looting of food and non-food relief in western provinces, and in the mitigation of discrimination against the most destitute to access the beneficiary list.

The establishment of an IASC country team in September helped ensure that ongoing emergency concerns, including protection issues, were kept on the agenda, and not overshadowed by transitional and development issues. Although no specific protection plan was elaborated, the IDP Action Plan addressed many protection issues, which were consistently addressed through the protection working group.

Along with WFP, FAO and NGO partners, OCHA continued to take a leading role as part of the executive committee of the food security early warning and response (SAP-SSA) project, which forewarned of anticipated crisis points from June to the end of the year and advocated with donors for support of preventive action. The early response that resulted helped prevent a large-scale famine anticipated for November.

By facilitating information sharing and coordination between humanitarian actors and the various components of ONUB, OCHA contributed to ensuring a greater level of protection and advocacy in favour of more than 400,000 conflict affected people in Bujumbura-Rural and Bubanza, where compliance with international humanitarian law is an ongoing concern.

With offices in Bujumbura, Makamba and Ruyigi OCHA was able to maintain comprehensive coverage of protection and humanitarian issues. Using its in-depth knowledge of the situation on the ground, OCHA played a key role in ensuring that actors at the national level were able to address actual needs.

OCHA's coordination efforts also allowed the senior management of ONUB to give adequate consideration to humanitarian and early recovery issues, as part of the whole process towards consolidating peace. The improvement of day-to-day working mechanisms between OCHA and the ONUB Civil and Military Coordination Unit resulted in joint humanitarian operations, provision of security to refugees and humanitarian workers in conflict zones, and logistics and engineering support to humanitarian assistance.

The Burundi CAP was 56 percent funded in 2005. The funding gap on reintegration activities was notable and did not allow for extending housing programmes as required. As a result, a significant number of Burundian refugees who had returned to Burundi went back to Tanzania or settled in IDP sites, as was the case in Makamba and Gisuru in Ruyigi province.

Burundi Requirements, Income and Expenditure Breakdown

Requirements	2,154,372
Income from Voluntary Contributions	2,100,471
EXPENDITURE	
Staff Costs	1,286,457
Consultant Fees and Travel	30,300
Travel	64,761
Operating Expenses	245,811
Contractual Services	46,030
Supplies, Material, Furniture and Equipment	121,489
Fellowships, Grants and Contributions	30,000
Programme Support Costs	237,230
Total Expenditure US\$	2,062,078

Central African Republic



Despite a return to constitutional legality following the election of President Francois Bozizé, the situation in the Central African Republic (CAR) continued to deteriorate. In 2005, people continued to die from preventable diseases, including measles and meningitis. Maternal and under-five mortality rates remained at the levels of a country experiencing war, though the civil war ended in March 2003, and the spread of HIV/AIDS continued, with infection rates up to 22 percent in some areas of the country.

The vulnerability of the population was compounded by growing violence in the northern provinces, already worst affected by humanitarian crisis. The impossibility of resuming basic social services in these areas and the disruption of livelihoods resulting from widespread insecurity increased the vulnerability of those in need, in particular in relation to food security and health. During the second half of the year, growing banditry and fighting between government forces and armed rebel groups forced 15,000 Central Africans to seek refuge in southern Chad. Thousands more were internally displaced. Aid agencies' responses were constrained by a general lack of access to affected populations. Up-country, UN field offices' radius of operations was limited to an average 20 km. Only five international NGOs operated in the country and the capacity of relief organisations remained insufficient overall to address humanitarian needs.

Key objectives

- Advocate and support the effective and timely provision of humanitarian assistance to vulnerable populations in need
- Strengthen intervention and expansion of humanitarian space
- Support the transition from humanitarian assistance to post-crisis development

Activities

OCHA consolidated its presence in the country and established various humanitarian fora for UN, international and national partners. The office organised and led various assessment missions aimed at expanding the reach of humanitarian interventions.

In the second half of 2005, OCHA deployed a humanitarian affairs officer and a public information officer to support the office of the HC. OCHA was instrumental in collecting new humanitarian data and in creating a network of humanitarian relays, a network of partners spread throughout the country for the timely collection and sharing of data and humanitarian information.

In August 2005, OCHA coordinated and led the UNCT's response to floods in Bangui that left thousands homeless. OCHA endeavoured to increase media and public coverage of the humanitarian situation in the country, organising numerous media and advocacy events.

The office led the mid-term review of the 2005 Appeal. Given an evolving humanitarian situation in the context of a profound structural crisis, CAR remained one of the most misunderstood and neglected emergencies in the world. The US\$ 26 million total requested in the 2005 CAP was only 34.70 percent funded, with worrying implications for the nutritional and health situation of the most vulnerable, given already degraded infrastructure and basic social services.

During 2005, OCHA also dispatched missions to support the Consolidated Appeal Process for 2006 and led the preparation of the CAP.

In its attempt to ensure a smooth transition from humanitarian assistance to development, the office contributed to the preparation of the United Nations Development Assistance Framework.

Performance evaluation

In 2005, OCHA led a number of exercises and activities that helped improve the coordination between partners in response to the humanitarian situation. However, due to persisting constraints, most of the key objectives set for 2005 were not met.

The lack of consensus of stakeholders on the essence of the crisis persisted and remained a major obstacle to an effective and timely humanitarian response. For the third time, the CAP was one of the most chronically underfunded, with only 35 percent of total requests met. A planned donor mission to the country had to be cancelled due to a general lack of interest.

At the end of 2005, humanitarian relays, established by the OCHA team to facilitate the regular flow of information on affected populations throughout the country, had to be suspended due to lack of funding. The dearth of local partners and the limited capacity of the government and the UN system to respond to emergencies was an additional impediment to effective humanitarian response.

The humanitarian space remained limited. The deterioration of the security situation in the most affected provinces of the country continued to limit humanitarian access to the most vulnerable population and did not allow for a deployment of UN Agencies in the field.

The humanitarian situation deteriorated during the year, and funding requirements increased from US\$ 26 million in 2005 to US\$ 47 million when the 2006 CAP was launched in November. In that context, the plan to facilitate a transition from humanitarian assistance to recovery could not be meaningfully implemented. The transition process was also affected by the absence of an agreed vision and concerted strategy in the international community to address the situation in the Central African Republic.

OCHA will be reviewing its presence in the country in 2006.

**Central African Republic
Requirements, Income and Expenditure Breakdown**

Requirements	534,861
Income from Voluntary Contributions	298,024
EXPENDITURE	
Staff Costs	232,937
Consultant Fees and Travel	5,139
Travel	51,981
Operating Expenses	31,426
Contractual Services	1,500
Supplies, Material, Furniture and Equipment	99,486
Fellowships, Grants and Contributions	8,500
Programme Support Costs	56,026
Total Expenditure US\$	486,995



Chad



Population movements from Darfur into eastern Chad declined significantly in 2005, and aid agencies were able to stabilise the humanitarian situation of the 220,000 Sudanese refugees in the region. Yet, the presence of a large aid-dependent refugee population in eastern Chad's depleted environment continued to raise considerable humanitarian challenges. Ongoing violence in Darfur made the return of refugees impossible. Therefore, aid agencies had to explore more long-term interventions, including sustainable assistance to affected host communities.

Meanwhile, internal socio-economic and political difficulties, as well as mounting tensions with neighbouring Sudan, resulted in a deterioration of the overall security situation in eastern Chad. Though the level of humanitarian access remained satisfactory, relief organisations operated in an increasingly volatile and insecure environment. Growing insecurity in the north of the Central African Republic (CAR) triggered the displacement of about 15,000 Central Africans into southern Chad, adding to an existing caseload of 30,000 CAR refugees present in the area since 2003. This new situation raised serious humanitarian challenges, which were compounded by logistical difficulties and a lack of resources to address their needs.

OCHA consolidated its presence in Chad during 2005 to support the HC and humanitarian partners in setting up and supporting the functioning of coordination mechanisms. OCHA's limited presence

in N'Djamena in 2005 is due to be reinforced in 2006 to strengthen the information management capacity of humanitarian actors.

Key objectives

- Provide effective humanitarian coordination and guidance in support of humanitarian partners
- Ensure sustainable and effective internal UN coordination
- Ensure effective operational coordination structures in Abéché and N'Djamena to ensure the provision of effective assistance to affected populations

Activities

OCHA provided a platform for humanitarian actors to plan activities and formulate strategies in response to the growing humanitarian needs. In particular, the OCHA team worked closely with UNHCR to improve information exchange and coordination between all actors. The strengthening of humanitarian coordination structures and various fora resulted in increased information sharing between Chadian authorities, UN Agencies, international and local NGOs, as well as with donors. OCHA was also instrumental in improving information sharing between the UNCTs in Chad and Sudan.

OCHA coordinated all CAP-related activities.

It ensured the continuous monitoring and review of the CAP 2005, and led the preparation of the CAP 2006. It advocated on priority resource mobilisation with donors, including through institutionalised humanitarian forums.

Together with UNHCR, OCHA supported the establishment and functioning of Sector Working Groups (SWG) in N'Djamena and Abéché. It endeavoured to ensure a smooth flow of information between working groups and other humanitarian actors.

OCHA also strengthened the information flow within the humanitarian community, by ensuring an appropriate dissemination of relevant humanitarian information in N'Djamena and Abéché, including WWW documents and databases on donors and host populations. OCHA initiated the set up of a humanitarian website, as well as of a humanitarian documentation centre in N'Djamena.

Performance evaluation

OCHA coordinated the improvement of the humanitarian coordination scheme for Chad. Five out of seven sectoral working groups were set up in 2005 and are currently functioning. The office coordinated numerous information sharing and analysis meetings with donors that served as a decisional tool for many agencies. Through maintaining and distributing products such as WWW and projects databases, it helped establish a broad understanding of the humanitarian situation.

Regular meetings with NGOs for analysis and exchange of information on the socio-political context proved a valuable tool of coordination. They gave rise to a shared analysis of the humanitarian situation in Chad. The humanitarian community agreed that Sudanese refugees in the east and Central African Republic refugees in the south, as well as the Chadian population directly affected by the refugee crisis, should be targeted as key beneficiaries of humanitarian assistance.

The CHAP and CAP 2005, and the 2005 mid-year review, facilitated by the OCHA office, set out humanitarian priorities and strategies for Chad. Nineteen organisations, including eight NGOs, participated in the CHAP/CAP 2005 and the 2005 mid-year review, a significant increase on 2004, when nine agencies, including one NGO, took part. The documents produced reflected a shared humanitarian understanding of the situation and agreed strategies to address it.

OCHA continued to monitor the functioning of existing working groups in Abéché. The office also facilitated and coordinated the establishment of

sector working groups in N'Djamena. They allowed a coordinated response to the humanitarian needs of target beneficiaries, according to agreed priorities. Coordination mechanisms, such as sector working groups and donors fora, facilitated a smooth flow of information between humanitarian organisations and helped improved their shared understanding of the crisis.

The 2005 CAP, which appealed for US\$ 227 million, was 59.9 percent funded – which was down on the 2004 funding level of 87.9 percent (US\$ 145 million). In percentage terms, funding was down on 2004 levels in all sectors, but in actual sums received, many sectors (such as agriculture, coordination, health, food, protection and education) received more in 2005 than the year before. The multi-sector (refugee) sector was a big exception, however, receiving about US\$ 16 million less in 2005 than the previous year, so that overall funding did not match increased humanitarian needs.

Chad Requirements, Income and Expenditure Breakdown

Requirements	546,337
Income from Voluntary Contributions	597,222
EXPENDITURE	
Staff Costs	218,653
Consultant Fees and Travel	6,060
Travel	70,840
Operating Expenses	58,260
Contractual Services	2,272
Supplies, Material, Furniture and Equipment	85,142
Fellowships, Grants and Contributions	2,400
Programme Support Costs	57,671
Total Expenditure us\$	501,298

Côte d'Ivoire



2005 was characterised by increasing vulnerability of the population due to the protracted political, protection and humanitarian crisis which has beset the country since 2002. Despite several peace agreements, the absence of an agreement on identification and lack of respect for deadlines to begin dismantling militias and implementing DDR contributed to the postponement of presidential elections, originally scheduled for October.

Persistent violence against civilians and instability caused by militia groups, particularly in the west and the Zone of Confidence separating government forces in the south and rebel Forces Nouvelles in the north, displaced 200,000 people in 2005, bringing the number of people displaced since 2002 to 800,000. Impunity for violent actions, along with poverty, food insecurity, HIV/AIDS, limited basic services and a weakened governance capacity, added to vulnerability. The challenges faced by vulnerable groups were compounded by hazards such as lack of rainfall in the north and epidemics in the northeast.

Key objectives

- Strengthen needs assessment and monitoring
- Increase advocacy on humanitarian principles, protection and IHL
- Improve the process of identifying vulnerable people and their needs and improve response by order of priority

- Strengthen operational capacities and coordination mechanisms in the field and increase the involvement of key partners in missions and activities in the field, particularly in the area of protection
- Improve the monitoring and follow-up of evaluation missions, as well as the impact assessment of activities

Activities

OCHA continued to support operational and policy coordination at national and local levels. Through mechanisms such as the Consolidated Appeal, the Inter-Agency Humanitarian Coordination Committee, relevant sectoral groups and joint assessment missions, it enhanced joint analysis of vulnerability, improved the quality of information on beneficiaries and supported the targeting of assistance.

OCHA, in cooperation with all major humanitarian partners, updated the contingency response plan for Côte d'Ivoire to enhance preparedness, early warning and response capacity. This contingency planning exercise was conducted, in coordination with UN Country Teams and partners in five neighbouring countries under the aegis of the OCHA Regional Office for West Africa, to enhance monitoring, preparedness and standby capacity.

The office continued to advocate for increased government involvement in coordination activities. As part of a concerted humanitarian and development advocacy effort, humanitarian and development partners drafted five memoranda addressed to the president and the prime minister, calling for greater involvement of national authorities in five priority sectors: protection (with a particular focus on IDPs), basic health care, education, water and electricity, and the deployment of civil administration areas under Forces Nouvelles control. OCHA sub-offices activated sectoral working groups in those five priority sectors to strengthen operational capacities and coordination mechanisms in the field and increase the involvement of key partners.

In 2005, OCHA strengthened its presence in Côte d'Ivoire. In addition to the head office in Abidjan, OCHA sub-offices, in Bouaké, Guiglo, Korhogo, Odienné and Man, worked together to facilitate the gathering, analysis and dissemination of information, and to advocate timely and relevant humanitarian assistance to vulnerable populations.

The Abidjan office remained the central reference point for humanitarian information, particularly with regard to mapping needs and coverage, periodic reports, daily media reviews, advocacy and information products, and resource mobilisation. The number of information products published by OCHA increased in 2005, as did their use and appreciation by humanitarian partners, donors and other parties. The number of geographic and thematic maps produced rose from 100 in 2004 to 155, and the number distributed from 4,000 to 6,000. In the summer of 2005, the layout of the OCHA website was upgraded and made more user-friendly, and its content diversified and strengthened.

The office advocated with both government and Forces Nouvelles structures on humanitarian problems related to protection. The office produced, along with the NGO Search for Common Ground, a weekly radio programme on humanitarian activities and social cohesion, which was broadcast by ONUCI-FM.

A protection network was established (including partners from the UN system, NGOs and human rights, as well as the gender and child protection elements of UNOCI) to establish a more coherent and predictable response to the main protection needs of the civilian population.

In 2005 membership of the Inter-Agency Humanitarian Coordination Committee was enlarged from two to almost a dozen international NGOs operating in Côte d'Ivoire. The participation of representatives of technical ONUCI units (on human rights, child protection, gender, etc) also rose, and the number of joint IAHCC field needs assessment and monitoring missions increased by about a quarter.

Performance evaluation

The dissemination of OCHA data and information products helped to highlight and advocate for humanitarian needs in Côte d'Ivoire. Ad hoc reports on the Fengolo (Zone of Confidence) crisis, education and water issues contributed to deeper analyses and helped to prioritise agency and donor response.

OCHA information products circulated to UN Agencies, donor countries, ministries and other humanitarian partners raised the profile of key issues such as the protection of civilians and respect for humanitarian principles.

Collaboration with UN Agencies, NGOs and donors was improved via regular meetings during which information was exchanged and humanitarian priorities agreed, as well as through the completion of joint field assessment missions. The organisation of inter-agency assessment missions, coordinated and supported by OCHA, helped identify gaps in assistance, and supported a more effective humanitarian response, better monitoring of needs and enhanced identification of appropriate operational capacity.

Through the Protection Network, OCHA was able to increase awareness among international partners and local authorities in 2005. The office ensured that standards such as the Guiding Principles on Internal Displacement were included in partners' activities, and that preventive and responsive action was taken in an increasing number of cases, such as the forced return of IDPs, forced displacement or ethnically driven violence. Relevant outputs were shared with ONUCI, particularly regarding violations of humanitarian principles and IHL.

The main constraint during 2005 was the lack of funding for humanitarian activities, with the 2005 CAP among the most underfunded (at 41 percent at the end of October, one month before the launch of the 2006 CAP). Although humanitarian actors addressed and contained the immediate effects of the crisis in sectors like health, education and water and sanitation, very little could be done to promote social cohesion, prevent violence and protect civilians in the volatile areas of the West and within the Zone of Confidence. Prevailing insecurity due to inter-communal clashes also posed a threat to humanitarian workers.

Côte d'Ivoire Requirements, Income and Expenditure Breakdown

Requirements	3,083,877
Income from Voluntary Contributions ^a	3,084,517
EXPENDITURE	
Staff Costs	2,044,172
Consultant Fees and Travel	79,753
Travel	82,482
Operating Expenses	348,589
Contractual Services	55,152
Supplies, Material, Furniture and Equipment	145,042
Fellowships, Grants and Contributions	23,500
Programme Support Costs	361,230
Total Expenditure US\$	3,139,920

^a Includes allocations from Field Coordination Reserve Fund for US\$ 747,264

Democratic Republic of the Congo



A somewhat improved security environment opened many new areas to humanitarian in the eastern provinces during the first quarter of 2005. However, disarming the remaining domestic and foreign militia became increasingly difficult and protracted in Ituri, the Grand Nord of North Kivu, South Kivu and the Central Tanganyika Triangle. Meanwhile, DRC reached a political turning point with 25.5 million citizens registering as voters in a huge electoral enrolment.

Humanitarian assistance requirements increased significantly, as previously isolated communities with urgent needs became accessible and as others fled their homes in fear of war or harassment by armed groups. An estimated 1.66 million persons are still displaced from their homes for varying lengths of time. A further 1.68 million people recently returning from displacement are trying to re-establish homes and livelihoods.

OCHA carried out humanitarian coordination in the field through 10 field offices/sub-offices in the eastern provinces. To further extend OCHA's presence, five Emergency Field Coordination Units operated in isolated crisis zones for periods of six months.

Key objectives

- Support the HC with the means and tools required for effective leadership of the humanitarian community
- Decentralise humanitarian coordination through a network of field offices

- Provide effective advocacy on behalf of vulnerable populations affected by emergencies and disasters
- Strengthen analytical and information systems to encourage key decision-makers to react in favour of vulnerable groups

Activities

OCHA supported the HC in coordinating inter-agency planning and response in a number of ways. A multi-sector needs assessment proved fundamental to the development of regional humanitarian action plans. A decentralised planning process was begun to inform a comprehensive Action Plan for 2006, involving numerous international and national NGOs. The document lays the foundation for transition programming vital to the formulation of sustainable solutions. A Pooled Fund was initiated in a pre-pilot phase, under the Good Humanitarian Donorship initiative, with initial grants provided for 17 international NGO and UN projects.

Decentralised coordination and response to humanitarian needs was carried out in all crisis-affected provinces. Three hundred rapid assessment missions were conducted in the wake of emergencies, resulting in 90 humanitarian interventions.

A nationwide, multi-sector needs assessment successfully provided difficult to obtain primary and secondary data on the humanitarian situation throughout the DRC, which was very valuable during provincial planning for, and prioritisation of, the DRC Action Plan. It was also the basis for Common Humanitarian Frameworks for emergency response in North Kivu and South Kivu provinces, and Ituri District.

Provincial IASC meetings brought together virtually all humanitarian actors each week for information sharing, response planning and monitoring in each of the 10 OCHA field locations.

In collaboration with UNICEF, Save the Children, the Norwegian Refugee Council and concerned local associations, essential humanitarian principles were promoted and disseminated among key stakeholders, including military leaders, influential individuals, police and select government workers.

The office produced widely-read humanitarian response and situation reports, and monthly humanitarian updates. A humanitarian website (www.rdc-humanitaire.net) was planned, designed

and constructed, ready for roll-out with the launch of the 2006 Action Plan.

Five UNV information officers were recruited and assigned to field offices in North Kivu, South Kivu and Maniema Provinces, as well as Ituri and Tanganyika Districts. They were vital to gathering and disseminating humanitarian information at the provincial level, producing situation, monitoring, response and assessment reports, as well as more ad hoc analytical reports.

Performance evaluation

Over 80 national and international NGOs participated in the development of the 2006 Action Plan during 2005, compared to only three that had chosen to participate in the 2005 CAP. This was due to a concerted effort by OCHA to promote the Action Plan which emphasised “one humanitarian community”, inclusive of NGOs and the UN, and consulting with donors to ensure that NGO projects would get equal consideration. Bottom-up strategising and planning in 2005 was participatory and inclusive, generating greater NGO ownership of the process and the Action Plan.

Specific national and provincial action plans for IDPs and returnees were not developed. However, the needs of these vulnerable groups were a fundamental part of provincial action plans, the DRC Action Plan and provincial contingency plans in the eastern provinces. Limited funding availability (21 percent of that requested) proved a key factor in a lack of operational leadership in the areas of internal displacement and civilian protection. A reinforced IDP Unit within the framework of the cluster mechanism is set to address that in 2006.

By the end of 2005, the humanitarian community had access to considerably more communities in the eastern provinces than at the start of the year. OCHA's ability to engage with civilian and military authorities or armed groups, particularly at the provincial level, opened the way for humanitarian assistance - in accordance with humanitarian principles and standards - in the Kivus, Katanga and especially in Ituri District. Yet, the security environment shifted continually and for varying lengths of time, so that enhanced access to some areas was often offset by different zones becoming inaccessible.

Six of 10 planned coordination antennae were established, in Shabunda and Baraka (South Kivu), Kabalo (Tanganyika District), Lubutu (Maniema), Lubero (North Kivu) and Mbuji Mayi (Kassai Oriental). This was fewer than planned due to constraints on funding and its timing. These short-term offices in

crisis zones were instrumental in facilitating access for humanitarian actors; establishing local coordination mechanisms; serving as a point of advocacy for local vulnerable populations; and facilitating dialogue with local authorities.

The Rapid Response Fund was fully funded, with additional in-kind contributions. The 90 interventions financed were among the first forms of humanitarian assistance to reach victims from pre-positioned stocks, within the first five days of a crisis on average, security permitting. Jointly managed by OCHA and UNICEF, the fund succeeded in providing shelter, healthcare, water, sanitation, emergency education and non-food items assistance to some 90 percent of about 420,000 newly-displaced people within 72 hours of displacement, security permitting.

Other projects, funded by the Emergency Humanitarian Intervention Fund and the pre-pilot phase 2005 Pooled Fund, assisted over 1.7 million longer-term IDPs and their host communities in the most crisis-torn provinces. They did so by facilitating physical access of aid workers to affected areas for the purpose of rehabilitating health, water and sanitation infrastructure.

While two staff received security and Sphere standards training, no general training of staff was carried out on those topics, or on first aid. Budget limitations and urgent daily operational demands kept those planned activities from being implemented.

Democratic Republic of the Congo Requirements, Income and Expenditure Breakdown

Requirements	10,718,184
Income from Voluntary Contributions	7,171,176
EXPENDITURE	
Staff Costs	5,134,008
Consultant Fees and Travel	269,624
Travel	1,291,220
Operating Expenses	1,390,571
Contractual Services	266,444
Supplies, Material, Furniture and Equipment	1,187,993
Fellowships, Grants and Contributions	45,519
Programme Support Costs	1,246,099
Total Expenditure US\$	10,831,478

Eritrea



Increased tensions related to the impasse on the demarcation of the border with Ethiopia showed no signs of resolution in 2005. In addition, recurrent drought conditions and the continued deterioration of the economy perpetuated chronic food insecurity and further weakened the coping capacities of the population. Thousands of IDPs and refugees remained in makeshift camps or with host communities.

From September, general food distributions were suspended for all categories of beneficiary except 72,000 IDPs, in line with government policy, pending the results of assessments to identify those to receive food for work or food aid. The working environment remained difficult, with operational challenges such as the regulation of NGOs and termination of some of their activities, the taxation of relief items, prohibition of UN Agencies channelling funds and projects through NGOs, impounding of UN vehicles and seizure of UN warehouses. In late 2005, the government declined to carry-out a Consolidated Appeal Process (CAP) and the annual joint FAO/WFP Crop and Food Assessment, deciding, in line with its self-reliance policy, to conduct its own harvest assessment.

Key objectives

- Raise awareness of the humanitarian situation in Eritrea within the international community
- Strengthen humanitarian coordination mechanisms

- Monitor the humanitarian situation effectively and disseminate humanitarian information widely
- Advocate for basic social services for IDPs, expellees, returnees and refugees
- Mobilise resources for the projects in the CAP 2005
- Ensure efficient and coordinated delivery of humanitarian assistance to vulnerable groups
- Strengthen the capacity of local partners

Activities

In cooperation with UN Agencies, NGOs, donors and the government, OCHA ensured the collection and dissemination of relevant and up to date information on the humanitarian situation through joint field trips and information sharing. OCHA field teams conducted monitoring trips every two weeks for the first six months. Information collected was used in the monthly Humanitarian Update, in maps and other targeted documents for awareness and advocacy. These products were posted on ReliefWeb and distributed to humanitarian partners and donors. After the proclamation regulating NGOs, the frequency of monitoring trips diminished before they finally ceased in September. After that, the Ministry of Labour and Human Welfare did not issue the travel permits required to carry out assessments and monitoring missions.

The office published monthly humanitarian updates, regular and targeted reports to headquarters, and one donor update. OCHA also facilitated field trips for journalists as part of its effort to improve humanitarian assistance to vulnerable populations. A WWW database established by OCHA proved very effective in providing partners with regular updates on humanitarian activities. This was well received by all stakeholders, including government counterparts, as it offered an overview of projects throughout the country. The office also continued to produce various humanitarian maps for use by partners and the media.

OCHA facilitated regular sectoral working groups meetings to coordinate humanitarian response among UN Agencies, NGOs, the Eritrean Relief and Refugee Commission (ERREC) and line ministries. The government's proclamation regulating NGOs and the subsequent restructuring of ERREC under the Ministry of Labour and Human Welfare put these fora on hold.

In the absence of a Consolidated Appeal for 2006, OCHA engaged the UN Country Team, NGO partners and donors in preparing a Common Humanitarian Action Plan that outlined a joint strategy to address critical humanitarian needs in the country. In response to increasing tensions on the border demarcation issue and persistent drought, OCHA also reactivated the Contingency Planning and Preparedness Working Group. The Contingency Plan was updated regularly in light of political and humanitarian developments, albeit with no government participation.

OCHA continued to update the humanitarian community with information and figures on the situation of IDPs. Despite the operational challenges, the humanitarian community advocated with relevant authorities in favour of IDPs and returnees.

Performance evaluation

Heightened awareness on humanitarian issues and the needs of vulnerable populations was achieved through the publication of periodic updates and information documents, humanitarian maps and press statements. CAP funding increased significantly in spring 2005 after publication of reports and media statements, and slowed down following the proclamation on NGOs, suspension of food distributions, operational constraints and subsequent decrease in advocacy and fund mobilisation efforts.

Efforts to strengthen humanitarian coordination mechanisms were hindered by the restructuring and transfer of the ERREC to the Ministry of Labour and Human Welfare (MoLHW). This resulted in the suspension of all humanitarian coordination fora with the government. In late 2005, OCHA re-established general and sectoral coordination mechanisms, re-engaged UN Agencies and NGO partners in developing a Common Humanitarian Action Plan, and reactivated contingency planning and preparedness working groups. The lack of a dedicated government counterpart to liaise and coordinate with the UN on humanitarian response continued to be a major challenge.

OCHA organised two donor briefings, in January and May. In June 2005, the MoLHW postponed the meeting and finally expressed its disapproval of such a forum. The meetings have since been suspended. A joint government-UN donor update was published in the first quarter of the year. A second update was submitted to the MoLHW but was not endorsed.

The 2005 CAP, coordinated by OCHA, was 64 percent funded (compared to a target of at least 70 percent at the start of the year), with food aid representing 80 percent of total commitments. Approximately US \$100 million was mobilised out of US\$ 156 million required. The poor donor response could be partly attributed to the government's suspension of food distributions in September, despite the availability of stocks in-country. The CAP Mid-Year Review was successfully conducted, together with partners, and launched in New York at the end of June 2005.

OCHA contributed to the return and rehabilitation of IDPs by providing baseline data on IDPs and returnees. The return and reintegration programme conducted by UNDP, together with supporting agencies and the government, resettled 19,000 IDPs to their places of origin and surrounding areas. The humanitarian and rehabilitation/recovery needs of IDPs were met according to the minimum humanitarian standard requirements and guiding principles of IDPs.

OCHA national staff participated in various training courses that improved their skills and competences in emergency field coordination, HIV/AIDS, project management, leadership and team building, results-based management, report writing and French language. The transfer of ERREC to the Ministry of Labour and Human Welfare prevented capacity building of the Information Coordination Centre (ICC), including in GIS, as planned for 2005.

Eritrea Requirements, Income and Expenditure Breakdown

Requirements	618,591
Income from Voluntary Contributions ^a	632,467
EXPENDITURE	
Staff Costs	228,173
Consultant Fees and Travel	1,313
Travel	42,486
Operating Expenses	62,778
Contractual Services	2,000
Supplies, Material, Furniture and Equipment	25,201
Fellowships, Grants and Contributions	2,000
Programme Support Costs	47,314
Total Expenditure US\$	411,265

^a Includes allocations from Field Coordination Reserve Fund for US\$ 71,553

Ethiopia



In 2005, there were significant humanitarian challenges in Ethiopia related to the delayed start of the Productive Safety Net Programme (PSNP), as well as underfunding in the first five months of the year of the joint government-United Nations 2005 Humanitarian Appeal. National elections held in May diverted attention from humanitarian issues during the first half of the year and the overall number of chronic and acutely affected populations was underestimated. A Flash Update was launched in May to draw attention to deteriorating conditions and bring the Humanitarian Appeal up to date, and this secured significantly improved funding.

The situation improved in the second half of the year following significant progress in the humanitarian response through enhanced food distributions and cash transfers as part of the PSNP. This was coupled with reasonably abundant rains, which helped ease extreme food insecurity conditions across most of Ethiopia. However, a number of humanitarian risks remained, including malaria and diarrhoeal outbreaks after flooding, localised acute malnutrition and the effects of tribal conflicts.

Key objectives

- Strengthen coordination in support of humanitarian decision making and response
- Develop a more collaborative, comprehensive and predictable response to humanitarian needs

- Improve government capacity to coordinate emergency actions
- Strengthen early warning and humanitarian monitoring
- Establish a nationally-owned and sustainable humanitarian information centre

Activities

OCHA advocated for and facilitated action to address the humanitarian needs of the most vulnerable populations, as well as to provide effective and accountable coordination in emergency situations, such as the drought in Afar early in the year and floods in Somali Region in May. A key priority was to ensure complementarity between the Humanitarian Appeal and the PSNP in order to effectively address humanitarian concerns.

The office hired a consultant to explore ways of strengthening non-food emergency responses in its assessments and appeals. The recommendations, which gave rise to a 10-point plan, were then adopted by government-led sector task forces and, where possible, incorporated into the 2006 Humanitarian Appeal. While much more work is necessary to develop a more clearly defined strategy that differentiates between emergency non-food needs caused by acute crisis situations and recurrent or predictable non-food needs, the task forces made significant progress in improving the identification of requirements and approaches for interventions.

In addition, OCHA field officers consistently made humanitarian assessment missions to areas of the country where people were reported to need assistance following flooding, volcanic eruptions or violent conflict-related displacement. They subsequently provided information to relevant humanitarian actors to facilitate an effective response.

The office provided regular strategic field assessments and analysis to all actors through formal reports to support effective humanitarian action, as well as improved publications for the general public. The office also organised and supported a visit by the Special Envoy of the Secretary-General for the Humanitarian Situation in the Horn of Africa, Maarti Ahtisaari, which was instrumental in highlighting the need to reach all those in need of assistance.

A monthly 'hotspots matrix and map' supported UN response and early action. Improved contacts with NGOs through the monthly UN-NGO forum at the federal level, and the production of a national and regional WWW database of NGO activities facilitated both the collection and development of predictable, comprehensive and collaborative responses to crises as they occurred.

OCHA facilitated 34 early warning field assessments and humanitarian monitoring missions with government counterparts and partners to enable early action, particularly on the government's resettlement programme. OCHA's findings and recommendations from resettlement field missions helped mitigate humanitarian risks that have occurred in past years. There is still room for improvement, however, in achieving action in other areas on a consistent and timely basis.

OCHA officially handed over its advisory support for the Disaster Prevention and Prevention Agency's information centre to UNDP in 2005. A two-year extension of the project, managed by UNDP with technical support from OCHA, is proposed so that it can build on the substantive progress made and systems established from 2003 to 2005.

Performance evaluation

A more collaborative, comprehensive and predictable response to the needs of the vulnerable populations was achieved through enhanced coordination with authorities and partners working to implement the PSNP. Action was also taken to ensure greater complementarity between the Humanitarian Appeal and the PSNP. OCHA's advocacy for all acute and chronically needy to receive assistance through either the Humanitarian Appeal or the PSNP helped improve collaboration with the government.

OCHA was instrumental in advocating for a Flash Appeal in May following an increase in the number of vulnerable people requiring assistance and the inadequacy of funding to that point (food needs funded at 64 percent and non-food needs at 22 percent) to address identified needs. OCHA continued to provide updated financial contributions to the government, UN partners and donor community on the status of funding for the 2005 Humanitarian Appeal and Flash Update. Successful advocacy activities resulted in strong donor response

to the Humanitarian Appeal after the Flash Update, with non-food requirements 84 percent funded and food requirements 111 percent funded. Overall, the 2005 Flash Appeal was 136 percent funded.

The office worked extensively with the government-led sectoral task forces to strengthen mechanisms for accurately identifying, properly resourcing and effectively addressing critical non-food emergency needs. Emergency units are now being established in each of the sector federal and regional bureaux to undertake full-time hazard mitigation, crisis prevention and disaster response.

Early warning systems and humanitarian monitoring were strengthened through the development of an early warning-early action hotspots matrix that was used in collaboration with other partners to identify actions taken and responses needed. This tool was instrumental in advocating for a Flash Appeal in response to increasing malnutrition across the country, and resulted in an increase in beneficiary numbers in the PSNP as well as a relaxing of the requirements for assistance, preventing further human suffering.

Basic information structures and services are in place at the humanitarian information centre, though a lot of work is still required in terms of information management and institutional arrangement. Sustainability remains a key challenge (especially with regard to human and financial resources) in view of the transition to national ownership, management and financing.

Ethiopia Requirements, Income and Expenditure Breakdown

Requirements	1,684,717
Income from Voluntary Contributions	2,287,230
EXPENDITURE	
Staff Costs	832,861
Consultant Fees and Travel	-
Travel	82,201
Operating Expenses	114,141
Contractual Services	3,560
Supplies, Material, Furniture and Equipment	137,099
Fellowships, Grants and Contributions	984
Programme Support Costs	152,210
Total Expenditure US\$	1,323,056

Guinea



The year was marked by key socio-economic and political developments such as the designation of a new prime minister, the resumption of dialogue with the opposition, liberalisation of the media and the creation of an anti-corruption commission. Despite some progress on the political front, humanitarian needs and a high level of vulnerability prevailed in Guinea due to the country's socio-economic crisis, which resulted in several strikes. By the end of 2005, however, the international community was assured of the government's willingness to fulfil the conditions for the resumption of a poverty reduction programme interrupted in 2002.

The key humanitarian concerns continued to be: protection of refugees; effective targeting of assistance to vulnerable groups other than refugees; recurrent outbreaks of epidemics; increased food insecurity; the continued breakdown of basic social services; and rising malnutrition, morbidity and mortality rates. The dire situation across Guinea was compounded by floods in Conakry and North West Guinea, and locust swarms that devastated crops in some parts of the country.

Key objectives

- Improve inter-agency coordination
- Enhance the government's coordination capacity
- Advocate for the rights of the most vulnerable

- Improve information and vulnerability data analysis to enable humanitarian agencies better target their assistance

Activities

OCHA enhanced inter-agency strategic and sectoral coordination at the country and local levels, with the participation of donors, UN Agencies and NGOs. The holding of sectoral working groups meetings in Conakry and Guinea Forestière helped improve coordination with national counterparts and raise awareness about funding needs to address humanitarian issues. Monthly IASC meetings were enriched with the participation of donor representatives.

Joint rapid assessments of the most critical needs were carried out for the first time in Guinea Forestière and Haute Guinea by humanitarian partners and relevant government bodies. They led to a better identification of critical gaps to be filled in order to reduce rising malnutrition, morbidity and mortality rates.

OCHA monitored protection issues and worked with the government, international partners and donors through data collection, briefings, coordination meetings and advocacy for better funding of priority needs. Throughout 2005, OCHA undertook advocacy efforts on key humanitarian issues. In April, it hosted a field mission to Guinea by the OCHA Donor Support Group, advocating on behalf of vulnerable groups (refugees, IDPs, returnees among others) in the Guinea Forestière region. This helped initiate reflections on what kind of assistance would be suitable within the Guinean context.

During the Mid-Year Review of the CAP 2005, non-emergency projects were removed from the document to allow for a more appropriate response to humanitarian needs for at least 630,000 people. However, lessons learned included the importance of responding simultaneously to both humanitarian and rehabilitation needs.

Securing Guinea's participation in a regional strategy to stabilise the sub-region was also a priority in 2005. The UNCTs of Guinea, Sierra Leone, Liberia and Côte d'Ivoire embarked on a joint coordination approach to address cross-border issues of common concern relating to instability in the sub-region. OCHA supported the UNCT in the preparation of the two sub-regional consultative meetings held in 2005.

In an effort to reinforce inter-agency information management and sharing, OCHA established an Information Management Unit (IMU) in September 2005. The office remained the central reference point for humanitarian information, particularly with regard to mapping and reporting. In addition, OCHA facilitated the work of the inter-agency technical working Group on Information and Communication (GIC) within the UNCT. Humanitarian information was made available through the OCHA Guinea website, which was reactivated in 2005.

OCHA contributed to advocacy work leading to specific assistance from the international community for victims of sexual violence. More sustainable assistance was given to vulnerable groups other than refugees. In addition, OCHA made recommendations for the funding of NGO projects (in and outside the CAP) with potential impact on vulnerable populations. More NGOs participated in the CAP and more were funded than in previous years.

Performance evaluation

Inter-agency coordination improved through regular monthly IASC meetings, which resulted in identifying gaps in assistance, making recommendations for better targeting of populations at risk, and facilitating a wider exchange of information among partners involved in relief and early recovery assistance. Partner NGOs and donors became more enthusiastic about participating, with more than 40 participants regularly attending these meetings.

Government-led coordination mechanisms worked well in most cases. Throughout 2005, five out of seven sectoral working groups met regularly, while two held only a few meetings. This was due to the fact that, by September, the national counterparts showed less engagement in holding sectoral working group meetings. They questioned the impact of such meetings in Conakry, Guinea Forestière and Haute Guinea when there was only limited donor support to implement projects addressing identified needs. Meetings of the National Committee on Humanitarian Action (CNSAH) were held in Nzérékoré and presided over by the Regional Governor. In Haute Guinea only a few CNSAH meetings took place. The humanitarian community did not manage to hold this meeting in Conakry.

A comparative analysis of available vulnerability data helped identify residual humanitarian needs in Guinea

Forestière, as well as priority vulnerable groups and key rehabilitation interventions. The results were used in preparing the Common Humanitarian Action Plan (CHAP) for 2006. Approximately 75,000 refugees were provided with assistance. IDPs, Guinean returnees and host communities received insufficient support, however, leaving them more vulnerable. Donors found it difficult to determine whether it was correct to characterise needs among non-refugee populations as humanitarian rather than to developmental.

Improved design and enhanced content encouraged more people to visit the OCHA Guinea website. As a result, 50 percent of all partners, including donors, NGOs and UN Agencies, increased their information sharing with OCHA.

Efforts to mobilise resources for the CAP 2005 paid off in the second half of the year, with 63 percent of the US\$ 37 million required actually resourced. While significant resources were raised for refugee assistance, health, agriculture, emergency education, water and sanitation and security sectors remained underfunded.

Guinea Requirements, Income and Expenditure Breakdown

Requirements	1,529,986
Income from Voluntary Contributions ^a	1,153,856
EXPENDITURE	
Staff Costs	718,972
Consultant Fees and Travel	6,313
Travel	57,744
Operating Expenses	152,350
Contractual Services	15,450
Supplies, Material, Furniture and Equipment	229,079
Fellowships, Grants and Contributions	13,000
Programme Support Costs	155,078
Total Expenditure US\$	1,347,986

a Includes allocations from Field Coordination Reserve Fund for US\$ 124,033

Liberia – Humanitarian Information Centre



During 2005, political activity in Liberia was dominated by the successful completion of the two-year transition process set out in the Comprehensive Peace Agreement of 18 August 2003 and the handover from the National Transitional Government of Liberia to the new, democratically-elected government.

The humanitarian situation continued to improve although enormous unmet needs remain (in relation to basic social services almost countrywide, as well as the particular needs of remaining IDPs and returning refugees) given the toll that war has taken on people, infrastructure, livelihoods and coping capacities.

Liberia is unusual within OCHA in having the Humanitarian Information Centre (HIC) remain as an OCHA project after the closure of the typical OCHA field office structure at the end of 2004, following the assumption of humanitarian coordination responsibilities by the Humanitarian Coordination Section (HCS) of the United Nations Mission in Liberia (UNMIL).

It was anticipated that, by the end of 2005, the HIC would transition into an information centre serving recovery, transition and development. However, with delays in the capacity of partners in-country to take over its stewardship amid continuing humanitarian needs and risks as Liberia moves to a recovery phase, the HIC remained with OCHA in 2005 and is now due to be handed over in 2006.

Key objective

- Improve the coordination of humanitarian assistance to Liberia by providing the humanitarian community and government of Liberia with a tool with which to facilitate planning, designing and implementing humanitarian activities, in conjunction with other humanitarian organisations and activities

Activities

During 2005, the HIC (with one office, located in the capital, Monrovia, and employing three international and 14 local staff) continued to provide autonomous support to coordination, planning and implementation of activities by the broad humanitarian community, working closely with the HCS structure of UNMIL.

The HIC was a focal point for access to maps, reports, databases, updates and other information products generated by humanitarian organisations, including NGO partners. It maintained an operational internet café for members of the humanitarian community and a dedicated HIC website with relevant reports and information products, links to related services and a weekly e-mail update.

OCHA continued the promotion of standardised data collection to allow broader and longer-term use within the humanitarian community, and assisted sector working groups (education, water, health/cholera, agriculture, etc) to develop databases and information systems, including the use of P-codes and other standardised datasets for each sector.

The HIC provided humanitarian partners with technical services including database design and processing, GIS and map production, upon request. It also produced and updated a catalogue of all maps available, as well as briefing packs for donors and other visiting delegations.

Two dedicated field information officers worked with county administrative centres to attend coordination meetings and liaise with UNMIL, NGOs, the National Transition Government, UN Agencies and other partners. They also served as focal points within the HIC and the HCS structure for information gathering and dissemination, promoting a regular and systematic flow of data and the dissemination of information products between Monrovia and the

field. With the newly-developed County Recovery Information System (CORE-SYS) database, for instance, the field information officers will liaise with several agencies at field level to ensure that data is regularly updated.

The HIC worked closely with UNMIL Civil Affairs to develop a system to allow county-level officials in both UNMIL and government structures better capture and report qualitative data for recovery and reconstruction. The HIC also coordinated with ECHO and USAID to capture information on the activities of implementing partners of these two major donors by sector and location. There have been requests since that the maps produced in this process be expanded to include other donors and their partners.

The HIC played a supporting role to humanitarian coordination at national and local levels. HIC representatives attended general coordinating meetings for the humanitarian community and sector working groups at both Monrovia and county (field) level, and provided follow-up support.

Performance evaluation

HIC staff managed to increase knowledge of the HIC and its products/services, improved adherence to standardised data collection in most sectors, and established recognition of the HIC as a key source of advice on data collection, surveys and other services.

With the HIC, the humanitarian community has an easily identifiable place to go for technical advice, humanitarian information, reports and maps, and to post information such as assessments, which supports planning, implementation and monitoring of humanitarian assistance. The internet café was used at 85 percent of its capacity while all of the reports, updates and other information products posted on the HIC website were used.

In a country shattered by war and where local government officials have little training or capacity, the HIC trained 24 local government officials and 16 civil servants in seven of Liberia's 15 counties on how to populate the County Recovery Database, including the use of P-Codes, which will support the sharing and broader utility of data. In addition, local authorities are now actively providing feedback on boundaries and towns for future maps and related

products. Major donors, UN Agencies, local government officials and NGOs have embraced the importance of P-codes in information management and are mandating the use of P-codes in all data collection activities.

Liberia - HIC Requirements, Income and Expenditure Breakdown

Requirements	804,728
Income from Voluntary Contributions	592,540
EXPENDITURE	
Staff Costs	565,810
Consultant Fees and Travel	4,025
Travel	13,000
Operating Expenses	101,037
Contractual Services	7,500
Supplies, Material, Furniture and Equipment	31,254
Fellowships, Grants and Contributions	4,000
Programme Support Costs	94,461
Total Expenditure US\$	821,087

Niger



Although an example of democratic rule and governance in West Africa, Niger is the second least developed country in the world according to the UNDP's human development indicators. In 2005, Niger faced a severe food security crisis, aggravated by serious drought in the Sahel region and by locust invasions, which threatened the livelihoods of 3.6 million people. Three million of these were considered highly vulnerable to food insecurity, and more than 200,000 malnourished children were admitted to some 800 therapeutic feeding centres around the country.

This food security crisis was compounded by a variety of structural factors such as rapid population growth, unsustainable farming practices, deep and widespread poverty, lack of access to essential health services, and intra-household inequities that work against women and children, including poor child feeding and childcare practices. In the face of this crisis, the OCHA Regional Office for West Africa (ROWA) supported the UNCT response, provided surge capacity and facilitated the establishment of an OCHA presence in Niger.

Key objectives

In view of the food security crisis in Niger, OCHA's ROWA developed objectives including:

- Advise the HC on issues related to the crisis
- Set up an operational information management mechanism
- Advocate for people affected by food insecurity and child under-nutrition
- Reinforce coordination mechanisms implemented by the government at national and regional levels
- Organise joint assessment missions to identify the needs of vulnerable populations and report on the humanitarian situation
- Support efforts to reinforce preparedness for crises through the elaboration of contingency plans

Activities

An OCHA emergency management team was deployed in July 2005 to establish an OCHA presence, including a HIC, one of the main purposes of which was to centralise all information produced by the humanitarian community in Niger. OCHA also produced regular situation reports on the crisis and the humanitarian response. A humanitarian contact list was developed, as well as maps representing the location of vulnerable populations, needs and interventions.

OCHA also facilitated the HC's contact with media for advocacy efforts through talking points, press releases, and so forth.

In order to take into account new vulnerabilities and needs associated with the desert locust invasion and drought in the countries of the Sahel, including Niger, OCHA reviewed the initial CAP for West Africa in January 2005.

In May, OCHA provided support to the UNCT in Niger on the elaboration of the inter-agency Flash Appeal, which was revised in August 2005. Some US\$ 87.64 million of the CAP was funded, representing 36 percent of the US\$ 244,003,531 requested.

OCHA contributed to the reinforcement of coordination mechanisms in Niamey and at field level in the most affected regions. At the national level, OCHA supported the global coordination meeting by collecting and analysing information from partners (UN, NGOs, donors and civil society), and providing

global information on the crisis. Sectoral coordination meetings were held regularly, with OCHA's support, in Maradi, Tahoua and Zinder.

OCHA participated in regular meetings on the vital issues of nutrition, health and food security, prepared terms of reference for them, and chaired the information and communication working group. Regular contact was also maintained with the government, NGOs, civil society actors and donors.

Performance evaluation

The HIC's series of thematic maps, contact lists and reports, especially in the nutrition sector, together with its website presence, was acknowledged as relevant and useful by the humanitarian community. Partners in the field have actively contributed to these products and provided feedback to ensure their accuracy.

Humanitarian partners demonstrated their appreciation and use of HIC Niger's material by reproducing them in a range of their information tools, including reports on the response to the nutrition crisis and their own situation reports. OCHA map products were used by UNICEF, WHO and WFP, and the HIC actively supported the creation of a GIS/data working group.

This range of accurate information proved to be crucial in preparing the documents for the Sahel consultation held in Dakar in November 2005.

The Government of Niger also benefited from technical guidance and support from the HIC for the development of a database in which to enter data collected on government food distributions. Such capacity is essential for post-crisis activities, including the reporting and review of actual distribution, as well as noting lessons learned to prevent/mitigate future food crises.

Regular situation reports were produced in close collaboration with the humanitarian community at national and regional levels, including in the worst affected regions of Tahoua, Maradi and Zinder. These enhanced information sharing on the food and nutritional situation, as well as on the responses of the government and the humanitarian community. The situation reports were also used to

support advocacy for the most vulnerable population and for resource mobilisation.

The deployment of surge capacity from the Regional Office from May to August 2005 allowed for early establishment of coordination mechanisms and resource mobilisation tools within the framework of the CAP and the Flash Appeal.

Lessons learned from the neglected and silent crisis of the Sahel, as illustrated in Niger during 2005, indicated that the scope and complexity of the situation required less focus on traditional response tools, which are often developed within the context of areas of conflict. In order to strengthen the dialogue among all actors concerned with food insecurity and nutritional crises, and to ensure that all tools available are used to simultaneously tackle acute and chronic vulnerability, OCHA initiated the Regional Consultation on the Sahel in November 2005.

A wide range of development, humanitarian, governmental, non-governmental and UN stakeholders attended the first consultation, and recommended that OCHA pursue this process in 2006. The process is expected to lead to the formulation of an Integrated Action Plan for the Sahel that will propose specific ways to bridge development and humanitarian activities.

Niger Requirements, Income and Expenditure Breakdown

Requirements	700,549
Income from Voluntary Contributions ^a	477,948
EXPENDITURE	
Staff Costs	88,393
Consultant Fees and Travel	-
Travel	68,971
Operating Expenses	48,721
Contractual Services	2,304
Supplies, Material, Furniture and Equipment	128,187
Fellowships, Grants and Contributions	-
Programme Support Costs	54,904
Total Expenditure US\$	391,480

^a Includes allocations from Field Coordination Reserve Fund for US\$ 249,220

Republic of Congo



The country remained relatively stable politically during 2005 even though most of the major political initiatives related to the Pool region – the organisation of partial legislative elections; the absence of an electoral list and the Disarmament, Demobilisation and Reintegration (DDR) programme – were not concluded. As a result, the humanitarian operating environment was still characterised by insecurity and difficulty with access to people in need.

In this context, OCHA established a sub-office in Kinkala where a UN Antenna was opened in April 2005. Despite the strong will of the humanitarian community, many basic needs in (water/sanitation, education, agricultural and health sectors) were not met due to prevailing insecurity. The nutritional situation of a vast majority of the population remains precarious in the Pool region, and there are still considerable reconstruction and rehabilitation needs. Seventy percent of the population continued to live on less than US\$ 1 a day.

Key objectives

- Provide support to the RC/HC by maintaining a humanitarian advisor in Brazzaville and recruiting a humanitarian affairs officer for the sub-office in Kinkala
- Encourage the involvement of UN Agencies and their respective programmes in the Pool region

- Issue a Mid-Year Review of the CAP and revision of the strategy according to new developments on plans for health, education, nutrition, security and coordination
- Prepare the 2006 CAP in line with the new strategy and highlight the transition challenges
- Provide timely and accurate information on the humanitarian situation by collecting and disseminating data on the Pool region

Activities

OCHA activated and maintained the usual inter-agency coordination mechanisms, such as IASC forums, sectoral meetings and technical meetings with the government and UN Agencies, which facilitated information-sharing and allowed partners to reassess ROC's common strategy and priorities.

A contingency planning exercise was held in July following the decision of the transition government in the Democratic Republic of Congo (DRC) to postpone elections. In particular, OCHA organised an inter-agency visit to the Pool region, where rebel groups were urged to allow access to the needy population. Following consultations with all actors, OCHA established a common contingency plan which highlighted: a joint analysis and scenario; planning assumptions; strategy and objectives; management and coordination arrangements; and response modalities.

In lieu of updating the September 2004 Contingency Plan, the humanitarian community produced a mid-year review of the situation as detailed in the 2004 CAP.

Furthermore, a national contingency plan (with the involvement of government authorities, UN Agencies and NGOs) was set up in June, and updated in July, after the postponement of the DRC elections.

The OCHA office in Kinkala, although effectively opened in the last quarter of the year (due to the prevailing insecurity) was able to provide regular and timely information on the situation as it unfolded in the Pool region.

A Rapid Response Fund was set up in April to provide financial support to facilitate access, speed deployment of humanitarian actors and enable delivery of emergency assistance to the population in need.

In 2005, OCHA produced nine monthly reports and eight situation reports. Six of the eight reports focused on situation in the Pool Region and were

produced after the full establishment of the OCHA sub-office in Kinkala in September 2005. After the UN pulled out from Kinkala for security reasons in November, OCHA produced five security-monitoring reports in November and December.

Performance evaluation

OCHA's participation and active involvement in the organisation of a UN Senior Management Meeting retreat brought the Pool question to the core of the UN's agenda, including the need to ask for concrete actions and a stronger presence and activities in the region, resulting in the deployment of four UN international project staff in Kinkala.

Despite the challenges of drawing due attention to the Pool region, including political arrangements which were not finalised and limited access to the population for security reasons, OCHA's advocacy contributed to CAP funding of 55 percent (compared to 30 percent in 2004).

OCHA's presence in Kinkala encouraged participation of local humanitarian actors (from government authorities, NGOs, civil society and UN local projects managers) in common targeting and joint advocacy efforts and enabled information sharing through meetings and field visits.

In October, OCHA's humanitarian access negotiations with the Ninja rebel groups in Mindouli contributed to a significant increase in the provision of assistance to vulnerable populations by humanitarian agencies. Over 60 percent of the conflict-affected population in Kindamaba and Mindouli was assisted by ICRC and MSF-H.

Throughout the year, OCHA-led coordination fora such as IASC groups, cluster meetings and technical meetings with the government and UN Agencies were attended by almost 100 percent of humanitarian agencies and were a good source of reliable information for all actors. The RC/HC made use of OCHA's analytical reports on several occasions to draw attention to the humanitarian situation in the Pool region and advocate for action.

Through the CAP, projects were carried out targeting a total number of 100,000 individuals. However, no NGO was funded under the CAP 2005, resulting in an acute lack of financial resources for most NGOs to continue their activities. As a result, at least four NGOs were obliged to close their offices in 2005.

The funding squeeze therefore resulted in a significant decrease in the number of humanitarian actors operating in the country.

It was not possible for OCHA, for security reasons, to organise a joint inter-agency assessment mission to collect and compile data on vulnerable populations, in order to facilitate advocacy campaigns for human rights and protection of civilians. This assessment mission is due to be carried out in 2006.

Republic of Congo Requirements, Income and Expenditure Breakdown

Requirements	858,337
Income from Voluntary Contributions	559,519
EXPENDITURE	
Staff Costs	334,642
Consultant Fees and Travel	-
Travel	56,677
Operating Expenses	70,118
Contractual Services	13,500
Supplies, Material, Furniture and Equipment	155,272
Fellowships, Grants and Contributions	2,940
Programme Support Costs	82,309
Total Expenditure us\$	715,458

Sierra Leone



Years of civil war in Sierra Leone have destroyed social infrastructure and aggravated the endemic poverty that was prevalent before the war. Post-war recovery programmes have brought some respite to many communities since 2000. Nevertheless, poverty is persistent, leaving many poor and vulnerable persons in need of humanitarian assistance. The needs of vulnerable groups (including Sierra Leonean returnees and IDPs, as well as amputees, orphaned and separated children, and ex-combatants) are many and remain largely unmet, as the focus has largely shifted to rehabilitation and community work.

Addressing the needs of vulnerable groups in the years ahead is a challenge for the government and international community if Sierra Leone is to continue towards stability and recovery. It was against this background that, in 2005, the UNCT requested OCHA to maintain a Senior Humanitarian Affairs Officer, who was supported by one national officer, in the office of the RC/HC to support coordination issues related to contingency planning, monitoring of residual humanitarian needs and response in the event of natural disaster.

Key objectives

- Enhance humanitarian strategic planning and coordination by ensuring that gaps and residual humanitarian needs are continuously identified

- Support the HC and UNCT in monitoring internal and external factors that may affect peace and stability in the country
- Support the capacity of the Government of Sierra Leone to respond to disasters
- Advise on policy issues related to humanitarian principles

Activities

OCHA worked closely with the Government of Sierra Leone through the year to support, strengthen and reactivate sector working groups. It also worked with the NGO Coordinator's Desk in the Ministry of Development and Economic Planning (MODEP) to develop a database on the NGOs in the country, and played a crucial role in advocating for NGO involvement in humanitarian and recovery activities at all levels.

OCHA Sierra Leone initiated and organised several joint inter-agency field assessment missions to the vulnerable districts Kambioa and Port Loko, and flood-affected Pujehun. The outputs of the inter-agency joint assessment missions were used for the elaboration of long-term development programmes aimed at addressing underlying vulnerabilities.

In collaboration with ICRC and the UNCT, the office organised a training workshop on International Humanitarian Law in December that targeted top government officials. In addition, OCHA organised training, in collaboration with UNAMSIL and the International Military Assistance Training Team, for 29 senior officers of the Republic of Sierra Leone Armed Forces. The training topics included humanitarian principles and international standards, human rights, child protection, women's rights and gender issues.

The office actively assisted the government in drafting a concept paper on the establishment of an effective Disaster Management and Emergency Unit in the Office of the President. The document will help the government in its efforts to set up a Disaster Management and Emergency Unit (DEMU) and to ensure that similar structures are established at district level.

In August and September, following floods in Pujehun District, OCHA coordinated the humanitarian

response in collaboration with the National Commission for Social Action (NaCSA), the Office of National Security (ONS), UN Agencies and humanitarian organisations. OCHA also made available an emergency cash grant of US\$ 76,000 for the procurement of relief items to address life-saving needs.

The government's capacity to respond to disasters is weak and, in 2005, the Office of National Security created the Disaster Management Unit with the responsibility of coordinating disasters in the country. OCHA worked with the unit and other stakeholders throughout the year to develop a national disaster management policy.

The development of that policy, on which OCHA is working closely with the government and other stakeholders, is at an advanced stage. The document is now being shared with officers of ONS at the provincial and district level to get inputs from local authorities and communities in order to ensure ownership. A national consultative workshop will be held to validate the document before submission to parliament for approval. The second phase of the process is to develop a national disaster response plan.

OCHA assisted the UNCT and partners in preparing an inter-agency contingency plan for Sierra Leone. Several meetings were convened between the UN, NGOs and the government to discuss recent events/trends; identify likely and worst-case scenarios; consider consequences, assumptions and triggering mechanisms; and agree on the most appropriate responses.

The Humanitarian Coordination Unit (HCU-OCHA) in Sierra Leone, in supporting the office of the RC/HC and the UNCT, commissioned a consultant on Rapid Gaps Analysis in Vulnerability Assessment Mapping to examine, review and identify gaps from several studies undertaken by the UNCT on vulnerability during the past three years. The final report provided clear direction and guidance on identified gaps and made recommendations for a comprehensive VAM study. The UNCT decided to have the VAM study undertaken during the first quarter of 2006 by staff from WFP, UNICEF, UNHCR, NGOs and government counterparts. The results will help enhance the targeting of the most vulnerable groups countrywide with adequate and timely humanitarian and development assistance.

Performance evaluation

OCHA's main challenge was to ensure that humanitarian needs remained on the agenda as the country moved from transition to long-term development. The UNCT did not issue a CAP in 2005 and, consequently fundraising for residual humanitarian activities was difficult. There is glaring evidence that many communities in Sierra Leone (including settlements very close to the capital) are in desperate need of social services, such as safe drinking water and health facilities.

The office was active in monitoring the humanitarian situation, supporting the preparation of the UN contingency plan and providing advice on humanitarian policy issues. The contingency plan, accomplished in coordination with the country programmes of Côte d'Ivoire and its five neighbouring countries, helped prepare humanitarian agencies in case of a deterioration of the crisis there. It led to better understanding and division of roles and responsibilities, and the establishment of standard operating procedures in case of a new outbreak of violence triggering new outflows of refugees to Sierra Leone.

The training provided on IHL contributed to increased awareness and understanding of the implementation of the conventions and international laws in the country among government and military officials, according to post-training evaluation.

The end of 2005 saw four months to run on the assignment of OCHA's humanitarian affairs officer. Humanitarian coordination responsibilities are due to be taken over by UNDP in 2006.

Sierra Leone Requirements, Income and Expenditure Breakdown

Requirements	331,360
Income from Voluntary Contributions ^a	173,744
EXPENDITURE	
Staff Costs	137,221
Consultant Fees and Travel	12,083
Travel	17,552
Operating Expenses	62,400
Contractual Services	466
Supplies, Material, Furniture and Equipment	28,257
Fellowships, Grants and Contributions	-
Programme Support Costs	33,537
Total Expenditure US\$	291,516

^a Includes allocations from Field Coordination Reserve Fund for US\$ 73,744

Somalia



The first half of 2005 witnessed the relocation of the Transitional Federal Institutions into Somalia after being in exile in Nairobi, Kenya, since their establishment in October 2004. However, the split relocation of the TFIs between Mogadishu and Jowhar, and disagreement between key leaders, impacted on the Institutions' ability to effectively exercise their functions and control over the national territory. Still, some positive developments were observed, with a number of local reconciliation processes initiated in southern and central Somalia. The situation in Somaliland and Puntland remained generally calm and relatively stable, despite continued friction over the contested areas of Sool and Sanaag.

The humanitarian situation throughout 2005 was characterised by intermittent humanitarian access, particularly in central and southern Somalia, intra- and inter-clan fighting, flooding, environmental degradation, widespread human rights abuses, internal displacement and, towards the end of the year, the beginnings of the worse drought in a decade in southern Somalia. The start of 2005 was additionally marked by the tsunami, which hit the northeastern coastline, further debilitating communities recovering from years of severe drought. OCHA Somalia responded to developments through its three Zonal Offices in Somaliland, Puntland and South/Central Somalia, and five sub-offices in the latter.

Key objectives

- Help save lives and assist vulnerable communities and populations at risk to become more resilient to crisis
- Advocate for access to basic services
- Work to enhance the protection of, and respect for, the human rights and dignity of all in Somalia
- Support existing and emerging governance structures to facilitate humanitarian-related and socio-economic activities

Activities

Throughout 2005, the office worked to enhance in-country coordination with the establishment of sectoral inter-agency meetings and the strengthening of IDP/Protection working groups in Somaliland and Puntland. The deployment of two international staff members to Puntland and south/central Somalia in the first half of the year significantly enhanced field level coordination in the two zones. OCHA provided coordination support to the Puntland Humanitarian Affairs and Disaster Management Agency (HADMA).

OCHA led the UN's initiative to improve access in southern and central Somalia. In mid-2005, the office facilitated a reconciliation meeting in Nairobi between Gare and Marehan leaders from Gedo region that eventually lead to a peace agreement. OCHA also established an Access Working Group to advise on access priorities and opportunities. In December, the HC and the Middle Shabelle Administration signed an MoU to govern relations.

OCHA expanded the Humanitarian Response Fund (HRF) to cover emergencies beyond the drought, including floods, conflict or displacement. In December 2004, an HRF-Tsunami was also established to improve response to the tsunami emergency and prevent further erosion of livelihoods for populations along the northeastern coastline. Two national officers administered the HRF on a full-time basis from July onwards.

OCHA facilitated assessment missions to drought-affected areas and chaired Humanitarian Response Group (HRG) meetings that brought together UN Agencies, NGOs and donors to develop response

strategies. The HRG outlined an exit strategy that ensured a smooth transition from emergency to development interventions in drought-prone northern Somalia.

OCHA played a key role in finalising the UNCT's Joint Strategy on IDPs, as well as in ensuring its application in agency programming and cohesion with non-UN actors. OCHA revived and co-chaired the UNCT Working Group on Protection and IDPs, which also benefited from the participation of partner NGOs.

OCHA facilitated the delivery of life-saving humanitarian assistance and livelihoods support to populations at risk through enhanced coordination with the Somali Aid Coordination Body (SACB), aid partners and local authorities in Somalia. The office facilitated field assessments, including for the tsunami response, and ensured a smooth transition from relief to rehabilitation activities in northeastern Somalia.

OCHA administered the HRF-Tsunami for 10 projects aimed at providing livelihood support, which helped affected communities cope with the economic impact of the tsunami, displacement, restored livelihoods and improved access in the affected area.

Performance evaluation

OCHA played a key role in mobilising partners for protection-related activities. The IDP Strategy was adopted by 15 aid organisations, including UN Agencies and NGOs, as well as some local authorities. The IDP Strategy laid the foundation for coordinated action on which subsequent interventions will be based. This has proven to be vital in an environment where protection issues have been given very little attention in the past. OCHA facilitated joint programme planning among UN Agencies involved in protection/IDP issues, including UNHCR, UNCP, UNICEF, UNIFEM, UNAIDS and HABITAT, in consultation with local authorities.

OCHA's advocacy also helped draw attention to the poor level of access to basic social services, particularly in south and central Somalia.

With regard to humanitarian access to affected populations, the Middle Shabelle Administration

signed an MoU with the UN in December 2005 following months of negotiations with OCHA. The agreement provided a solid foundation for relations between the UN and the Administration, and paved the way for improved humanitarian access to affected populations in areas under the Administration's control.

Somalia Requirements, Income and Expenditure Breakdown

Requirements	2,271,416
Income from Voluntary Contributions	1,560,549
EXPENDITURE	
Staff Costs	1,092,689
Consultant Fees and Travel	19,180
Travel	240,253
Operating Expenses	148,614
Contractual Services	3,500
Supplies, Material, Furniture and Equipment	47,025
Fellowships, Grants and Contributions	35,000
Programme Support Costs	206,214
Total Expenditure US\$	1,792,475



Sudan



The year began with the Government of Sudan and the Sudan People's Liberation Movement (SPLM) signing the long-awaited Comprehensive Peace Agreement (CPA) on 9 January, bringing to an end Africa's longest civil war. This paved the way for the formation of the Government of National Unity (GoNU) and the Government of Southern Sudan (GoSS). Mere weeks after his July 9 swearing-in as First Vice President, John Garang, the leader of the SPLM, tragically died in a helicopter crash.

In spite of fears that Garang's death would derail the peace process, the implementation of the CPA progressed in 2005, albeit slowly in some areas, and as many as 500,000 people returned to areas in the South, mostly spontaneously and with minimal support. While some were inspired to move by the newly signed peace, others returned due to forced relocations of IDPs in and around Khartoum. An almost complete lack of basic services in the areas of return and the increased pressure on host communities were critical humanitarian concerns in the South, one of the poorest and least developed areas in the world.

At the same time, the conflict in Darfur continued unabated, with its horrific impact on the civilian population. Throughout the year, the massive humanitarian operation in Darfur continued to reach about three million people, including some 1.8 million IDPs. Contrary to urging and expectation, the parties to the conflict, who were trying to negotiate a peace deal

in Abuja, failed to reach an agreement by the end of the year. Instead, as the talks dragged on, significant deterioration in security conditions on the ground during the last quarter of the year endangered the significant humanitarian gains made in late 2004 and into 2005.

Key objectives

- Strengthen field-based coordination for humanitarian and recovery efforts in all priority areas of Sudan
- Help strengthen the response capacity of the humanitarian community through joint assessments, evaluation, monitoring and capacity building, as well as improved analysis and reporting
- Ensure full and unimpeded access to populations in need throughout Sudan
- Mobilise resources for humanitarian assistance through the 2005 Work Plan and a clear funding strategy
- Help ensure the implementation of protection mechanisms

Activities

Confronted with widespread new and ongoing humanitarian needs and concerns, OCHA scaled up its presence in areas throughout Sudan in 2005. In the South, OCHA was among the first international organisations to establish its main office in Rumbek, and later in Juba. New offices were also set up in Eastern Sudan, Abyei and Kosti. By September, humanitarian operations across all areas of Southern Sudan were unified under the Southern Sudan operation, coordinated by the Deputy RC/HC. In Darfur, OCHA set up new satellite offices in under-served areas as NGOs established operations.

In 2005, OCHA was to the fore in advocating for a geographic expansion of humanitarian assistance, mobilising UN Agencies and NGOs to establish operations where critical needs were not being met, particularly in parts of the South and the East. In Darfur, the massive humanitarian response, begun in late 2003 and dramatically expanded in 2004, continued throughout 2005. The coordinated efforts of humanitarian actors helped to maintain a relatively stable humanitarian situation, with no large-scale

outbreaks of disease, and improvements in malnutrition and mortality rates. OCHA negotiated and ensured safe access for humanitarian assistance through constant coordination and interaction with the parties and armed groups, as well as key partners, including the African Union, UNMIS, UN Agencies and NGOs.

In Southern Sudan, OCHA expanded its presence during the year to areas where populations were highly vulnerable, and where OCHA was often one of very few humanitarian organisations. This was done in an attempt to ensure greater NGO and UN Agency presence, to initiate assessments, and offer stronger situation analysis. This targeted expansion was conducted with a view to handing over coordination responsibilities to the newly established RC's Office following its deployment to the field, particularly in areas where an early transition to recovery and development is feasible. However, continued insecurity (sometimes increasing, as in the Equatoria regions) has delayed hopes for transition and resulted in the suspension of refugee returns into other parts.

OCHA further strengthened and consolidated the coordination of humanitarian assistance. In Khartoum, Juba and Rumbek, it set up coordination mechanisms on returns, protection, information and advocacy. OCHA worked closely with the Protection, Returns and Public Information units within UNMIS as they were being established in Khartoum and Juba, providing them with essential support.

OCHA led the way in advocating for increased attention to Khartoum IDP camps, mobilising protection, humanitarian response, media attention and donor support.

The office also supported the Return and Reintegration Unit and the Protection Unit of UNMIS with strong field-based coordination and information in areas in South Sudan and Darfur where the mission had no capacity, or where it was very limited. OCHA established mechanisms to strengthen monitoring and tracking of returning IDPs, introduced activities supporting spontaneous returns, including the training of more than 200 monitors and enumerators to track returns, and to monitor and report on protection violations and emergency needs along the main return routes. An initial returns plan was put in place with OCHA guidance and participation.

In 2005, OCHA took over the Emergency Preparedness and Response Unit (EP&R) previously managed by UNICEF. This strengthened its ability to support joint

assessments and response to emergencies. Funding received towards the end of 2005 as part of the Emergency Response Fund (ERF) greatly enhanced the capacity of agencies to respond to emergencies in a timely fashion.

OCHA was integral to contingency planning for the East and for possible regional unrest with Chad. Led by the Deputy Humanitarian Coordinators, response plans for potential humanitarian crises were developed through joint regional country team and sectoral meetings.

The office took the lead in developing a capacity building programme for its government counterpart in the South, the Sudan Relief and Rehabilitation Commission (SRRC), and setting up joint offices of SRRC and the North Sudan counterpart, the Humanitarian Aid Commission (HAC) in the three Transitional Areas. This programme included provision of offices, equipment, stipends and operating expenses until the end of 2005 for the headquarters, each of the 10 state offices in Southern Sudan and the three Transitional Areas.

OCHA organised and facilitated the first and subsequent joint HAC/SRRC meetings. It facilitated joint missions throughout Southern Sudan and the three Transitional Areas, supporting the setting up of new offices and facilitating the handover of offices to the SRRC and formation of joint offices.

OCHA helped mobilise resources through the 2005 Work Plan for the Sudan, with 56 percent (US\$ 1.1 billion) of the assistance requirements provided by donors.

By the end of 2005, there were more than 12,000 humanitarian aid workers, 80 NGOs and 11 UN Agencies operating in Darfur. All relied heavily on OCHA's coordination network for planning appropriate and proactive responses. OCHA satellite offices were opened in Darfur to expand humanitarian operations and to reach populations in need outside IDP camps and main towns, thereby enabling humanitarian partners to identify and respond to the needs of local populations.

Performance evaluation

Throughout 2005, field-based coordination was strengthened in the South through the establishment of eight field offices, supporting the creation of sector and area coordination arrangements where none previously existed. It also ensured close working relationships with

counterparts at the state level, and allowed for an element of capacity building in order for state authorities to be able to take on their coordination roles, paving the way for future development opportunities.

At the field level, the deployment of Humanitarian Affairs Officers and the opening of new offices expanded the provision of timely analysis and information. Reports providing information and analysis on a regular basis on the full range of humanitarian issues in Sudan were improved and widely distributed.

Despite sustained efforts to ensure access to all those in need, security constraints limited access to a number of areas, particularly in West and South Darfur. Some armed groups refused free and safe access to areas under their control.

Through advocacy and the deployment of additional protection officers to the field, OCHA ensured that the protection needs of the civilian population were addressed more effectively. Gaps remained in some areas that started to be filled by the expanding UNMIS protection unit in late 2005.

An Inter-Agency Real-Time Evaluation on the Humanitarian Response to the Darfur Crisis found that aid organisations were slow to scale up, given the scale of the crisis at the time, affecting nearly 1.2 million IDPs and residents of host communities. Among the reasons for this were significant government restrictions and obstruction; limited capacity, including surge capacity; limited deep-field presence that could have led the response, for access, security and operational reasons; a still-inadequate protection framework; and limited strategic planning.

The evaluation also found weaknesses in monitoring and accountability; in the level of common understanding among agencies of the operating environment; the integration of assessment missions to provide for cross-sectoral issues (especially protection and gender); managing the tension between urgent, short-term needs and quality programming; and the induction and training of humanitarian workers.

Generally declining morbidity and mortality rates over time suggest that the response did prevent additional

mortality that could have resulted from the displacement and loss of access to livelihoods after the initial crisis. But, as the evaluation team concluded during its third visit in June 2005, the still significant gaps in assistance, continuing human rights abuses, lack of access to war affected populations in rebel-controlled areas and concerns about the quality and consistency of aid delivery and services were troubling.

The HC is now leading discussions with key stakeholders in Sudan to prioritise the most relevant among the recommendations, and to develop an action plan for their implementation. The IASC has also committed to ensuring that critical areas of concern identified in the evaluation are adequately addressed within individual member organisations, subject to the availability of resources.

Sudan Requirements, Income and Expenditure Breakdown

Requirements	21,475,870
Income from Voluntary Contributions	11,814,895
EXPENDITURE	
Staff Costs	8,722,987
Consultant Fees and Travel	388,026
Travel	1,488,030
Operating Expenses	2,997,561
Contractual Services	75,832
Supplies, Material, Furniture and Equipment	2,282,815
Fellowships, Grants and Contributions	141,258
Programme Support Costs	2,060,551
Total Expenditure US\$	18,157,060

Sudan - Darfur HIC Requirements, Income and Expenditure Breakdown

Requirements	1,353,844
Income from Voluntary Contributions	1,141,838
EXPENDITURE	
Staff Costs	-
Consultant Fees and Travel	-
Travel	-
Operating Expenses	-
Contractual Services	-
Supplies, Material, Furniture and Equipment	-
Fellowships, Grants and Contributions ^a	385,840
Programme Support Costs	24,217
Total Expenditure US\$	410,057

a Allocation to UNOPS

OCHA's presence in Sudan expanded throughout 2005 in response to growing humanitarian needs.

In Darfur, the largest humanitarian operation in the world, OCHA continued to coordinate and facilitate the work of some 1,000 international and more than 13,000 national relief workers amid continued violence, massive displacement, severe access restrictions and a volatile security situation.

In Southern Sudan, large-scale and acute humanitarian needs remain since years of war have ravaged essential services and eroded people's coping mechanisms. Needs are only likely to increase with the expected return of hundreds of thousands of IDPs and refugees, as well as increased access to many areas.

Internally Displaced

The situation of several million IDPs in and around Khartoum continues to demand attention and assistance, while the former Transitional Areas and the eastern region present yet more humanitarian challenges.

In that context, OCHA's coordination activity is essential. With a large number of aid agencies and even greater numbers of beneficiaries in Africa's largest country, ensuring that aid reaches vulnerable populations is vital. Regular joint assessments and monitoring, organised by OCHA, allow all agencies to target aid more effectively, facilitate greater coverage and enable work to protect civilians.

Safety and Security

The Emergency Preparedness and Response Unit helps agencies prepare contingency plans and responses, and OCHA plays a crucial role as the primary interlocutor with government and rebel movements, advocating with all parties and authorities to respect international and national law, and working to ensure the safety and security of civilians and aid workers.

Advocacy and Information Management

With very difficult conditions on the ground, OCHA's information gathering and dissemination keeps not just Sudan but the world abreast of the humanitarian situation. As a glaring microscope and prohibitive environment with a daily threat of punishment has effectively halted NGO advocacy, OCHA uses its mandate to publicly address issues relating to humanitarian affairs.



Uganda



The long-running Lord's Resistance Army (LRA) insurgency in northern Uganda has displaced an estimated two million people, more than 1.7 million of them living in marginal conditions in 188 heavily congested camps in the districts of Gulu, Kitgum, Pader, Lira, Apac and Adjumani. In September 2005, the insurgents expanded their activities in southern Sudan and northeastern DRC. Following the indictment of its five top commanders by the International Criminal Court, the LRA attacked humanitarian workers and foreigners in northern Uganda and Southern Sudan in October and November.

Limited access in the districts of Gulu, Pader and Kitgum remained a major constraint to the delivery of humanitarian assistance. Only 15 of 105 IDP settlements were accessible without military escorts due to LRA attacks. An estimated 35,000 "night commuters", mainly children, in the Acholi sub-region continued the daily routine of commuting between their rural homes and adjacent towns to escape abduction. In the Teso and southern Lango sub-regions, relative peace contributed to the voluntary return of an estimated 400,000 IDPs. However, in the Karamoja sub-region, low literacy levels, poor pastoral practices and long-term neglect by successive governments in service provision and development have contributed to a high degree of food insecurity and environmental risk. This is compounded by a tradition of inter-clan and cross-border cattle-rustling.

Key objectives

- Improve access to IDPs, refugees and other vulnerable groups for delivery of humanitarian assistance
- Strive to improve protection for all vulnerable groups, with an emphasis on children and women, in accordance with international and national human rights laws and humanitarian principles
- Support improved provision and delivery of comprehensive and timely humanitarian assistance to vulnerable populations, respecting their dignity, in a sustainable manner
- Support efforts to improve livelihoods and coping mechanisms among IDPs and refugees, to promote self-reliance in camps/settlements and return areas

Activities

In partnership with UNHCHR, the Uganda Human Rights Commission and the government, OCHA supported the creation and establishment of human rights promotion and protection sub-committees at the district level to support the promotion of human rights through education and information dissemination activities.

OCHA also supported an IDP camp decongestion working group through drafting policy and procedures. Decongestion is vital to improving overcrowded camp situations by providing adequate basic services to smaller camps and places of origin. This process has relieved heavily congested camps and promoted somewhat improved conditions for displaced people.

OCHA advocated with the government to increase access to all IDP camps through the provision of more military escorts. As a result, the army made more soldiers available to escort humanitarian agencies, while OCHA and the UN Department of Safety and Security coordinated their use. It was not possible to engage the LRA in discussions on humanitarian access.

The office worked on sensitising district authorities on the National IDP Policy, formulated in 2004, and their responsibilities under its terms. OCHA also contributed to the drafting of a human rights and protection strategy, which provides the basis for an

enhanced coordinated response to key concerns, including Sexual and Gender Based Violence (SGBV) and night commuting children.

To improve coordination, OCHA maintained field offices in Gulu, Kitgum, Lira, Soroti, Pader and Katakwi. This expanded presence strengthened humanitarian coordination structures at the district level and advocacy with local authorities on issues related to the protection of civilians.

At national and field level, OCHA provided the humanitarian community with basic coordination tools and services, including coordination fora, WWW database, mapping services, policy development and advocacy support.

In November, the UNCT embraced the cluster approach in four gap areas: water and sanitation, protection, health, and early recovery. OCHA, in support of the Humanitarian Coordinator, facilitated discussions between the country team and the inter-agency Internal Displacement Division, as well as follow-up actions, including the revision of CAP 2006.

OCHA continued to support the HC, UNCT, IASC, donors and OCHA headquarters through humanitarian updates, briefs, development of the CAP and facilitation of various headquarters and donor missions. Monthly sit-reps and updates served to keep the humanitarian community informed of key issues. Several joint assessments were undertaken to provide baseline data on the humanitarian situation, and vulnerability mapping pursued to represent this clearly, in order to allow for better decision-making.

Performance evaluation

Poor humanitarian access continued to constrain activities in 2005, but OCHA and other humanitarian partners helped reduce the number of night commuters in the North in the latter half of the year. The number of night commuters, primarily children, fell from 27,000 in August to 23,000 in December, and continues to decline, as a result of improved security. The OCHA office assisted, in particular, through monitoring, advocacy and continued support to coordination mechanisms.

Implementation of the National IDP Policy was limited in 2005 due to capacity and resource

constraints on the part of district authorities. OCHA supported the establishment of the coordination mechanisms envisaged in the IDP policy, with minimal government involvement. At the district level, OCHA continued to support the functioning of the coordination mechanisms and the establishment of sector working groups in all the conflict-affected districts where it had a presence. Here again, government leadership was limited.

Improved coordination on security, which included strong input from OCHA, allowed for more sustained surveillance of the humanitarian situation by all partners involved. Advocacy with the army and other government officials resulted in increased access by IDPs to land around IDP settlements, up from two to three kilometres in the first quarter to between two and five kilometres in the third quarter.

Approximately 400,000 IDPs voluntarily returned to their home areas in 33 sub-counties in Lango and Teso regions, with the support of return packages promoting self-reliance. OCHA contributed to this process in advocating for provision of return packages, facilitating the return, and monitoring the integration process.

Uganda Requirements, Income and Expenditure Breakdown

Requirements	3,580,154
Income from Voluntary Contributions	3,849,367
EXPENDITURE	
Staff Costs	1,466,843
Consultant Fees and Travel	33,252
Travel	177,614
Operating Expenses	334,069
Contractual Services	33,292
Supplies, Material, Furniture and Equipment	310,198
Fellowships, Grants and Contributions	-
Programme Support Costs	306,185
Total Expenditure US\$	2,661,453

Zimbabwe



The humanitarian situation in Zimbabwe in 2005 was characterised by deepening and widening vulnerability, due to factors including food insecurity, HIV and AIDS, weakened capacity for the delivery of basic services, economic decline and a changing social fabric. At least three million people required food assistance and, while the HIV/AIDS prevalence rate among adults dropped from 24.6 percent in 2002 to 21.3 percent in 2005, the disease continued to cause the death of 3,000 Zimbabweans per week. The economic situation, with high inflation, shortages in foreign exchange and negative growth, added to the vulnerability of the population. The humanitarian situation was compounded by Operation Restore Order/Murambatsvina, which caused an estimated 650,000 to 700,000 people to lose their homes, their livelihoods, or both.

In 2005, OCHA's work in Zimbabwe took place in the context of the Humanitarian Support Team (HST) under the overall leadership of the RC/HC. OCHA provided one international staff member and one national staff member to the HST throughout the year, but also sent a surge capacity team of three international staff that helped galvanise support for humanitarian coordination following Operation Restore Order/Murambatsvina. In order to serve the humanitarian community and all stakeholders more effectively, the United Nations decided to replace the HST with a regular OCHA Field Office, which was opened on 1 January 2006.

Key objectives

- Promote a regular dialogue between the UN, other humanitarian partners and the government by organising regular joint coordination fora and providing relevant analysis on humanitarian and transitional needs
- Advocate for recognition and support of the humanitarian needs and rights of highly vulnerable groups through strengthening and consolidating existing humanitarian coordination mechanisms
- Improve the quality and effectiveness of vulnerability assessment committees (VAC) and undertake a consultative process aimed at developing an exit strategy for humanitarian programming in favour of activities promoting sustainable solutions
- Improve access to timely and comprehensive humanitarian information
- Work to ensure a smooth transition from humanitarian to recovery programming

Activities

OCHA and the HST played an important role in a cross-section of coordination issues that included: support to the RC/HC and IASC members in consultations with the government; more systematic sectoral coordination and collaboration through working groups; facilitation of IASC meetings; and facilitation and production of the UN Interim Response Plan and the UN Common Response Plan to Operation Restore Order/Murambatsvina.

The year's work also involved facilitation of the visit by UN Special Envoy Anna Tibaijuka and that of Under-Secretary-General and Emergency Relief Coordinator, Jan Egeland; participation in vulnerability assessments and other surveys; organisation of training in disaster preparedness and planning; production of the 2006 Zimbabwe CAP; and inter-agency contingency planning.

OCHA/HST facilitated and produced the 2005 Humanitarian Framework and the 2006 Zimbabwe CAP, through consultative processes in which a common analysis of the humanitarian situation was developed. This was the first CAP issued for Zimbabwe since 2003, despite persistent

humanitarian needs, and the process served to galvanise joint planning, information sharing and cooperation among local IASC members.

OCHA/HST also instituted bi-weekly meetings of the IASC country team, and monthly meetings of the RC/HC with NGOs, the government and donors. Some of these consultations had taken place on an ad hoc basis in the past, but were instituted on a regular basis in the last quarter of 2005, with a positive impact on the flow of information and the ability of humanitarian actors to jointly discuss issues on the humanitarian agenda.

OCHA/HST also coordinated regular Coordination and Humanitarian Guidance Group meetings, which analysed the humanitarian space and operational difficulties of NGOs and developed an access matrix. The group also monitored issues of protection, humanitarian principles and the standards for care provided to the most vulnerable.

The information management part of OCHA/HST's work increased in quality as well as quantity in 2005, and served to promote information sharing and coordination. Activities included: building and expanding a working network of contacts from UN Agencies, NGOs and government sectors; the production of coordination documents such as situation reports and WWW matrices; and, support for the VAC process in the gathering and dissemination of data.

OCHA/HST was also instrumental in providing the humanitarian community with GIS services, such as spatial mapping and analysis, scanning and conversion of analogue to digital data for large maps, and GIS and GPS training. The office offered support in data analysis and mapping to humanitarian working groups and individual government institutions, NGOs, UN Agencies and international organisations.

Performance evaluation

Most of the office's key objectives for 2005 were met, except the development of a humanitarian exit strategy, due to the severe increase in food insecurity and the additional humanitarian needs and vulnerabilities created by Operation Restore Order/ Murambatsvina.

As a result of active efforts by the Humanitarian Coordinator and the IASC Country Team, including

OCHA, over 30 UN Agencies and NGOs participated actively in and submitted projects through the CAP.

Feedback from partners indicated that the new humanitarian coordination mechanism was useful in promoting the sharing of information and joint strategy-setting for difficult issues on the humanitarian agenda, including the response to Operation Restore Order/Murambatsvina.

OCHA's value-added to the ZIMVAC included policy and technical assistance, including on GIS services and logistics. This work helped ensure that ZIMVAC was considered a key tool by all actors, including the government, to survey the humanitarian situation and plan response. While joint assessments such as ZIMVAC were useful in building a common analysis of the humanitarian situation, sustaining such a joint understanding within the humanitarian community remained a real challenge throughout 2005.

Products such as the humanitarian situation report and the WWW matrix helped all humanitarian actors stay abreast of the humanitarian situation and response, particularly following Operation Restore Order/Murambatsvina. However, ensuring the regular flow of information remained a constant challenge, given the heavily politicised context. OCHA therefore considered it necessary to establish a full-fledged field office in 2006.

While issues of access and protection remained sensitive in the Zimbabwean context, the work of the Humanitarian Guidance Working Group, coordinated by OCHA, served to inform advocacy efforts at local and headquarters levels.

**Zimbabwe
Requirements, Income and Expenditure Breakdown**

Requirements	731,576
Income from Voluntary Contributions	1,587,933
EXPENDITURE	
Staff Costs	207,950
Consultant Fees and Travel	-
Travel	68,813
Operating Expenses	21,218
Contractual Services	3,400
Supplies, Material, Furniture and Equipment	6,500
Fellowships, Grants and Contributions	10,000
Programme Support Costs	41,324
Total Expenditure US\$	359,205

Regional Office for Southern Africa



Across southern Africa, millions of people are vulnerable to the triple threat of food insecurity, HIV/AIDS and a lack of basic services. The UN system works together to reduce the impact of these threats, with OCHA coordinating the humanitarian response. The triple threats are reversing southern Africa's development gains and the region is more vulnerable to shocks. A failure of the 2004-2005 cropping season increased the number of people in need of humanitarian assistance to 12 million.

The Regional Office for Southern Africa (RO-SA) supports Resident Coordinators in ensuring appropriate disaster preparedness and response. The regional office is the first line of response for 14 countries in the region, with the exception of Zimbabwe. During the period under review, OCHA responded to the needs of those affected by the Indian Ocean tsunami in the Seychelles and Sri Lanka by providing surge capacity, as well as to two volcanic eruptions in the Comoros and floods in Madagascar.

Key objectives

- Provide support to the RC system to improve planning, monitoring and accountability of humanitarian actions
- Deliver efficient secretariat functions in support of UN regional inter-agency coordination efforts
- Ensure that the SAHIMS Secretariat is fully established and supports relevant humanitarian information networks

- Facilitate an inter-agency agreement on a unified approach to analysing vulnerabilities in the region
- Participate in regional disaster management capacity-building efforts in collaboration with UNDP, ISDR, SADC and other partners
- Support an inter-agency advocacy strategy for southern Africa

Activities

The Regional Office facilitated the preparation of the Inter-Agency Regional Humanitarian Strategic Framework for Southern Africa, launched in April 2005. This framework guides the current humanitarian response, identifying actions required to address immediate and longer-term needs. The response to identified emergency needs is also increasingly integrated into longer-term planning and national development plans.

The OCHA regional office continued to support the Special Envoy for Humanitarian Needs in Southern Africa, preparing his mission and subsequent report, which highlighted growing humanitarian concerns, resulting in a letter from the Secretary-General to alert donors. The RO also prepared two special updates from the Special Envoy, focusing on Zimbabwe and the looming food crisis. The RO continues to lead discussions on humanitarian issues at the monthly Regional Directors Team meetings, aligning the humanitarian agenda with longer term planning.

The regional office supported RCs throughout the region, with regular missions and the deployment of humanitarian affairs officers to Malawi, Madagascar and Namibia. The office helped mobilise international capacity and technical expertise, address humanitarian needs and issued situation reports. The RO supported three RC offices in the region with personnel to boost their disaster management capacity. In Angola, the RO helped strengthen disaster response preparedness and vulnerability assessment. In Malawi, the office helped prepare the Flash Appeal, and assisted with monitoring and reporting on progress, as well as its revision in November 2005.

Inter-agency contingency planning was supported in Namibia, Lesotho, Comoros, Malawi, Mozambique and Zimbabwe. The process brought together key regional stakeholders, ensuring that participants were informed of the status of preparedness in their respective countries and consolidated a comprehensive picture of the support expected. The RO also developed a regional matrix that strengthened linkages between early warning and early

action in the region, contributing to an IASC Early Warning-Early Action report.

Food insecurity plunged Malawi, Mozambique, Zambia and Zimbabwe back into an acute phase of crisis. The regional office helped develop response strategies, and facilitated the Malawi Flash Appeal. It facilitated the deployment of humanitarian affairs officers to Namibia, Madagascar and Malawi, and deployed support missions to strengthen information management in Zimbabwe.

After Mount Karthala volcano in the Comoros erupted twice, in April and again in November, the response was in line with the contingency plan that the regional office had helped to prepare. OCHA also helped mobilise resources to respond to immediate needs. In Madagascar, OCHA coordinated a response to floods, insect infestation and drought, which had exacerbated food insecurity.

The Southern Africa Humanitarian Information Management Network (SAHIMS) broadened its information management services to include the entire response to the triple threat. The service provided includes a website (www.sahims.net), training and capacity building, and functioning as a resource base for implementation of DevInfo in Southern Africa. SAHIMS worked with regional stakeholders to harmonise information systems and to develop a common approach to monitoring and enhancing information management capacities at national level; UN regional strategic information requirements, including those to address sustainable development needs; and attainment of MDGs.

As co-chair of the Inter-agency working group, the regional office developed a communication strategy to address the triple threat. The RO helped mobilise more than US\$ 51 million in emergency funds for the region in response to humanitarian needs in Angola, Comoros, Malawi, Seychelles and Zimbabwe. The office also produced an Emergency Tools and Services booklet for RCs and promoted the IASC guidelines on HIV/AIDS. The effort fostered understanding of the pandemic in the workplace and in promoting protection-oriented activities. During the first two months of 2005, two international staff were deployed to Sri Lanka to assist with the initial response to the Indian Ocean tsunami. The regional office also participated in discussions on the establishment of a tsunami early warning and mitigation system for the Indian Ocean.

Performance evaluation

SAHIMS played a central role in providing strategic information to support the UN's regional capacity and RCs in achieving common analysis, supporting joint

programming addressing critical vulnerabilities and response to emergencies. Website hits increased in 2005, making SAHIMS one of the most popular humanitarian and disaster response sites in Africa. Thirteen new partners joined Sahims.net. However, no new national platforms were established. Though important, national ownership of these platforms is not sustainable at present.

OCHA supported the formulation of a five-year programme on Strengthening Vulnerability Assessment and Analysis in the SADC region, as well as planning annual vulnerability assessments. This contributed to understanding of the prevailing humanitarian needs and critical areas of vulnerability, and ensured the use of appropriate methodologies.

In 2005, the office intended to coordinate its disaster preparedness activities with the UNDP/BCPR regional disaster risk reduction initiative. However, since the BCPR project did not begin until mid-2005, parallel activities were created in some countries. Coordination will continue in 2006.

RO – Southern Africa Requirements, Income and Expenditure Breakdown

Requirements	912,754
Income from Voluntary Contributions	728,286
EXPENDITURE	
Staff Costs	609,037
Consultant Fees and Travel	16,396
Travel	55,564
Operating Expenses	80,565
Contractual Services	17,084
Supplies, Material, Furniture and Equipment	6,865
Fellowships, Grants and Contributions	-
Programme Support Costs	102,116
Total Expenditure US\$	887,627

SAHIMS Requirements, Income and Expenditure Breakdown

Requirements	687,546
Income from Voluntary Contributions ^a	200,000
EXPENDITURE	
Staff Costs	145,375
Consultant Fees and Travel	9,361
Travel	(1,828)
Operating Expenses	68,557
Contractual Services	998
Supplies, Material, Furniture and Equipment	8,434
Fellowships, Grants and Contributions ^b	146,504
Programme Support Costs	36,537
Total Expenditure US\$	413,938

^a Includes allocations from Field Coordination Reserve Fund for US\$ 100,000

^b Allocation to UNOPS for US\$ 146,504

Regional Office for Central and East Africa



The Central and East Africa region covered by the OCHA Support Office comprises 14 countries. In 2005, the formal political transition period was completed in Burundi and there was a North-South peace deal in Sudan, though violent conflict continued in Darfur. Meanwhile, Ethiopia-Eritrean relations soured and both countries engaged in a build-up of troops at their common border. Localised and devastating conflicts continued in eastern DRC, southern Somalia, northern Uganda, Darfur, some provinces of Burundi and the Republic of Congo, threatening fragile peace processes and impeding humanitarian response. Kenya, Uganda, Ethiopia and Somalia continued to experience sporadic inter-communal and/or cross-border violence. Drought persisted in Ethiopia, Eritrea and Djibouti, and the effects of drought and erratic rainfalls caused flash floods in Kenya, Somalia, Tanzania, Sudan and Ethiopia, resulting in chronic food insecurity and malnutrition.

The impact of conflicts and disasters imposed severe hardships on nearly 13 million people, either internally displaced or refugees. The sustainable return of refugees and IDPs remains a key challenge, especially in Burundi. Massive human rights violations were prevalent in the region, notably sexual violence in DRC and Darfur. The protection of civilians was a major challenge, with states either unable or unwilling to protect their own people. The scope and scale of needs in the region continued to grow. Chronically food-insecure populations need substantial food assistance and competing emergencies restricted the resources available.

Key objectives

- Improve technical expertise among humanitarian actors in the region
- Develop a more coordinated and inclusive regional humanitarian strategy to respond more efficiently to assessed needs
- Better-harmonised and coordinated advocacy strategies among regional partners, and the committed engagement of policy makers towards addressing the root causes of crises in the region
- Enhance early warning for crisis mitigation and strengthen preparedness for humanitarian response
- Improve support to emergency assessment and coordination of disaster response

Activities

The RO CEA provided backstopping and technical support to OCHA country offices in the region and elsewhere. The office organised workshops and consultations on: displacement and protection; HIV/AIDS guidelines in emergency; humanitarian mapping in disaster preparedness and response; and civil-military coordination.

The Inter-Agency Working Group on Early Warning and Disaster Preparedness, chaired by the RO CEA, mapped the preparedness level and response capacity of regional partners and 14 governments. Upon completion, a one-day 'tsunami simulation' confirmed areas of weakness, overlaps or gaps in regional supports. The RO CEA provided analyses on trends and indicators where there is no OCHA office, compiled in early warning reports. The office also assisted the UNEP-OCHA unit with a toxic waste assessment in Somalia. In light of the avian flu threat, the RO CEA established an inter-agency group, which supports governmental strategies and coordinates interventions.

Whenever an emergency arises, the RO CEA consults concerned partners and advocacy strategies are developed. Individual agency/organisation advocacy campaigns undertaken in 2005 stemmed from an overall regional advocacy strategy. On the policy side, achievement is less easy to measure, as many factors cannot be attributed to the RO CEA alone. However, the protocols prepared for the International Conference on the Great Lakes Region are an example of positive policy outcome spearheaded and supported by the RO CEA.

The RO CEA organised bi-annual scenario development workshops for the Horn of Africa and for the Great Lakes Region at which UN and NGO regional partners and donors elaborated scenarios, identified humanitarian consequences and reviewed preparedness and response capacity.

Information exchange meetings chaired by the RO CEA, continued on a regular basis. The RO CEA produced specific reports on affected populations in the region, on Kenya, on the relations between Sudan/Chad, Sudan/Ethiopia and Somalia/Kenya/Ethiopia.

To reach a common understanding of crises in the region and agree upon regional strategies and plans of action, the RO CEA organised and chaired monthly Steering Committee Meetings. In 2005, the focus was on HIV/AIDS and environmental risks posed by the Nyiragongo volcano in DRC, as well as some more country-specific concerns.

Implementation of the 2005 regional strategy was regularly monitored. Stakeholders participated in the development of the 2006 Great Lakes CAP. The RO CEA supported Somalia, Djibouti, Pakistan, West Africa, CAR and DRC in the elaboration of their CAPs through workshop facilitation and technical support.

Advocacy activities directed towards regional partners focused on several countries and themes, with an emphasis on HIV/AIDS and Sexual and Gender-Based Violence, including dissemination of IASC guidelines. Severe crises lacking adequate international attention (Darfur, Eritrea-Ethiopia and Kenya) were particularly supported.

The Information Management and Analysis Unit (IMAU) surveyed regional partners to identify expectations and needs, launched an inter-agency working group website, elaborated a regional information management strategy, maintained a regional contact database, and participated in the IAWG information technology-information management sub-group.

The RO CEA pursued its role as lead agency for the Social and Humanitarian Issues cluster of the International Conference on the Great Lakes Region (IC/GLR) and facilitated discussions of the 11 core countries, during which 11 projects and three protocols (on Internal Displacement, Sexual Violence, and Property Rights of Returning Populations) were elaborated.

Performance evaluation

Surge capacity and technical expertise among OCHA offices in the region was improved through support missions totalling 110 weeks on issues ranging from displacement and protection to HIV interventions in emergency settings, civil-military cooperation, and humanitarian mapping in disaster preparedness and response. Receiving offices rated the RO CEA performance highly, and requests for such support surpassed the capacity of the office to deliver. More than 200 humanitarian partners benefited from regional workshops.

The major achievement towards a more coordinated and inclusive approach was the establishment of inter-agency sectoral and thematic groups, such as the Avian Flu and cross-border groups, where UN and NGO regional actors coordinate their interventions on the basis of regional objectives.

The RO CEA directly supported and facilitated the elaboration of three contingency plans, for Rwanda, Burundi and the volcano in Goma, DRC. The regional office also started the process in Somalia, Djibouti and Eritrea.

Following the humanitarian mapping and the simulation conducted under the coordination of the RO CEA, regional partners took measures to strengthen and improve their collective and individual assessment and disaster response. While it may still be too early to draw conclusions, commitment to working together has been illustrated on Avian Flu and HIV/AIDS, issues on which all partners have taken a coordinated approach.

RO – Central and East Africa Requirements, Income and Expenditure Breakdown

Requirements	1,833,710
Income from Voluntary Contributions ^a	1,750,099
EXPENDITURE	
Staff Costs	1,046,314
Consultant Fees and Travel	20,372
Travel	94,204
Operating Expenses	91,100
Contractual Services	23,750
Supplies, Material, Furniture and Equipment	35,700
Fellowships, Grants and Contributions	20,000
Programme Support Costs	173,087
Total Expenditure US\$	1,504,527

^a Includes allocations from Field Coordination Reserve Fund for US\$ 352,177

Regional Office for West Africa



West Africa is largely returning to peace and physical security as witnessed in Sierra Leone and Liberia, despite pockets of tension in Côte d'Ivoire. However, food insecurity and a nutrition crisis dominated Niger, while a cholera epidemic affected nine countries and floods affected five states.

The OCHA Regional Office for West Africa, based in Dakar, Senegal, supports the 15 ECOWAS countries plus Mauritania, the Central African Republic and Cameroon. The regional office also provides support to UN Resident Coordinators, donors, NGOs and governments through its network of resident national officers in Côte d'Ivoire, Niger and Guinea, and the ad hoc deployment of its 10 national and seven international staff based in Dakar.

Key objectives

- Strengthen consultation and coordination efforts, and thereby achieve effective monitoring, planning and response
- Facilitate the systematic application of policy instruments for the improvement of the protection environment in West Africa
- Coordinate needs-based planning and information management systems for improved monitoring, preparedness, decision-making and related advocacy

Activities

The regional office undertook humanitarian coordination, preparedness and advocacy activities in support of UN Resident Coordinators in Guinea Bissau, Benin, Mauritania, Senegal, Togo, Niger, Liberia, Guinea, Mali, Burkina Faso and Ghana during 2005.

In Niger, the humanitarian consequences at the onset of the lean season turned out to be as critical as foreseen in the West Africa CAP in November 2004 and the Flash Appeal launched in May 2005. An OCHA emergency management team was deployed in July to establish an OCHA presence, including a HIC.

The regional office also assisted UNICEF and WHO in developing the Cholera Flash Appeal for six countries affected by the epidemic in 2005.

The office initiated a policy dialogue with development partners through a regional consultation on the Sahel in November. The objectives were to sustain dialogue between actors concerned about the sub-region's food and nutritional insecurity, to ensure that the requisite tools are used to tackle acute and chronic vulnerability simultaneously, and to formulate an Integrated Action Plan for the Sahel that includes recovery and humanitarian relief activities.

In close cooperation with UNDP and the CILSS (Interstate Committee for Combating Drought in the Sahel), the regional office launched a regional consultative process on the need to bridge the transition from emergency response to recovery assistance. The process enabled governments and development partners to better understand the emergency response requirements of the international community. It led to concrete recommendations on how best to link humanitarian assistance and long-term development aid in the Sahel.

Following recommendations of the UN Security Council mission to parts of West Africa in 2004, ROWA and the UN Office for West Africa started cross-border meetings aimed at developing an integrated border stabilisation strategy. This institutional relationship was further reinforced in 2005 through participation in the Inter-Peace Missions Working Group chaired by the SRSG for West Africa.

Several UN country teams (Togo, Benin, Guinea Bissau, Mauritania) received preparedness support to facilitate contingency planning, training on human rights and humanitarian principles, as well as use of rapid needs assessment tools, WWW databases, humanitarian contact lists, situation reports and so forth in anticipation of crises.

In 2005, a newly established Information Management Unit (IMU) in the regional office supported regional coordination efforts by providing standard information tools, including contact lists, maps and a website, to the humanitarian community. The IMU also worked closely with OCHA's Field Information Support Project and Early Warning Unit in preparing early warning analyses and key data sets.

Performance evaluation

Humanitarian consultation and coordination efforts were strengthened at the regional level in 2005, including through the Inter-Agency Contingency Plan for the five countries bordering Côte d'Ivoire, the Flash Appeal for the cholera outbreaks, and the CAP for West Africa (funded at 69 percent).

The protection environment in West Africa continued to be fraught and challenging, but there was some progress in relation to security improvements in areas emerging from violent conflict, especially in Liberia.

Although there is still room for improvement, the IMU enhanced the regional office's capacity to provide timely and more accurate information for planning monitoring and responding to emergency situations in West Africa.

Lessons learned from the crisis in the Sahel in 2005 clearly showed that early warning does not necessarily lead to early action. Therefore, a public information and advocacy officer was recruited to increase public awareness and to galvanise the concerned states, supported by the international community, into taking prompt action in the event of an emerging crisis.

RO – West Africa Requirements, Income and Expenditure Breakdown

Requirements	2,049,067
Income from Voluntary Contributions ^a	1,849,716
EXPENDITURE	
Staff Costs	980,480
Consultant Fees and Travel	-
Travel	104,468
Operating Expenses	143,280
Contractual Services	11,514
Supplies, Material, Furniture and Equipment	135,435
Fellowships, Grants and Contributions	43,000
Programme Support Costs	184,363
Total Expenditure US\$	1,602,540

^a Includes allocations from Field Coordination Reserve Fund for US\$ 177,781



MIDDLE EAST



occupied Palestinian territory



The OCHA office in the occupied Palestinian territory (oPt) was established in late 2001 in response to a sharply deteriorating humanitarian situation caused by an escalation in the Israeli-Palestinian conflict. In 2005, despite the positive climate that prevailed following the evacuation of around 8,000 Israeli settlers from settlements in the Gaza Strip and northern West Bank, poverty worsened. Sixty-four percent of the Palestinian population lives in poverty with 32 percent living in acute poverty. With violence continuing, physical protection of civilians and their property - along with access for humanitarian workers - remained key concerns.

The primary causes of the protracted humanitarian crisis among the Palestinian people are the controls imposed on access and movement by Israel, which states that such limitations are necessary to prevent attacks on Israeli citizens. While movement restrictions within Gaza have eased, the importation and exportation of goods is often blocked.

In the West Bank, Palestinian movement is hampered in several ways. The first is the 'closure system', a series of more than 400 obstacles, including checkpoints and roadblocks. The number of these

obstacles has steadily increased since the disengagement of settlers in August. The second measure is 'the Barrier', which runs along the entire west side of the West Bank, projecting up to 22 kilometres into Palestinian territory. Land-requisitioning and levelling by Israeli forces has steadily accelerated for its construction. The third is the permit regime, which controls Palestinian access to many roads in the West Bank and into Israeli-declared 'closed areas', such as the area between the Green Line and the Barrier, the Jordan Valley and East Jerusalem.

Key objectives

- Provide strategic oversight for a wide range of humanitarian coordination activities
- Develop more comprehensive needs analysis to improve targeting of assistance and aid monitoring
- Develop specialised maps and analysis through a range of services and products (available in Arabic and Hebrew) designed to inform policy-makers, assist aid organisations to make operational decisions and to advocate on behalf of vulnerable populations
- Enhance coordination mechanisms at the district level
- Provide inter-agency advocacy strategies through the joint-chairing of the UN Inter Agency Humanitarian Advocacy Group

Activities

OCHA's physical presence in the West Bank and Gaza Strip enabled the coordination of humanitarian response via liaison with local governorates, municipalities and local humanitarian actors. The staff were able to directly respond to the needs of each area, and provide valuable data on the humanitarian situation and continuous monitoring that assisted the efforts of other agencies.

To better respond to the needs of the population of Gaza, OCHA facilitated a contingency planning

exercise to preposition stocks in the event that access to affected populations was restricted. To further identify requirements and define the strategic objectives of the UN, a comprehensive needs analysis was undertaken through the office, which provided the basis for the 2006 CAP. The launch of the CAP was attended by over 100 members of the donor and local humanitarian community, and covered by over 15 media outlets.

The Information Management Unit produced a series of maps highlighting access difficulties, progress of the West Bank Barrier as well as a comprehensive database monitoring protection of civilians. Humanitarian analysis was enhanced with the development of an analysis unit within the office that brought together macro-economic analysis and field-based research to provide a comprehensive picture of humanitarian trends and, increasingly, the impact of aid. Humanitarian advocacy efforts included briefing 150 visiting delegations composed of foreign dignitaries, members of parliament, donors, international humanitarian organisations, academics and other policy-makers.

Inter-agency advocacy activities included the release of: a joint statement on International Women's Day; an Information kit (including a contact sheet and press advisory) from UN Agencies on the humanitarian situation in the oPt, delivered to journalists and humanitarian actors before the Israeli disengagement from the Gaza Strip in August; a UN poster for International Peace Day in September; and a joint fact sheet on poverty, with a special meal at an orphanage in the West Bank, on International Day against Poverty in October.

OCHA produced weekly humanitarian briefing notes, 12 humanitarian updates (monitoring access among other issues), 10 situation reports (on the West Bank and Gaza during disengagement), 12 Gaza access reports with the latest humanitarian information, analysis and maps (four of the West Bank, seven of Gaza and one of Hebron Old city) on pressing humanitarian issues. A Mid Year Review was launched in June 2005.

Performance evaluation

Operational coordination, as well as coordination among UN Agencies and other humanitarian groups, was greatly enhanced through linkages and relationships developed with the Palestinian Authority.

OCHA's reports, produced in three languages, were used and quoted by decision makers and the media, as well as by official and nongovernmental bodies in Israel, the oPt and internationally.

Coordination was enhanced through the incorporation of all humanitarian agencies in the CAP. Through its emergency projects, the CAP allowed a better and more appropriate response to humanitarian needs and enhanced targeting of vulnerable and needy groups.

Though access continued to be a key constraint in 2005 OCHA, through its policy development, advocacy and coordination efforts, managed to draw the attention of decision-makers and policy-makers to this, and to the deteriorating humanitarian situation that flowed from it. OCHA oPt is seen by local and international policymakers as an essential member of the humanitarian community and a reliable source of information and analysis. It is frequently consulted and called upon by donors and the wider humanitarian community for its information, services and advice.

occupied Palestinian territory Requirements, Income and Expenditure Breakdown

Requirements	2,588,423
Income from Voluntary Contributions	2,746,891
EXPENDITURE	
Staff Costs	1,598,941
Consultant Fees and Travel	29,990
Travel	57,217
Operating Expenses	198,324
Contractual Services	25,109
Supplies, Material, Furniture and Equipment	42,631
Fellowships, Grants and Contributions	1,711
Programme Support Costs	254,010
Total Expenditure US\$	2,207,933

Regional Office for the Middle East, North Africa, Iran and Afghanistan



The Regional Disaster Response Advisor (RDRA) Office in Dubai, United Arab Emirates, was established during the latter part of 2005. Noting the logistical advantage that Dubai provides as a support hub and the lack of an OCHA presence in the Middle East and North Africa region, it was decided to expand the role of the office from an RDRA to an official regional office, covering the Middle East, Iran and Afghanistan, and North Africa.

Given the increasing role and contribution made by the Islamic charities and aid organisations from the Arab-Islamic world to the humanitarian aid operations in various parts of the world (Indian Ocean tsunami, South Asia earthquake, Sudan, oPt, etc.), as well as the existing disconnect between them and the UN and other international humanitarian players, the objective is for the regional office in Dubai to ensure a more coordinated humanitarian response regionally and globally, as well as encourage these actors to increasingly work in a coordinated manner at the multilateral level. OCHA is also striving to provide a platform for discussion and interaction with organisations within the region in order to overcome suspicion and mistrust towards the UN and other international organisations that could be seen among certain humanitarian stakeholders, particularly following 9/11.

The region provides a diverse set of humanitarian challenges that underscore the need for enhanced OCHA attention and coordination support. Various countries and territories in the region continue to be affected by intricate political, religious and other socio-economic challenges resulting in conflict, insecurity, violent hostilities, terrorism or fragile post-conflict environments. Furthermore, the region is prone to serious natural and man-made disasters, including floods, landslides, earthquakes and droughts.

Key objectives

With the transformation of the RDRA Office into a Regional Office, the objectives and key priorities were expanded in 2005 to include, in conjunction with the originally envisaged RDRA activities, other humanitarian coordination support services. The expanded key objectives for 2005 were as follows:

- Improve capacity of national counterparts and the UN system in the region within the domains of natural disaster and emergency preparedness and response
- Strengthen humanitarian partnerships and networks in the MENAIA region
- Improve humanitarian decision-making and response through advocacy and information management

Activities

The Regional Office was established in August 2005, with its primary focus on practical matters relating to the technical and operational functions of the office, as well as the development of a new strategic direction and initial regional networking. The office quickly became fully functional and, in October, undertook an exploratory mission to Iran in order to obtain a more thorough understanding of the most pertinent humanitarian challenges there and the role of the OCHA presence in Tehran in that context.

Given the revised objectives with the expansion to a regional office and in view of the nascent character of the office, the primary focus was on the establishment of a regional humanitarian network, involving analytical groundwork, such as compiling country

profiles and steadily growing supportive activities in the region as required.

The RO also initiated the groundwork on disaster profiling, risk mapping and prioritisation on the basis of assessments of vulnerabilities and response capacities of various countries in the region. Initial interaction with humanitarian/disaster response players in the region revealed that many partners sought OCHA's guidance and support in capacity building, in order to become better organised internally and to strengthen coordination with the international humanitarian response system.

The RO also developed strong links with Red Crescent Societies in the region with a view to developing proposals for joint collaboration in various fields. The RO has, for example, worked intensively on financial tracking issues with the Qatar and UAE Red Crescent Societies, as well as on training and capacity building initiatives, disaster response and coordination.

In an effort to strengthen partnerships and networking with Islamic charities and aid organisations from the Arab/Muslim world, the RO participated in meetings with charitable organisations from the Gulf region (in Kuwait in September 2005, for example). That contributed to an improved identification of concerns among players in the region, as well as prospects for future collaboration between the UN system and Islamic charities and aid organisations.

The office also engaged in the development of detailed partnership profiles (for UAE, Saudi Arabia, Qatar and Kuwait) that map out 'who is who' within the humanitarian community and related domains in countries covered by the RO. These profiles will serve as a basis for further networking, external and donor relations. The office started to play an increasingly prominent role in terms of advice and liaison work on resource mobilisation in the Arab world, as well as related matters such as the need for improved financial tracking of donations in the region through OCHA's Financial Tracking Service (FTS).

The RO became increasingly involved in public information activities aimed at disseminating information on the work of OCHA and the wider UN system, as well as general humanitarian concerns, in a

region where OCHA's presence is limited. This entailed media contributions, among other things, but also participation in charitable and corporate responsibility events, as well as an active role as part of the Scientific Advisory Board of the Dubai International Humanitarian Aid and Development (DIHAD 2006). This is a conference and exhibition on international humanitarian assistance, organised for April 2006, which is to include an address by the USG/ERC.

Performance evaluation

Important progress was made during the initial phase in terms of creating vital links and substantive interaction with key humanitarian constituencies in the Arab/Muslim world, such as Islamic charities and Red Crescent organisations. In addition, the office contributed to enhancing knowledge of resource mobilisation within the region.

Since the main focus of the RO throughout the remaining few months of 2005 was on setting up the office and establishing a network in the region, the office was not in a position to fully provide support to national and UN counterparts with regard to contingency planning and preparedness activities. It is expected that this critical objective will be actively pursued in 2006.

**RO – Middle East, North Africa, Iran and Afghanistan
Requirements, Income and Expenditure Breakdown**

Requirements	376,408
Income from Voluntary Contributions	533,000
EXPENDITURE	
Staff Costs	148,635
Consultant Fees and Travel	17,915
Travel	49,213
Operating Expenses	31,805
Contractual Services	1,625
Supplies, Material, Furniture and Equipment	49,700
Fellowships, Grants and Contributions	-
Programme Support Costs	38,856
Total Expenditure us\$	337,749

ASIA



Democratic People's Republic of Korea



During the month of September, the Democratic People's Republic of Korea (DPRK) informed the S-G, OCHA, UN Agencies and the international community in Pyongyang that it would close all humanitarian programmes at the end of 2005, saying it would rather receive development assistance, both bilaterally and multilaterally. Furthermore, the government requested that NGOs terminate their operations in the DPRK. While the government had appreciated the efforts of the humanitarian community, it was of the view that the humanitarian situation had significantly improved. The September announcement followed the DPRK's decision not to have a CAP in 2005 and its request to OCHA to close down its office in Pyongyang at the end of 2005. Consequently, at the end of 2005, OCHA closed its office and the distribution of essential medicines and food commodities came largely to a halt. Most NGOs had also started to wind down their operations.

Although the humanitarian situation in the DPRK has improved since the mid and late 1990s, humanitarian assistance continued to play a vital role in safeguarding the well-being of millions of vulnerable persons. Despite an improved harvest in 2005, the food security situation continues to be precarious. The health infrastructure is poor and international organisations were the most important source for the supply of essential medicines. There is a genuine risk that the important gains in reversing the effects of malnutrition will be lost. Moreover,

the significant impact in reducing morbidity and mortality may be compromised.

Key objectives

- Continue to support the Humanitarian Coordinator (HC) in the coordination of humanitarian activities, in particular contingency planning, needs assessments, programme planning and implementation, and monitoring and evaluation
- Raise awareness of the application of human rights and humanitarian principles
- Strengthen the presence and capacity of international NGOs, including through the use of the OCHA NGO Funding Mechanism
- Strive to strengthen the DPRK's national capacity to deal with and mitigate natural disasters

Activities

OCHA continued its role as the secretariat for the HC during 2005, convening and participating in regular inter-agency and sector meetings. OCHA also acted as the central agency for receiving and disseminating information for the international community. OCHA continued to produce bi-monthly bulletins, which were distributed to a wide variety of agencies, partners, donors, embassies and academic institutions worldwide. OCHA's internet café was also fully utilised, and provided NGOs and other partners in Pyongyang with a means of accessing the internet on a daily basis. Due to technical difficulties, the humanitarian information website was closed during the year, though it remained open for historical viewing purposes.

OCHA, via the NGO Fund, supported nine different projects for five NGOs in 2005, covering a range of activities including quick impact emergency response projects, hospital rehabilitation, and support projects to orphanages and orthopaedic institutions.

OCHA worked closely with the Red Cross movement in attempting to address the ongoing issues of responding to natural disasters, and participated in assessments missions after summer floods.

A document entitled A Framework for International Cooperation was developed with the support of all international partners, and was initially endorsed by

the government. Following the government's decision not to participate in the CAP for 2005, this document was designed as a planning mechanism to ensure a coherent and strategic approach to humanitarian and development-orientated activities. At the government's request, the Framework document did not include any specific projects or monetary values. However, it did include a humanitarian analysis, sectoral chapters and an overview of operational constraints. Furthermore, OCHA mobilised partners to provide projects and funding requirements that, in turn, were submitted to donors upon request.

Regarding the mainstreaming of gender, which OCHA intended to pursue in 2005, the office again found little opportunity to introduce gender-related policies into the broader community, given the cultural background of DPRK, which is a traditionally male-dominated society.

Performance evaluation

OCHA continued to play a key role in the overall coordination mechanisms within the DPRK and fully supported the Humanitarian Coordinator (HC) in his activities in developing strategic policies and coordinated responses to the fluctuating operating environment during 2005. The Framework document was warmly welcomed and utilised by international partners and the donor community as the planning tool for activities in the DPRK.

During 2005, OCHA continued to emphasise the importance of principled humanitarian aid, including unconditional access for all partners. While acknowledging that the DPRK had "security concerns", OCHA incorporated many of the tenets of humanitarian advocacy in the Framework for International Cooperation document.

The NGO Funding Mechanism in DPRK, managed by OCHA, has been generously funded by the Swedish International Development Cooperation Agency (SIDA) for several years. The mechanism has provided a valuable tool in supporting international NGOs with emergency funds for quick impact projects; sponsoring new initiatives, feasibility studies and pilot projects; and developing capacity building programmes for DPRK institutions through training programmes. In 2005, nine projects were funded for five NGOs, compared to eight projects for six NGOs in 2004. Three international NGOs sought to

establish operations in DPRK in 2005. However, despite advocacy efforts by the RC/HC, OCHA and the donor community, the government would not grant permanent residency to the NGOs.

The lead agency in DPRK for natural disasters is the Federation of the Red Cross. OCHA worked closely in supporting its advocacy efforts during 2005. OCHA continued to suggest to the government that there were opportunities to be involved with INSARAG, and training opportunities for national colleagues to participate in UNDAC training. However, given the change in position by the government during the course of 2005, OCHA was not successful in engaging the government to participate.

Democratic People's Republic of Korea Requirements, Income and Expenditure Breakdown

Requirements	432,926
Income from Voluntary Contributions	266,930
EXPENDITURE	
Staff Costs	162,571
Consultant Fees and Travel	893
Travel	53,178
Operating Expenses	36,104
Contractual Services	2,758
Supplies, Material, Furniture and Equipment	10,090
Fellowships, Grants and Contributions	-
Programme Support Costs	34,527
Total Expenditure US\$	300,121

Indonesia



During 2005, the level of violent conflict across the country declined significantly, although sporadic security incidents continued to occur in Central Sulawesi and Maluku. In addition to providing direct relief assistance where critical needs persisted, most humanitarian partners enlarged the scope of their activities to longer-term development assistance in support of conflict-affected communities reaching self-sufficiency.

The humanitarian community in Indonesia was of the view that the situation had improved to the point where a consolidated appeal for humanitarian assistance would no longer be needed. With this positive change, it was planned that OCHA Indonesia would phase down its presence and hand over its coordination functions to the government and relevant agencies.

OCHA had planned to close its presence in Indonesia by June 2005. However, this changed after the massive earthquake and subsequent tsunami that hit countries along the Indian Ocean coast, including Aceh and North Sumatra, on 26 December 2004.

Key objectives

- Monitor the humanitarian situation in post-conflict and natural disaster-affected areas, and advocate for the remaining needs of the vulnerable

- Support the government and humanitarian organisations in developing contingency plans for areas likely to require humanitarian assistance in case of natural disasters
- Facilitate linkages between humanitarian and development programmes through facilitating relations between local authorities and development agencies

Activities

Based on a request by the Government of Indonesia, the United Nations, through OCHA, coordinated the international response to the tsunami. The HC and OCHA, supported by the UNCT, worked in close cooperation with the government, donors and NGOs. A much more complete report on tsunami-related activities in Indonesia, which were the main focus of the year, is included in Part IV of the report, while this section addresses the rest of the office's activities and accomplishments.

In light of the transition from emergency to recovery and reconstruction, and the need for strategic coherence across a broad range of multifaceted programmes and activities, the UN established the Office of the UN Coordination Recovery Coordinator for Aceh and Nias (UNORC) in mid-2005. Its overall priority is to support the government, specifically the Reconstruction and Rehabilitation Agency (BRR), as well as provincial and local governments, in implementing a comprehensive recovery and reconstruction programme. A Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) formalising the relationship between BRR and UNORC was signed on 30 November 2005.

In Maluku, Central Sulawesi, and Papua, OCHA continued to monitor developments, in close collaboration with local authorities and NGOs, to ensure that the remaining needs of conflict-affected communities were addressed, and that preparedness measures were in place to accommodate any conflict-related displacement.

In Central Sulawesi, particularly, OCHA provided capacity building support to the local authorities in order to effectively hand over coordination functions prior to OCHA's phasing out. Assistance included the development of a database on IDPs

and humanitarian assistance, including training on the maintenance of the database.

OCHA held extensive discussions with local authorities and UNDP upon exiting the province, so that the residual humanitarian needs and concerns would be addressed in the longer-term planning and recovery process. As a result, local authorities accepted full responsibility for maintaining the IDP database and for conducting regular coordination meetings with the international NGOs and UN Agencies active in the area.

The Indonesia office continued to manage the Emergency Response Fund (ERF) and the Humanitarian Response Fund (HRF) established with contributions from the governments of the United Kingdom and Australia. They were set up to provide emergency humanitarian assistance to conflict- and disaster-affected populations through international and national NGOs in Aceh, Maluku, Sulawesi, West Kalimantan and West Java. Five new projects were funded during 2005 in health, education, income generation, and water and sanitation, in order to meet life-saving needs as well as to help affected populations rebuild their lives.

In cooperation with UN Agencies, OCHA arranged several workshops during the year, including: a National Post-Tsunami Lessons Learned and Best Practices workshop in Jakarta, Regional Post-Tsunami Lessons Learned and Best Practices Workshop in Medan, North Sumatra, and UN-NGO-Donor Convergence. Training courses included a series of Emergency Management Training and Contingency Planning Exercises for facilitators and stakeholders at provincial and district level in West Sumatra Province.

Through the UN Technical Working Group on disaster preparedness and management, efforts were also made to build capacities at central and provincial levels, focused on areas especially prone to natural disasters.

OCHA supported the new Coalition for Disaster Management Legislative Reform, in coordination with donors, INGOs and UN Agencies. More than 50 seminars, workshops, media campaigns, lobbying sessions, hearings and other activities have taken place since the Coalition was formed in early March 2005. The Coalition was facilitated by the

Indonesian Society for Disaster Management (MPBI) and involved civil society, the Indonesian Red Cross, UN Agencies, international organisations and government ministries.

OCHA also participated in a series of preliminary hearings conducted by a Working Group of the House of Representatives to study the Indonesian Disaster Management Draft Bill, which was submitted to the government at the end of 2005.

Performance evaluation

Donors and humanitarian organisations' interest was maintained in the remaining humanitarian needs in post-conflict and natural disaster affected areas, particularly in areas where funding gaps exist.

Following the tsunami many NGOs had to fold their operations in post-conflict-affected areas, as donors allocated funds to Aceh. Every month OCHA hosted a donor, NGO and UN Agencies coordination meeting at which NGOs were able to present their work and where OCHA was able to highlight areas of concern, thus renewing the interest of the donor community.

Significant progress was made on the Indonesian Disaster Management Draft Bill, with input from OCHA among others.

Indonesia Requirements, Income and Expenditure Breakdown

Requirements	697,687
Income from Voluntary Contributions	-
EXPENDITURE	
Staff Costs	484,802
Consultant Fees and Travel	-
Travel	79,891
Operating Expenses	61,383
Contractual Services	17,970
Supplies, Material, Furniture and Equipment	9,121
Fellowships, Grants and Contributions	3,544
Programme Support Costs	83,091
Total Expenditure US\$	739,802

Islamic Republic of Iran



Iran is one of the world's most disaster-prone countries, with regular earthquakes, floods and droughts resulting in the loss of lives and prolonged population displacements. In February 2005, a major earthquake in Zarand province, eastern Iran, led to the loss of 600 lives, injuries to 1,500 people and some 32,000 persons adversely affected, in a region still recovering from the legacy of the Bam earthquake in 2003. The difficulty in ensuring disaster preparedness and management needs is further exacerbated by the rapid urbanisation of major cities.

Following the Bam earthquake, a small OCHA presence was established in Tehran to lend support to the Resident Coordinator's office and government counterparts on matters related to humanitarian coordination for natural disaster management and response. Although a relatively small operation (with three national staff), the Liaison Office is well established within the UNCT and has become the main interface between the government and the UN on coordination during a natural disaster situation. In addition, the Liaison Office has been working with OCHA headquarters in furthering advocacy activities as part of the Middle East Initiative.

Key objectives

- Provide leadership on humanitarian coordination in support of humanitarian partners and the Government of Iran in disaster preparedness and response
- Develop a coordinated disaster management policy to ensure assistance for vulnerable populations affected by disasters and emergencies, such as: responding proactively and quickly to emergencies as they arise in the region; mobilising, supporting and leading emergency response missions whenever required, as well as ensuring resource mobilisation; supporting inter-agency efforts to build UN capacity at the country level to manage disasters and emergencies; and increasing capacity for risk management and pre-disaster preparedness in Iran

Activities

The OCHA Liaison Office, together with government counterparts and the UNCT, has been working closely in order to ensure a smooth and coordinated response for natural disasters. In terms of strengthening the government's capacity in responding to natural hazards, a joint OCHA/UNEP mission was fielded to Iran in July 2005, examining best practices and common approaches in responding to environmental emergencies. The office also identified the lessons learned from previous disasters, which fed into the overall response system through workshops, advisory meetings, consultations, preparation of guidelines and manuals. The office was instrumental in establishing direct contact between government partners, national organisations and international partners on disaster management and response tools.

In support of the government and the UNCT, a key achievement of the Liaison Office was the preparation of the UN Disaster Management and Response Plan, which is regularly reviewed and updated, and is used as the reference for international assistance in the event that local resources are overwhelmed during a disaster situation. An arrangement was also agreed upon between the

Ministry of the Interior and the OCHA Liaison Office on conducting local and community level disaster awareness seminars and ensuring the efficient involvement of NGOs in disaster response.

Working closely with OCHA headquarters on advocacy issues and the promotion of international humanitarian action and principles, the Liaison Office has formed an effective partnership with the University of Tehran. A seminar was held with academics, scholars and students from Tehran University analysing the challenges of humanitarian assistance in the Middle East. A separate seminar was held with Islamic Clerics from the holy city of Qom to discuss the commonalities between the Islamic tradition of charity and international humanitarian assistance. Both seminars helped improve understanding of the international humanitarian community's activities in relation to emergency response.

The second anniversary of the Bam earthquake was commemorated as part of a workshop with the University of Tehran, as well as the introduction of Humanitarian Assistance Day (27 December). Agreement was reached to continue cooperation with the University of Tehran in 2006, while expanding the initiative to a regional level.

Performance evaluation

The OCHA Liaison Office successfully established itself as the main body providing coordination support to the RC and UNCT for natural disaster response and management, while increasing support for the UN Disaster Management Team. As such, the UNDMT mobilised in a timely and efficient manner in responding to emergencies. For instance, the UNCT's responses to the Zarand earthquake, Gleston floods and Qeshm earthquake were coordinated through the Liaison Office, in close collaboration with government officials, within 24 hours of the emergency. OCHA was also part of the Field Assessment Team evaluating the situation during the Zarand earthquake.

In forming common disaster management policies, the 10th Edition of the UN Disaster Management

and Response Plan was approved by the UNCT and government counterparts with OCHA's support.

As a result of continued liaison and support to government counterparts from the OCHA office and the UNCT, the quality of disaster-related reports and information provided by the government improved considerably in 2005. The number of government and civil society organisations in regular contact with UN Agencies and international organisations, and running projects in the field of Disaster Management and Risk Reduction, also increased.

A lessons-learned workshop held after the Zarand earthquake, facilitated through the Liaison Office, identified the need for more information management services at the field level to help coordinate the activities of relief agencies, as well as improved and timely reporting by agencies on their activities. These recommendations have been incorporated into the UN Disaster Management and Response Plan.

Islamic Republic of Iran Requirements, Income and Expenditure Breakdown

Requirements	328,984
Income from Voluntary Contributions	14,578
EXPENDITURE	
Staff Costs	52,074
Consultant Fees and Travel	-
Travel	14,176
Operating Expenses	31,182
Contractual Services	41,424
Supplies, Material, Furniture and Equipment	-
Fellowships, Grants and Contributions	5,000
Programme Support Costs	14,499
Total Expenditure US\$	158,355

Nepal



2005 was a turbulent year in Nepal. On 1 February, King Gyanendra dissolved the government of Prime Minister Deuba and assumed full executive control, clamping down on the freedom of political parties, the media and local human rights organisations. The death toll in the conflict between the Communist Party of Nepal/ Maoist (CPN/M) and the government rose to almost 13,000 despite a four-month CPN/M unilateral ceasefire.

Protection remained the primary humanitarian concern, with both parties to the conflict guilty of continued violations of International Humanitarian Law and threatening the lives of civilians, including health workers and teachers, leading to significant displacement and suffering among the general population. Assessments conducted during 2005 found alarming levels of malnutrition and a significant deterioration in the coping mechanisms of civilians in remote rural areas, coupled with reduced availability of basic services. Economic decline was tempered only by significant growth in remittances from overseas. Protection of humanitarian space remained challenging, despite the formal acceptance of the Basic Operating Guidelines by both parties to the conflict.

OCHA formally established an office in Kathmandu during the second half of 2005, with two sub-offices later opened in Nepalgunj and Biratnagar.

Key objectives

Given the expansion of the OCHA office over the second half of 2005 and strong donor support, the objectives were updated to:

- Provide a consolidated picture of needs and responses to humanitarian and development challenges in Nepal for active communication to partners
- Strengthen existing systems of coordination, decision-making and response for different sectors and target groups
- Increase protection to IDPs by developing a common IDP strategy together with the government, the international community and local NGOs
- Strengthen the UN's public information messaging with the development of a common UN public information strategy
- Improve UN planning for natural disaster response

Activities

OCHA supported the Humanitarian Coordinator, newly appointed in February 2005, to lead a number of inter-agency planning initiatives, including a Contingency Planning exercise and the development of a Common Humanitarian Action Plan, which formed the basis of the Consolidated Appeal (CAP) for the period October 2005 to December 2006. Work was also started on preparedness for disaster management, since the country is very prone to natural disasters.

OCHA facilitated a number of external and inter-agency assessment missions, including a joint mission for the Representative of the Secretary-General on the Human Rights of Internally Displaced Persons and the Head of the Inter-Agency Internal Displacement Division. The office started to conduct systematic assessments, often in partnership with other agencies, to gather information on the protection of civilians, emerging humanitarian needs and the operational environment for humanitarian organisations. The information gathered is now being disseminated to the growing international humanitarian community in Nepal, and being used for increased advocacy.

In partnership with the UNCT, OCHA was instrumental in securing formal recognition and acceptance of the Basic Operating Guidelines by the government and the CPN/M during 2005. Mechanisms were established to monitor and report on adherence to the guidelines, as well as other incidents affecting operational space for humanitarian /development assistance.

An Information Management Unit was established within the office, where a number of coordination tools were developed, including an 'Information Platform' website (www.un.org.np) housing a virtual library as well a WWW database. The UNCT benefited from the inputs of two short-term IDP advisors seconded to OCHA from the Norwegian Refugee Council during early 2005.

Performance evaluation

The information management tools and products developed by OCHA have been well received, with the Nepal Information Platform website regularly receiving several hundred hits per day. UN, donor, international and local NGOs assessments and activities were shared through this forum.

The 2005 CAP and contingency planning exercises were instrumental in bringing together a diverse array of actors to develop common sector-based strategies to address conflict-related needs for the first time. More effort will be required to ensure that general humanitarian and sector coordination forums sustain a collective momentum to bring together UN Agencies, donors, NGOs and the government around these issues on a more regular basis. While OCHA is fully funded, more efforts are needed to attract funds to other humanitarian programmes, which were only 26 percent funded.

IDP-related issues remained contentious. OCHA assisted agencies in clarifying UN Agencies' role in the application of the UN Guiding Principles on Internal Displacement in Nepal. The government continued efforts to develop a national IDP policy, which the UN reviewed and commented upon, with OCHA's input and support, in draft form, noting concerns about the proposed IDP definition. Local IASC plans to formally elaborate a common IDP strategy were postponed to 2006 to allow the

outcomes of a number of planned inter-agency assessments to inform it.

A common UN Public Information Strategy and Crisis Communication Plan for the UN system were developed, resulting in more coherent and common public information. OCHA also led preparations of a number of joint advocacy statements from the UNCT and Basic Operating Guidelines agreed by donors for humanitarian and development activities.

Due to the prevailing complex emergency situation in Nepal and the need to address the situation resulting from the deepening of the crisis, natural disasters preparedness could not be advanced as much as hoped. More work will have to be done on natural disasters preparedness with the government and partners, notably with the preparation of a contingency planning with different earthquake scenarios.

Nepal Requirements, Income and Expenditure Breakdown

Requirements	1,626,350
Income from Voluntary Contributions	1,785,334
EXPENDITURE	
Staff Costs	306,015
Consultant Fees and Travel	-
Travel	78,365
Operating Expenses	104,723
Contractual Services	18,000
Supplies, Material, Furniture and Equipment	281,640
Fellowships, Grants and Contributions	-
Programme Support Costs	102,537
Total Expenditure us\$	891,280

Regional Disaster Response Advisor for Asia



Key objectives

- Respond quickly and appropriately to disasters by leading or supporting UNDAC and other OCHA missions
- Support the inter-agency effort to build UN capacity at the country level to manage disasters in cooperation with RCs and UNCTs
- Build effective working relationships with national and regional partners in disaster management and provide assistance directly
- Continue to promote the integrated disaster risk management approach with key stakeholders in the region
- Follow up on initiatives proposed at the World Conference on Disaster Reduction

Activities

The RDRA in Kobe was deployed and took joint leadership of the UNDAC team in response to the Indian Ocean tsunami and South Asia earthquake, as well as supporting the RC/HC in Thailand. The office also took part in UNDAC missions to the Philippines and Mongolia, to assess the state of disaster preparedness in both countries, and formulated a series of recommendations for improvements ranging from policy review, managerial and technical improvements to operational procedures, including how to ensure a better integration between national and international relief response.

The office played an active role in preparing for and organising the World Conference on Disaster Reduction. The concept of Total Disaster Risk Management, a holistic approach to disaster risk reduction and response, promoted by the office with the Asian Disaster Reduction Centre (ADRC) and other regional partners, was incorporated in the HFA.

The office provided the Association of Southeast Asian Nations (ASEAN) Committee for Disaster Management (ACDM) with technical inputs to support regional activities on regional disaster management and emergency response. OCHA helping to link the ACDM to the existing international humanitarian response systems, such as the UNDAC and INSARAG.

The Indian Ocean tsunami saw the international community, governments in the region and military forces work together on the humanitarian response in an unprecedented way. The coming decade's disaster risk reduction strategy was formulated through the Hyogo Framework for Action (HFA) adopted by the World Conference on Disaster Reduction (WCDR) three weeks after the tsunami. The RDRA Kobe had been actively involved in preparing for the conference, and played an important role as the focal point in the region for following up on the HFA. Just as the world was about to shift its attention to the recovery and rehabilitation phase of the tsunami, the South Asia earthquake took place, with similar devastation but very different features. These major disasters provided a strategic impetus for the establishment and development of natural disaster preparedness schemes in the Asia and Pacific region.

OCHA in 2005 set out plans for the Regional Disaster Response Advisor for Asia. However, in early 2005, in response to the need for more comprehensive coverage of the region, OCHA established the Regional Office for Asia and the Pacific in Bangkok. As a result, the office of the RDRA Kobe focused its activities on East Asia, forming an integral part of the regional office in Bangkok.

Together with ADRC, the RDRA supported the Asian Disaster Reduction and Response Network (ADRRN), a network of disaster management NGOs in the region, in developing its website and organising workshops to strength the capacity of member NGOs. This involved them sharing their experiences of the tsunami response and exploring opportunities for joint activities in disaster-hit areas.

The office of the RDRA strengthened the ADRRN through its support and advice, and provided technical support to ACDM to promote a more integrated approach to response and response preparedness in the region.

Following up on the WCDR the office and other partners launched the International Recovery Platform (IRP), which aims to function as an international repository of knowledge and a clearing-house for recovery activities. The IRP focuses on mapping best practices and lessons learned on recovery processes following major natural disasters and to disseminating this knowledge to governments.

Performance evaluation

During the deployment of six UNDAC missions over four months in responding to the tsunami, RC/HCs and UNCTs benefited from the office's coordination activities and technical support. The RDRA was a key

resource in the region, leading the mission in Phuket, Thailand and coordinating disaster response as the interim head of the Regional Office in Bangkok.

Recommendations that emerged from the UNDAC Preparedness Missions to the Philippines and Mongolia helped identify how the governments, RCs and UNCTs can improve national disaster response capacity. The recommendations have been instrumental in clarifying priorities for improvement of existing national disaster management capacities and identifying how the UNCT and individual UN Agencies and donors can better support national efforts.

RDRA – Asia Requirements, Income and Expenditure Breakdown

Requirements	528,786
Income from Voluntary Contributions ^a	164,000
EXPENDITURE	
Staff Costs	139,720
Consultant Fees and Travel	-
Travel	64,137
Operating Expenses	15,957
Contractual Services	881
Supplies, Material, Furniture and Equipment	4,864
Fellowships, Grants and Contributions	4,000
Programme Support Costs	29,843
Total Expenditure US\$	259,402

^a Includes allocations from Field Coordination Reserve Fund for US\$ 25,000



Regional Disaster Response Advisor for the Pacific



The Pacific is one of the most disaster-prone regions of the world. Severe cyclones, floods, landslides and other natural disasters affect the region every year. Although the region is highly diverse, it is characterised by physical isolation, a high degree of dependence on external support to meet people's basic needs, ongoing governance challenges and a growing HIV/AIDS problem. The effects of climate change, especially a rise in sea level, are also of concern.

In February and March 2005, the Cook Islands and Tokelau were affected by five cyclones in close succession, with Cyclone Percy causing the greatest damage. While there was no loss of life, these cyclones had a devastating impact on infrastructure and agriculture. During the year, floods also affected Fiji and Papua New Guinea. Volcanic eruptions occurred in Vanuatu and Papua New Guinea, resulting in population displacement.

The office of the RDRA for the Pacific, located in Suva, Fiji, provides support to the 15 independent Pacific Island Countries (PICs) in natural disaster management and response preparedness. The office works at three levels: assisting National Disaster Management Offices (NDMO) in capacity building and in coordinating disaster response; supporting RCs

and UNCTs in the region; and supporting the broader humanitarian community by providing a systematic flow of information and acting as the UN focal point for disaster preparedness and response.

Key objectives

- Support RCs, UNCTs and NDMOs in their response to disasters in the region
- Provide the broader international community with a systematic flow of information
- Contribute to improving countries' preparedness and emergency response coordination

Activities

In March 2005, the office supported the deployment of two UNDAC teams to the Cook Islands and Tokelau in response to Cyclone Percy. The teams undertook rapid assessment, supported coordination mechanisms and ensured that priority needs were communicated to governments and the international community. The team also helped initiate the preparation of a National Recovery Plan for the Cook Islands and reviewed the existing National Disaster Plan.

In March, the office undertook an assessment of the humanitarian situation on Manam Island, Papua New Guinea, after a series of volcanic eruptions that displaced approximately 10,000 people. After an assessment of the IDP Care Centres and stakeholder consultations, a Plan of Action was presented to the government and UN Agencies. A follow-up mission articulated possible longer-term solutions.

OCHA worked closely with regional organisations to improve the quality and coordination of capacity building support provided to governments through the Pacific Emergency Management Training Advisory Group (PEMTAG), a valuable first step toward a wider collaboration in enhanced response capacity of the region, which will encourage systematic exchange of information on capacity building.

Work on the development of a Catalogue of Disaster Response Profiles was restarted late in 2005 with an expanded group of partners including OCHA, UNDP, IFRC and the South Pacific Applied Geoscience Commission (SOPAC). A detailed project document was agreed upon to guide the development of the database, which will encompass not only disaster response information but also data relating to disaster risk reduction and recovery.

The office of the RDRA continued to promote greater levels of coordination for preparedness and response activities through meetings of Disaster Focal Points of UN Agencies and NDMOs.

During 2005, the office undertook two series of consultations aimed at reviewing its role in the region and recommending future action. In June, a mission visited Papua New Guinea, Fiji, Australia and New Zealand to get feedback from governments, regional organisations, UN Agencies, RCs and donors. Another mission in December focused on strengthening the UNDAC system in the Pacific. These missions recommended an expanded OCHA presence in both Fiji and Papua New Guinea. A new RDRA and a humanitarian affairs officer for Fiji were identified in late 2005. The Australian Youth Ambassador scheme also deployed an assistant programme officer in November 2005.

Performance evaluation

The OCHA missions that took place in 2005 found that the work of the RDRA on disaster management and preparedness was not well integrated with that of the UNCTs in the region because a coherent approach in response/response preparedness was not in place, resulting in separate programme planning. Strong linkages with governmental and regional organisations were also lacking. OCHA has taken steps to strengthen its presence in the region by strengthening the office of the RDRA in Fiji and fielding a staff member to support the RC in Papua New Guinea.

The governments and UNCTs in Samoa and Fiji appreciated the support provided by the RDRA in relation to the strengthening of UNDMTs to

take charge of response and response preparedness activities. The support of the UNDAC teams in the Cook Islands and Tokelau after Cyclone Percy, supported by the office, was also valued.

Progress on the Catalogue of Disaster Response Profiles was interrupted due to the departure of the RDRA in May 2005. A revised project document was agreed to in late 2005 with joint implementation to begin in early 2006.

RDRA – Pacific Requirements, Income and Expenditure Breakdown

Requirements	419,917
Income from Voluntary Contributions	382,368
EXPENDITURE	
Staff Costs	131,953
Consultant Fees and Travel	208
Travel	57,387
Operating Expenses	30,315
Contractual Services	685
Supplies, Material, Furniture and Equipment	5,070
Fellowships, Grants and Contributions	-
Programme Support Costs	29,330
Total Expenditure US\$	254,948

Regional Office for Asia and the Pacific



More than half of the world's natural disasters occurred in the Asia and Pacific region during the past decade, making it the most disaster-prone region in the world. While countries in this region have developed disaster management capacities at varying levels, many remain vulnerable and at risk due to rapid urbanisation, unregulated land use and environmental degradation. This became particularly obvious in the aftermath of the Indian Ocean tsunami in December 2004. In addition, there are serious humanitarian concerns and preparedness needs that arise from existing and emerging complex emergencies in the region.

OCHA in 2005 set out the agenda for the Regional Disaster Response Advisor for South Asia. In response to the need for more comprehensive coverage of the region and following the Indian Ocean tsunami OCHA established the Regional Office for Asia and the Pacific (ROAP) in Bangkok in early 2005. As of 2006, the office covers 37 countries in the region and provides support to the RDRA in Suva and OCHA's presence in Papua New Guinea, as well as assisting the RDRA's office in Kobe, which is a constituent element of the regional office. The regional office assists in determining requirements and responds with targeted technical assistance and surge capacity to support governments, RC/HCs and UNCTs. The ROAP also works closely with OCHA's field offices in Indonesia, Nepal, the Maldives, Pakistan and Sri Lanka.

Key objectives

- Strengthen UN system coordination and capacity to respond to humanitarian requirements, including vulnerable groups affected by complex emergencies, by supporting RC/HCs, UNCTs and OCHA offices
- Facilitate disaster response preparedness and management at the national level by providing technical advice and by mobilising regional and international support
- Promote regional cooperation among governments and international organisations to enhance disaster management and emergency response capacities

Activities

In May 2005 the ROAP supported country-level lessons-learned workshops relating to the Asian tsunami response in Indonesia, the Maldives, Sri Lanka and Thailand. Participants came from national governments and the humanitarian community. A regional workshop was subsequently organised to share these experiences among countries affected by the tsunami. ROAP also contributed to the tsunami response by providing a Public Information Officer to support the RC/HC and UNCT in Thailand. The office represented OCHA management at regional events organised to coordinate tsunami response and recovery.

The regional office supported UNDAC missions and reinforced OCHA field office capacity by deploying staff following the earthquakes in Nias, Indonesia and Pakistan. The office participated in UNDAC missions in Mongolia and the Philippines to enhance national response preparedness, and supported contingency planning exercises related to both natural and conflict related threats in Bangladesh, Laos, Nepal and Papua New Guinea. These missions identified gaps in the inter-agency preparedness and response mechanisms of UNCTs and governments. Advisory support and coordination was provided to UNRC offices in Laos, Myanmar and Thailand. ROAP worked closely with the Early Warning Unit and the Papua New Guinea UNCT in order to generate an early warning country analysis and develop documents on potential scenarios and preventive action entry points.

ROAP played an active part in needs assessments of disaster response coordination via UNDAC deployments in the region. The office assisted RC/HCs

and UNCTs with inter-agency contingency planning exercises related to natural disasters and conflict-induced vulnerabilities to assess and enhance response preparedness. ROAP provided capacity that was otherwise unavailable at the country level.

The regional office provided specific training for UNDP Deputy Resident Representatives on disaster response and strengthened UNDMTs in the region.

Between August and November, the regional office participated in joint inter-agency missions for avian influenza preparedness planning in Thailand, Vietnam, Cambodia and Lao PDR. It was agreed that ROAP would support the Regional Coordinator of the Office of the UN System Influenza Coordinator (UNSIC) in 2006. ROAP was actively involved, in cooperation with UN partners, in preparing national contingency plans on Avian and Human Influenza in three high-risk countries (Cambodia, Laos and VietNam).

The regional office's Information Management Unit undertook data-preparedness and mapping projects in the Maldives and Vanuatu, and conducted an evaluation of the HIC in Sri Lanka. The deployment of IMU staff to Pakistan was instrumental in establishing the HIC there in response to the South Asia earthquake. The IMU also participated in conferences and training workshops hosted by bilateral partners in the region, and held initial discussions with key agencies of the Thai government.

ROAP established technical resources, software and equipment to support a range of information management activities, including spatial analysis, mapping and printing. A data preparedness strategy intended to support early warning, contingency planning and rapid response is now being used to support missions to RC/HCs in the region. Improved information management has aided decision-making in the region and at headquarters by ensuring a comprehensive overview and effectively prioritising information.

The regional office also deployed IMU staff to establish and maintain the post-earthquake HIC in Pakistan.

The office was a key supporter of the Asian Disaster Reduction and Response Network (ADRRN) of NGOs by functioning as advisor to the ADRRN board and facilitating training in areas such as humanitarian principles, good governance, advocacy and transparency.

ROAP provided training for the military on humanitarian principles and the roles and

responsibilities of UN humanitarian agencies in Singapore, and participated in the regional 'Cobra Gold' military exercise in Thailand.

Performance evaluation

The regional office became fully operational during 2005 in support of UNCTs and OCHA field offices in the region. ROAP tested its surge capacity by fielding staff twice in 2005 to Pakistan and Indonesia, when regional office staff added value by bringing additional skills and experience, and by providing a bridge between in-country and regional structures. The office demonstrated its flexibility and its ability to provide essential support without disrupting its own operations.

The office undertook UNDAC preparedness missions in the Philippines and Mongolia to strengthen national capacity for disaster management. As a result, governments have adopted recommendations for priority actions including a closer integration of international response in national contingency planning, the need for standardised operating procedures and a clear line of command and responsibilities in disaster preparedness and response situations.

The regional office developed an informal network of technical partners in GIS and information management to collaborate on joint projects, providing access to otherwise unavailable data and an overview of regional capacity.

ROAP initiated formal introductions with Thai government ministries and regional donors, which served as a model for greater collaboration with governments and organisations region-wide.

RO – Asia and the Pacific Requirements, Income and Expenditure Breakdown

Requirements	804,687
Income from Voluntary Contributions	1,057,500
EXPENDITURE	
Staff Costs	497,810
Consultant Fees and Travel	4,242
Travel	34,688
Operating Expenses	51,054
Contractual Services	1,500
Supplies, Material, Furniture and Equipment	100,049
Fellowships, Grants and Contributions	-
Programme Support Costs	89,615
Total Expenditure US\$	778,958

EUROPE



Russian Federation



The main challenge for OCHA in the Russian Federation in 2005 was to create, together with humanitarian and development partners, a new framework for coordinated, strategic planning to fit the changing circumstances in Chechnya and its neighbouring republics. The humanitarian community entered the year determined to do more toward recovery assistance to address the root causes of vulnerability. The Russian government further requested that the 2005 CAP be the last, although it continued to welcome humanitarian assistance from the UN and NGOs. OCHA has offices in Moscow and Nazran, Ingushetia. The common interest of the humanitarian community and the government was to build, on the basis of established humanitarian coordination mechanisms, a broader, more flexible assistance framework.

The humanitarian situation in the North Caucasus, especially Chechnya, remained serious in 2005 despite some improvement on early 2004. What became increasingly apparent was that socioeconomic factors as well as human security problems were among the major causes of vulnerability. Therefore, the aims of the UN were broadened in 2005 to meeting humanitarian needs (which continued into 2006), while promoting and supporting domestic reconstruction and development activities in the North Caucasus.

Key objectives

- Improve humanitarian access and protection of civilians in the North Caucasus
- Strengthen humanitarian relief and emergency support
- Enhance information analysis and management linking humanitarian assistance to sustainable recovery and the rebuilding of livelihoods

Activities

OCHA continued to support effective humanitarian action through its facilitation of coordination meetings, advocacy and information sharing with all partners. The most important accomplishments in 2005 relate to humanitarian access, transitional planning, and capacity building in information management.

OCHA lobbied with UNDSS in favour of a Phase 4 designation for most of Chechnya in order to introduce UN staff presence in the republic and give adequate humanitarian coverage of the most vulnerable population. This advocacy and the inter-agency plan to eventually deploy UN staff, first local and eventually international, in Chechnya were consistent with the findings of a December 2004 Security Assessment Mission and the position of the UN Security Management Team. Access to vulnerable populations in neighbouring republics was unproblematic.

OCHA sponsored, organised and led a Protection of Civilians workshop in March 2005 in Nazran. It drew on expertise from OCHA and UNHCR headquarters, and enabled a lively and productive discussion of the key protection challenges among UN Agencies, NGOs, ICRC, the Russian government at federal and republic levels, and the diplomatic/ donor community.

Establishing a new Information Management Unit in OCHA, the Russian Federation helped OCHA to build new tools for coordination, assessment, service delivery and evaluation in the humanitarian operation, including a needs assessment library, WWW database, planning maps, etc.

OCHA took a central role in transitional programming, facilitating the dialogue between

traditional humanitarian partners and those more concerned with reconstruction/ development. In the spring, the HC led, jointly with the Russian government, a comprehensive all-stakeholders assessment of humanitarian need and review of the CAP. At the request of the Humanitarian Coordinator and UN Resident Coordinator, OCHA served as the “think tank” and secretariat for conceiving and producing the 2006 Inter-Agency Transitional Workplan for the North Caucasus.

Performance evaluation

The most important accomplishments in 2005 relate to humanitarian access, transitional planning, and capacity building in information management. Access to vulnerable populations in the North Caucasus improved in 2005, although not as much as was desired by OCHA and its humanitarian partners. Chechnya remained at UN Security Phase 5 throughout the year, yet the number of UN day missions into Chechnya climbed to a total of 99 in 2005, compared with 70 in 2004 and 26 in 2003. Besides leading missions in to Chechnya, OCHA managed the monthly planning for all UN missions into Chechnya, and thus helped realise this significant increase in access.

The protection of civilians workshop organised and led by OCHA gave inputs to the evolving Protection Strategy for the North Caucasus, including identification of potential partnerships for projects to strengthen local protection capacity.

Through the addition of information-management tools/skills, but also through effective coordination, the advances in information management began to produce results in terms of more nuanced needs assessment. Further, modifications to coordination mechanisms in Moscow and the North Caucasus increased participation by all partners. NGOs gained a stronger voice when eight of them formed a consortium, which was invited by the Humanitarian Coordinator to join an IASC field team. Development agencies and government bodies became active parties to planning and material relief.

A strengthened North Caucasus sub-office allowed for deploying staff to Chechnya as soon as security clearance is given.

The information unit was not as productive as anticipated in 2005, but continued to produce monthly inter-agency situation reports and press packets, as well as assistance coverage maps and other information products. The unit will convene, and be the core of, an inter-agency Information Management Cell in 2006.

The process of developing an integrated humanitarian-recovery framework to replace the CAP stimulated development agencies and potential donors to take action. Republic-level governments in the North Caucasus engaged with the UN, NGOs, ICRC and donors on their recovery priorities. The Transitional Workplan, launched in December, set forth an US\$ 88 million integrated programme for relief and recovery, to be conducted by nine UN Agencies and 13 NGOs.

Russian Federation Requirements, Income and Expenditure Breakdown

Requirements	1,645,993
Income from Voluntary Contributions	1,492,250
EXPENDITURE	
Staff Costs	570,290
Consultant Fees and Travel	9,357
Travel	74,237
Operating Expenses	151,848
Contractual Services	27,000
Supplies, Material, Furniture and Equipment	65,562
Fellowships, Grants and Contributions	10,147
Programme Support Costs	118,097
Total Expenditure us\$	1,026,538



AMERICAS AND THE CARIBBEAN



COLOMBIA



The level of violence and the number of people displaced was reduced during 2005, according to government reports, but the situation in Colombia was still characterised by internal armed conflict, with continuing attacks by the illegal armed groups against the civilian population, planting of anti-personnel mines and attacks on infrastructure. At the same time, the process of demobilising paramilitary forces led to differing positions among members of the international and humanitarian community.

During 2005, the key humanitarian concerns focused on the situation of a large number of communities at risk as a result of violent conflict and 2,271 children officially demobilised by illegal armed groups or connected with urban militias. The government and humanitarian community made significant progress in addressing the basic needs of vulnerable populations, but greater efforts are needed to resolve the humanitarian crisis in Colombia, particularly in prevention and finding long-lasting solutions to the violence.

In 2005, OCHA strengthened its presence in the country by extending its presence beyond Bogotá, establishing three regional sub-offices and three satellite antennas to offer enhanced humanitarian coordination throughout the country and support the protection of civilians through greater presence and engagement.

Key objectives

- Strengthen overall coordination within the UN system in support of humanitarian partners and increase the availability of humanitarian information through the Humanitarian Situation Room
- Ensure a more coordinated response by all partners to the humanitarian crisis, including preparedness for the possibility of a major natural disaster
- Improve the coordination capacity of the office of the Humanitarian Coordinator (HC) for a coordinated and adequate response to humanitarian crises and natural disasters

Activities

In 2005, OCHA played a central role in supporting the HC and the humanitarian community by providing information products and promoting information sharing through the Humanitarian Situation Room. The office also maintained and expanded a centralised WWW database on some 2,000 humanitarian projects and 2,500 organisations to support the overall coordination process and avoid duplications in the humanitarian response. The Humanitarian Situation Room also provided a mapping service on the changing status of affected populations, delivering 86 such maps to facilitate planning and preparedness process within humanitarian actors.

OCHA identified gaps and humanitarian needs through the coordination of 24 inter-institutional needs assessment missions (with local ombudsman offices, UN Agencies, NGOs and local authorities) in 20 areas directly affected by the conflict. These resulted in increased visibility of the Colombian conflict, as well as addressing protection issues and more efficient humanitarian response.

In 2005, in order to strengthen its counterparts' coordination capacities, OCHA organised two workshops on Effective Mechanisms for Humanitarian Coordination and Individual Risk Reduction, in Quibdó and in Florencia, in association with UNDSS and AECI and with the participation of UNIFEM. A total of 60 organisations participated.

The office assisted in the elaboration of contingency plans destined to increase local capacities in mitigating natural disasters. OCHA also collaborated with local authorities and the Colombian Red Cross on the elaboration of a contingency plan for local action

supporting approximately 8,000 people in Pasto, Nariño and neighbouring communities in light of volcanic activity at Galeras Volcano. The plan will be used in the event of a major emergency, such as a massive eruption of the volcano.

OCHA also designed a strategy to provide its local counterparts with effective tools for coordination (in relation to preparedness, needs assessments and rights-based community planning) through thematic training modules among its key partners in the field.

The office carried out substantive coordination work, particularly focused on promoting the rights of IDPs and vulnerable populations, strengthening existing coordination mechanisms, and encouraging cooperation between the different humanitarian actors in Colombia - UN Agencies, national and local government entities, national and international NGOs, and civil society.

After floods in Girón, Santander, OCHA played an important role in the identification of critical needs (shelter, water and sanitation) of some 12,000 affected people and worked with local authorities to find sustainable and durable solutions such as the diffusion of the WHO basic module for health and shelter.

The office strove to improve the working conditions of its staff by fully equipping its office in Bogotá and the regional sub-offices, including with communications equipment, with support from OCHA's Information and Communications Technology project. The expanded presence of OCHA in seven of the most important cities in Colombia allowed the opening of multi-agency regional coordination spaces among the humanitarian community and the strengthening of alliances with different state bodies.

OCHA presence in the field facilitated needs assessments for 24 communities and approximately 120,000 beneficiaries at risk and, through local advocacy activities, the implementation of an integrated response in line with the Colombian legal framework.

OCHA regional sub-offices supported the establishment of four contingency plans to address protection issues targeting approximately 200,000 beneficiaries from indigenous and Afro-Colombian communities.

Performance evaluation

OCHA made an increased amount of humanitarian information available through the Humanitarian Situation Room (HSR), increased advocacy for vulnerable populations and improved humanitarian coordination mechanisms through the Humanitarian Coordinator (HC). Pertinent humanitarian information was disseminated among humanitarian partners mainly through a local web page (www.colombiassh.org), increasing the visibility of the humanitarian crisis in Colombia, supporting the identification of gaps and providing the basis for an enhanced humanitarian response.

OCHA's coordination and risk reduction training provided counterparts with practical tools which allowed a better understanding of the overall coordination process, including planning and preparedness, within a gender- and community rights-based approach. The participants considered training activity as fundamental to their efforts to better focus their humanitarian activities in Colombia.

The office supported the reactivation of the thematic working group on IDPs led by UNHCR, which held two meetings at the end of the year, as well as a more efficient coordination structure at the department (local) level.

Through the adoption of the Humanitarian Action Plan II, after two years of negotiations facilitated and coordinated by OCHA Colombia, the government started implementing approximately 80 projects for approximately one million beneficiaries in critical areas of the country.

Colombia Requirements, Income and Expenditure Breakdown

Requirements	2,797,691
Income from Voluntary Contributions	1,512,390
EXPENDITURE	
Staff Costs	1,102,840
Consultant Fees and Travel	-
Travel	84,800
Operating Expenses	287,114
Contractual Services	4,234
Supplies, Material, Furniture and Equipment	372,602
Fellowships, Grants and Contributions	19,500
Programme Support Costs	243,242
Total Expenditure US\$	2,114,332

Haiti



In 2005, the political and social situation in Haiti was extremely volatile, with elections initially scheduled for November 2005. Kidnappings throughout the capital Port-Au-Prince and in some other areas of the country were a continuous threat, with illegal armed groups imposing their law in several slums like Cité Soleil. During the year, Haiti was particularly affected by two major hurricanes, Dennis and Alpha, with the southern regions of Grande-Anse and Artibonite worst affected.

The growing number of expulsions of Haitians living illegally in neighbouring Dominican Republic has become an increasingly serious humanitarian and human rights issue. A total of 20,700 people were repatriated to Haiti in 2005. This escalating repatriation has already negatively affected the political, social and economic relationship between the two countries.

In June 2004, the Humanitarian/Development Unit of MINUSTAH, the UN Stabilisation Mission in Haiti, was given the responsibility to assist the HC. OCHA's role was to support information management, and it was initially represented by a liaison officer. In September 2005, it added an information management officer.

Key objective

- Ensure that humanitarian actors, at operational and strategic levels, have access to information management tools to assess, plan, deliver, coordinate and monitor humanitarian assistance in Haiti

Activities

OCHA's information unit only really started its activities late in the year, after the deployment of the information management officer. Once it was up and running, situation reports were prepared regularly and disseminated to all actors concerned. A total of 10 humanitarian situation reports were issued. Four separate situation reports were issued after Hurricanes Alpha and Dennis.

A website portal was designed for the Haiti Humanitarian Information Network and continuously updated after its launch in October 2005. The website averages 210 hits per day, with the document centre section the area most visited. Partnerships were established with WFP and UNDP for information sharing. Meeting calendars, WWW lists and contact lists were among the improved information products designed and made available to the humanitarian community. They were posted online on HaHIN website and distributed to the humanitarian community during the bi-weekly forum humanitaire.

After the arrival of the OCHA liaison officer in May 2005, fortnightly coordination meetings were held with all international humanitarian actors. At least 15 such coordination meetings were held before the year's end. OCHA contributed substantially to the coordination of humanitarian assistance in response to two major floods during the year. It participated in needs assessment missions, compiled sectoral and need reports and produced situation reports, thereby informing the international community of urgent needs. OCHA also started producing user-friendly maps for better presentation of situation reports and summaries of affected areas in Haiti.

Performance evaluation

In 2005 OCHA decided to open an independent Humanitarian Information Unit. Since its inception, it has struggled with lack of funds and personnel but, later in the year, increased the flow of humanitarian information and baseline data to and from humanitarian actors. In doing so, it paved the way for a reduction in the duplication of interventions and increased awareness of the humanitarian situation at any given time among stakeholders. It contributed to the availability of timely and comprehensive data, and helped the humanitarian community to provide a rapid, relevant and coordinated response to recurring humanitarian situations.

The Haiti Humanitarian Information Network (www.hahin.org) a portal offering access to a wide range of information products, including those developed by the OCHA Information Unit, is used and appreciated by the humanitarian community, including donors. These products have allowed donors and other humanitarian actors to obtain vital information on different humanitarian partners operating in Haiti, their activities and programme locations. The Humanitarian Information Network was greatly appreciated by all humanitarian partners as an improved coordination tool, particularly in a country lacking adequate humanitarian database management.

The improved humanitarian information system helped collect and disseminate conclusions and recommendations from several humanitarian coordination meetings and fora, involving national authorities, UN Agencies and NGOs in several départements and cities, including Port-au-Prince, Gonaives, Cap-Haitien and Grande-Anse.

The Humanitarian Coordination Forum continued to be convened by OCHA to ensure information dissemination and coordinate humanitarian assistance activities. The forum was regularly attended by some 50 institutions, including MINUSTAH, NGOs, donors, UN Agencies and

national authorities, as a useful means to share information; plan programmes; review food security, health and nutrition, water and sanitation, education, shelter and logistics; and address protection and gender issues.

A partnership with WFP and UNDP Haiti made some progress in establishing standards in data collection and sharing destined to develop the quality and quantity of relevant humanitarian information available.

Haiti Requirements, Income and Expenditure Breakdown

Requirements	563,879
Income from Voluntary Contributions ^a	443,980
EXPENDITURE	
Staff Costs	283,409
Consultant Fees and Travel	6,560
Travel	12,104
Operating Expenses	95,660
Contractual Services	9,036
Supplies, Material, Furniture and Equipment	39,700
Fellowships, Grants and Contributions	-
Programme Support Costs	58,041
Total Expenditure US\$	504,510

^a Includes allocations from Field Coordination Reserve Fund for US\$ 230,000

Regional Office for Latin America and the Caribbean



The Latin America and Caribbean region covers over 20 million square kilometres of landmass in the western hemisphere and is home to over 500 million people. Throughout its history, it has suffered a series of catastrophes caused by natural disasters. In addition, despite over 20 years of democratic governments, many Latin American countries are increasingly facing potential crises due to profound inequality, extreme poverty, economic stagnation and the growing impact of the Colombian conflict in neighbouring countries. The 2005 hurricane season was the most intense in recorded history, with 27 named storms. Fifteen of those became hurricanes, which were directly responsible for over 3,000 deaths, affected more than six million people and caused over US\$ 133 billion in economic losses.

The number of disaster management organisations in the region and the high level of public awareness can sometimes lead to an overestimation of the current state of preparedness, response and mitigation capacity. In fact, commitments by national governments to fulfil their obligations vary from country to country and, given the multiplicity of actors, capacities and protocols at different levels, emergency coordination becomes very complex. One of the main functions of the OCHA Regional Office is to strengthen coordination mechanisms by leading

the IASC Regional Task Force for Risk, Emergency and Disasters in Latin America and Caribbean (RED-LAC). Members of this group include UN Agencies, donors and NGO regional offices working in disaster preparedness and response.

Key objectives

- Improve planning, monitoring and accountability in emergencies and transition contexts
- Strengthen systems for the provision of timely and quality information in support of humanitarian decision-making and response
- Help establish, update and revise the United Nations Disaster Management Team (UNDMT), the United Nations Emergency Technical Team (UNETE) and national disaster response agencies
- Improve regional inter-agency partnerships (RED-LAC)
- Ensure that the United Nations Disaster Assessment and Coordination (UNDAC) system is operational in the region

Activities

During 2005 the regional office worked at two levels: with regional offices of humanitarian institutions based in Panama and, at the national level, with national emergency management authorities, UNCTs and other key humanitarian partners. Preparedness for response has been identified as one of the priority issues in the region. At the national level, four workshops were carried out to enhance the countries' planning processes in the event of a natural disaster. The methodology used provided an efficient and simple Inter-Agency Emergency Response Plan Matrix that helped determine responsibilities and appropriate coordination mechanisms within the UN system and with national authorities and partners.

OCHA's team developed new means of strengthening information sharing and coordination among all the organisations and agencies during the busy hurricane season. In this context, a Humanitarian Information Management workshop for Latin America and the Caribbean was held in Panama in August, organised by ReliefWeb and the Advocacy and Information

Management Branch, in coordination with the regional office. Public information and information management surge support was provided by headquarters in support to hurricane preparedness. This support resulted in the development of a regional information management strategy.

In June 2005, the regional office supported Jan Egeland, Under-Secretary-General for Humanitarian Affairs and Emergency Relief Coordinator, during his mission to Havana, Cuba, for the 10th Meeting of the Association of Caribbean States Special Committee on Natural Disasters. The office also supported the organisation of a special two-day workshop, which resulted in the formulation of Lines of Action to be considered as guidelines by the Caribbean governments, the UN and other regional/international partners to enhance preparedness and response for the 2005 hurricane season.

The office supported RED-LAC. The main activities carried out by this group in 2005 included 10 meetings held during and after emergency situations caused by the hurricanes in Central America and the Caribbean, as well as joint missions for the development of preparedness workshops in Guyana, Venezuela, Mexico and Jamaica.

The regional office was directly involved in four UNDAC missions deployed to Guatemala, Guyana, El Salvador and Nicaragua. In the latter case, the UNDAC team was pre-deployed in preparation for the potential effects of the rapidly approaching Hurricane Beta.

Performance evaluation

Four emergency preparedness workshops were successfully completed in the region with the participation of the RDRA, who was accompanied by at least one representative of the regional UN Agency offices (WFP, UNJLC, UNICEF, UNDP/Bureau for Crisis Prevention and Recovery). These included the establishment, under the umbrella of the UNDMT, of UN Emergency Technical Teams tasked with the formulation of inter-agency contingency plans. One capacity-building workshop could not be completed due to the severe hurricane season in 2005.

OCHA staff monitored hurricane activities in the region, collected country information from various

sources and produced Country Situation Sheets and Daily Field Situation Reports. These were updated on a daily basis and disseminated among RED-LAC members, donors and other actors in the region to support decision-making regarding priority relief activities. The reports also served as the basis for the formulation of OCHA situation reports at headquarters level.

Standard materials for conducting contingency planning workshops were developed. Among the results of RED-LAC meetings were a new mechanism of preparedness, including a “kit” with documents prepared by OCHA to facilitate the formalities required when requesting assistance. By leading the RED-LAC, the regional office was able to create a platform for the exchange of information, and develop actions for the optimisation of natural disaster preparedness and response in the region.

The regional office acted as an efficient interface between the UNDAC system and regional/national organisations for the four UNDAC missions that took place in 2005 by establishing the necessary links and ensuring close collaboration. This helped improve the effectiveness of the UNDAC system.

RO – Latin America and the Caribbean Requirements, Income and Expenditure Breakdown

Requirements	983,694
Income from Voluntary Contributions ^a	555,000
EXPENDITURE	
Staff Costs	267,595
Consultant Fees and Travel	27,025
Travel	52,173
Operating Expenses	74,054
Contractual Services	20,251
Supplies, Material, Furniture and Equipment	92,186
Fellowships, Grants and Contributions	2,000
Programme Support Costs	69,587
Total Expenditure US\$	604,871

^a Includes allocations from Field Coordination Reserve Fund for US\$ 280,000

PART IV

SUDDEN-ONSET DISASTER COORDINATION ACTIVITIES



OCHA/IRIN

INDIAN OCEAN TSUNAMI

In the early hours of the morning of Sunday 26 December 2004, a massive earthquake measuring 9.0 on the Richter scale struck the west coast of northern Indonesia, followed by aftershocks ranging from 6 to 7.3. The epicentre was some 30 km under the seabed and 250 kilometres south-southwest of Banda Aceh. The quake triggered a large tsunami that surged across the Indian Ocean, damaging coastlines of the west coast of northern Sumatra, Thailand, Myanmar and Sri Lanka, the east coast of India, the Maldives, and the east coast of Africa, notably in the Seychelles and Somalia.

Approximately 240,000 people across 12 countries were killed in the disaster, with children comprising one-third of the victims in some parts. In many affected areas, three times as many women were killed as men; in some communities it was more than half. The tsunami flooded coastal areas and wiped away homes and buildings, roads and bridges, water and electricity supplies, crops, irrigation and fishery infrastructure, food and fuel networks. In Indonesia, Somalia and Sri Lanka the disaster took place within the context of long-standing complex crises. The earthquake and tsunami predominantly affected poor coastal communities, destroying critical infrastructure and basic services.

The response to the tsunami challenged OCHA as never before, calling on the entire Office. Experienced

OCHA staff members were quickly deployed to the affected areas to coordinate the various humanitarian actors, and headquarters staffing levels were immediately reinforced to provide maximum support to the response efforts. In Geneva, OCHA established a Tsunami Task Force, which involved all relevant sections within the Office.

Anticipating the magnitude of the operation required, the Secretary-General immediately appointed the Deputy Emergency Relief Coordinator, Margareta Wahlström, as the Special Coordinator for Humanitarian Assistance to Tsunami-affected Communities, to provide leadership and support to United Nations Country Teams and, particularly, to facilitate the delivery of international assistance through high-level consultations with the governments of the affected countries. The appointment of the DERC reinforced OCHA's role as the main focal point for inter-agency coordination.

Five UNDAC teams comprising 44 disaster-response experts from 18 countries and four international organisations were deployed to five of the tsunami-affected countries. Sixteen UN Agencies, 18 IFRC response teams, more than 160 international NGOs and countless private companies and civil society groups deployed to affected areas to provide emergency food, water and medical services to an estimated five million people in need of assistance.

Trust Fund for Tsunami Disaster Relief* (US\$)

Summary	TOTAL
1 Opening balance	-
2 Adjustments	-
3 Income	72,696,230
4 Transfers, refunds, savings	-
5 Other funds available	1,360,596
6 Total funds available	74,056,826
7 Expenditure	16,805,869
8 Allocations to UN Agencies	46,335,059
9 Closing balance	10,915,898 ^a

a Includes mandatory operating reserves of US\$ 1,393,653

* All figures subject to audit

- 1 The opening balance reflects the situation of each Trust Fund as of 1 January 2005
- 2 Includes adjustments to prior period income and expenditure
- 3 Includes contributions from donors for the year 2005
- 4 Includes transfers between Trust Funds, refunds to donors and savings on prior period obligations
- 5 Consists of interest and miscellaneous income and exchange adjustments for the year 2005
- 6 Consists of the opening balance and income (addition of 1+2+3+4+5)
- 7 Includes disbursements and unliquidated obligations as of 31 December 2005
- 8 Consists of allocations provided to UN Agencies for implementation of tsunami projects
- 9 Includes operating cash reserves and fund balances as of 31 December 2005

Allocations to UN Agencies (US\$)

AGENCY	TOTAL
UNDP	20,913,675
FAO	4,900,111
UNHCR	3,823,174
IOM	3,200,000
UNFPA	2,636,759
WFP	2,548,400
WHO	2,432,940
UNDP Thailand	2,000,000
UNEP Trust Funds	1,338,780
ILO	1,256,380
UNESCO	704,840
UNIDO	350,000
WHO/HQ - UNAIDS	150,000
UNOSAT (UNOPS)	80,000
TOTAL	46,335,059

OCHA deployed 74 international staff in total, spread over four countries, to cope with the enormity of the coordination challenge, and had 14 new central and sub-offices at the peak of the crisis.

Two Humanitarian Information Centres (HIC) were deployed to Sumatra and Sri Lanka to assist in the significant information management challenge created by the massive scale of the destruction, the influx of humanitarian, military and government personnel, and the degraded communications infrastructure in the affected areas. HIC generic products were provided quickly, enabling the humanitarian community to gain a broader understanding of the dimensions of the crisis and the response.

Except in Indonesia, where the Humanitarian Coordinator position was already established, OCHA quickly appointed as HCs the existing Resident Coordinators in the affected countries to ensure that their efforts received the full backing and support of the international humanitarian community.

During the course of 2005, OCHA either decreased its presence in countries where the immediate needs were met, or advocated for an integrated office concept. As the focus of the response operation shifted to recovery and reconstruction, OCHA increasingly merged its staff and functions into the office of the RC/HC. This occurred in the Maldives at the end of 2005 and the integration process is continuing in Indonesia and Sri Lanka.

As the disaster generated an unprecedented display of public and private solidarity, OCHA worked to channel funds in a coordinated and transparent manner. OCHA's Financial Tracking Service played a central role in monitoring financial flows and funding status, thus allowing advocacy for underfunded projects and organisations. To ensure the highest standards of accountability and transparency, OCHA both developed a new partnership with a private sector accounting firm, PricewaterhouseCoopers, which lent vital support to ensure that OCHA was able to effectively monitor the disbursement of funds, and instituted real-time, online financial tracking.

During this period, OCHA continued to provide guidance to donors on humanitarian priorities and, during February, OCHA and the Geneva-based Task Force proposed a mechanism to channel unearmarked contributions received from donors to the tsunami operation, which was endorsed by the IASC Tsunami Task Force. The amounts made available to UNCTs and the HCs in Indonesia, Sri Lanka, Maldives, Thailand, Seychelles and Somalia were calculated on a proportional basis of their unmet Flash Appeal requirements. Clear

Trust Fund for Tsunami Disaster Relief Donor Contributions in 2005 (US\$)

SOURCE OF CONTRIBUTION	TOTAL
United Kingdom	20,593,870
Greece	12,742,000
Nigeria	6,000,000
Norway	5,307,569
Japan	4,900,000
Mexico	3,452,146
Qatar	3,000,000
New Zealand	2,094,900
Trinidad and Tobago	1,991,340
Private Donors	1,510,657
Ireland	1,307,190
Azerbaijan	1,000,000
ECHO	975,610
Denmark	914,159
France	913,326
Switzerland	840,407
Canada	797,385
Australia	756,500
China	500,000
Germany	400,000
United States of America	391,369
France	250,000
Spain	250,000
Turkey	250,000
Republic of Slovakia	234,080
Equatorial Guinea	204,975
Mali	199,700
Senegal	198,560
Lithuania	137,540
Liberia	133,537
Monaco	130,656
Israel	100,000
Netherlands	93,000
Palau	53,326
East Timor	50,000
Baha'i International Community	20,000
Jamaica	2,139
Colombia	289
TOTAL	72,696,230

project selection criteria were defined by each UNCT, and agencies and projects benefiting from 100 percent funding or more were not eligible for funding. There was also a grant component for regional projects. A total of US\$ 50 million was allocated to 49 projects from 13 partner organisations.

Overall, the United Nations estimates that a total of US\$ 6.8 billion was pledged to the tsunami effort, including US\$ 5.8 billion from government sources and US\$ 1 billion (35 percent) from corporate and private donations. These figures represent the amounts reported through the Financial Tracking Service (FTS) of the CAP; the actual amount is much higher, but as it comes from

Statement of Income and Expenditure in 2005

Trust Fund for Tsunami Disaster Relief (US\$)

COORDINATION ACTIVITIES	Original Requirements	Revised Requirements	Opening Balance	Contributions	Other Income, Transfers, Savings and Adjustments	Expenditure	Closing Balance
Trust Fund for Tsunami Disaster Relief							
Indonesia	5,789,621	6,156,904	-	6,298,150	187	5,388,268	910,069
HIC Sumatra	1,354,611	1,491,816	-	1,187,028	-	1,077,540	109,488
Sri Lanka	1,793,360	2,864,169	-	2,589,677	(1,712)	1,892,705	695,260
HIC Sri Lanka	1,310,580	1,380,270	-	1,461,385	(3,295)	1,084,142	373,948
Thailand	2,454,030	1,704,676	-	1,240,000	238	899,500	340,738
Maldives	1,006,089	837,524	-	704,655	125	603,421	101,359
Somalia	230,073	376,428	-	271,369	-	106,923	164,446
Headquarters	4,505,526	5,642,787	-	4,689,332	411	2,743,377	1,946,366
Unallocated Unearmarked Funds for Field Offices and Headquarters	-	-	-	1,772,281	1,364,642	-	3,136,923
Total Field and Headquarters	18,443,890	20,454,574	-	20,213,877	1,360,596	13,795,876	7,778,597
Humanitarian Response/ Intervention Funds for Somalia	-	-	-	2,620,686	-	1,679,555	941,131
Other Grants	-	-	-	126,800	-	66,755	60,045
Allocations to UN Agencies	-	-	-	47,701,782	-	47,598,742 ^{b c}	103,040
Unearmarked Funds for Grants and Allocations ^a	-	-	-	2,033,085	-	-	2,033,085
Total Field, Headquarters, Grants and Allocations	18,443,890	20,454,574	-	72,696,230	1,360,596	63,140,928	10,915,898

a Funds totalling US\$ 2,000,000 have been committed in 2006 for allocation to UN Agencies

b Amounts allocated to UN Agencies which are reflected in the UN Financial Statement as Advances are shown as Expenditure to reflect the available closing balance

c Includes allocations to UN Agencies of US\$ 46,335,059 and other expenditure of US\$ 1,366,723

donations not reported through the FTS, it is not represented above. One estimate puts the total amount pledged at US\$ 14 billion.

OCHA supported the establishment of UNDP's Development Assistance Databases (DAD) implemented in Indonesia, Maldives, Sri Lanka, Thailand and at the regional level. DADs were set up at the governments' request, to support them in enhancing aid coordination capacity for recovery and reconstruction. The DADs provide detailed accountability on funds received and programmed and have led to a more transparent system of providing expenditure information. In each country, the work is led by the nodal government agency, supported by the UNDP Country Offices and the UN. In Indonesia, the HIC played a significant role in supporting the roll-out of the DAD in support of the government.

Indonesia

Though OCHA offices already existed in Jakarta and Aceh, further deployments to support the in-country team were made by 28 December 2004, where OCHA spearheaded coordination on the ground in Aceh by immediately setting up coordination mechanisms with

local government, the military and humanitarian actors. Within a week, it had established a HIC and soon after deployed a Deputy Humanitarian Coordinator to lead the response. On 6 January 2005, the UN launched a Flash Appeal for the tsunami, with an initial requirement of approximately US\$ 373 million for Indonesia (Aceh).

On 26 March, the Government of Indonesia declared an end to the emergency operation phase, but a strong earthquake followed on 28 March, devastating Nias and Simeulue islands. UN Agencies responded immediately by temporarily diverting some resources from the ongoing tsunami response. OCHA deployed coordination and information management staff to both Nias and Simeulue within 12 hours of the earthquake to assist in setting up local emergency response coordination. Over 130,000 people were killed as a result of the initial tsunami and the earthquake of 28 March, with 35,000 more missing and approximately 550,000 internally displaced.

A joint UNDP/UNDG/OCHA mission in June 2005 recommended strengthening the UN's coordination role in line with the Secretary-General's reform proposals, and the Office of UN Recovery Coordinator for Aceh

and Nias (UNORC) was established. To ensure strong leadership and coherent system-wide response to the transition, UNORC and Indonesia's Reconstruction and Rehabilitation Agency (BRR) signed a Memorandum of Understanding on 30 November, formalising the relationship between the two.

OCHA's key objectives in Indonesia were: to ensure the humanitarian needs of the tsunami-affected populations were met and their concerns addressed within the longer-term recovery/reconstruction process; to assist government institutions and civil society actors at targeted strategic sites to maintain and strengthen the coordination of activities, monitor humanitarian needs and effectively respond to those affected; ensure that the coordination of all stakeholders was successfully transferred to relevant government institutions and UN Agencies; and ensure that the identified humanitarian needs of tsunami-affected populations were met during the first half of 2005, and that the transition towards full recovery was accelerated.

Activities

OCHA (and later UNORC) provided support to the HC in Jakarta and the Deputy Humanitarian Coordinator (and later UN Recovery Coordinator for Aceh and Nias) in Banda Aceh for coordination of the tsunami response and the post-tsunami recovery, as well as for public information and advocacy through deployment of surge staff. Coordination mechanisms were established in Banda Aceh, including creation of the UN Team, a local IASC meeting, convening of a Donor Round Table, weekly Open Humanitarian Briefings, and Sector Heads and sectoral working groups. OCHA/UNORC also supported coordination of the Humanitarian Common Services.

OCHA also established field offices in Meulaboh, Calang, Medan and Nias to strengthen coordination at the local level. Where a lead agency was not present, UNORC took the lead.

In June OCHA and IFRC initiated a temporary shelter working group to address the emerging problems and bottlenecks in this sector. Together with partners, it launched the Temporary Shelter Plan of Action to replace tents and other types of ad hoc shelters, and to repair and upgrade water and sanitation facilities. HIC Sumatra/UNMIS was able to immediately develop and disseminate a range of standard information products and later produced the Tsunami Recovery Status Report.

To assess gaps in the response to the immediate humanitarian needs of IDPs in various settlements, OCHA initiated a Transitional Settlement Monitoring

Mechanism (TSMM) in July. Gaps were matched with resources through the monthly Humanitarian Action Fora (HAF) held in each of the affected districts of the province. HIC Sumatra provided support survey design, database and GIS support for this project, the data collection element of which was undertaken by the Norwegian Refugee Council.

In recognition of the unmet needs in Nias, UNORC increased capacity there with the deployment of two humanitarian affairs officers in September, as well as UNMIS GIS officers. The team strengthened sectoral as well as sub-district coordination, and consolidated baseline data and progress updates and information.

In response to the need for a comprehensive disaster management law, and risk reduction and preparedness strategy, OCHA Jakarta, with partners, supported the Coalition for Disaster Management Legislative Reform, through a number of seminars, media campaigns and advocacy efforts throughout the year. OCHA Jakarta coordinated the UN technical working group on disaster risk reduction by rolling out an emergency management training and contingency planning exercise in West Sumatra in collaboration with BAKORNAS PBP, the national coordinating agency for disaster management and refugees/IDPs, which took place in September.

Performance evaluation

Through sustained interaction with the government and the humanitarian community, the humanitarian needs of affected populations were kept on the agenda during the early recovery and continuing transitional periods.

However, the TEC found that, given the sheer number of actors (over 500 NGOs at one point), coordination was very difficult and not effective. The competition among actors on the ground, in particular competition for "clients" or affected populations, and the lack of incentive to coordinate since funds were abundant, led to duplication and confusion. In addition, actors focused on what was easily reachable, resulting in oversupply in Banda Aceh but undersupply in other areas such as Nias. Diverting resources to respond to the evolving immediate needs of IDPs was also a challenge, since some partners did not participate in the coordination mechanisms.

OCHA field presence was strengthened to provide support and coordination at the local level through the opening of offices in Aceh, Nias, Meulaboh, Calang and Simeleue. Sustained dialogue with local authorities and NGOs facilitated the resolution of overlaps and gaps.

Information for planning and monitoring was collected by the HIC in its humanitarian common service role and shared with the humanitarian/recovery community. The challenge lay in ensuring the quality and accuracy of the data. The sheer number of actors involved, with pressure to deliver quickly, posed a challenge in generating a culture of information sharing.

The continued need to support the transitional coordination through UNORC required OCHA to maintain staff throughout 2005. The hand-over of OCHA's coordination function in the field to governmental authorities and civil society actors, initially planned for mid-2005, was amended to a gradual phase-down from the end of 2005.

Phasing into full swing recovery and reconstruction has taken longer than anticipated, due to the scale of devastation, logistical challenges, limited availability of materials and continuing displacement and movement of survivors, as well as the fact that reconstruction had to take place from "ground zero" in many affected areas. Compelling humanitarian needs still persist.

Maldives

OCHA Maldives, consisting of a small team of up to three people established in early January 2005, worked throughout the year in support of the RC/HC and UNCT in the aftermath of the tsunami. Beside its usual coordination functions, OCHA worked in partnership with the Managing Internally Displaced Persons (MIDP) Unit of the National Disaster Management Centre to respond to priorities, while supporting this newly-formed ministerial department.

Throughout the course of 2005, OCHA supported the RC/HC with coordination, advocacy, financial tracking and resource mobilisation, information management and advice on IDP issues. In addition to supporting these fundamental coordination mechanisms, OCHA supported the RC/HC Office and the UNCT on national disaster response and in the formulation of a medium-term transition/recovery strategy. The OCHA team worked diligently with UNICEF and UNFPA to ensure that IDP issues were fully addressed. It funded the registration of IDPs, the design of a database to manage IDP statistics, and the funding and training of three IDP Desk Officer positions.

The OCHA team established 15 IDP committees in the worst affected atolls, involving approximately 340 people from IDP and host communities. In addition, it established a Training of Trainers programme for all

IDP committee members, with an emphasis on ensuring the appropriate use of Sphere standards for IDP shelters.

The OCHA office produced reports, analyses and recommendations, and advocated for critical policy considerations by MIDP, government ministries, the UN and other national and international partners. It engaged with Red Cross/Crescent Societies and the Care Society in IDP camp support activities, launching a pilot camp management service in Laamu Gan in October 2005.

OCHA Maldives also improved information flows on the humanitarian situation, including commissioning a TV documentary on IDP issues for TV Maldives for local broadcast in December 2005 and encouraging the production of monthly programmes for TV Maldives on shelter, water and sanitation, disaster management and reproductive health issues.

OCHA progressively withdrew international staff during 2005, while building the capacity of national staff with the intent of merging the OCHA functions into an integrated office under the leadership of the RC/HC. This happened successfully by the end of 2005, when OCHA closed its office in the Maldives.

Myanmar

In the days following the tsunami, the relief community in Myanmar sent urgent emergency support to affected communities, with the distribution of food and non-food items to cover identified needs. This included food, water, health, shelter materials and sanitation relief to some 6,000 affected people.

In parallel to these emergency first-phase distributions, a series of assessment and verification missions were undertaken in the 10 days after the tsunami by humanitarian partners already working in Myanmar. Assessment missions went to the Rakhine Coast and the Ayeyarwady Delta on the southern coast (including the most populated islands of the Myeik archipelago and the islands off Kawthaung around Lampi Island) to determine the immediate impact of the tsunami. This first round of assessments was followed by joint evaluation missions aimed at assessing mid- to longer-term needs.

Tsunami damage was limited in Myanmar by comparison with other countries in the region. Relief agencies were able to provide swift assistance precisely because the number of victims was not overwhelming and basic stocks were available locally. Funds already made available by various donors and the agencies themselves after the onset of the disaster were sufficient to cover recovery activities until the end of 2005.

In addition to initial support provided by the Government of Myanmar, relief agencies carried out assistance in accordance with the planning outlined in the Indian Ocean Flash Appeal. The number of directly affected people identified by early assessments remained unchanged. Approximately 6,000 people were in need of emergency assistance. Priority needs were food and non-food items including clothing, essential drugs and drinking water. Epidemiological surveillance was also conducted. By the end of January 2005, acute food and non-food items needs were generally met and no major outbreak of disease was reported.

During the latter half of 2005, the tsunami response in Myanmar focused on medium- to longer-term needs. Shelter and infrastructure rehabilitation activities were implemented, including on water and sanitation systems, sometimes coupled with food for work support. Other programmes included support to education (supplies and school furniture) and child protection, as well as a generalised focus on malaria-reducing activities in affected townships. Organisations and agencies already involved in livelihood support, including the fishing industry, scaled up their activities to respond to the new needs.

In Myanmar, the emergency response to the tsunami disaster revealed a lack of disaster preparedness and inherent complications linked to coordination between international partners and national authorities. A lessons-learned exercise was undertaken to identify opportunities for a more efficient response in the future.

Seychelles

In the aftermath of the tsunami, the OCHA Regional Office for Southern Africa (ROSA) contacted the RCs' offices in the Comoros, Madagascar, Mozambique, Mauritius and Seychelles, as well as relevant IASC partners in the region, with a view to assessing the impact of the tsunami in the southwestern part of the Indian Ocean. Based on a request from the Government of the Seychelles to the SG's office, OCHA facilitated an UNDAC mission from 3 to 11 January 2005.

In the Seychelles, about 500 families were displaced as a result of the destruction of many buildings and public infrastructure. The livelihoods of more than a thousand people were affected due to the loss of assets such as fishing boats and equipment. While the government took the lead in terms of relief efforts, additional resources from the international community were required. Five projects for the Seychelles, totalling US\$ 11.6 million, were included in the Flash Appeal for the Indian Ocean Earthquake-Tsunami. The projects focused on the provision of shelter, non-food items

and livelihood support, as well as the rehabilitation of infrastructure and the development of early warning systems. Over US\$ 4.5 million was received in support of these projects.

Additional assessments determined that the number of affected dwellings was 500 rather than 100. Immediate needs were actually addressed by the government and the Seychelles Red Cross Society with their own resources during the first few months. UN expenditure was essentially linked to infrastructure rehabilitation and reconstruction. Because of the nature of UN interventions, that remained low for most of the year.

ROSA provided support to the RC, based in Mauritius, to monitor and report on progress achieved against the Common Humanitarian Action Plan for the Seychelles in the Flash Appeal. UN Agencies carried out assessment and project formulation missions to the Seychelles to ensure the resources requested were commensurate with the scale of actual needs in the country. These missions provided technical details and costs estimates to prepare project proposals for: rehabilitation of essential infrastructure; rehabilitation/reconstruction of private dwellings, schools and utilities; establishment of the early warning and disaster management system; and, rehabilitation of livelihoods in the fisheries/agricultural sector.

In March, the regional office undertook a joint mission with UNDP/BCPR to assess the need for capacity building in the areas of disaster management and early warning. As a follow-up to this mission, ROSA collaborated with UNDP/BCPR to develop a comprehensive early warning and disaster management system, which is due to be implemented in late 2006.

Somalia

In Somalia, the tsunami struck just as a drought was coming to an end and livelihoods were beginning to recover from multiple shocks such as flash floods, freezing rain and environmental degradation. The tsunami affected large parts of the coast, particularly a stretch of 650 km of coastline in the Puntland region, from Hafun in the north to Garacad further south. The tsunami resulted in the death or disappearance of 289 people, destruction of infrastructure, contamination of water sources, and the loss of livelihood assets. Some 44,000 people required emergency humanitarian assistance, including drinking water, food and medication, as well as support for the reconstruction or rehabilitation of houses and shelter. The damage caused to the fishing industry, which is the main income-generating activity of coastal communities, was significant.

OCHA, along with other UN Agencies and NGOs, created a humanitarian action plan in order to respond effectively to the urgent humanitarian and recovery needs of the tsunami-affected communities, focusing on 10 projects providing shelter and non-food items, security, livelihood support, food and healthcare.

Two funds, the Humanitarian Response Fund (HRF) and Emergency Humanitarian Intervention Fund (EHIF), were established to provide for quick and flexible emergency actions. In 2005, nine projects were supported through these funding mechanisms, for projects ranged from water trucking for tsunami-affected residents in Puntland to emergency mental health services for rural areas of northeastern Somalia. A psychosocial project helped 25,000 people to cope with the effects of a series of disasters that had affected their region and resulted in economic impoverishment, displacement, harsh living conditions and increased insecurity.

Humanitarian access was of major concern in the tsunami-affected coastline because of the rugged terrain and underdeveloped road networks in the area. The HRF supported two Cash for Work road rehabilitation works to improve access, provide income opportunities and help boost the local economy in the longer term.

Water sources contaminated by the tsunami waves that washed over wells were rehabilitated and benefited 34,236 people. In addition, 4,000 displaced households from fishing and pastoralists communities were given water through trucking. A pilot project for energy source diversification supplied solar cookers to 950 households and thereby addressed environment degradation issues.

Projects funded under the HRF were designed to provide assistance to all the tsunami-affected populations to meet their immediate needs, such as water, access, counselling and environment protection. In addition to meeting the needs of the population in the Puntland region, some of these projects facilitated the expansion of humanitarian access more generally.

Sri Lanka

Before the tsunami, the effects of two decades of conflict continued to disrupt the daily lives of hundreds of thousands of Sri Lankans languishing in IDP camps in the north and east. After the tsunami, which devastated two thirds of the coastline, killing over 31,000 people and nullifying livelihoods in a matter of seconds, existing vulnerabilities and inequalities were exacerbated for both poor and conflict-stricken coastal communities.

OCHA began operations in Sri Lanka shortly after the tsunami struck with the arrival of the UNDAC on

27 December 2004. An initial assessment was carried out to define the short-term financial, material and human resources needed to effectively aid the Sri Lankan government and its people. The HIC was deployed in early January 2005.

In response to the tsunami, OCHA Sri Lanka acted as the secretariat to the RC/HC and assisted the work of the Office of the UN Secretary General's Special Envoy for Tsunami Recovery, former US President Bill Clinton, including during missions by the Special Envoy and Deputy Envoy to Sri Lanka. In 2005, OCHA staff were located in Colombo, in field offices in Kilinochchi, Trincomalee, Batticaloa, Ampara and Galle, and in two temporary sub-offices in Matara and Hambantota, to support coordination at the district level.

OCHA's key objectives during the response in Sri Lanka were to: ensure effective coordination of humanitarian action and a smooth transition from relief to recovery; strengthen information management and public information and advocacy for humanitarian needs, in conjunction with the HIC, and introduce effective tracking and monitoring of needs and response; improve the level of understanding of, and capacity to conduct, contingency planning, and support disaster preparedness planning; facilitate/coordinate UN contributions to Government of Sri Lanka efforts to establish a solid foundation and speed up the transition from relief to recovery; foster the application of humanitarian principles and advocacy where required, and support the UNCT in developing a communications strategy.

Activities

OCHA, as an element of its secretariat support to the RC/HC, helped develop common priorities, shared goals, agreed strategies and coherent responses among all actors to support the relief and recovery effort. Such assistance included identifying the overall cost for the tsunami response; conducting public information activities through the deployment of surge staff and later regular staff; securing temporary housing and shelter for some 500,000 people; providing food, water, sanitation, clothing and medical attention; and working to return the population to a sense of normalcy as soon as possible.

Several assessments were conducted on a sectoral basis, including a stock-taking exercise in March 2005, facilitated by the HIC, which included an assessment of achievements and gaps that needed to be filled. This led to practical actions, such as the Care and Maintenance Workshop in September to ensure minimum standards by agencies for some 53,000 shelters housing over 250,000 tsunami displaced persons during the transition phase.

The Mid-Term Review of the Flash Appeal, which extended the timeframe until the end of 2005, was incorporated into the two-year UN Post-Tsunami Recovery and Reconstruction (UN Transitional) Strategy, running from December 2004 to December 2006. The document focused on: ensuring physical security by upholding human rights and the provision of shelter; the recovery of livelihoods through employment programmes, vocational training and loans or grant provision; ensuring that basic needs are met through the provision of essential services (health, food, education, etc); and building response capacity and disaster preparedness procedures. Overall, the strategy is a tool to realign resources to current priority projects, and raise funds for underfunded and new activities.

Performance evaluation

The launch of the Flash Appeal in January served as the principal funding request vehicle. OCHA strengthened the coordination structure by convening meetings with all partners, which discussed and mapped out response activities and addressed issues of common concern.

OCHA played a pivotal role in the development of the Transitional Strategy which led to the Tsunami Working Group initiative, an operational platform to monitor and address gaps in tsunami response and related matters.

OCHA's field presence continually provided much-needed support at the district and divisional level. However, OCHA's performance at the district level was not fully effective due to the deployment of junior staff without enough back-up or equipment in many places. While some of these staff performed well beyond their expectations, the overall picture as recorded by the TEC is one of a lack of OCHA effectiveness at district level. This was in part due to the lack of conviction by the UNCT of the need to deploy coordination officers to the districts. In future, OCHA needs to ensure that experienced people are also sent to coordinate and provide value-added at the decentralised level.

Underlying all activities in 2005 was the attempt to be attuned to both the government's priorities and initiatives, and to those of tsunami-affected communities. This included informing the communities of their benefits and being a conduit to share their views and aspirations regarding the restoration of their lives and livelihoods.

The establishment of the HIC provided a vital lifeline in coordination, communications and information exchange. The HIC supported the establishment of the Donor Assistance Database (DAD), launched in early September, which is the Sri Lankan government's principal database for financial and other information related to tsunami relief and recovery. The HIC

improved access to information as well as stakeholders by developing a shared understanding of needs and responsibilities. Through regular mapping and monitoring activities, clearer information products were developed, which resulted in a more coordinated approach to information.

The Transitional Shelter Site Tracking Project (TSST), which surveyed the locations and quality of temporary shelters and was used to identify future shelter sites, was much appreciated by all partners.

Streamlining communication to develop a "one voice" message was addressed through the establishment of the Media Working Group and consolidating the existing UN Communications Group. OCHA and the HIC also ensured that all humanitarian actors worked towards strengthening communication capacities at the district and local levels, to ensure that tsunami-affected communities – and, particularly, displaced communities – are kept abreast of development plans and play an integral role in decision-making.

Key challenges in implementing the UN's Post-Tsunami Recovery and Reconstruction strategy included: addressing persistent or unmet humanitarian needs; highlighting identified, emerging and/or unresolved issues and problems; ensuring transparency and accountability; promoting equity; and ensuring better communications with affected populations.

Thailand

OCHA headquarters in Geneva responded swiftly and decisively to immediate humanitarian needs in the aftermath of the tsunami, deploying an UNDAC mission within 72 hours of the disaster. Over a three week period, the UNDAC team provided an informal clearing house function for international partners, undertook initial needs assessments and provided daily status reports. OCHA provided critical guidance to the UNCT, supporting the HC in setting up a Disaster Management Team, bringing together the heads of UNCT agencies to coordinate support, and helping to ensure the appropriate use of Military and Civil Defence Assets (MCDA) in response to the tsunami, as well as the proper involvement of regional MCDA providers in the strengthening of response preparedness. The coordination of MCDA is a key role for OCHA. OCHA resources should be strengthened in this area and UN-CMCoord officers should be deployed as early as the UNDAC team.

The OCHA Regional Office for Asia and the Pacific (ROAP), established in early 2005, facilitated transition and early recovery activities during the course of the

year. The office supported the RC/HC with tsunami-related coordination, including UNDMT meetings, UNDAF preparation and liaison with the DERC, Deputy Special Envoy, UNDGO and regional RC/HCs.

Although ROAP was not set up to support the tsunami, it nevertheless played a very strong supporting role. The regional workshops organised by ROAP were widely praised and appreciated by national actors in the countries where they were held.

ROAP also seconded a Public Information Officer to the RC/HC Office to support the UNCT with tsunami response; established an Inter-agency Communication Officers Working Group; researched and wrote situation reports, compiled briefings, presentations and talking points for the RC/HC; wrote press releases and engaged with local and international media; organised the visit of the UN Messenger of Peace; redesigned and relaunched the UNCT tsunami web page; and coordinated production of the UNCT tsunami anniversary report.

The regional office carried out a UNCT financial tracking exercise for tsunami projects; organised a series of lessons learned workshops in four tsunami-affected countries (Thailand, Sri Lanka, Maldives and Indonesia) and a regional event in Indonesia; organised two workshops for regional field office representatives to share tsunami-related information, experiences and carry out planning activities; and participated in two

key post-tsunami media-training events: the Asia-Pacific Journalism Centre regional videoconference on reconstruction and accountability and the ISDR/ABU workshop in Bangkok.

In addition, ROAP worked to strengthen civil-military cooperation for disaster preparedness and response by participating in workshops and training sessions in India, Japan, and Thailand; organised a familiarisation visit to OCHA Geneva for the Thai Ministry of Foreign Affairs aid management agency (TICA) and the Department for Disaster Prevention and Management (DDPM); and supported the training of National Audit Commission representatives in tsunami-affected countries.

At the time of the disaster, OCHA helped to ensure an effective working relationship between the UNCT and the government and promoted the flow of information within the UN system and with external actors. During the course of 2005, the regional office ensured that issues relating to natural disasters remained on the agenda and strengthened collaboration between stakeholders in the region, including national governments.

Thailand was not initially seen as a priority country and was not a direct participant in the flash appeal, which limited the funding that was made available. The need for OCHA involvement in coordination of the tsunami response in Thailand was also limited by the prior existence of strong national coordination structures.

TSUNAMI RESPONSE—LESSONS LEARNED

173

In the context of the tsunami response, a number of evaluations and lessons learned exercises were conducted. During 2006, OCHA will address the specific recommendations and lessons learned that can be taken on board as well as considering the wide range of evaluations conducted in the service of strengthening the broader humanitarian response to crises.

OCHA's internal tsunami lessons learned exercise revealed that the time taken to put out a Flash Appeal for the tsunami, at 11 days, was too slow, given the rapid peak of media interest and the fact that donors generally expect an idea of the funds required to respond in the initial days after a disaster. However, the Tsunami Evaluation Coalition (TEC) needs assessment report stressed that even this appeal was not based on solid needs assessment and that it should be acknowledged that many donors and the public took funding decisions not based upon the appeal but upon the information provided by the media. In hindsight,

an earlier appeal probably would have been just as effective and more timely, while a more substantive needs assessments could have followed later. An internal lessons learned review has suggested that OCHA review the timeliness and the content of future Flash Appeals in the context of this experience.

The tsunami lessons learned review also found that internal coordination mechanisms between New York and Geneva needed “fine tuning”, a matter that was improved upon but not resolved in the earthquake response in Pakistan. Issues were also identified in relation to the speed and ease of staff deployment, the need for an enhanced emergency roster system, standardised reporting lines and procedures, and the division of tasks between different providers of UN Common Humanitarian Services.

Strong public information and advocacy support, especially in Indonesia, Sri Lanka, New York and

Geneva, a strengthened relationship with external partners, the private sector, effective standby arrangements and the rapid deployment of senior, experienced OCHA managers and UNDAC staff, and the rapid deployment of the HIC were found to have been important, although there were concerns raised in relation to the handover from UNDAC staff after the completion of their missions.

OCHA was also instrumental in setting up the TEC during the first half of 2005. The coalition, which continues to be chaired by OCHA, now includes over 40 UN Agencies, NGOs, donors and non-profit organisations that have agreed to jointly evaluate sector-wide performance. The overall funding for the TEC was well over US\$ 1 million. OCHA was the lead actor in managing and evaluating coordination efforts, which was undertaken by a team of external and independent evaluators, with the support of a steering committee composed of donors and agencies.

By the end of the year, the TEC had identified six critical findings:

- The relief phase was effective in ensuring that the immediate survival needs were met, through a mixture of local assistance in the immediate aftermath and international assistance in the first weeks after the disaster, but these were not based on joint needs assessments and were not well coordinated;
- The scale of the response was unprecedented, which allowed an early shift to rehabilitation and the use of cash assistance programmes, but the scale of funding also created coordination problems since it increased the number of agencies while removing some of the normal incentives for agencies to coordinate activities;
- Local capacity was underestimated, undervalued and possibly undermined;
- The capacity of the international humanitarian system is not sufficiently elastic to be able to scale up with ease to respond appropriately to a large emergency such as the tsunami;
- Agencies focused too much on brand promotion and not enough on the needs of affected populations;
- The recovery phase is a far bigger challenge than the relief phase.

A key challenge for this innovative initiative will be to ensure that the findings and recommendations

result in concrete action and improvements for future emergencies.

The TEC evaluation found that the role of OCHA was pivotal in the tsunami response. Once deployed, OCHA staff did well to set up offices and coordinate humanitarian response efforts. However staff turn over was generally high and experience varied between countries and field posts.

The coordination constraints identified in the evaluation revolved around issues that tend to fall outside OCHA's direct control and are indicative of systematic failings of the humanitarian response community as a whole. The humanitarian system is fragmented into separate UN Agencies and organisations, all of which have their own mandates, governance structures, administrative procedures and reporting lines. It proved difficult at times for the UNCT to reach a consensus on who should coordinate and where.

The proliferation of actors, including NGOs, coupled with the lack of incentives of many of these to coordinate in what was a uniquely resource-rich environment, also affected OCHA's effectiveness. To succeed, OCHA needs full support from partners and authorisation, where due, to insist on minimum standards. Efforts to create an intra-NGO mechanism by ICVA in Indonesia failed because NGOs were unable to reach collective agreement on the proposal. The concept of an OCHA regional coordination from Thailand did not fully succeed, in part because OCHA's UNDAC team had not been invited to assist from the outset. The Thai authorities had the situation there under control very early on. This raises the broader question of whether or not OCHA should deploy UNDAC into a country where there is existing expertise and adequate national/local capacity. In contrast, coordination was relatively straightforward in the Maldives and UN organisations were based together in one compound. OCHA's role was clearly to support the RC/HC there. The recruitment of an OCHA-funded NGO liaison officer in Colombo/Sri Lanka was instrumental in bringing the UN together with its partners. The concept has been praised and should be considered elsewhere too.

The traditional coordination structures also presented problems. As a rule, they were fragmented into sectoral groups, which inhibited integrated planning within any specific geographic area and did not adequately enough address cross-cutting issues such as gender.

OCHA's coordination experience during the tsunami confirms that it should ensure that it focuses on facilitating an effective transition to recovery at the outset of any humanitarian response.

SOUTH ASIA EARTHQUAKE

On 8 October 2005 a massive earthquake, measuring 7.6 on the Richter scale, struck Pakistan, India and Afghanistan at 8.50am local time. This was the most devastating earthquake for a century in the region. In Afghanistan, tremors were felt in Nangarhar and Jalalabad provinces, leading to four deaths and minor building collapses. In India, the worst-hit region was Jammu and India-administered Kashmir, with 1,300 people dead, 7,510 injured and more than 37,600 houses and buildings damaged.

In Pakistan the earthquake completely destroyed 30,000 square kilometres of the North West Frontier Province (NWFP) and Pakistan-administered Kashmir (PAK). The official death toll was over 73,000, with a staggering 69,400 severely injured and some 3.3 million people left homeless. It is estimated that over 3.5 million people were affected, including up to 2.2 million children. The earthquake destroyed 400,000 homes and 230 health facilities as well as many government buildings. Hundreds of doctors, government officials and community leaders died.

In Afghanistan, UNAMA coordinated a rapid relief response with the local government. The Government of India did not request international assistance and coped with a large national response relief and rescue operation managed by the National Crisis Management Committee. The UN Disaster Management Team organised information-sharing on UN and NGO relief activities.

Pakistan

Over 200 international and national relief organisations, including the UN, international organisations, NGOs, EU, NATO and bilateral partners, participated in the humanitarian response alongside the Government of Pakistan and its agencies. Initial interventions focused on search and rescue for earthquake survivors, the provision of first aid and the delivery of relief goods to inaccessible mountainous areas. The difficult terrain, coupled with the fast-approaching winter, meant that the humanitarian response was conducted under great time pressure and posed a major coordination challenge.

Key objectives

- Mobilise and coordinate the emergency relief response in support of the Government of Pakistan, through sustained cooperation and

strong partnerships with all stakeholders

- Support the Humanitarian Coordinator through the establishment of appropriate coordination mechanisms, the development of a strategic emergency response plan and appropriate contingency planning
- Provide strategic and operational guidance through thematic cluster meetings
- Ensure that the international community, donors and the media are kept informed of the situation and challenges in order to maintain engagement and elicit support

Activities

Rapid emergency response coordination was achieved through the deployment of an eight-member UNDAC team to Islamabad on 9 October, and the establishment of a UN reception centre at Islamabad Airport for incoming search and rescue teams. Public information support and civil-military coordination teams arrived soon after to reinforce the team.

To identify priorities, OCHA Pakistan worked closely with the government and other key partners in preparing a Priority Humanitarian Actions document in November, and a 90-day Winter Plan issued in December, to guide efforts in a coherent manner. The Winter Plan aimed to ensure assistance and support for an estimated 350,000 to 380,000 people in remote, high-altitude locations. It also aimed to support an estimated 250,000 people living in camps at lower elevations.

By mid-October, OCHA Pakistan had established humanitarian hubs in four cities in PAK and NWFP, namely in Bagh, Muzaffarabad, Mansehra and Battagram. The Humanitarian Information Centre was established on 14 October 2005, with staff based in Islamabad and the four hubs, to support and complement information management.

OCHA also moved to strengthen coordination mechanisms through the establishment of a reinforced integrated office in Islamabad, containing the key units of Cluster Coordination, Field Support, Civil-Military and Civil Authority Liaison, NGO Liaison, Public Information, Reporting and Analysis, Administration and Finance, and an Emergency Coordination Centre. The OCHA office brought together and continuously updated an overview of

the activities of the international community, available assets and the movement of relief items. OCHA's field presence continually provided much-needed support at the provincial level.

The UN adopted a new relief coordination framework in Pakistan, with the support of OCHA, comprising 10 thematic clusters that brought together a broad range of partners, including the Government of Pakistan and the Pakistani army – with which OCHA worked in close coordination throughout – as well as NATO and NGOs. To mobilise resources for the response, OCHA issued the South Asia Earthquake Flash Appeal three days after the disaster. After a subsequent revision, following more detailed assessments, US\$ 550 million was requested for a six-month period.

The cluster approach was applied to coordinate relief assistance for the first time in Pakistan. Clusters met regularly, initially daily and later weekly, to discuss operational issues, identify gaps, coordinate relief operations and build harmonious strategies. In many cases, OCHA co-chaired cluster meetings with Government of Pakistan counterparts. As expected, the cluster mechanism had teething problems, as lead and partner agencies reduced their visibility to ensure effective implementation and delegated leadership and coordination required continuous strengthening.

The organisation of regular press conferences, joint assessment missions and a number of high-level visits, including by the ERC and the Secretary-General, helped to mobilise the support of the international community. The additional support of OCHA through verbal briefings to all stakeholders, compilation of consolidated overviews, updates, achievement matrixes, press interviews and media queries, daily and weekly press releases, and situation reports kept the wider humanitarian community informed of priority needs, funding status, operational constraints and cluster activities.

In late October, the Flash Appeal was only 12 percent funded. Six months later the pace had picked up and the appeal is now over two-thirds funded, sufficient for current agency relief efforts.

OCHA worked in close collaboration with the Federal Relief Commission (FRC) and the Pakistan Army to help ensure that emergency humanitarian needs of the affected populations, especially those at severe risk, were understood and identified and

appropriate aid delivered, and that sufficient assistance was provided to those in the most remote areas to prevent mass population movements. In doing so, OCHA also facilitated the efforts of donors, UN Agencies, IOM, FRC and NGOs. There were no major outbreaks of disease, and no increase in morbidity and mortality by comparison with pre-earthquake levels. The “second wave of deaths” predicted in many media reports was avoided.

Performance evaluation

Some of the shortcomings identified in early 2005 with regard to the tsunami response were avoided in the Pakistan earthquake operation, according to the findings of a lesson-learning review undertaken by OCHA's Evaluation and Studies Unit.

The Flash Appeal served as the principal resource mobilisation tool for the earthquake response in Pakistan. OCHA, working with the government and its partners, managed to reduce the preparation period for the Flash Appeal from 11 days to three, helping keep the profile of the crisis high in the international media from the very start of the humanitarian operation – although there were concerns that the production of the appeal may have been too quick, cutting short discussions around projects and budgets, and limiting the completeness of data.

The Priority Humanitarian Actions document in November 2005 and 90-day Winter Plan issued in December 2005 established the priorities and provided a common strategy for the response of the humanitarian community. Through chairing the ‘Heads of Cluster meeting’, OCHA helped ensure that gaps were raised and addressed.

Relief assistance, carried out in a rather chaotic operational environment, became more focused and better integrated through OCHA's streamlining of relief coordination using the cluster approach. There were teething problems with its use, especially around analysing national relief capacities, collaborating to best effect with the Pakistan authorities and defining the roles and responsibilities of different IASC partners. The Humanitarian Common Services were particularly challenged by the cluster approach.

Although the experience was too short to measure success, it was already clear at year-end that the

cluster approach was a useful framework for relief coordination and offers significant potential for addressing sectoral gaps and building systemic capacity for humanitarian response. In Pakistan, humanitarian actors lacked sufficient information on and related understanding of the approach and sometimes had difficulty distinguishing between cluster responsibilities and agency functions. Maintaining close communication between the Islamabad clusters and the field clusters was a constant challenge.

The lessons-learning review noted that strengthened advocacy and public information capacity at the field level from the earliest stages of the response, and high-profile missions – including that of the ERC – were considered highly effective and useful, allowing the development of a ‘one voice approach’ within a more focused, strategic communication policy. The establishment of a HIC also created improved access to information through regular mapping and monitoring products that provided an overview of cluster achievements, although a number of necessary improvements to the HIC were identified as required in a joint OCHA/donor mission in early 2006. Despite improvements, UN capacity to provide mass information to the beneficiary population remained uneven and lacking in coordination.

The early deployment of UNDAC and senior, experienced OCHA managers was welcomed, and standby arrangements (such as International

Humanitarian Partnership and airlifts) worked well, but would have benefited from greater capacity. The timely deployment of the HIC module from the UK ensured timely set-up of the HIC.

Concerns remained about the clarity of command and reporting lines; the absence or non-use of specific guidelines and checklists; the sustainable strength of OCHA’s surge capacity; delays with recruitment and deployment of personnel; and certain aspects of internal logistics and supply, including technical support to field bases.

**Pakistan - South Asia Earthquake
Requirements, Income and Expenditure Breakdown**

Requirements	5,795,759 ^a
Income from Voluntary Contributions	4,442,440
EXPENDITURE	
Staff Costs	334,389
Consultant Fees and Travel	76,963
Travel	183,070
Operating Expenses	41,534
Contractual Services	17,349
Supplies, Material, Furniture and Equipment	156,005
Fellowships, Grants and Contributions	-
Programme Support Costs	147,877
Total Expenditure US\$	957,187^b

a Requirements are as follows: Field US\$ 4,641,050, HQ-Geneva Operations US\$ 289,624 and HIC US\$ 865,085

b Expenses are US\$ 712,082 for the field and US\$ 245,105 for the HIC



ANNEXES



OCHA/IRIN

ANNEX I: IN-KIND AND OTHER CONTRIBUTIONS

Other Activities and Events Financed by Governments

OCHA benefited in 2005 from many other in-kind contributions from donor countries that sponsor a variety of activities like UNDAC training (induction and refresher courses), deployment of additional support staff, additional funds to sponsor UNDAC members from developing countries, and so forth.

A detailed list of in-kind contributions by donor country is presented below:

Australia	Asia-Pacific Humanitarian Partnership
Austria	UNDAC Africa-Europe Refresher, Salzburg, September
CDERA*	OSOCC Training, Montserrat, June - sponsorship of participants
Canada	Supporting deployment of developing country UNDAC team members on UNDAC missions through the Canada UNDAC Mission Account
China	Asia-Pacific Humanitarian Partnership
Denmark	OSOCC Training, Denmark, November
Estonia	OSOCC Training, April International Humanitarian Partnership - mission support INSARAG Global USAR Team Leaders Meeting, November
Finland	IHP Support Staff Refresher Training Course, Kupio, October
Germany	INSARAG Antenna for the Middle East and North Africa
India	INSARAG Asia-Pacific Regional Meeting, Delhi, September
Japan	Asia-Pacific Humanitarian Partnership Regional Disaster Response Advisor (RDRA) based in Kobe Hosted and maintained the Office of the RDRA Radio Project, IRIN. Human Security Trust Fund The Brookings-Bern Project in Internal Displacement. Human Security Trust Fund
Korea	Asia-Pacific Humanitarian Partnership
Netherlands	International Humanitarian Partnership
New Zealand	Asia-Pacific Humanitarian Partnership
Norway	International Humanitarian Partnership - mission support Offer of use of national UNDAC Mission Account to deploy developing country UNDAC team members on UNDAC missions
Singapore	Asia-Pacific Humanitarian Partnership - APHP Training Course & Technical Meeting/Exercise, Singapore, May-June UNDAC Asia Induction Course, Singapore, August-September
Sweden	Training of Trainers Workshop, Sweden, July Personal equipment for new UNDAC members Funding of insurance cover for UNDAC missions International Humanitarian Partnership - mission support HIC Training – technical support HIC deployments - technical support
Switzerland	UNDAC Europe Induction Course, Lausanne, May Provision of Swiss plane to transport first UNDAC team to Pakistan INSARAG Africa-Europe Regional Group Meeting and Steering Committee Meeting, Geneva, April
Tunisia	INSARAG Awareness Module, Tunisia, April
UK	OSOCC Training, Montserrat, June - sponsorship of participants International Humanitarian Partnership - mission support Provision and transport of the Heavy Module (technical equipment) to emergency HIC deployments HIC Training, UK, June
USA	OSOCC Training, Montserrat, June

* Caribbean Disaster Emergency Response Agency

ASSOCIATED EXPERTS PROGRAMME (JPOs)

	HQ	HQ	Field	TOTAL
Country	New York	Geneva	Offices	
Denmark	1	1	-	2
Norway	1	1	2 ISDR Tajikistan, ISDR Kenya	4
Italy	2	1	-	3
Finland	-	1	-	1
Sweden	-	1	1 DRC	2
Switzerland	2	-	-	2
Germany	-	1	-	1
Netherlands	-	-	3 Senegal, South Africa, Colombia	3
France	1	2	-	3
Japan	1	-	-	1
United Kingdom	-	1	-	1
Republic of Korea	1	-	-	1
TOTAL US\$	9	9	6	24

Other humanitarian organisations also support OCHA by seconding staff to the field offices, namely: Outscore, DFID, Norwegian Refugee Council, Oxfam, SIDA and SRSA.

ANNEX II: AFGHANISTAN AND THE AFGHANISTAN EMERGENCY TRUST FUND (AETF)

In 2005, OCHA, through the Coordination and Response Division and the Administrative Office, continued to support the Office of the Deputy Special Representative of the Secretary-General (DSRSG) for Relief, Recovery and Reconstruction within the United Nations Assistance Mission to Afghanistan (UNAMA). Within the auspices of an integrated mission, the DSRSG functions also as the RC/HC.

Although the focus in Afghanistan has clearly moved on to reconstruction, the humanitarian situation remains volatile three years after the end of the war. Nearly 6.5 million Afghans remain food insecure, approximately half of them chronically and half seasonally. Some 150,000 IDPs remain of concern due to drought, insecurity and land issues as obstacles to return, while Afghans also face continued large-scale population displacements, a degraded environment prone to natural disasters, limited access to basic services, vulnerable livelihoods and pockets of intense insecurity or violent conflict.

While the transition to recovery and reconstruction has been gaining momentum, many inequalities

between provinces and serious humanitarian concerns remain.

Therefore, although OCHA does not maintain an independent office, it continues to support the office of the DSRSG/RC/HC in its coordination of humanitarian affairs, including in relation to: advocacy and donor liaison, civil-military relations, surge capacity requirements, natural disaster management and preparedness, and advice on internal displacement, protection and assistance.

The OCHA-funded staff support throughout the year consisted of one humanitarian affairs officer, one IDP advisor, one civil-military affairs officer, two programme/ finance officers, and three senior humanitarian affairs officers heading UNAMA regional offices. The staff presence will be scaled down further in 2006.

Programme Activities Implemented by UNAMA

In line with the two Memoranda of Understanding between OCHA and UNAMA, two programme activities continued to be implemented in 2005.

MoU I relates to the utilisation of 7.8 million euro contributed by the Netherlands to support NGO relief and rehabilitation activities. This funding provided resources to immediately assist emergency and rehabilitation needs in communities in Afghanistan by contracting NGOs, either local or international.

A total of 48 projects in nine areas of activity (livelihoods, resettlements, rehabilitation, research, health, capacity building, education, disaster management, and media) were financed under this arrangement.

A small amount of funding remaining at the end of 2005 has been programmed for one final road construction project, and activities under the MOU are due to be completed by 31 August 2006. A request for extension of the MoU is with the donor.

MoU II relates to the use of US\$ 15.2 million for humanitarian and economic development activities, in line with the original mandate of the Afghanistan Emergency Trust Fund. The funding has been derived from the Miscellaneous and Interest Income accumulated in the AETF during its 15-year existence, as well as some remaining voluntary contributions by donors.

By the end of 2005, approximately US\$ 13.7 million had been programmed by UNAMA under this MoU, against 68 projects through a broad cross-section of organisations in various regions of Afghanistan. The areas of activity included capacity building, disaster preparedness and information management.

As foreseen, constraints in access to certain parts of the country, either due to insecurity or severe weather conditions, delayed the implementation of some projects. Thus, the MoU has been extended to 31 December 2006.

Financial Analysis of the AETF for the Year 2005

The full amount available for MoU I, amounting to US\$ 8,398,377, has been programmed by UNAMA. Accumulated expenditures of US\$ 8,077,161 were recorded against that MOU as at the end of 2005.

For MOU II, allotments of US\$ 13,647,020 have been done by OCHA. Accumulated expenditure of US\$ 4,467,958 was recorded against that MoU by the end of 2005. The balance is to be re-phased

for 2006. US\$ 1,552,980 is available for further programming towards activities outlined in the MoU.

The Afghanistan Emergency Trust Fund was also used to support the Afghanistan-related activities of the Integrated Regional Information Networks (IRIN).

The available balance in the AETF at the end of the year was US\$ 5,447,469. The commitments and outstanding advances against the fund as of 31 December 2005 are detailed in the accompanying table.

Statement of Income and Expenditure Summary of the Afghanistan Emergency Trust Fund US\$

1 Opening Balance	22,004,279
2 Adjustments	-
3 Income from Contributions	-
4 Transfers, refunds, savings	(1,027,034)
5 Other Funds Available	676,130
6 Total Funds Available	21,653,375
7 Expenditure	4,754,090
8 Closing balance	16,899,285

Income and Expenditure Breakdown

Income from Voluntary Contributions	-
EXPENDITURES	
Staff Costs	1,812,447
Consultant Fees and Travel	-
Travel	148,380
Operating Expenses	1,322,096
Contractual Services	782,162
Supplies, Material, Furniture and Equipment	522,264
Fellowships, Grants and Contributions	-
Programme Support Costs	166,741
Total Expenditure US\$	4,754,090

Reserves and Fund Balances

as at 31 December 2005	16,899,285
Outstanding Advances and Commitments against MOU I with UNAMA	321,216
Outstanding Advances and Commitments against MOU II with UNAMA	10,732,042
Outstanding Advances with Mine Action NGOs	122,911
Unallocated Mine Action Funds to be transferred to UNMAS	122,911
Other Outstanding Advances	152,736
Balance of Funds for other activities in 2006 US\$	5,447,469

ANNEX III: CENTRAL EMERGENCY REVOLVING FUND (CERF)

The CERF continued to maintain a solid financial standing during 2005. A total of US\$ 36,497,241 was advanced during the year for eight operations that continued to use the CERF, driven primarily by the magnitude of emergencies that require a system-wide response.

Crisis	Agencies involved	Total amount US\$
Sudan/Chad (7 requests)	WHO, UNICEF, UNHCR, DPKO/UNMAS, UNOG	25,493,300
Niger (2 requests)	WHO, FAO	1,308,000
Pakistan (2 requests)	IOM, OCHA/PAKISTAN	4,195,941
Burundi (1 requests)	UNHCR	5,000,000
DRC	WHO	500,000
		36,497,241

In 2005, WHO requested four advances, UNICEF two, UNHCR two, and IOM, UNOG, FAO, DPKO/UNMAS and OCHA/Pakistan one each.

The largest recipient of these advances was Sudan with US\$ 21,872,000, which represented 60 percent of the funds requested from the CERF. Five agencies requested funds for Sudan: UNICEF, UNHCR, WHO, DPKO/UNMAS and UNOG.

Burundi, with UNHCR requesting, received US\$ 5 million, which represents 14 percent of the funds requested.

Pakistan received US\$ 4,195,941, representing 12 percent. Those funds were requested by IOM and OCHA Pakistan.

Chad received US\$ 3,621,300, representing 10 percent, with the request from UNICEF.

US\$ 1,308,000 went to Niger, requested by FAO and WHO, for a total four percent of the use of the CERF.

DRC received one advance of US\$ 500,000, requested by WHO, which represents one percent of the total use of the CERF.

During 2005, UNICEF was the agency which requested the highest volume of funds for a total of US\$ 14,893,300 (41 percent). UNHCR requested US\$ 10 million (27 percent), WHO US\$ 6 million, (16 percent), OCHA Pakistan US\$ 3,195,941 (9 percent), IOM US\$ 1 million (3 percent), FAO US\$ 808,000 (2 percent), UNOG and DPKO/UNMAS US\$ 300,000 each (representing less than 1 percent of the total.)

By the end of 2005, US\$ 4.61 million (12 percent) had been reimbursed. US\$ 15,393,300 (43 percent) is to be paid during the first quarter of 2006 and US\$ 16,195,941 (45 percent) is to be paid in the last quarter of 2006.

The Central Emergency Response Fund

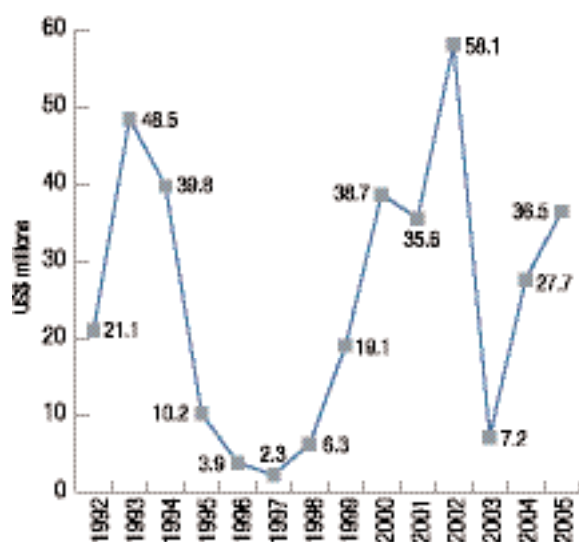
The enhanced Central Emergency Response Fund (CERF) is a stand-by fund established by the United Nations to enable more timely and reliable humanitarian assistance to victims of natural disasters and armed conflicts.

The CERF was approved by consensus by the United Nations General Assembly on 15 December 2005 to achieve the following objectives:

- promote early action and response to reduce loss of life
- enhance response to time-critical requirements
- strengthen core elements of humanitarian response in under funded crises

The CERF will have up to US\$ 500 million, including a grant facility of up to US\$ 450 million and a loan facility of US\$ 50 million. The CERF is funded by voluntary contributions from around the globe from

CERF Utilisation 1992-2005



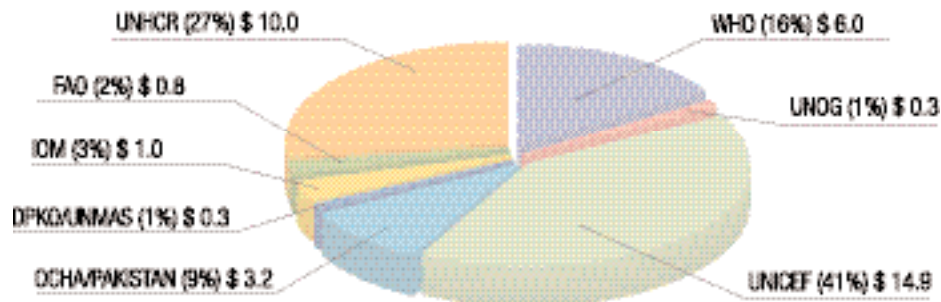
Member States of the United Nations, private businesses, foundations and individuals.

The Fund is managed by the Emergency Relief Coordinator (ERC), on behalf of the United Nations Secretary-General. The Fund allows the UN to react immediately when a disaster strikes by making funding available for life-saving activities to eligible

agencies, including the UN and its funds, programmes and specialised agencies, and IOM.

CERF is intended to complement – not to substitute – existing humanitarian funding mechanisms such as the UN Consolidated Appeals. The CERF provides seed funds to jump-start critical operations and fund life-saving programmes not yet covered by other donors.

CERF Utilisation per agency 2005 US\$ millions



The Grant and Loan Facilities

United Nations and its funds, programmes and specialised agencies, as well as the International Organisation for Migration (IOM), are eligible for both grants and loans.

The components have a number of distinct features:

GRANT FACILITY

- Up to US\$ 450 million, depending on voluntary contributions received
- Established in December 2005 by the United Nations General Assembly
- Allows the Emergency Relief Coordinator (ERC) to ensure coverage of life-saving programmes when funds are not available from other sources
- Used to allocate funds to UN operational agencies to address critical humanitarian needs based on priorities established under the leadership of the RC/HC in the field
- Each applicant must justify the need for funds, taking into consideration other available resources. If a donor pledge is forthcoming, the loan facility should be used

LOAN FACILITY

- US\$ 50 million available
- Established in 1991 as the Central Emergency Revolving Fund. The Revolving Fund is now managed separately as part of the upgraded Central Emergency Response Fund
- Used to make loans to UN Agencies for emergency programmes based on indications that donor funding is forthcoming
- Loans must be reimbursed within six months.
- US\$ 337 million was disbursed in loans over the last 14 years
- Primarily used as a cashflow mechanism, allowing UN Agencies to access funds rapidly while they are waiting for donor pledges to be transferred

Acronyms

ADRC	Asian Disaster Reduction Center	FSS	Field Support Section	NSDR	National Secretariat for Disaster Reduction
ADRRN	Asian Disaster Reduction and Response Network	FTS	Financial Tracking Service		
AERC	Assistant Emergency Relief Coordinator			OCHA/CR	Office for the Coordination of Humanitarian Affairs Central Register
AGEE	International Advisory Group on Environmental Emergencies	G 8	Group of 8 Countries	ODI	Overseas Development Institute
AIMB	Advocacy and Information Management Branch	G-77	Group of 77 Countries	ODSG	Office for the Coordination of Humanitarian Affairs Donor Support Group
ALNAP	Active Learning Network for Accountability and Performance of the ODI	GBRR	Government's Bureau for Recovery and Reconstruction	OECD	Organisation for Economic Cooperation and Development
		GHD	Good Humanitarian Donorship	OECD/DAC	Organisation for Economic Cooperation and Development/ Development Assistance Committee
AMIS	African Union Mission in Sudan	GHDIG	Good Humanitarian Donorship Implementation Group	OFDA	United States Office for Foreign Disaster Assistance
APHP	Asia-Pacific Humanitarian Partnership	GIS	Geographical Information System	OHCHR	Office of the High Commissioner for Human Rights
AU	African Union	GIST	Geographic Information Support Team	OHRM	Office of Human Resources Management
ATCEHI	Advanced Training on Coordination and Emerging Humanitarian Issues	GPPAC	Global Partnership for the Prevention of Armed Conflict	OIOS	Office for Internal Oversight Services
		GPID	Guiding Principles on Internal Displacement	ONUB	United Nations Peacekeeping Mission in Burundi
Austcare	Australia Care				
		HAC	Humanitarian Affairs Commission	PBC	Peace Building Commission
BCPR	Bureau of Crisis Prevention and Recovery	HAC	Humanitarian Area Coordinator	PBSOS	Peace Building Support Office in the Secretariat
BCRF	Budgetary Cash Reserve Fund	HAO	Humanitarian Affairs Officer		
		HAP	Humanitarian Action Plan	RB	Regular Budget
CAP	Consolidated Appeals Process	HC	Humanitarian Coordinator	RC	Resident Coordinator
CAR	Central African Republic	HCC	Humanitarian Communication Centre	RC/HC	Resident Coordinator/Humanitarian Coordinator
CDERA	Caribbean Disaster Emergency Response Agency	HCS	Humanitarian Common Service	RDRA	Regional Disaster Response Advisor
CENTCOM	Coalition Central Command	HDCS	Humanitarian and Development Coordination Section	ROTA	Recovery-Oriented Transitional Assistance
CEPRENAC	Coordination of Natural Disaster Prevention in Central America	HFA	Hyogo Framework for Action	RRF	Rapid Response Fund
		HFDRR	Hyogo Framework for Disaster Risk Reduction	RSERG	Register of Stockpiles of Emergency Relief Goods
CERF	Central Emergency Revolving Fund	HIC	Humanitarian Information Centre	RSG	Office of the Representative of the Secretary General
CERF	Central Emergency Response Fund	HIMN	Humanitarian Information Management Network		
CHAP	Common Humanitarian Action Plan	HIN	Humanitarian Information Network	SAHIMS	Southern Africa Humanitarian Information Management Network
CM Coord	Civil-Military Coordination	HIV/AIDS	Human Immuno-Deficiency Virus/Acquired Immuno-Deficiency Syndrome	SART	Search and Rescue Team
CMCS	Civil-Military Coordination Section			SC	Security Council
CORE-SYS	Country Recovery Information System (CORE-SYS)	HLPR	Housing Land and Property Rights	SE	Special Envoy
CPA	Comprehensive Peace Agreement	HLWG	Humanitarian Liaison Working Group	SG	Secretary General
CPAA	Comprehensive Peace Agreement in Accra	HOC	Humanitarians Operations Centre	SIDA	Swedish International Development Agency
CPN/M	Communist Party of Nepal/Maoists	HPD	Humanitarian Programming Document	SMT	Security Management Team
CRD	Coordination Response Division	HRF	Humanitarian Response Funds	SMT	Senior Management Team
CRDMC	Central Register of Disaster Management Capacities	HRR	Humanitarian Response Review	SOP	Standard Operating Procedure
		HSTF	Human Security Trust Fund	SRA	Senior Recovery Advisor
				SRCC	Sudan Relief and Rehabilitation Commission
DA	Dynamic Atlas				
DCG	Development Coordination Group	IAET	Inter-Agency Emergency Telecommunications	TCPTDRMO	Tampere Convention on the Provision of Telecommunication Resources for Disaster Mitigation and Relief Operations
DDRP	Disarmament Demobilisation and Reintegration Programme	IAHCC	Inter-Agency Humanitarian Coordination Committee	TS	Transitional Strategy
DERC	Deputy Emergency Relief Coordinator	IASC	Inter-Agency Standing Committee	TWG	Technical Working Group
DFID	Department for International Development, (UK)	IATFDR	Inter-Agency Task Force on Disaster Reduction		
DHC	Deputy Humanitarian Coordinator	ICC	International Criminal Court	UAE	United Arab Emirates
DHP	Darfur Humanitarian Profile	ICP	International Conference Process	UK	United Kingdom
DHS	Demographic and Health Survey	ICRC	International Committee for the Red Cross	UNCMCoord	United Nations Civil-Military Coordination
DMC	Disaster Management Capacities	ICT	Information and Communications Technology	UNCT	United Nations Country Team
DMP	Disaster Management Plan	IDD	Internal Displacement Division	UNDAC	United Nations Disaster Assessment and Coordination
DMS	Disaster Management Strategy	IDP	Internally Displaced Persons	UNDAF	United Nations Development Assistance Framework
DMT	Disaster Management Team	IFRC	International Federation of Red Cross and Red Crescent Societies	UNDMT	United Nations Disaster Management Team
DPA	Department of Political Affairs			UNDP	United Nations Development Programme
DPKO	Department of Peacekeeping Operations	IHL	International Humanitarian Law	UNDRO	United Nations Disaster Relief Coordinator
DPRK	Democratic People's Republic of Korea	IHP	International Humanitarian Partnership	UNDSS	United Nations Department of Safety and Security
DRC	Danish Refugee Council	IM	Information Management	UNEG	United Nations Evaluation Group
DRM	Disaster and Risk Management	IMF	International Monetary Fund	UNEP	United Nations Environmental Programme
DRPC	Disaster Response Preparedness and Coordination	IMR	Integrated Management Resources	UNER	United Nations Emergency Roster
		IMT	Integrated Missions and Transition	UNHCR	United Nations High Commission for Refugees
ECHA	Executive Committee on Humanitarian Affairs	IMU	Information Management Unit	UNJLC	United Nations Joint Logistics Center
ECHO	Humanitarian Aid Department of the European Commission	INGO	International Non-Governmental Organisation	UNHRD	United Nations Humanitarian Response Depot
ECOSOC	Economic and Social Council	INSARAG	International Search and Rescue Advisory Group	UNIHAG	United Nations Inter-agency Humanitarian Advocacy Group
ECOWAS	Economic Community of West African States	IRIN	Integrated Regional Information Networks	UNMIS	United Nations Mission in Sudan
ECPS	Executive Committee on Peace and Security	IRP	International Recovery Platform	UNORC	Office of the United Nations Recovery Coordinator
EEP	Environmental Emergencies Partnership	ISDR	International Strategy for Disaster Reduction	UNTS	United Nations Transitional Strategy
EFCT	Emergency Field Coordination Training			UNV	United Nations Volunteer
ELN	National Liberation Army (Columbia)	JEERP	Joint Environmental Emergency Response Plan	USG	Under-Secretary-General
ELRF	Emergency Logistics Response Facility	JPT	Joint Planning Team	USRT	Urban Search and Rescue Team
EMERCOM	Russian Ministry of Emergencies				
EPRT	Emergency Preparedness and Response Training	LAC	Latin America and the Caribbean	VAC	Vulnerability Assessment Committee
ERC	Emergency Relief Coordinator	LRA	Lord's Resistance Army (Uganda)	VOSOCC	Virtual On-Site Operations Coordination Center
ERR	Emergency Response Roster				
ERTF	Emergency Response Task Force	M&E	Monitoring and Evaluation	WB	World Bank
ESB	Emergency Services Branch	MCDA	Military and Civil Defence Assets	WCDR	World Conference on Disaster Reduction
EU	European Union	MDGs	Millennium Development Goals	WEF	World Economic Forum
EUMS	European Union Military Staff	MINUSTAH	United Nations Stabilisation Mission in Haiti	WFP	World Food Programme
EWS	Early Warning System	MONUC	United Nations Organisation Mission in the Democratic Republic of the Congo	WWW	Who Does What Where
FAO	Food and Agriculture Organisation	MOSS	Minimum Operating Security Standards		
FARC	Revolutionary Armed Forces (Colombia)	MOU	Memorandum of Understanding		
FAS	Field Accounting System	MS	Member States		
FIDMS	Field Document Management System				
FCRF	Field Coordination Reserve Fund	NAF	Needs Assessment Framework		
FIMS	Field Information Management Strategy	NATO	North Atlantic Treaty Organisation		
FIO	Field Information Officer	NDMP	National Disaster Management Plan		
FN	Forces Nouvelles (Côte d'Ivoire)	NEMC	National Emergency Management Centre		
FNL	Front National de Libération (Burundi)	NGO	Non-Governmental Organisation		
FSAU	Food Security Analysis Unit	NRC	Norwegian Refugee Council		

OCHA ANNUAL REPORT 2005 ACTIVITIES AND USE OF EXTRABUDGETARY FUNDS

OFFICE FOR THE COORDINATION OF HUMANITARIAN AFFAIRS



United Nations